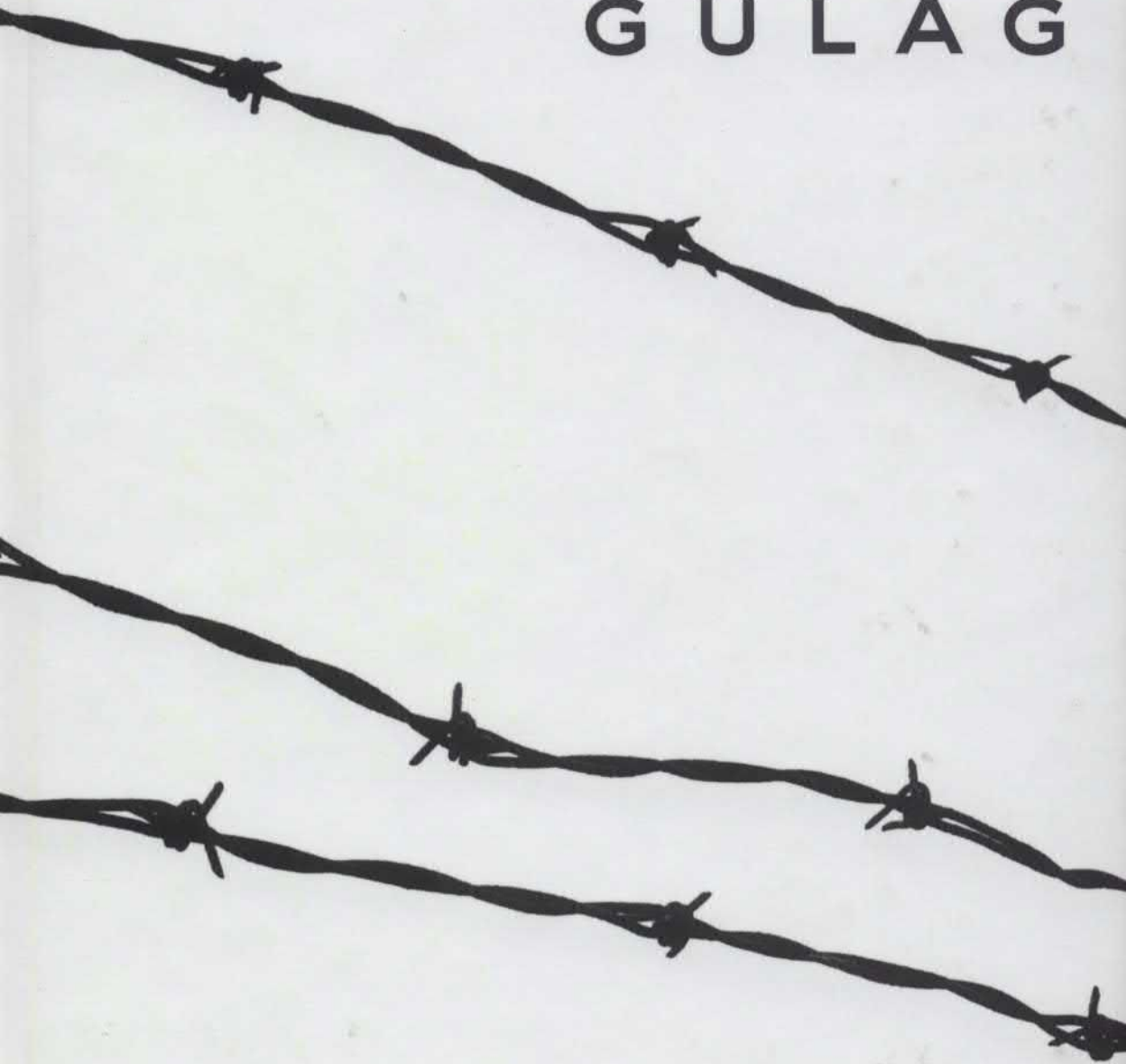


THE DEMOCRATIC GULAG



Patriarchy, Leadership & Education

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INTRODUCTION

This book is about patriarchy—its evolution, expression, and dominance as a social ideology—the patriarch of all other ideologies that continues to influence and direct our social beliefs, values, attitudes, and behaviors, despite numerous assertions to the contrary. It is the culmination of a lifetime of experience and work as a full-time educator in elementary schools and a career-long part-time pursuit of academic study during which I reflected deeply upon why our world and social experience are so dysfunctional, dissatisfying, and problematic.

In modern Western society we exist in a “democratic gulag”—a mythological prison of ideas, values, and beliefs constructed within a historical tradition of patriarchy, religion, leadership, education, politics, and capitalism that has been refined to the point that we no longer question the prison or its bars; they have become all but invisible to us (Lerner, 1986). Patriarchy has become deeply embedded in our human conscience and has *become* our consciousness (A. Johnson, 2005).

Like modern Western democracies, our institutions and organizations are built on a foundation of patriarchal values, beliefs, and attitudes about power, economics, religion, and leadership. These values, for example, have created our contemporary capitalist democracy—a concept that has heavily

influenced what we perceive as democracy and that is dramatically different from a substantive, participatory democracy. It has also deeply influenced our education system and everything else in society. Understanding patriarchy demands that we understand its integrated and integrating influence on all major social institutions and every detail of our everyday life. We currently live in an elaborate democratic gulag built on domination, control, and violence—a biased, complex, and patriarchal ideological prison as real as the Soviet gulag described by Alexander Solzhenitsyn but far more insidious in its effects because for all intents and purposes we are not aware that it exists (A. Johnson, 2005). It is constructed of distorted conceptions related to democracy and a democratic way of life, leadership, education, religion, politics, and gender relationships that we accept as normal. We have been progressively socialized to accept these values without question or resistance. This contemporary prison is not made of concrete and steel but self-made abstract ideas where the reality of the patriarchy that underlies them has been disguised to create a superficial illusion of democratic freedom. Western democracy is an unrealized concept—the prison exercise yard of a much larger ideal world experience. We have become complacent in the West about democracy and its meaning and we have rarely, if ever, looked critically and seriously at the concept in its modern incarnation. As Rueshemeyer (2001) states, true democracy contains a different view of power:

Democracy is a matter of power. It is an approximation of equality in the political sphere of collective decision making, however imperfect in reality. A certain balance of power in society is a necessary precondition for democracy. In particular, democracy comes about and gains in quality if previously weak groups and classes gain in power (Rueschemeyer, Stephens, and Stephens, 1992). (p. 80)

In contrast, patriarchal democracy contains a significant imbalance of power. The influences of patriarchy for the most part are gender biased, negative, destructive, adversarial, and violent and restrict the ability of modern society to imagine or achieve true autonomy or to move past their control to a more formally empowered democratic, collective, and sustainable human belief system that gives primacy to all life and its right to control its own individual and collective fate, free from the intimidating, exploitative influences and the socially blinded self-awareness that patriarchy has spawned. Patriarchy is not only a dysfunctional and destructive ideology in its own right but also actively suppresses the ability of society to achieve real democratic

freedom. Achieving a fuller humanity is about looking beyond patriarchy to envision what a post-patriarchal world would and could look like, and why it is critically important that we realize this goal.

Patriarchy is the universal, defining paradigm of social history that has been evolving and growing for thousands of years, always beneath the surface of human interaction and behind the scenes of human activity (A. Johnson, 2005). It requires and deserves our full attention as a society, as individuals, as men and women, and as a human species because it determines who we are, how we behave, what we believe, and how we act. All social behavior and structures are governed or influenced by it, either abstractly or physically. Gender relations, family dynamics, economics, history, politics, culture, leadership, education, or religion—no major theory, practice, or belief (including matriarchy) has been untouched by patriarchy. We are caught in what Eldstrom (1992) refers to as “paradigm paralysis” where we cannot break out of one ideological paradigm to envision anything new:

Paradigms are common and most often useful; however, there are occasions when a paradigm becomes “the” paradigm. When this occurs the phenomenon is referred to as “paradigm paralysis.” This paralysis is a disease; a disease of certainty wherein one believes that the paradigm is the only way, the right way, the unchangeable way. New ideas, new concepts, and new theories cause concern and create tension within the paradigm. New ideas are met with resistance and changes are seen as a threat to the status quo. Individuals who strive to create new paradigms are usually outside the old paradigm. (p. 3)

Paradigm paralysis and patriarchal ideology are synonymous. Beliefs that have crystallized in one form or another and become dominant and unwilling to change are ideologies that resist reason or modification. We have been in a patriarchal paradigm paralysis for most of human history. Generation after generation have been socialized into its ways and mores and dutifully and unquestioningly have taken their place and played their role in its ideological value pyramid that ranks individuals, groups, races, and genders and all living species in a complex hierarchical order of power, valuing, and dominance (Daly, 1978 cited in Walby, 1990; A. Johnson, 2005). However, people throughout time have also aggressively resisted patriarchy as a social currency, including women—even if they have done so unsuccessfully while being ignored by the annals of history. The lives of billions of people throughout time have been given up rejecting the ideology of patriarchy. Throughout the ages people have harbored significant misgivings and

doubts about its fundamental validity and efficacy (Eisenstein, 1999). Those who oppose it far outnumber those who support it, yet through the power of force and numbers, patriarchy has prevailed. It imposes its dominance by depending on each level of the hierarchy to acquiesce to its demands and to ensure their relative control over those below them to maintain or advance their position in the hierarchy of valuing that patriarchy creates (A. Johnson, 2005; Lerner, 1986; Miller, 2003). Patriarchy creates an ideological caste system in society. It has evolved into a complex matrix of benefits and deficits that maintain its allure. The balance between the positive and negative perceived effects must always be slightly tilted in favor of the former to maintain social stability and support for patriarchy—sometimes referred to as “pareto optimality” in other applications—a view expressed by the Italian economist Vilfredo Pareto that held that, in sum, more people must benefit from a change than not for it to be ethically valid and supported (Dunleavy & O’Leary, 1987). It also holds that improvements in another’s condition can only come if not at the expense of others, which is most often not the case within capitalism. Unfortunately, this view describes a divided, polarized society that is constantly in competition to gain ground.

Patriarchy is a self-sustaining and self-perpetuating system. We witness its power in the adherence of both men and women to its archaic dogmatic dictums; in the social relations of their respective faiths and their cultural and domestic relations; their approach to employment, and their willing acceptance of its inequities within their own familial relationships. While at various times and in various ways women in particular have railed against the injustices of patriarchy and brought superficial changes to its application, by and large they have willingly acquiesced to and colluded in its dominance and tacitly accepted its controlling influence (Lerner, 1986; Ng, 1991). It has been such an integral and pervasive part of human existence that it operates as an invisible, subconscious backdrop to all human life. It cannot be studied or analyzed in isolation, nor can other topics such as feminism, leadership, economics, politics, religion, or education. They are all an integrated, self-sustaining system that cannot be separated. Any study of patriarchy must necessarily take into account its effects on the other areas as well (J. Acker, 2006). In a similar manner, any study of the latter topics must necessarily take into account patriarchy, yet it is rarely mentioned in connection with these concepts. The oppressive reality and enormous power of patriarchy is revealed in its complexity, and in its ability to convince society that its influence is negligible.

The study of patriarchy is crucial to understanding every point in human history because it exposes the underlying forces, relationships, and human motivations that drive our society and have driven our history. Its investigation provides great insight into the origins of social problems. It also helps us to envision a post-patriarchal world. The system that patriarchy promotes generates unhealthy values, attitudes, and beliefs that govern the lives of people everywhere—from the breakfast table to the boardroom table.

The world is in desperate need of a renaissance of renewal that embraces the rights of the majority of humanity as the driving force for social decisions if we are to move toward what Schafer (2008) terms a new “age of culture” (p. 1). This age of culture, as he envisions it, will evolve away from an economic age where current destructive and unsustainable economic values are replaced by broader cultural and social values as the driving force in social decision making. While this is the necessary change required for the future of society it is utopian in its view and neglects the powerful and violent grip of patriarchy and its unrelenting influence on society. While Schafer (2008) correctly acknowledges the age of religion that dominated the Middle Ages, the aesthetic age that dominated the Renaissance and the economic age that currently contextualizes modern society, he fails to acknowledge the crucial role of the millennia-long age of patriarchy that has framed all these periods since the beginning of time as a controlling supra text or supra ideological cocoon. Patriarchy will also appropriate this age of culture and all other successive societal periods unless its pivotal role is recognized and changed. Nothing will change until patriarchy changes. Michael Apple (1995) points this out: “The cultural meanings and practices that grow out of the interaction of gender and class both penetrate to the heart of patriarchal power and class relations, and limit the possibilities for action if they are once again left unorganized” (p. 101).

We have been living in the age of patriarchy for thousands of years of recorded history. We have never known anything else. Throughout this time the male worldview has been tempered but has prevailed. The inertia created by patriarchy is significant and has prevented just such a cultural renaissance from occurring in the past. As French (1985) observes: “To understand a past age is difficult even when written records exist. Documents that are preserved usually serve the interests of the preservers, and all events are reported from a personal—that is to say, biased—perspective” (p. 43). In fact such renaissances when they have occurred have often been colonized by the patriarchal power of primarily male monarchies, military leaders, aristocracies, and economic

elites (Lerner, 1993). In addition, war and conquest have often brutally ended a culture's hiatus. In *The Shock Doctrine: The Rise of Disaster Capitalism*, Naomi Klein (2008) documents the destruction of Iraq by invading U.S. forces whose inaction subsequently allowed the looting and destruction of the Library of Antiquities and with it the cultural memory of the Iraqi people and the world in a misguided effort to remake the country into a new capitalist outpost. Culture has been no protection against primitive and insidious patriarchal brutality—then or now—as we are reminded daily in news reports of ISIL beheadings. If we deal with patriarchy, we deal with all the problems of society at their source rather than attacking interlocking parts of its support system. We also must begin to confront our collective social and personal demons. Engaging patriarchy is not about demonizing males but about demonizing authoritarianism and hierarchical power and control as methods of social expression and organization, whether practiced by males or females. We must re-socialize both genders to think and act differently with each other than they have for the past 5,000 years. As Stegemann (2009) asserts:

So what will this shift from a patriarchal society look like for us and our generation? My prediction is that it will not privilege one gender or the other but harmonize both. The new emerging society will be a society where human beings, both male and female, have the ability to transcend gender stereotypes. All people will live beyond the patriarchal myth of women being tender and men being tough. The myth will no longer control us and people will be free to live authentically and perform right action, rather than simply fulfill cultural expectations. (p. 25)

Stegemann describes a post-patriarchal world that Reich (1974) also postulated as a “work democratic” society, but getting there presents a major challenge for humanity (p. xxiv). Positive ideas, however, are not enough. Like an octopus, we can cut off the leg of economics but patriarchy can continue to function on its other arms of education, religion, politics, domestic and social life, and gender relations. It will simply regrow a new arm of economics to serve its needs as it has in the past—whether it is monarchist, aristocratic, feudalism, or capitalist. To kill the octopus we must target the head of patriarchy to free ourselves from its tentacles (Lerner, 1997; Walby, 1990).

We are no closer today than we ever were to living in a vibrant, ideal, substantive, free democracy because this has never been and never will be the goal of patriarchal societies, values, and cultures; the sooner we realize this, the better. In fact, in the midst of growing radical conservatism, in many ways

we are moving farther away from democracy and toward a re-entrenchment of extremist, neoconservative ideological and theological control promoted under the guise that faith-based, moral, and white superior viewpoints are the only valid alternative for society. The neocon right is no less dangerous than the Islamist militant, the Russian oligarch, or the tyrant monarch. They are all power-hungry extremists who want to impose their self-righteous, deluded patriarchal beliefs on everyone else. In all their forms they are dangerous to the free and democratic evolution of society and a threat to the health and well-being of everyone on the planet. To break the logjam of social progress requires deconstructing patriarchy and its effects across the globe and confronting its influence. It requires overthrowing wealth and power and anachronisms such as monarchies, traditional religion, and dictatorships to allow people everywhere to own their societies and determine their collective directions free from the chains of patriarchal mythology and ideology.

The broader vision suggested here is that we need to move away from a patriarchal age to a "post-patriarchal," "post-heroic," and "post-mythological" age, and toward an "age of equity," an "age of realism," and "age of democracy" that will abandon democratic materialist patriarchy and hegemonic masculine dominance and control as the operative value base of society. It argues that we must move toward a fully developed substantive gender-neutral democracy, the equitable sharing of economic wealth, and real human freedom and egalitarianism as the fundamental rights *and reality* of every person in the world (Osborne, 2001; O'Sullivan, 2001). This society should be based on principles of "deliberative democracy" as expressed by Young (2000) including several "...normative ideals for the relationships and dispositions of deliberating parties, among them inclusion, equality, reasonableness, and publicity" (p. 23) (cited in Mawhinney, 2004, p. 211). This book asserts that we replace individual-centered economics and self-interested individualism with peaceful leadership and collectively focused "peopleship" (Bahlieda, 2008).

Make no mistake, this will require everyone to view their roles vastly differently and to make major adjustments over time to their lifestyles in the future, but it will mean the gradual demise of concentrated wealth, violence, domination, aristocracies of all kinds, religious belief, and self-interested power. These things have no place in a real, open democracy. While we may not be able to ever eliminate the human urge for dominance, we can at least choose not to sanction it. The role of education is paramount in re-socializing the future generations of society into a different positive ethic that eschews violence and inequity for positive socialization and equality for all (Lerner, 1997).

Patriarchy serves the needs of an increasingly small minority as it moves toward its ultimate ideological conclusion and thus the patriarchal age and values are unsustainable and must come to an end. These are not utopian ideals but required directions if humanity is to survive. We live in an unconsummated democracy set in current conceptions of capitalism and consumerism. If we continue on this path we will consume the world's resources in an alarmingly short period of time, placing global humanity in crisis. In many ways with climate change, environmental degradation, economic inequality, and geopolitical strife, the crisis is already upon us. We need to develop sustainable economic, political, religious, and gender relationships that focus on collectivism and not individualism. This direction must be driven by a human uprising of discontent around the globe that will reject the politics of derision, division and confrontation by using the power of their democratic franchise to affirm new, progressive, and fully democratic alternatives that abandon partisan politics for open, democratic, gender-balanced government. This opposition will employ nonviolent, passive methods of resistance and sabotage to expose and reject patriarchy wherever it rears its ugly head and to silently make demands for change known, but they will be made assertively and without compromise as well. No one should mistake passivity for weakness as Gandhi and Martin Luther King Jr. so powerfully demonstrated. This struggle will unfortunately not come easily or without a period of violence and bloodshed generated by the status quo in power against such forces of change since the ruling classes will react viciously and aggressively to such overtures no matter how nonviolently or democratically they are presented—much like we are witnessing currently in Syria and the Ukraine. We have witnessed this also in Libya, Egypt, Iraq, and other countries ruled by repressive dictatorships but we have also seen it in less expressive ways at the G8/20 Summits in Toronto, Seattle, and Quebec and at Guantanamo Bay in Cuba. The ruling right have used intimidation, threats, torture, and death as a political methodology for centuries (Klein, 2008). We live in a “placebo democracy” where freedom of speech and peaceful protest are tolerated as long as they do not change anything (Brookfield, 2005).

These change values, however, must survive and eventually generate the social renaissance in politics, economics, religion, education, and gender relationships that will revolutionize the world as Schafer (2008) suggests. The age of culture must be preceded by a transition to an “age of post-patriarchy” to permit it to flourish. However, to suggest as Schafer (2008) does that this can be accomplished with minimal violence and global struggle is naive.

While this is not the desire of democratic change supporters, it is inevitable in a world that has known no other way of solving problems and suppressing people's desire for freedom for thousands of years. Changing patriarchy means changing the fundamental institutions and relations of power in society, including the patriarchal family, and this is an extremely dangerous proposition as many generations have realized. This means starting over—from the beginning—and rebuilding society from the ground up; as difficult as that may be for us to accept, it is critical to the survival of the human race. It starts with self-awareness.

For thousands of years we have been living in a patriarchal gulag that has controlled and mythologized human experience through a specific male lens and worldview (Lad, 2002) that has so skewed our collective social vision of reality that we have become accustomed to this state, much like the characters living in the movie trilogy *The Matrix*. We willingly allow our own "attentional blindness." We are looking at the problems every day but not seeing them. We look for answers but cannot find them. We have been convinced that the structures of the world are inevitable (French, 1985) while in fact we are living in a dark fantasized reality that defies the superficial assertions of its success. It will take great collective global courage to break free of its grip. In our deepest heart of hearts, people all over the world, including those who perpetrate violence for self-interest, understand that the human race is living a lie of success, progress, and advancement created on the backs and at the expense of millions around the world who are exploited and suffer for the sake of avarice and power so that it can be achieved. This is why capitalism is a corrupt and flawed theory and practice because it cannot function successfully without exploitation, and that is why patriarchy is a predatory ideology that must be changed if society is ever to change. Profit can only be created by taking money out of the system somewhere to create wealth. Success can only be achieved by getting something at the expense of someone else. This is unsustainable as a social credo. It may be the superficial veneer of self-deceit that we project to ourselves, but beneath this lies a disturbing sense that it is wrong and should be changed. Any ideology that justifies violence as part of its beliefs has no moral validity. Patriarchy is the primary religion in the world. As von Werlhof (2007) states:

A true alternative to capitalist patriarchy would have to be an *alterna-depth*. This is to say that scholars would no longer deal with 500 years of capitalism; rather, we would take on 5,000 years of patriarchy! We need to free ourselves from a religion that counts even atheists amongst its followers and that is characterized by a firm

belief in the systems of violence that have defined patriarchy's history since its beginnings. (p. 26)

Von Werlhof (2007) accurately portrays patriarchy as a universal religion of violence. Patriarchy is the only belief system that can make this claim. For the last century we have been living in a democratic capitalist gulag of classical liberal, neoliberal, and neoconservative patriarchal beliefs, attitudes, and values that are a unique, complex, and contradictory amalgam of politics, leadership, technology, economics, religion, media, education, science, and gender relationships that all have the same focus: creating an unfair, unjust social distribution and social valuing based on distorted and unjustifiable male values that have brought great wealth and prestige to a small percentage of society and great suffering to all the rest. We can no longer live in a bubble of Western privilege nor can males live in a bubble of gender dominance. The condition of these two groups is directly linked by the ideology of patriarchy and capitalism. Still, we doggedly cling to their distorted and unjustifiable values while defending what we know to be based on universal deception and a society-wide lie.

The last century has been an age of materialism that has superimposed a thin veneer of wealth and social progress on our Western social experience and disguised a system riddled with massive social, ethical, and moral problems. The significant advances achieved by humankind in the past century have given us a false sense of accomplishment and value to what is often a darkly ironic "free" world that is in many cases directly responsible for the problems and conflict in other parts of the world. We are all culpable. This has skewed our conscience away from the enormous costs of these advances in terms of human suffering, wasted resources, and the degradation of the natural environment while presenting a glowing view of elite society through our media as a representation of how our world looks. These costs are ignored by conventional economic analysis. They are assiduously avoided by those who are responsible for them. While our patriarchal society is often lauded for having achieved great things for a relatively and increasingly smaller segment of humanity, these benefits must be placed in context beside the overwhelming human and global carnage required to produce these triumphs, including the global exploitation of people to serve Western needs, two world wars, numerous proxy wars, and constant localized conflict essentially driven by patriarchally driven ideological differences among men (Lerner, 1997). Regarding the rapid globalization of society and its

attendant problems, Schafer (2008) cites futurist guru Marshall McLuhan's accurate assertion that we all live in a global village, no matter what period of history we live in. This has far deeper meaning than increasing corporate and private wealth. It includes global obligations to everyone on earth. With modern electronic media and communication, people around the globe are beginning to realize how inequitable our global society is. Patriarchy and most recently capitalism have created massive collateral damage throughout history to deliver their promise of social evolution to a select few. It must also lay claim to having visited the greatest destruction and despair on that same humanity. This ideology is morally and spiritually bankrupt and must be disavowed and abandoned by humanity everywhere. It has made fantasy our reality and reality a fantasy. We cannot ignore the massive negative consequences of our patriarchal legacy while only extolling its dubious virtues. We need to take a "sober second look" at our historical social developmental experience through critical eyes and re-evaluate it in terms of its patriarchal reality and its devastating consequences, rather than the romanticizing, mythologizing, and false political civility that currently is the veneer of these ideologies. As a global society we live on the surface—not willing to dig too deep lest we discover who we really are. This is not an issue of right, left, or center but one of human, moral, ethical, and spiritual honesty and survival in creating a civil world where the most important currency is human, not economic and economics in the service of all humanity as the economist Karl Polanyi asserted (McQuaig, 2001). Civilized, controlled behavior has become a perversely twisted and purposely propagated logic disguising the horrendous abuses of the system. For too long our society has willfully ignored, turned a blind eye to, and tacitly endorsed the dark side of patriarchy and the devastation and destruction that are a living part of its legacy while trivializing its impact. Such is the case with charismatic leadership in particular (Begley & Associates, 2000). Human bondage is not the basis upon which democratic societies are built, and we have yet to build a democratic society without it. Much more can be accomplished by people working together than working against each other. Whether the conqueror holds a machine gun, a Bible, a law book, a Koran, or a paycheck, their power wielded over the conquered is the same and carries the same moral responsibility to do no harm. In most cases in our modern world that individual has been male. It is the propensity of the world to gravitate toward ideological inflexibility that has created problems for humankind. As Petras and Veltmeyer (2001) state:

The paradox of the current period of right-wing rule is that while economic exploitation and misery deepen, the Right will continue to play by the “democratic rules.” However, if the popular movements seriously challenge the conditions of exploitation, history teaches us that the Right will most likely shift from free markets and elections to free markets and machine guns. (pp. 154–155)

These events do not occur by accident or coincidence but are a direct result of conscious and unconscious patriarchal relationships; their social, political, educational, and economic structures; and the organizations that support them (O’Sullivan, 2001). This is the complex hegemony of patriarchy. Patriarchy is an intentional choice made by people every day—both consciously and unconsciously—to live and act out patriarchal values in their gender relationships; leadership practices; political, religious, educational, and organizational structures; and intellectual philosophies. They can easily choose fair, equitable, cooperative, and consensual, but for most these values are acted out as a charade to cover manipulative personal agendas. Patriarchy depends on social compliance, whether forced or accepted, to permit it to operate. For most people, if they have a modest amount of personal comfort they are lulled into complacency and have little concern about either how that comfort was achieved or who suffered to provide it. We go about our Western consumerist lives without asking where our goods come from and what price was paid to make them. We “go along to get along” as the expression goes. The less we know, the better. There is a willing suspension of disbelief about the exploitation and human misery that occurs elsewhere to bring us the comforts that accompany our political and economic systems and, as a result, our lifestyle. The success of developed countries (including the West) has been created by conquering and exploiting less developed people around the world, while inflicting cruelty and death on most animal-aquatic and bird species populating our planet, and while consuming finite natural resources at a rapacious rate; it continues to this day. We do not want to know how horses are slaughtered or how people are abused to create our comfortable, materialist lifestyles in the West and thus are complicit in the behavior no less than the Germans who disavowed any knowledge of the death camps. As our legal system is fond of intoning, ignorance of the law is no excuse—nor is ignorance of the iron law of oligarchy (S. Maxcy, 1991). Like Pontius Pilate we wash our hands of the responsibility for the misery of the world; however, anyone who wears a shirt made in Bangladesh, or jeans made in China, or owns electronics made in Taiwan or Japan are culpable in the exploitation of others around the world. We do not want to face the ugly reality that our Western lifestyles are built

on the misery of others around the world (A. Johnson, 2005). Let he who has not worn or used cast the first stone. Everyone who holds an iPhone in their hands holds exploitation.

It is becoming increasingly clear that the social and anthropological life cycle of humankind on earth is rapidly coming to an end as a result of our unrelenting patriarchal evolution, unless we can radically restructure our future. The human misery of the world can be traced directly back to patriarchy and its impact on it. We see it in the worldwide cultural and political divisions, the global cultural, racial, and economic strife and conflict; the growing poverty, the widening gap between the rich and the poor, the rapid destruction of the planet, and the expanding destructive wave of economic globalization that is sweeping the earth (Schafer, 2008). We must envision a post-patriarchal world and begin to demand the changes that will allow us to make that transition before it is too late. Short-term gain may mean long-term extinction. Freeing ourselves from patriarchy will allow the age of culture to blossom. Continuing on the path we are on right now will lead us like lemmings to the cliff's edge. We must shake ourselves out of our deeply dissatisfying materialist reverie and realize that human fulfillment comes from treating others in self-fulfilling ways. This begins in the cradle and ends in the grave. Someone, somewhere, pays the price for capitalism and the limited democracy it provides. Any world founded on principles of elitism, domination, economic greed, violence, and control of one person, gender, or group over another cannot hold any moral validity for civilized societies of the future, nor can it survive without destroying itself. We must find a way to live peacefully and supportively or we may not live at all. We cannot live by dividing society into winners and losers in a zero-sum game of global natural selection through a creeping process of economic and materialist Armageddon. The shock wave from ground zero in England in the late 19th century during industrialization has spread around the world for more than a century, levelling all societies in its path. Ironically, it requires that men take up this challenge to reform the structure from which they benefit for the benefit of future generations of the world. This means that leadership must change dramatically. Those in power must restructure their own male attitudes toward who they are and how they view power, and with it patriarchy, and be enlightened and courageous enough to initiate more fully democratic social systems around the world; this requires real leadership, not status quo leadership. Without their willing cooperation this change will not happen and will not happen peacefully. Men must withdraw from the ideological field of battle and allow real democracy to flourish.

Nothing in society can be analyzed or understood without considering the presence and impact of patriarchy and gender on human relations, yet both act in invisible and subtle ways to influence social experience. To understand present-day society we must understand both the history of patriarchy and its current influence on what we do, how we do it, and why we do it. "The history of patriarchy comprises the history of the world as we have been taught it. It is a history of power" (French, 1985, p. 123). We must be free to write the history of the world as we *want* it. We must also be able to see the observable manifestations of patriarchy in our modern world and guard against their impact on our collective and individual social psyche and our shared future. Much of how patriarchy operates is seemingly innocuous and innocent, but in many ways it is exactly these aspects of patriarchy that are most dangerous because they entrench values, attitudes, and beliefs related to it into our collective consciousness that influence and direct our behavior toward others. The "invisible hand" of Adam Smith's (1965) economics is more the invisible hand of patriarchy. If we can imagine and realize a patriarchal "phallogocentric" (Paechter, 2006) or "phallogocentric" (Tan, 2009) world we can just as easily imagine and realize a more equitable, democratic, and egalitarian post-patriarchal world that shares wealth fairly and is free from arbitrary violence, discrimination, domination and authoritarianism of any kind. We need to learn to oppose and sanction patriarchal authority with the same zeal that we put into maintaining our current corrupt democratic institutions.

THE LEGACY OF PATRIARCHY

Nothing is more despicable than respect based on fear—Albert Camus

Human experience has been characterized by a history of male domination, control, and violence—in short, a history of patriarchy and power (French, 1985; A. Johnson, 2005). Eisenstein (1999) describes the latter's parameters as follows:

Power, or the converse—oppression—derives from both sex and class, and this is manifested through both the material and ideological dimensions of patriarchy and capitalism. Oppression is inclusive of exploitation but reflects a more complex reality. It reflects the hierarchical relations of the sexual division of labor and society. (p. 203)

Although patriarchy is now draped in the clothing of postmodern civilization with all its superficial artifice and guile, it operates in exactly the same way that it did thousands of years ago (French, 1985; A. Johnson, 2005). As feminism has long asserted, the evolution of the separation of the roles of men and women into public and private spheres is a social and patriarchal construct responsible for the historical dialectical tension between the sexes and is entrenched in the gender socialization that pervades human experience

(Gaskell & McLaren, 1991; Lerner, 1986). As Fox (1989) explains, patriarchy is a “system of practices, arrangements and social relations that ensure biological reproduction, child rearing and the reproduction of gendered subjectivity, as well as gender ideology, or the sense of gender identity, itself” (p. 147). It is also responsible for the same tension between all of our societal institutions: religion, politics, economics, education, and culture. Radical and socialist feminists are among a limited number of intellectuals who focus serious attention on patriarchy and its negative impacts on society. Eisenstein (1999) again points out:

Radical feminism offers a criticism of patriarchy through the analysis of sex roles themselves. Patriarchy is defined to mean a sexual system of power in which the male role is superior in possession of power and economic privilege. Patriarchy is the male hierarchical ordering of society. Although the legal institutional base of patriarchy used to be more explicit, the basic relations of power have remained intact. (pp. 202–203)

As she correctly notes, patriarchy has become subsumed within today's world and synonymous with our current social environment despite the absence of its formalized presence. Eisenstein (1999)—like others—makes the connection among patriarchy, gender, power, leadership, education, and economics. These have been the key themes of patriarchal society throughout history and are the key issues this book will critically examine. It will investigate the legacy and meaning of patriarchy for modern society, the evolution of neopatriarchy, and specifically the ongoing effects of patriarchy on leadership and education. These factors and many others are the perfect storm of social evolution that has created our current flawed reality.

What is critical in Eisenstein's (1999) definition is that patriarchy is gender-based and hierarchical. Radical feminist research accurately asserts that it is rooted in male power, domination, and control as well as capitalism (A. Johnson, 2005; von Werlhof, 2007). This association is a critical and often overlooked implication of the dominance of patriarchy and its influence on democracy. These definitions maintain that patriarchal attitudes, values, and beliefs shape our cultural, social, political, and economic decision making, interpersonal relationships, leadership models, religious beliefs, and educational practices. The reciprocal relationship between men and women, the family and society, and production and reproduction defines the lives of women and men everywhere as it has throughout human history (Eisenstein, 1999).

However, the four major theoretical traditions of feminist research—radical, Marxist/Socialist, liberal and dual-systems theory—like many other areas of scholarly investigation in this area, often restrict their focus and their theorizing about patriarchy primarily to the role of men or capitalism or both in the subordination of women or in the case of liberal feminism on generic social factors like sexism, deprivation, or discrimination that hold women back (equal rights etc.) (A. Johnson, 2005; Walby, 1990) rather than viewing it as an all-encompassing, overarching, multidisciplinary ideology that affects everyone—men and women alike—across multiple cultures, histories, religions, economics, geographies, and institutions. The four main feminist theoretical positions limit their validity with this theoretical essentialization of the role of patriarchy and thus leave it under-theorized and our understandings incomplete. These major theoretical traditions fail to fully integrate the key roles of religion, education, and politics in addition to economics and male values in their theoretical constructs and in determining the influence of patriarchy as Walby (1990) attempts to do with her theory of patriarchal structures.

With progress in women's rights over the past century across multiple cultures and institutions there has also been a decline in the criticism of patriarchy and its effects (Gilligan & Richards, 2009). Patriarchy has increasingly become viewed narrowly as a familial anachronism that has been dispatched with the advent of women's rights in the 20th century rather than an invasive and growing meta-ideology (Lerner, 1986; Daly, 1978 cited in Walby, 1990). It continues to benefit only a select few (both male and female) at the top of the social and economic pyramid, yet the reasons for this are rarely attributed directly to patriarchy. It is less about gender than it is about socialized domination and power—by either gender—and how this is employed in social and other relations (Laxer, 1999). Laxer muses about society's limited response to this circumstance: "Should we draw the conclusion that we would be better advised to turn our attention to minor ameliorations of the condition of those around us than to confront and challenge the idea of class-divided society" (p. 251)?

The wellspring of the "domination of the many by the few" as Laxer describes it is the system of patriarchy (p. 251). In practice, patriarchy has been overwhelmingly male, but to this day women who have led have also done so in a patriarchal manner. Ultimately, the contributions of feminist scholars are unhelpful in untangling the pervasiveness of the source of the real problems at the core of society because their viewpoints are often restricted to theoretical silos and marginalized and have not been normalized in academic or popular

views of society (A. Johnson, 2005; Daniels, 2010). This is often due to the morass of cross-disciplinary problems that patriarchy generates like many other areas of research. Scientific rationalism encourages the atomization of academic research through the bureaucratic, hierarchical segmentation and over-specialization of organizations and academic disciplines—a system that works against a comprehensive, integrative response to, and analysis of, its influence that ensures its ongoing supremacy (Lerner, 1997). It is a system of organizational and societal divide-and-conquer that has worked in favor of patriarchal values for centuries. Society spends its time putting out a myriad of small social fires rather than removing the fuel source (A. Johnson, 2005). Men have both consciously and unconsciously manipulated and taken part in its ethos over the history of the world and everyone else has been socialized beneath its umbrella. This has occurred for centuries and centuries for tens of thousands of years (Lerner, 1986; Wong & Sunderman, 2001).

Feminism is also hampered by interdisciplinary biases suffered by all scholarly and other research including this work, written from the perspective of a white, middle-class, North American male (Brookfield, 2005; Capper, 1998). Despite the accuracy of many of the arguments of radical and socialist feminists Apple (1995) points out that they also have been affected by the recognition that their own critiques were often positioned from a privileged white, middle-class, Western perspective that ignored the perspective of black feminists and other marginalized women (Acker, 1994; Daniels, 2010; Lerner, 1997). They are also hampered by the fact that any scholarship that is openly critical of the existing status quo—of academia, education, society, politics, economics, science, organizations or leadership—is quickly marginalized by the dominant and traditional scholarly and other discourses in each of these areas (A. Johnson, 2005). Taking a change position is not an easy task as Copernicus or Galileo or Christopher Columbus discovered (Lerner, 1986).

Nonetheless, the more important point about the variety of theoretical, epistemological, and philosophical scholarly debates and positions about the origins and impact of patriarchy on society is not the differences in theoretical positions themselves or the successful dominance of one or the other but the collective voices that are clamouring for change in our patriarchal world. The diversity of voices is the important issue in research on patriarchy and it is exactly this diversity that reflects the true problematic reality of patriarchy and our struggles to confront it. The real problem is that feminist theories of patriarchy have not resonated with men and women around the globe and change has slowed or been reversed in the emancipation of women

(A. Johnson, 2005). Motivating both men and women to change is the major challenge for theory. Attacking patriarchy and the status quo is also often like shadow boxing because patriarchy has no form, no substance, and no reality beyond that evoked through human interaction. Both sexes have a great deal invested in the current social system and are loathe to fundamentally destabilize it. Despite these difficulties, patriarchy is palpable in every human event we witness. Because it is rooted in genetic sexual differences and the related gender-socialized behaviors between men and women that these generate, patriarchy is as palpable today as it has ever been and forms the ever-present, dominant, and yet transparent ideology of human relations in the 21st century (Eisenstein, 1999). This book will explore its role across the broad spectrum of human experience and its key expression through the critical vehicles of leadership and education.

Where to Start?

The key to changing our civilization lies in understanding patriarchy and its overwhelming control over who we are, how we act, and how we think as a human civilization. This book will employ the perspective of critical theory to evaluate the influence of patriarchy on our modern world (K. Brown, 2006). It is the most dominant yet least critiqued ideology in history because it is a male ideology and as such is rarely open to challenge; it is not viewed as a clear political or religious ideology but rather as a set of normalized relationships between the sexes and in families. Half the world's population does not see patriarchy as a problem (A. Johnson, 2005). At the geopolitical and historical level it has been the values of the dominant, the victorious, and powerful who have coincidentally been, for the most part, men. Brookfield (2005) provides a critical perspective on the meaning of ideology:

Critical theory views ideology as the broadly accepted set of values, beliefs, myths, explanations, and justifications that appears self-evidently true, empirically accurate, personally relevant, and morally desirable to a majority of the populace. The function of this ideology is to maintain an unjust social and political order. Ideology does this by convincing people that existing social arrangements are naturally ordained and obviously work for the good of all. (pp. 40–41)

Thus when ideology is a shared, debated, and contested concept it has relevance and vibrancy, but when individuals or societies become slaves to a particular ideological interpretation, it becomes oppressive and frequently

accepted and tolerated—as it is in the case of patriarchy in many oppressive socialist regimes, like Russia, China, and other authoritarian systems, but is also similarly problematic in Western democracies (A. Johnson, 2005). The moment ideas become crystallized into dogma, they become ideology. Even ideologies such as democracy become oppressive when they no longer are subjected to rigorous scrutiny and the tempering of penetrating critical debate. To a large degree modern democracy is subjected to limited critical scrutiny by Western societies in particular. The ideology of patriarchy conforms to Brookfield's (2005) interpretation. Thus he views ideology as pervasive and cohesive but also covert and manipulative. Ideology is frequently dogmatic although it does not need to be.

Ideology within patriarchy has been this way but ideology within a non-authoritarian society could be equally democratic and positive. Obviously democracy is an ideology that most humans value while the values of dictatorships are ones they revile. Ideologies that suppress human freedom are almost universally rejected by their citizens yet frequently imposed. The latter are almost always the values of patriarchy and yet most modern democracies are also patriarchal. Ideology can also be subtly and covertly oppressive as in the case of Western democracies. Most people unfortunately idolize the ideal with little critical reflection on whether that ideal can be demonstrated in their lives. Ideology generally places value on rigid belief over rational thought and as soon as belief dominates an ideology, it becomes detached from reality and becomes repressive. Most major religions fall into this category. Even though people willingly subordinate themselves to mythical religious figures and beliefs, these values demand unbending adherence from their advocates often to the point of extremism. Rational logic ceases to become a mediating factor.

There are myriad social examples of this process throughout history. The mass brainwashing of the German people during World War II, the equally effective brainwashing of the Cambodian people by Pol Pot, and the actions of Hutus in Rwanda and the Serbs and the Croations during the Bosnian conflict are only several in a litany of human experiences where nations were manipulated into believing in genocidal and anti-Semitic values that led to actions that caused enormous human tragedies. Equally compelling is the phenomenon of St. Vitus' Dance, a temporary madness that took over medieval society, demonstrating the power of suggestive thinking. Wright (2004) in his book *A Short History of Progress* quotes Adolf Hitler as having once gleefully exclaimed, "What luck for the rulers that the people do not think!" (p. 130).

Ideologies can also be informal, positive, and fluid as with the hippie revolution of the 1960s when young people bonded around a loose ideology of sex, drugs, and rock and roll to dramatically transform society but continued to confirm patriarchal attitudes toward sexual freedom. The ideology of peace and love that permeated the thinking of millions of young people at the time brought wide-reaching and fundamental change to post-war North American and global society that persists to this day (Evans, 2009). One thing it did not change was patriarchy and radical feminism grew out of the subordination of women in the political protest movement that was dominated by males (A. Johnson, 2005). Ideologies can be constructive or oppressive depending on how slavish they become to their own values and the orientation of the particular ideology. In the hands of shrewd or unscrupulous politicians or dictators, ideology can be a formidable weapon for evil. Ideology in the service of ambition or power becomes dangerous.

Brookfield's (2005) concept of ideology also gives rise to an understanding of the related concept of hegemony—a far more subtle form of social manipulation described by Antonio Gramsci. It entails the impress of a wide variety of cultural, gender, ideological beliefs and practices that convince people that a socially unjust system is an acceptable natural order (Reynolds, White, Brayman, & Moore, 2008; Gall, Gall, & Borg, 1999; Lerner, 1986; Williams, 1977). Most importantly, as Osborne (2001) notes, "In short, hegemony is a process, not an end-state" (p. 39).

Hegemony is an accurate description of the action of patriarchy. The final internalization of hegemony that leads to self-controlling behavior follows upon a long period of direct or indirect control lasting, in some cases, centuries if not longer. Determining the critical difference between ideological brainwashing and real democracy is a difficult and challenging process since one can often masquerade as the other. In a true democracy, its ideology is always open to real debate, challenge, and change, something that is seen only in formulaic, stultified ways in modern democracies. If this happens, ideology is always vibrant and adapting to meet the needs of society and culture at a particular moment in history. If it fails to do this then culture (and democracy) can become a means to an end. The reason for this is the ingrained complexity of culture as Sergiovanni and Corbally (1987) explain: "...culture includes customs and traditions, historical accounts be they mythical or actual, tacit understandings, habits, norms, and expectations, common meanings associated with fixed objects and established rites, shared assumptions and inter-subjective meanings" (p. viii cited in Giles and Proudfoot (1994), p. 204).

Culture is the social expression of ideology and patriarchy is the social expression of culture. It is like society-wide “group-think,” a term coined by Irving Janus (1982) regarding the propensity of groups to collectively come to decisions (often wrong or dangerous) by ignoring obvious conflicts with their sequestered views. Patriarchy, ideology, hegemony, and culture are inextricably intertwined. It is important to understand their interrelated roles in understanding the evolution of society.

Thus patriarchy is the primary and oldest group-think ideology of humankind upon which all other ideologies are premised and from which all other ideologies arise. It is interwoven with culture, gender, economics, religion, education, leadership, and power. These elements are the lifeblood of all our global social institutions. Patriarchy simultaneously coexists within these bodies while also creating their complexity. It has not taken control of society overnight but through a glacially slow evolution throughout human history in which generation after generation has been socialized into its ideologically restrictive belief system and relationships. As Reich (1974) notes in his book *The Sexual Revolution*:

Based on these conditions of production, certain ideas about life, morals, philosophy, etc., develop. They generally correspond to the level of technology at a particular time, i.e., to the ability to comprehend and master life. The social ‘ideology’ thus created forms the human structure and is turned into a material force to be preserved in that structure as ‘tradition.’ Now, everything depends on whether the whole society or only a small minority participates in the formation of the social ideology. If a minority holds political power, then it also determines the type and content of the general ideology and the formation of human structure. Therefore, in an authoritarian society, the thinking of the majority corresponds to the economic and political interests of the rulers. Conversely, in a work-democratic society, where there are no minority power interests, the social ideology would correspond to the vital interests of all members of society. (p. xxiv)

What Reich is indicating is that power creates the ruling ideology and the ruling ideology of the world is male. He is also describing an ideal, fully participatory, substantive democracy where power is balanced, all are enfranchised, and none excluded. This is similar to Young’s (2000) concept of “deliberative democracy” described by LiPumaa & Koelbleb (2009), which to be valid must meet the threshold of inclusion, political equality of participants, reasonableness of discussion and equal accountability on all partners for implementation of any results (pp. 203–204). Few would argue that any society has realized such a state to date. Those with power control the ideology of culture, politics,

religion, and economics and create these in their own image. In human history this image has been patriarchal. While you can eradicate any living thing it is much harder to erase an idea that exists within that living thing, much like the Islamic extremists currently brutalizing Iraq. Eradicating people is easy; eradicating ideas is much more difficult. Like a virus, patriarchy mutates and changes to survive in another form. Just as humankind contains genetic links to the earliest humans, the world holds ideological links to the earliest forms of patriarchy. Just as *Homo sapiens* are the most highly evolved of the animal species, modern patriarchy is the most highly developed form of ideological belief. Its trend will not be reversed overnight but the change can begin by acknowledging its power and breaking down its grip on social functioning with real changes that attack its authoritarian, paternal core. Rather than being a political curiosity and an anachronism, patriarchy is a vibrant, active, living presence in our modern world. It is the true "invisible hand" of society, in contrast to the economic one spoken of by Adam Smith (1965).

Modern capitalist democracies have been most successful in implementing this hegemonic view of society that is implemented in their economic systems. They are the highest and most refined iteration of patriarchy and male dominance yet perfected by our gendered society. Brookfield's (2005) perspective views the concepts of ideology and hegemony as sublimated within thousands of years of complex socialization and social, political, economic, religious, and other forms of historical human development, but patriarchy is as powerful a force today as it has ever been and still dominates human relations in overt and clandestine ways (Chinoy, 1967; Daly, 1978 cited in Walby, 1990). As Gramsci correctly points out, every relationship in human existence is an educational one and thus the overwhelming importance of understanding the role and purpose of both formal and informal education and socialization in society (Brookfield, 2005). This implies a detailed appreciation and understanding of the role of leadership and education.

In contrast to the linear progression of society toward an improved civilization as believed by Enlightenment thinkers, and generally accepted in society today, humankind's progress toward evolution has been anything but smooth and progressive. Society has tended to block out, erase, or minimize the continuous male-driven conflict that has characterized social history. Many would say these are merely random occurrences that are a normal part of human development, but the pattern is so consistent that clear trends are

evident. Schafer (2008) underscores the frequently negative potential of our patriarchal social culture:

There is also a more sinister side to history that must also be taken into account in all future developments: the countless conflicts and confrontations between the different cultures and peoples of the world, and the record of acts of brutality, barbarism, violence, and oppression. As the history of colonialism, imperialism, Nazism, fascism, and "cultural revolutions" throughout the world confirms only too well, there are always problems when too much power is concentrated in too few hands and there are major inequalities in the world. This makes it imperative, as indicated earlier, to be ever mindful of, and to create safeguards against, the abuses of culture. (pp. 183–184)

Power, and with it patriarchy, subverts the spontaneous progression of social evolution toward the most beneficial state for humankind as it has been doing for thousands of years since *Homo sapiens* began evolving. Enlightenment thinkers did not factor the distortion of human progression by political and social power into their views—in contrast, they accepted it as part of the natural process. Power concentration is and has been a fundamental problem in society, and power concentration is the fundamental premise of patriarchy. The use and application of power and force is a conscious human choice, not a random act. Thus patriarchy is a key issue requiring the attention of all of society. Dobbin (1998) links hegemonic ideology and power in modern times: "Ideology has been called meaning in the service of power, that is, the creation of rationalizing myths, ideas, and, in today's lexicon, "common sense," that pave the way for people to accept conditions they would otherwise protest against" (p. 184). Campbell (1969)—a highly respected historical and religious scholar—provides a similar conclusion to an interpretation of the instrumental and self-serving role of primitive patriarchal myths such as Genesis that are accepted as historical fact by major religions and blame women for man's fate:

We have already noted the role of chicanery in shamanism. It may well be that a good deal of what has been advertised as representing the will of "Old Man" actually is but the heritage of a lot of old men, and that the main idea has been not so much to honor God as to simplify life by keeping woman in the kitchen. (pp. 322–323)

So clearly in Campbell's view, ideologies such as patriarchy are not random and spontaneous but the willful acts of a self-interested and controlling male culture. Social power has progressed from overt and periodic to covert and continuous. With increasing frequency, subliminal socialization is the

preferred method of groups who hold power, but physical force is still employed as necessary to maintain control at both the geopolitical and domestic level. There exists in society a continuum of authoritarian responses that ensures the maintenance of the system. Authoritarianism has progressive levels of control that are implemented depending on the need and circumstances, from casual and subtle auto-suggestion as occurs through media and advertising to physical violence such as occurs during riot control by governments and dictators or the slaughter of people that we are currently witnessing in Iraq by ISIL (J. Acker, 2006). Covert distortion, disinformation, and propaganda are more discrete and subliminal methods regularly utilized by modern governments, businesses, and other groups to create an illusion of reality (a spin) surrounding a certain event or events (Cook, 1990). Such manipulation of reality has become commonplace and literally indistinguishable from actual reality, distorting people's ability to discern fact from truth.

The inexplicable violence we experience everywhere today comes in many forms and types from centuries old cultural patterns—all or most of which have been generated by patriarchal views of the world (Lerner, 1986). As O'Sullivan (2001) points out:

One of the perennial problems of community life is the presence of differences of power that lead to structures of oppression and domination. We can see oppression and domination both between and within human groupings. Structures of oppression and domination exist at all levels of human interaction and seem to be present in human history from its very beginnings. (p. 248)

What must be acknowledged is that these are merely ways of acting learned by generations of humans that can be just as easily unlearned, if we are willing to do so. They are not natural, immutable, unchangeable, or intractable—they are simply ways of behaving and thinking that can and must be altered (Lerner, 1986).

Patriarchal domination, control, and violence have diversified their manifestations and now exist in overtly physical as well as subtle cultural, psychological, and emotional forms. Violence occurs through direct physical means as well as passively through economic, political, educational, racial, religious, and cultural means—all at the psychological and emotional level—all of which have their roots and their current genesis in the history of patriarchy (Schafer, 2008).

The impact of this is the same as it has been for thousands of years—a selected small group of males have benefitted at the expense of all others by

employing various forms of violence to accomplish their goals. At times this reaches the extreme heights of global conflict while at others it is a tolerable cruelty of poverty, exploitation, and neglect as we exist in today. At its core such a system is grossly unfair, destructive, and unsustainable. In today's world we are quickly reaching the limits of the rule of patriarchy as the products of its values threaten to destabilize and ultimately destroy the world in the ethnic and cultural violence in Ukraine, Syria, and Iraq, and the rapid destruction of the planet driven by self-interest and competition. It is a complex polarized and polarizing system and as such creates winners and losers. The winners generally gain at the expense of the losers.

Patriarchy as the archetypal myth pits one gender, person, religion, race, and nation against the other in a competitive, destabilizing zero-sum win-lose struggle for control of the social, intellectual, and human and material resources of the planet (Walby, 2004). Most people today are oblivious to this ideological basis for their present behavior. O'Sullivan (2001) points out that the dominance and subordination structures of patriarchy occur in all cultures and races in the modern world, operating over all classes and ages. The structure of patriarchy operates globally. It is the most dominant, long-lasting, repressive, and universal ideological myth that humankind still adheres to with dogged uncritical determination.

The History of Patriarchy

Patriarchy is the most elemental essence of society that has existed since the dawn of time and certainly since recorded history more than 5000 years ago (French, 1985; Lerner, 1986). Societal values are governed by the single overarching ideology of patriarchy that is known to reach back formally 5000–7,000 years (von Werlhof, 2007). Crocco (2007) points out this subtle influence of patriarchy as she notes the seminal work of Gerda Lerner on patriarchy and the difference between “oppression” and “subordination”:

The origins of patriarchy in the West go back millennia. Gerda Lerner chronicles the evolution of patriarchy in *The Creation of Patriarchy* (1987) and *The Creation of Feminist Consciousness* (1993). In both books, she highlights the differing effects of patriarchy according to time, place, and social class. Lerner prefers the word subordination to oppression in describing women's status in most societies, defining oppression as “forceful subordination,” a term signifying the “subject condition of individuals and of groups” (1987, 233). She believes the term oppression inadequate in capturing “paternalistic dominance, which, while it has oppressive aspects, also involves a set

of mutual obligations and is frequently not perceived as oppressive" (Lerner 1987, 233). (p. 258)

Subordination also constitutes what can be termed "silent violence" whose impact is most often seen through poverty, homelessness, and neglect rather than open hostility and can victimize both men and women. It also indicates the unconscious and conscious mutual socialized acceptance of patriarchy by both women and men (Lerner, 1986). The damage is no less real. It is violence perpetrated by withdrawing or withholding the conditions for life rather than directly affecting them. More and more in our present world this form of violence has become the norm, although physical violence and social unrest are still pervasive as well. We are a global culture suffering from Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder (PTSD) resulting from the effects of pervasive patriarchal violence, domination, and control (A. Johnson, 2005). Far more people have been killed as a result of silent versus overt violence. As Freire (1985) suggests: "The relationships between the dominator and the dominated reflect the greater social context, even when formally personal. Such relationships imply the introjection by the dominated of the cultural myths of the dominator" (p. 73).

More recently, Europe was swept by waves of intense "patriarchalization" as von Werlhof (2007) terms it during the last several thousand years in the form of the Roman conquest, the rise of Christianity, and feudalism—all of which consolidated its values within society (p. 23). The eminent religious and historical scholar Joseph Campbell (1969) reminds us in his book *Masks of God: Primitive Mythology* of the important historical caveat that accompanies the study of history and patriarchy—it even influences the study of patriarchy itself:

In Part Four, diagramming sketchily the main blocks of the prehistoric periods of myth, from the first we know of man's appearance on earth to the dawn of the ages of writing when the literary record of mythology begins, we must try to bear in mind the force of this dialogue. For it is one of the curiosities and difficulties of our subject that its materials come to us for the most part through the agency of the male. The masters of the rites, the sages and prophets, and lastly our contemporary scholars of the subject, have usually been men; whereas, obviously, there has always been a feminine side to the picture also. (pp. 352–353)

Patriarchalization occurred during periods where the control and presence of patriarchy was intensified in society. Schafer (2008) notes that society was

governed during this time by dominant cultural themes as well—in the Middle Ages, the age of religion; the Renaissance, the age of aesthetics; and in the 18th–20th centuries, the age of economics (capitalism)—but all these parallel periods were governed by the mega-age of patriarchy and its values. All the great periods of history are essentially the records of male achievements (Martin, 2001). In the past century we have witnessed a similar pattern culminating with the technological intensification period we are currently undergoing. The various ages identified by Schafer (2008) and von Werlhof (2007) were expressions of the continued efforts by ruling male elites to craft a society that consolidated their power and entrenched their preferred status in perpetuity. The torch of patriarchy has been handed down from generation to generation, from father to son, from dynasty to dynasty as an accepted and unalterable values lineage of male social power and authority that was achieved with physical power and authority. While there is substantial evidence that those who were subject to it intensely disliked, resisted, and rejected it, patriarchal aristocracies ruled through a mixture of brutal power and religion (Laxer, 1999). Religion was the earliest servant of patriarchy as males created mythological beliefs that romanticized their exploits and superiority (A. Johnson, 2005; Lerner, 1997). Each age in history was built upon the elite legacy of the previous ones and had the effect of increasing and expanding the influence and power of its presence. Scientific breakthroughs such as the discovery of gun powder, the printing press, the Industrial Revolution, the development of modern science, the broad acceptance of intellectual rationalism, the discovery of nuclear power, and the development of information and computer technology have all contributed significantly to the enrichment and entrenchment of the male worldview of human existence across societies worldwide and were extensions of its development (Laxer, 1999). They were also almost totally the creation of males with few exceptions, since women and others were categorically excluded from any form of social participation that would have led to such advances (Lerner, 1997). In this regard women continue to be effectively denied full participation as equals in countries around the world. Male assumptions became the enforced reality and that reality became social dogma.

This patriarchal social state replaced more matricentric societies that existed around 6500 BC–3500 BC and as far back as 9,000 years ago when agriculture was being established (A. Johnson, 2005). French (1985) points out that there is some evidence that truly matriarchal societies (the rule of women over men) did exist but there is more compelling evidence of matricentric societies organized around mothers and child-rearing:

In the beginning was the Mother; the Word began a later age. The single universal covering primate and ungulate (hoofed) species, indeed all mammals and much other animal life as well, is that the core of society, the center of whatever kind of social group exists, is mother and child. Such a social organization is called matrifocal or matricentric. These terms are not the same as matriarchal, a word formed by analogy with patriarchal, which denotes leadership (from the Greek root *arche*, meaning chief, and *archein*, to be first, to rule). A matriarchy would thus be a society in which mothers rule in the same way fathers have ruled for the past few thousand years. (p. 27)

Lerner (1986) in her seminal work *The Creation of Patriarchy* concludes that the historical and archaeological evidence does not support the existence of matriarchy at any point in history. Walby (1990) asserts the same conclusion. Nonetheless, even matricentric or matrilineal societies have been rarer throughout recorded Western history in comparison to the dominance of patriarchy. They primarily existed during periods where primitive peoples began moving from hunting and gathering cultures to more stable agricultural periods. Formally institutionalized patriarchy is a relatively recent development historically (A. Johnson, 2005). Despite the presence of elements of patriarchy throughout history Wilkinson and Pickett (2010) point out that for millions of years, hunter-gatherer societies lived relatively egalitarian lives that changed to the more distinctly contemporary form of sexually divided patriarchy with the shift to a more agrarian existence. In pre-patriarchal times around 7,000 years ago goddess imagery was a central feature of European, African and Middle Eastern countries (A. Johnson, 2005). The characteristics that would have been selected in more egalitarian societies were much different than those in patriarchal, dominant ones that followed. Miles (1993) observes that women had a better chance of equality in primitive versus advanced societies. Sanal (2008) points out a similar circumstance in Turkey prior to the Turks accepting Islam as their primary faith. Patriarchy was more strongly rooted in hunting and gathering societies such as North America and Europe while farming societies that had little access to game often evolved in more matricentric ways. Women were associated with the fecundity of the earth and its life-giving abilities to feed early clans and bear children. Frederick Engels (1975) in his book *The Origin of the Family, Private Property and the State* points out the Marxist case that the patriarchal family unit was a transition between the matriarchal communistic family that existed in primitive humankind and the modern isolated family of industrialization. Engels asserted that inequality originated in the family and women were the first oppressed group (A. Johnson, 2005). Lerner's (1986) historical analysis supports this view. This is the same concept proposed by Socrates in Ancient Greece versus the

accepted polarized patriarchal Aristotelian worldview largely embraced by present humanity (Lerner, 1986). Reich (1974) explains that in the evolution of matriarchy into patriarchy, early primitive clans migrated from matricentric clans to patriarchal families with the male patriarch gradually dominating the family structure and taking over prominence as the economic unit moved from the clan to the family and the family became the crystallization point of patriarchy as it continues to be today (Lerner, 1986).

These matricentric female values and social culture have survived into modern times, but only as cultural adornments to patriarchy while holding a massive parallel history that has never been told or valued. For current practical purposes, patriarchy has been the modal experience of societies around the globe for millennia (Lerner, 1986). Matricentric societies have been post-scripts to the others and generally preceded recorded history in many civilizations. They have been suppressed and distorted to serve as subsystems of patriarchal expectations throughout recent history (French, 1985). As a result our entire human experience has been skewed toward a male-slanted interpretation and practices of human experience, success, and values. The world has struggled (mostly unsuccessfully) to resist the hegemony and the insidious, forced domination of patriarchy.

More importantly, patriarchy has carried out a process of cultural socialization that has normalized male domination, violence, and control in human relations (including modern democratic societies), leading to an inability to potentially conceive of more successful social systems to organize human behavior (French, 1985; Lerner, 1986). As J. Ryan (1996) points out in describing Michel Foucault's view of power:

The crucial point here is that power does not act on people from a distance from the outside, but on the interior, so to speak, through an individual's self-intervention on social relations. In other words entrapment proceeds as we become ourselves: we are very much our own prisoners. In this sense power not only works on us, but perhaps more importantly, through us. We are not just its target, but also its vehicle. (p. 12)

Patriarchal power is absorbed and deeply embedded into the psychological fabric of humankind. We become unwitting hosts of its effects and co-collaborators in its action—whether male or female. Von Werlhof (2007) also suggests that a key difference is that truly matriarchal societies where they have existed have not known "...a state, domination, classes, war, gender conflicts, or ecological catastrophes." (p. 27; A. Johnson, 2005). Lerner (1986) points out, however, that this suggestion is based on a single case of Catal

Huyuk in Turkey where warfare did occur in neighbouring communities and the settlement was inexplicably abandoned in about 5700 BC indicating either calamity or inability to adapt. She concludes that peaceful societies such as this if they did exist simply did not survive. While this particular situation may be true we have very little experience with this type of society to be able to suggest with any certainty that they would not be subject to the same flaws as patriarchy if more established.

The roots of patriarchy and violence lie in the long distant historical past, tens of thousands of years ago, where hominid survival in a hostile environment was dependent on genetic physical strength and animalistic prowess. It was a world where the dominant natural social reality was violence and death that were a necessary daily experience as pre-humans fought to survive. Aggression and violence were hard-wired into early societies in order to exist and thus there are few examples of groups who peacefully co-existed and survived (Lerner, 1986). Those that did were often conquered by violent and aggressive tribes and disappeared from the social and anthropological landscape. However, as humankind evolved and stabilized into more secure social units, the aggression and violence became internalized rather than extinguished through more pastoral existence. This destructive evolutionary pattern continues today. Passive and peaceful cultures throughout history have been victimized by those who revered power and control. Unfortunately, aggression and violence are the great levellers, preventing more peaceful, often more highly developed and democratic species from surviving. French (1985) points out that it took millennia for patriarchy to gain domination over the minds of people but it has now spread to all corners of globe:

But patriarchy is a militant ideology. To revere power above everything else is to be willing to sacrifice everything else to power. Many cultures accepted such a morality only with reluctance, but power worship is contagious. If a worshipper of power decides to extend his power over your society, your choices are between surrendering and mounting an equal and opposite power. In either case, the power worshiper wins—he has converted your society into a people who understand that power is the highest good. Over the millennia, patriarchy spread to all corners of the planet, and only a couple of tiny societies still exist that appear not to have been influenced by it. (pp. 18–19)

French expresses the corrupting influence that patriarchal power has had on society. When presented with power, if we ignore it we are at risk of not surviving, but if we respond to it then we become an unwitting party to its influence. When given the conditions and the opportunity to live more peaceful

and agrarian lives, early societies adopted these practices, indicating that violence was not the preferred but the required mode of operating prior to the rise of such cultures. Primitive violence defined and continues to define the experience of the human species and to be a visceral part of patriarchy from its earliest inception to the most recent newscast. But while early humans needed the genetic disposition toward violence to survive, they lacked the cranial development to mediate those primitive instincts to prevent eradicating the species through overkill. *Homo sapiens* was the first hominoid to overcome this evolutionary hurdle but not without its ongoing problems. Biologically and genetically males were more powerful physically and thus better equipped to dominate the small social pods of early society (Lerner, 1986). In our well-educated and civilized world of today, we have no such excuses for our inability to restrain our bloodlust. Our threats and anxiety are more often internal to our psyches than external to our perceptions.

More recently, the work of Charles Darwin (1859) in the 19th century exacerbated the mythical view of societal violence as normalized through his work *The Origin of Species*. In his research on natural selection Darwin noted that animals competed for resources to survive, which resulted in the survival of the fittest, the most intelligent, and the strongest (Schafer, 2008). This resulted in increasing the quality of the surviving breeding line. More recently works such as Robert Ardrey's (1966) *The Territorial Imperative* have reinforced that view and fed the mythical nature of male violence and the superiority of the victor (Miles, 1993). Rather than acknowledging that humans aspire to be a different breed of animal, as a society we continue to embrace and accept Darwin's beliefs as self-fulfilling explanations for our more primitive behaviors while we apply his theories as explanations for a wide variety of maladaptive modern social behavior (Parsons, 1964).

Humans also soon learned that some things could only be accomplished collectively and that survival depended not only on an individual's capacities but often on the collective capacities of larger groups of people working in concert. Humankind was an increasingly social but inherently violent species. As social communities of beings with shared interests in survival grew, nomadic existence progressed to more stable and efficient agrarian subsistence, which allowed communities to create more enduring social entities. However, this did not stop the propensity for violence. Banding together still meant a collective massing of potential for even greater violence directed toward anyone outside of the group. Fear was still a powerful social motivator. Throughout this process the dominance and influence of patriarchal male values and

behavior permeated early social development based on physical violence, power, and force and continued to dominate human experience long after the need to survive had passed. As Lerner (1997) points out:

In its earliest form patriarchy appeared as the archaic state. Long before its formation in the 2nd millennium B.C. gender had already been created and defined.¹⁵ Gender—the different roles and behavior deemed appropriate to each of the sexes—was expressed in values, customs, and social roles. During the long period that led to the establishment of patriarchally organized archaic states, gender definitions became institutionalized in laws, the organization of hierarchies and in religion. Gender was also expressed in leading metaphors that shaped the culture and entered the explanatory systems of Western civilization. (p. 155)

Patriarchal aggression became etched in the genetic biology of humans and increasingly poses a major challenge to the ongoing survival of mankind (Miles, 1993). Thus while we have a necessary biological need and drive to survive, if we cannot suppress this instinct in humankind we may not survive at all. Our intellectual progress has outstripped our behavioral evolution and this may be the Achilles heel of modern humanity.

Many of the qualities that gave rise to violence are rooted in primeval genetics, survival, and social conditioning, which can be reversed—although slowly and can be overcome more quickly by conscious mental and moral constraint, the supposed qualities of a civilized human honored more in the breach than the observance. We give ourselves more credit than we are due as a species. Qualities that were necessary and valued for millions of years have now become a serious and deeply ingrained liability for humankind as our global village approaches the end of its zenith. Humankind has overreached its genetic evolution and is now capable of destroying the entire human species with the push of a button while also being yet unable to fully control the compulsion to do so. As Gilligan and Richards (2009) state: “The great historical lesson of the 20th century is the terrifying price we pay when our technology is so much in advance of our ethics and politics” (p. 237). Patriarchy and leadership may have permitted humankind to survive into modern times but the life cycle of humankind in anthropological terms has been exceedingly brief. We may be simply a shooting star in the anthropological cosmos—burning brightly for a few moments in the history of the earth and then disintegrating to be replaced by a new species that develops in a more peaceful, collective, shared, and nonviolent manner that is respectful of the social and natural environment, much like the practices

of the early First Nations peoples of North America and indigenous peoples around the world. Living in harmony with nature and only taking what was absolutely required for survival reflected their sustainable approach to the natural world (Lerner, 1997). In the past several centuries under capitalism the ethos has been to take as much as you can for personal gain while disregarding the consequences to one's self, the environment, or others. If that future is not to be humankind's, significant changes need to be made to our social psyche and our collective direction together as a species. Or perhaps the whole human experience on earth is simply an evolutionary experiment that will expire. Perhaps in the billions and billions of galaxies, stars, and solar systems that Carl Sagan made us wonder at, there is a peaceful human race that is evolving to succeed us. As sophisticated as we think we are, we are still exceedingly primitive.

As societies grew and flourished throughout the modern world, social organization became increasingly more complex with a diverse range of predominantly male religious, social, and political leaders taking the most important positions in society. Religious aristocracies developed and evolved into military, political, economic, social, and cultural elites (Lerner, 1986; 1993). Patriarchy simultaneously expressed itself at the individual and interpersonal as well as the societal level (Daly, 1978 cited in Walby, 1990). Men dominated within their own families and enforced the patriarchal code of compliance on their partners, their children, their consorts, and ultimately all women (Lerner, 1986; Miller, 2003). They also enforced this code on other males as well. The role of males evolved as public and outside the home, while women's was private, domestic, and within the home (Apple, 2006; Gaskell & McLaren, 1991). The hierarchy of male power and authority reflected within patriarchy reinforced the dominance of males in vertical social, family, and political structures and organizations as well as in other dimensions of society (Eisenstein, 1999; A. Johnson, 2005; Lerner, 1986).

Patriarchy is an unsustainable ideology for the future of humankind yet it has persisted for thousands of years and been responsible for untold violence and human cruelty. As Stegemann (2009) describes the views of Professor Colin Starnes regarding the future of patriarchy:

There can be no correction to the unsustainable life of the rich half of the world—which we have obtained by making the lives of the poor half unlivable—without bringing about the end of patriarchy in both its consuming and producing halves. Patriarchy has been the driver of all civilization to this point. And it has now brought us to the strange point of recognizing that civilization no longer depends on patriarchy.

Human civilization can exist without patriarchy. In this new situation, holding on to this wildly awkward, intensely abstract (where there is only right or wrong), appallingly wasteful, inherently unfair, and now quite unnecessary assumption for a second longer than we need to, is transforming it into a dreadful destroyer of all it has brought to pass. (p. 24)

Unfortunately, there has been only marginal and superficial progress made in changing patriarchy, but our capacity for violence has increased exponentially. Thus the assertion that we have evolved into a more civilized and higher form of entity is open to serious challenge. A cursory look at the ongoing global violence around the world would be argument enough. One could suggest that we are nothing more than intelligent thugs much like Al Capone. It is important to note that when we say that, we are referring categorically to men who perpetrate the vast majority of the world's violence in its various forms.

Patriarchy, leadership, education, and religion have worked in concert for thousands of years to dominate the historical landscape of our social knowledge, experience, and ideas and to infuse their values into successive generations of men, women, and children. We need to begin the process of deprogramming society and reversing this trend before it is too late. The world is at a tipping point where our intellectual and psychological evolution is at a sophisticated enough point to realize that we must control our baser violent instincts or we will not survive, but whether we are capable of succeeding at this will write the final epitaph of humankind. The first step must be awareness; the second step, change.

Thus far, rather than attempting to suppress these violent instincts humankind has revelled in them and mythologized, romanticized, and popularized them (Elmore, 2000). We desperately need to stop the idolatry of patriarchy. What this has resulted in is a world that operates on two different levels –the fantasy of male history and culture and the paradoxical fantasy/reality of modern life for the rest of the world's inhabitants that happen to exist at the whim of male interests. Increasingly in our e-world we are fed a glossy, biased, global illusion of life and gender relationships that focuses on a small percentage of the successful world's population while the actual grim reality for the vast majority is ignored. The former informs the latter. Patriarchy socializes and subordinates everyone into a hierarchy of valuing concluding with the one supreme individual (most frequently male) at its apex (Lerner, 1986; Miller, 2003). We are taught from an early age to accept this situation as "normal." The expressions of patriarchy, gender, leadership, and religion can be witnessed

everywhere, in every age and in every interaction, whether large or small, and are not difficult to discern but are extremely difficult to change (Rao & Kelleher, 2000). Every human being experiences patriarchy in their daily lives. Thus the reality of life is that we need to pay much more attention to the informal, unwritten social codes and rules of organizations and society than the formal veneer that we use to paper over them. It is these informal codes that govern the reality that people live. This is certainly the case with patriarchy.

Many of its modern effects are blatantly obvious but are ignored by society as though they were unchangeable and immutable. An example is the numbers of men who continue to dominate business and politics worldwide (Stegemann, 2009). Despite advances by women into these positions their role remains token and ceremonial on the grand scale despite notable exceptions. Men continue to believe they should dictate the opportunities for women, their value, their reproductive rights, and their entire lives. Extremist Islamic cultures are experiencing a resurgence as are right-wing extremist views in countries around the world. The rights of women and society are being unilaterally rolled back across the globe including Western democracies. In more recent history women have simply been permitted to take part in patriarchal leadership rituals without disturbing the ideological and practical dominance of patriarchy that sets the rules of engagement for it (French, 1985). Also, women have done little to change the fundamental dynamics of traditional leadership or its impact on the followers of leaders. In fact, women who have broken through the “glass ceiling” have simply picked up where men left off and shown little interest in or self-awareness of reforming the fundamental traditional leadership paradigm as males have constructed it (A. Johnson, 2005).

For the most part we benignly accept patriarchy as the way things are and a natural form of human behavior rather than a nurtured social, economic, and historical construction as Lerner asserted (Crocco, 2007). History itself is the history of victorious patriarchal leaders—whether religious or political, benevolent or malevolent—and their conquests or failures. However, the monotheism of patriarchy cannot continue if we wish to change our future world and its prospects for survival. To do so we must examine, critique, and change the major historical forces of patriarchy, leadership, education, religion, and economics and with them the essence of our social value structure, beliefs, attitudes, practices, and institutions that they have generated and that we hold dear. We must hold them up to scrutiny and challenge their premises as well as their application. It is a tall order but not impossible, and it is absolutely imperative that we accomplish it.

The Meaning and Influence of Patriarchy

Taken literally, *patriarchy* is defined as the rule of the father (Vavrus, 2002). Walby (1990) offers the following definition: "...a system of social structures and practices in which men dominate, oppress and exploit women" (p. 20). Monagan (2010) elaborates:

The most commonly accepted definition of patriarchy is the social structure of society based on the father having primary responsibility for the welfare of and authority over their families. However the true reach of patriarchy extends far beyond the privacy of the familial realm. (p. 160)

Von Werlhof (2007) adds: "For most women, it has simply meant the rule of men or fathers, within the family, the workplace, or the state. It is known that patriarchy is older than capitalism" (p. 23). In practice it is a pervasive, idealized system of social power in which men dominate (O'Sullivan, 2001)—values that permeate every aspect of our modern social being and are the foundation of our entire social fabric (Lerner, 1986; von Werlhof, 2007). A. Johnson (2005) identifies the three salient characteristics of patriarchy as follows: "A society is patriarchal to the degree that it promotes male privilege by being male dominated, male identified, and male centered. It is also organized around an obsession with control and involves as one of its key aspects the oppression of women" (p. 5). Reich (1974) asserts that patriarchy was a repressive socio-familial ideology that influenced every aspect of human life with a conservative worldview in support of authoritarian ideologies including the critical sexual development and mores of children and later adults:

It is the bridge between the economic structure of society and its ideological superstructure; it is permeated by a conservative atmosphere which necessarily makes an ineradicable impression on each of its members. Through its very form and its direct influence, it not only transmits general attitudes toward the existing social order and a conservative way of thinking, but also, due to the sexual structure from which it springs and develops, it exercises an immediate influence, in the conservative sense, on the sexuality of children. (pp. 74–75)

Thus the birth of patriarchy in each new generation is in the family and thus the family is a critical area of change if patriarchy is ever to be reformed. Gilligan and Richards (2009) offer the following anthropological view that coincides with focus provided by Reich:

Patriarchy is an anthropological term denoting families or societies ruled by fathers. It sets up a hierarchy—a rule of priests—in which the priest, the *hieros*, is a father, *pater*. As an order of living, it elevates some men over other men and all men over women; within the family, it separates fathers from sons (the men from the boys) and places both women and children under a father's authority. (p. 22)

Eisenstein (1999) further points out that the family still plays a crucial role in patriarchy: "Today patriarchy, the power of the male through these sexual roles in capitalism, is institutionalized in the nuclear family" (p. 205). This philosophy has permeated modern life and continues to have a strong although mediated influence in Western religious traditions, leadership practices, educational and political organizations, economic theories, and personal relationships. Hierarchic ordering makes patriarchy a self-policing and self-leveling distributed system where power of all kinds and forms determines an individual's place on the patriarchal ladder (J. Acker, 2006). As Chesterman, Ross-Smith, and Peters (2003) state:

The dominance of gendered ideologies is reflected in a deeply embedded belief in Western cultures that public work is peripheral to women's lives despite the growing number of women who work outside the home. Women are essentialized in a patriarchal discourse that presumes heterosexuality, domesticity and motherhood (p. 425).

As French (1985) indicates regarding the values that surround patriarchy:

This morality, which is still with us, holds power (control) to be the highest good, and values qualities that tend to strengthen or sharpen the male image of isolation, individuality, and control. Virtue is equated with manliness; one proves one's manhood by demonstrating control over women, children, property, and other men. (p. 18)

Smith (1981) makes a connection to economics: "patriarchy is a system of property relations firmly anchored in a politics of interpersonal domination" (p. 338). Eisenstein (1999) additionally observes: "The reality of social relations involves both capitalist class *and* patriarchal relations" (p. 198). Hartmann (1981) indicates the paradoxical complexity that accompanies the presence of patriarchy in relation to women when defining the term:

We can usefully define patriarchy as a set of social relations between men, which have a material base, and which, though hierarchical, establish or create interdependence and solidarity among men that enable them to dominate women. Though patriarchy is hierarchical and men of different classes, races, or ethnic groups have different places in the patriarchy, they also are united in their shared relationship of

dominance over their women; they are dependent on each other to maintain that domination. Hierarchies 'work' at least in part because they create vested interests in the status quo. (p. 197)

Patriarchy and hierarchy are thus closely linked (Lerner, 1986). Our organizational structures that we use in society are key symbols of patriarchy that reflect and support the ideology that we live by. They are all part of the enculturation subtext that convinces society to comply with its values. Thus patriarchy is more than just a method of dominance; it is a socially connected and socially entrenched way of knowing and being that men and women equally participate in together in relation of dominance and subordination in both conscious and unconscious ways (Lerner, 1986). It also gives rise to social and cultural attitudes and physical and organizational structures that reciprocally reinforce its power. As Hartmann (1981) correctly notes, all men are invested in patriarchy since they are in one form or another the direct and indirect beneficiaries of its presence. Whether they are the poorest of the poor or the most powerful individual on earth, they all receive some relative status from being male in society. For many males this is the only status they may possess. Eisenstein (1999) adds, "As a power structure, patriarchy is rooted in biological reality rather than in an economic or historical one. Manifested through male force and control, the roots of patriarchy are located in women's reproductive selves" (pp. 202–203) while Fox (1989) in contrast argues that it is clear that patriarchy is intertwined in society:

Elsewhere, in attempting to define patriarchy, I have argued that the term refers to the 'system of practices, arrangements and social relations that ensure biological reproduction, child rearing and the reproduction of gendered subjectivity', as well as gender ideology, or the sense of gender identity, itself (Fox 1988a: 175). While the social relations organizing 'reproduction' are distinct from other relations, once it is recognized that men and women differ in their personal identities, it is no longer possible to separate gender from other aspects of social organization. (p. 147)

Fox's (1989) view reflects Collinson's (2005) perspective that patriarchy is a contested, dialectical process of social interaction. Monagan (2010) describes a similar view of patriarchy as much more than a familial social contract:

Carole Pateman argues in *The Sexual Contract* that "Modern civil society is not structured by kinship and the power of fathers; in the modern world, women are subordinated to men as men, or to men as a fraternity (Pateman, 1997)." In patriarchal systems, as a collective group, women are systemically unrepresented or

underrepresented in the economic, political, military, criminal justice, legislative and educational arenas. Men serve in the highest levels in all areas of society. This is particularly important when examining women's rights of equality and freedom from violence. Men ultimately decide freedom and the extent to which it is afforded to others. Woman only has the freedom that man has willingly given to them. (p. 161)

French (1985) raises another key point with patriarchy—although it is primarily directed at and applied to women, the system is a vertical hierarchy of power in which men are also marginalized by other men higher in the competitive order than they are. Ideologically, patriarchy is a massive Ponzi scheme much like capitalism where those on the lower rungs of the ladder support the success of those higher up and artificially prop up the entire system that has no inherent validity (A. Johnson, 2005; Lerner, 1997).

Thus patriarchy is a massive pyramid system that is based on individual competition, power, and dominance. It is a social caste system that designates a value and social place for every person on earth (Lerner, 1993). Tan (2009) describes the exploitation hierarchy of Singaporean working women who hire off-shore domestics from developing countries at poverty wages that they subsequently abuse in a perverse exercise of social power by middle class women who often have little power themselves. Therefore patriarchy is not, has never been, and will never be about democracy. It is at best about benevolent conservative paternalism and at its worst patronizing, inhumane sadism such as that recently evidenced by ISIS in Iraq. The ironic fact—both puzzling and paradoxical—is that patriarchy is and has been for the most part accepted for centuries as the dominant social code and currently masquerades as democracy in Western and other societies around the world with little widespread or concerted resistance due to its virtual invisibility in social relations. What people see is the behavioral expression of patriarchy without making the connection to its source. It is a pervasive, subtly invasive set of beliefs that insidiously socializes succeeding generations of people into its skewed value structure. It is paradoxically accepted for the most part without question by both women and men. It creates a complex global socioeconomic value-ladder that most directly affects women but that also forces everyone to climb the same steps to improve their position in the world. It is the penultimate global sorting system that slots people into predetermined social roles based on their gender and their ability to control and dominate others. To do this one must compete—not cooperate—to move up. It forces all social interaction to be an individual, competitive, zero-sum game where for someone to win, someone else must

lose. Zero-sum games are always destructive. Rather than reinforcing shared effort and cooperation, patriarchy endorses human control and competition.

Thus patriarchy predates capitalism and is its parent (von Werlhof, 2007). Everyone, whether men or women, rich or poor, children or adults, blacks or whites, Christians or Muslims, have been socialized to believe that a patriarchal society is normal, God-given, and the only kind of social organization possible (French, 1985), just as capitalism—another outgrowth of patriarchy (von Werlhof, 2007)—has more recently convinced our present world that capitalist economics and the theories that justify it are the only way to organize the economies of the world (Schafer, 2008). Patriarchy is like a set of Russian dolls with capitalism, politics, education, and religion all nested within it. As the dominant ideology of humankind, patriarchy has been responsible for generating all the major institutions of society throughout history: religion, economics, politics, and education. It has also shaped our leadership models, gender and race relations, and our entire human social experience in a profound way in both democratic and despotic political regimes. These have become the pillars of the democratic gulag where everyone on earth is imprisoned. We live in a global ideological penal colony.

In addition, it has been reflected in the development of physical structures and artistic expression that reify its concepts and ideology: art, music, architecture, organizational structuring, and other forms of human expression that reflect and imbue society with its values. Many of these influences are subtle, covert, and indistinguishable unless one makes a concerted effort to see them. We all worship at the altar of patriarchy. Patriarchy has defined the knowledge base that informs the world. Myth and symbol play important roles in its consolidation and continuance. Myth and religion are two of the most powerful and long-serving adjuncts of patriarchy. O'Sullivan (2001) summarizes its more recent historical influence:

Our own historical prehistory appears to stem from the worship of a father god. The Judaeo-Christian heritage, with its emphasis on father-god worship, also carries with it a gender dominance of male privilege. This hierarchy of male dominance is accompanied by the presence of violent social structures. (p. 136)

Prior to being consolidated under monotheism, patriarchy also influenced religious beliefs from our earliest times. Engels (1975) also identified monogamy as the beginning of the sexual dominance of women. So patriarchy, religion, economics, militarism, and a host of other forces and institutions in society that we take for granted express and exude patriarchy in our modern

world. Our physical reality is like a mirror that reflects the internal ideology and psyche of humankind throughout history, just as our intellectual ideologies are projected upon the world through physical expression. Our physical world reflects the accomplishments of men. What we see is a concrete and reciprocal manifestation of what people believe—the Washington Monument, the American eagle, the statue of Christ in Sao Paulo, Brazil, the stones of Stonehenge, the pyramids in Egypt, the twin towers in New York. This would be nothing more than an obvious truism unworthy of note if the direct, crushing, and continuous impact of patriarchy were not felt by every person on earth every day in myriad undetectable, subliminal, and direct ways. Patriarchy is the artist painting the canvas of our lives. Throughout history humankind has influenced and been influenced by the physical reality around it and the physical reality it created. There is a reciprocal relationship between human and object—between perceptual and physical reality. We can look to both to understand our world and ourselves. The person driving the Bentley is making a silent statement about success and power. The monarch, president, or pope is doing the same, as is the headmaster and father. In most cases these are men saying “we are in control.”

Patriarchy is pervasive and persistent in its effects and hidden in its operation. It is the global context for all human experience and must be recognized as a critical and often negative normative factor in all our major social institutions. It has permeated every part of human life and expresses itself in the most miniscule events of personal interaction to the most life-changing circumstances of history. The majority of the great art we admire was produced by men. Even feminists are unconsciously affected by it. Patriarchy is everywhere and nowhere, much like being white (Dickinson & Vasby Anderson, 2004). Patriarchal masculinity is the invisible force that controls everything in the same way that whiteness does as an expression of racial dominance (Blackmore, 2006; A. Johnson, 2005). Being white is mute evidence that you are elite in society. In fact, these forces work in complementary, integrative, and additive ways that are much more effective than any one influence, creating an oppressive and impenetrable matrix of social, political, economic, and cultural forces that resist liberating change (Dickinson & Vasby Anderson, 2004; Lerner, 1997).

It is this collective and all-encompassing complexity of interlocking influences that ensures the dominance of patriarchy. Changes in one area of society have little ultimate impact on its influence, which gathers its strength from multiple sources and the power of interpersonal socialization that occurs

between men and women in families and personal relationships. There is a socio-historical inertial mass built up in patriarchy throughout the centuries that makes it difficult if not impossible to stop. The only way to change its effects is to attack its influence at its core—the family—as well as on multiple social and political fronts simultaneously by making the connections between situations explicit. This requires a concerted and coordinated effort on behalf of the world's peoples to assert the value of their common knowledge, their right to have their views heard and be given equal weight with all others if they are ever to free themselves and our future world from the dominance of patriarchy. It effects every action of human life in conscious and unconscious ways—some of which are buried thousands of years in the past and others that appeared yesterday (Beasley, 2008; A. Johnson, 2005). Many of its effects are invisible and innocuous, but others are observable and prescient in contemporary human history (Lerner, 1986). When we step back from the human world and take a holistic view of what we have created, it is an undeniably paternal and patronizing social environment by whatever measure of scholarship it is assessed that operates by encouraging people to use each other for their own gain and to separate themselves from one another along gender and other lines in master/servant relationships—in opposition to their primal human instincts for cooperation (McQuaig, 2001).

Rather than being a social curiosity, as some scholars contend (Miller, 2003), patriarchy is in contrast the vibrant core of our modern world that actively but subconsciously influences individuals every single day and that exists as a social backdrop everywhere in our human experience. It is the canvas that society is painted on. People are the bristles on the brush recording the events of social history. Patriarchy has formed and continues to shape our social values, beliefs, actions, and relationships in ways that control social development while suppressing fully democratic and collective ways of organizing society. It expresses itself through “hegemonic masculinity” that inculcates in everyone the normative male code of behavior in society. Of this male cultural code described by Connell and Messerschmidt (2005) they indicate, “Hegemony did not mean violence, although it could be supported by force; it meant ascendancy achieved through culture, institutions, and persuasion” (p. 832). The hegemony of patriarchy has evolved from being a familial and interpersonal concept into a highly sophisticated neopatriarchal social value code that permeates the modern psyche to such a degree that we are unaware of its subtle effects on our thought processes. Bierema (2003) states that “The rules and roles accompanying gendered power relations are so ingrained in the

culture that they are practically invisible, neither questioned nor challenged by most people" (p. 5).

Patriarchy is mythologized and symbolized in our institutions and relationships, organizational structures, art, language, architecture, sports, social interactions, economic philosophies, religious traditions, education systems, and our modern electronic media. It permeates and molds our social experience yet remains largely transparent within it. It is rarely the subject of serious or sustained critical attention in modern Western society regarding its impact or identified as a problematic causal agent in key social changes (A. Johnson, 2005). It is also responsible for much of the devastation visited on society throughout history and the wellspring of problematic social issues that we face today. We would be well advised to pay close attention to it. As with all history our present is the legacy of our past.

Patriarchy has dominated our leadership and economic models, theories and practices, and influenced our political and legal systems, our religious traditions, and our gender stereotypes. It has governed our political decision-making and societal structures for thousands of years. It is in our museums, universities, sports stadiums; our military-industrial complex, policing system, media, and economies. Patriarchy is at its core right-wing, patronizing, elitist, racially and gender-biased, and authoritarian. It appeals to every negative instinct of humankind yet it is vigorously defended at every turn. As a system it is dysfunctional and primarily targeted at women but equally affects everyone in society. Everyone is a victim and a perpetrator of patriarchy—including those who benefit from it. It saturates our social structures, our psyches, and our attitudes and it generates values, biases, conflicts, and disparity while oppressing others in society. It is adversarial and ultimately pits everyone against everyone else in a relentless competition for survival. It has come to be viewed as the way we are rather than the way we have become and blinded us to the way we can be.

We live in a continuously violent patriarchal social culture despite the superficially relative peace and political stability of the world community. It is a peace enforced by the threat of violence or overt violence. For thousands of years our society has mythologized violence and lionized heroic and violent leaders. Violence always simmers just below the surface despite our supposedly civilized veneer but that same violence is perpetrated by a miniscule number of people worldwide when compared with the total population of the earth. It is this minority that is the most dangerous group while the remaining majority want nothing more than to lead peaceful, productive, cooperative lives.

Patriarchy and leaders are the rogue elements in society that should be suppressed, not saluted. Violent confrontation has never delivered peace as long as history has been recorded. While Western nations have a self-satisfied smugness about our democratic societies, we are in reality the most bigoted and delusional about our purported success. While in Western democracies we claim to be peace-loving, violence saturates our cultures and is mythologized and romanticized in our media, the Internet, electronic games, and on television. Our entertainment viewing is filled with police, medical, and legal melodramas based on violence, hero worship, and fantasy (Eliade, 1976). This is counterbalanced with heavy doses of mindless, inane escapist comedy sitcoms and reality TV that provide a counterpoint to the more "serious" programming. This is intended to distract us from critical analyses of the intractable problems created by our patriarchal relationships. The fiction that the good guys always win and that life is just a bunch of laughs is important to maintaining the control of patriarchy on our world by papering over its grim, unrelenting negative reality that the majority in society experience. Both the comedy and the violent programming are all stereotypical and biased escapism. Neither stimulates any serious reflection on the state of life and society—in contrast, they are intended to do exactly the opposite. As Herman and Chomsky (2002) observe, "Furthermore, in a system of high and growing inequality, entertainment is the contemporary equivalent of the Roman 'games of the circus' that diverts the public from politics and generates a political apathy that is helpful to the preservation of the status quo" (p. xviii). The modern drug is electronic entertainment. It has given an entirely new and prophetic meaning to the 60s drug guru Timothy Leary's famous quip to "tune in, turn on, drop out."

Everything we see currently has patriarchy as its foundation. This fundamental effect of patriarchy can be seen in evidence throughout the ages. We have built our modern civilization on a base of mythological male power, control, conflict, and forced submission and agreement, rather than unrestricted freedom, democratic decision making, and human autonomy that is unencumbered and free of intimidation (French, 1985). Men have been the primary enforcers and beneficiaries of patriarchy since its inception. The hierophanies of the world's religions are populated by male deities and our monotheistic deities are gendered masculine (A. Johnson, 2005; Miles, 1993). This is not a coincidence or divine act. Men continue to receive a disproportionate amount of the rewards and benefits from a social structure that gives their patriarchal gender ideology deferential preference and continues

to skew the world into an unequal balance that favors their interests while disenfranchising the majority to serve the minority. Those in power control the rules that govern the definition of knowledge, values, decisions, social relationships, political and economic decision making, and religious beliefs that the world is predicated on (Martin, 2001). In short, they control the rules of the game. Patriarchy is at the root of all the social, political, religious, racial, and interpersonal strife in the world and through the ages because it is an ideology based in divisiveness, superiority, conquest, dominance, and violence. It is on patriarchy that we must focus our attention if we ever hope to change our world.

Patriarchy, Gender, and Violence

Patriarchy creates what O'Sullivan (2001) terms an "ecology of violence" that is deeply woven into global male cultures whose common denominator is the dominance of women, children, and the earth itself. As he points out: "It is nested in all of our institutions of power from the government to the boardroom to the military-industrial complex to the school room" (p. 147). Violence is the one constant that defines all of human and animal experience with one significant exception. While animals kill only to survive, humans have evolved to the point where they do not need to kill to survive, yet they continue to do so despite this. Power for survival and evolutionary dominance has become power for capricious social dominance. As humankind has evolved, the physically strongest and best breeding line no longer survives. Anyone can survive by employing sophisticated weapons of war. Thus the evolutionary insurance of Charles Darwin has been broken by advances in civilization's ability to destroy itself. We continue to be primitive, senseless, and aggressive while proclaiming our progress as a civilization. The mark of a truly civilized society is the restraint of power in relation to the powerless. Without doubt, humans are the most dangerous animal on earth and a growing threat to global survival.

While it is understandable that in order to survive, violence was required in the past, the human species remains unique in its expression of senseless, gratuitous violence far beyond what is required for continuance. *Homo sapiens* has developed extraordinary capabilities during its evolution that supposedly separate it from lower orders of the animal kingdom and previous forms of humans—the ability to reason, believe, imagine, and create; the possession

of a conscience and morality; and the ability to feel compassion and express love and affection beyond simple sexual gratification, to name only a few (Lerner, 1986). The human species has always lauded itself for its ability to be governed by a moral conscience that controls human behavior yet repeatedly we allow our animal instincts to prevail. The superego, the id, and the ego of Freud described the internal psychological struggle that all humans go through in determining their behavior. The id continues to persist in social evolution rather than atrophying as humankind becomes more civilized. Our self-pretentious belief in our superiority and civilization is overextended.

In contrast, however, the capacity of the human species to employ violence to kill other things and each other without reason or hesitation and without need continues to be a serious evolutionary developmental flaw that threatens the entire human race with extinction as our proficiency in killing continues to grow. We are the Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde of social evolution. We operate on the geopolitical military logical/illogical acronym of MAD (Mutually Assured Destruction) as our nuclear deterrent philosophy or what Lerner (1997) terms a "balance of terror" that has ruled Cold War and subsequent politics for 50 years (p. 89). You must possess the capability of responding and destroying your adversary after a pre-emptive attack that will in all likelihood destroy everything in your country. This is appropriately named. Despite the entire world being destroyed, one surviving military can claim ultimate victory. This truly is the ultimate deranged madness of patriarchy and is not viable as a survival strategy for the human race. Most of the major scientific and technological developments have been created in the service of military or business needs and are immediately put into service to increase the ability of the discoverer to eradicate their enemies or competitors and control the world. We pour trillions of dollars into war-making instead of peacemaking. In the animal world, combatants rarely fight to the death unless their own lives or territory are threatened. Humans seem incapable of exercising the same restraint. Humans will kill without reason and without provocation and thus by far are the most dangerous, unpredictable, and wasteful species ever to walk the earth. While aggression is a way of maintaining a hierarchy of order necessary to survive in the animal world, it is a serious problem in the human one.

In our modern patriarchal world we not only accept violence, we encourage, condone, and celebrate it, despite many platitudes to the contrary. Our paradoxical attitudes toward violence and many other issues are a hallmark of postmodernity. As O'Sullivan (2001) observes:

When patriarchy is the norm, then the top of the hierarchy is a white, male heterosexual. All sorts of violence and selection are carried out within the normative structures of patriarchy. Within the norms of patriarchy there are high correlations between position and gender and this positioning or favouring of males is legitimized by the culture through its political, economic, religious and educational institutions. The institutions of patriarchy, like any other deeply violent social formations, combine direct, structural and cultural violence into a vicious triangle. Patriarchy is not only an institutional structure that protects male privilege; it also serves as a legitimizing institution for the perpetration of male violence. (p. 164)

While violence may never be totally eradicated from the human species, it also does not need to be celebrated and socialized into human culture. We need to be serious about violence everywhere and all the time. Nonviolent modeling should be our primary goal as a society because of its fundamental importance in de-socializing violence. Rather than suppressing and sanctioning violence at every level of society, we openly accept it as a necessary adjunct to successful existence. We have a paradoxical and duplicitous stance toward violence that we celebrate in thousands of ways from sports, to media, to music to video games while decrying real violence in our society. We will never eradicate it as long as we allow these paradoxes to exist. Conquest is hard-wired into our psychological make-up from an early age. We cannot have it both ways. There are more positive ways to organize society that do not condone or include violence. Instead, we sanction mixed martial arts blood sports that metaphorically return to the symbolic Roman coliseum and the death of gladiators in the arena. If we find no difficulty in socializing a society *into violence*, we should also find no difficulty in socializing it *into peace and nonviolence*. The two alternatives are simply social and moral choices. If we say we are peaceful then we need to act that way and structure our society to socialize and reinforce that view. In contemporary postmodern society, under the guise of individual rights we have abdicated our collective social responsibilities to establish moral expectations encouraged by hedonistic, predatory capitalism. In today's world this is more and more the case. Morality is becoming more *laissez-faire* each day.

We both glorify and vilify violence and male aggression, creating a constant tension that creates paradoxical inconsistencies in our value structures, sending mixed messages about our social behavior, particularly to young people in their formative stages of development. These are in perpetual competition with each other. Our values and social conditioning are conflicted and inconsistent with democratic principles. While we intellectualize democracy, we actualize violence and authoritarianism. Our social, political, economic,

educational, and religious beliefs under the umbrella of patriarchy are forced—and as such give rise to constant antagonism between those who want a more democratic vision and those who support the controlling status quo. As Henry Giroux (2002) notes of the events following the September 11 terrorist attacks, militarism often intensifies patriarchal attitudes and anti-democratic assaults on dissent. We must create a social structure that mimics the ideals we want to achieve. We are troubled at the deepest psychological level over which of these values to embrace and which to reject.

Our entire social make-up and all the major institutions within it socialize society to be competitive and aggressive while paradoxically promoting peace and harmony. We live in a democratic social oxymoron. The two cannot continue to coexist. Violence is like drinking to an alcoholic—one drink could set off an orgy of drinking—just as one violent act triggers an orgy of violence throughout society and sanctions violent acts for others. Both set off a cascade of catastrophic effects for the alcoholic, the violent individual, and society. Nonviolence may be utopian, but this should be our goal nonetheless—yet we do little to realistically achieve it, and the stark reality is that we need to structure society to make it possible to achieve it. As Lerner (1997) asserts: “Such an Utopian approach may, in fact, be far more practical than the endless repetitions by politicians, statesmen and military leaders of worn-out and utterly inappropriate clichés of 19th-century wisdom” (p. 103). Eradicating violence involves coordinating the various institutions in society to send the same messages about sanctioned social behavior, not simply incarcerating people who perpetrate it. All serious social change requires change at the source, not the presentation of problems. Real arms control at the level of production, reductions in military spending, strict gun laws, and antiviolence socialization from the earliest years of life in education and parenting would begin the process of turning society around. We control nuclear proliferation at the source; why not weapons of all kinds? Why are small weapons acceptable but big weapons are not? The moral issue is identical. Our violent, pro-business culture must be radically altered if society is ever to evolve and progress, but if we do not make the structural and societal changes required it cannot be achieved. We need to disabuse ourselves of the notion that because someone is an employer they have a moral right to override the collective common sense of the public in conducting their business and to ruthlessly exploit people for personal gain. We have compartmentalized the morality of society and business, insulating business from the moral and legal consequences of their actions.

The solution to violence rests in economics, politics, militarism and social culture as well as socialization in self-control through education and social sanctions through governments. It does not require an army of classical economists or academics to know that people who have a decent standard of living and are treated fairly and equitably are much less inclined to be angry, frustrated, and violent than people who don't, yet our social and economic system continues to operate in ways that are diametrically opposed to this goal and to deny this to the vast majority of the world's population—in contrast, it actually encourages the problem rather than helping it. Capitalism encourages a culture in which the individual is only concerned with himself or herself. People who grow up in nonviolent cultures and families are less likely to be violent. This has huge implications for the role models of parents, educators, politicians, economists, and religious figures to do more than go through the motions of decrying violence and to move to action on violence of all kinds and at all levels. The most powerful human statement that leaders of Islam could make currently is to soundly condemn and disavow ISIL and other Islamic extremists, yet they remain silent on this issue. This is not rocket science. Currently, we live with a schizophrenic democratic social personality that idolizes and romanticizes violence while censuring and abhorring its effects. This is the essence of a destabilizing and destructive paradox within our postmodern neopatriarchal world.

Gender violence against women and their overall subordination is a major sub-component of patriarchy. They are inextricably intertwined. Gender violence encompasses violence against women as well as men and all other forms of violence perpetrated between the sexes. By far the most violent group by gender are men, and women suffer the most physical violence at their hands (Ehrenreich, 2001). When we think of violence we immediately think of physical forms of violence such as domestic abuse, rape, assault, murder, and other forms of sexualized violence driven by gendered power, but violence within patriarchy against women occurs in the economic marginalization of women who are often single parents, of wage inequity between men and women, and in the absence of women in other than token positions of power (A. Johnson, 2005). It also occurs in the system from schoolyard bullying and name calling to intimidation of employees by supervisors on the job. O'Sullivan (2001) indicates that violence against women crosses all cultural, religious, and regional boundaries in social, political, and economic systems.

Throughout their lives, women are disproportionately exposed to this gendered abuse and vilification at the hands of males starting with their

fathers and extending throughout their lives in their relationships with other men and their employment circumstances. Violence has myriad forms and intensities and permeates our social structures in such pervasive ways that we have become habituated to its effects. Like a heroin addict who can take a larger and larger hit before finally overdosing, as a society we are developing a higher and higher tolerance for social violence of all kinds and intensities because we are increasingly exposed to its reality vicariously through media and personal experience. Other forms of violence are not so obvious—cutting off funding for homeless shelters, cutting benefits and pensions, exploiting workers in sweatshops, and taking advantage of vulnerable women and children through pornography, to name only a few (Lerner, 1997; Walby, 1990). Genital mutilation is a particularly egregious example of patriarchal cultural violence against women that is most often perpetrated by women on their daughters, driven by archaic moral and cultural social codes (A. Johnson, 2005; Monagan, 2010; Walby, 1990). The cooperation of women in patriarchally driven cultural rights like stoning have a long history (Lerner, 1986).

We are saturated in a continuum of patriarchal violence that targets women particularly and extends from murder to subtle social exclusions and stereotyping. This mimics the authoritarian male social continuum that governs our society at large. We have been indoctrinated to respond aggressively and violently by our patriarchal culture when we are threatened in any way. Our responses can range from mild upset to vicious physical attacks. These forms of violence are all aspects of the culture of violence that animates patriarchy. Patriarchy and violence set the tone for socialized violent relationships between men and women and the social rules and structures that define them. The gender attributes of males contribute to and reciprocally reinforce patriarchy while also being the reference point against which all other elements of society are measured and shaped. The role of women has largely been influenced by patriarchal values that portray and socialize them as subordinate, submissive, and deferential to males (Connell & Messerschmidt, 2005). Women in particular have been subordinated and socialized within a patriarchal history and have been excluded from the concerns of “the history, culture, politics, and economy of (paid) work, industrial relations, and organizational studies” (Franzway, 2005, p. 270). History, for the most part, is the history of men, written by men about the exploits and achievements of men (French, 1985; Lerner, 1986; Smith, 1991). Coulter (2005) further suggests of more recent events:

As Boutilier and Prentice argue, the professionalization of history by the first half of the twentieth-century meant that the discipline became, by definition, one that "privileged male experience and preserved most permanent academic jobs for university-trained men" 52. Donald Wright is even more blunt: "Sexism not only protected the status of history as a masculine discipline but protected the academic labour market for men." 53. (p. 678)

The same can be said of literature, science, and technology (St. Pierre, 1999). Women and all other groups are afterthoughts in these disciplines if they are acknowledged or mentioned at all and are often portrayed in submissive, subordinate, and passive roles. The contributions of women are absent from our history books with few notable exceptions (Lerner, 1997).

The expression of violent patriarchy in society is one of male values, beliefs, and attitudes toward society and life. Patriarchy is expressed through the male gender with the support of physical sexual differences between men and women (physical strength, aggression, domination, etc.). Male models and norms continue to define what is acceptable and legitimated (St. Pierre, 1999). Violence is often directed at women in society by men, but violence between males through personal aggression, sports, wars, and other conflicts is also widespread. Within this elitist male view all other groups are marginalized using physical or other kinds of threats for the benefit of males in society (A. Johnson, 2005). It is an extraordinarily dysfunctional social view that taken to its ultimate conclusion leaves one man standing on earth as the ultimate victor in human competition. Is this a sustainable social model? Brunner (2002, pp. 705–706) quotes bell hooks (2000) about the effect of patriarchal thinking on society and women:

...an inferior and a superior party, one person is strong, the other weak, and that it is therefore natural for the powerful to rule over the powerless. To those who support patriarchal thinking, maintaining power and control is acceptable by whatever means.... While the contemporary feminist movement has done much to intervene with this kind of thinking, challenging and changing it, and by so doing offering women and men a chance to lead more fulfilling lives, patriarchal thinking is still the norm for those in power. (p. 97)

It is not that patriarchy is a problematic expression of specific gender relationships—although it is, it is that it becomes a way of thinking about *all* human relationships. It becomes generalized and normalized across our entire society (A. Johnson, 2005). Violence is the patriarchal framework of gender relationships between men and women and between men and other men.

One also cannot discuss gender and patriarchy without noting the use of rape against women as a systematic and systemic form of male violence and dominance employed to reinforce and enforce the unwritten code of patriarchy, particularly in developing or Middle Eastern countries or any areas of conflict throughout the ages (Lerner, 1986). Reproductive dominance is the ultimate form of male social power. Women can withhold their reproductive power selectively to ensure the best possible mate. Men can force their reproductive power on women. In most cases there is an acceptance of the right of the woman to withhold her reproductive power, much like the female of animal and bird species will. There is no acceptance of the male's right to force his advances on a female. This only happens in human species. There is extensive research indicating that men are the primary perpetrators of sexual violence. In Canada 98% of domestic violence is committed by men against women (O'Sullivan, 2001). Rape is about power, not sex, as Susan Brownmiller (1975) detailed in her book *Against Our Will: Men, Women and Rape*. Chowdhury's (2009) research indicates that single women in Bangladesh are targets of sexual harassment and violence and women are viewed as chattels of men with no rights. It is also about economics, race, and class. Sommers (1994) cites research showing that the potential of poor women to be raped was significantly higher than middle-class women. French (1985) points out that black women are three times more likely to be raped than white women. The reality is that one in four women can expect to be raped during their lifetime (Martin, 2001). A. Johnson (2005) indicates that up to one-half of American women can expect to experience some form of sexual violence in their lifetime. In Canada in 2014 the RCMP inquiry into almost 1200 missing or murdered Aboriginal women found they are four times as likely to be murdered as white women. Fifty-seven percent of Aboriginal women have been sexually abused. Of every 100 cases of sexual assault committed, only 6 are reported to police (Sexual Assault Statistics in Canada, 2014). Of every 100 Canadian sexual assault victims, only 12 will ever see the inside of a courtroom (Muisse, 2014). The act of penetration and images of penetration are pervasive in our social history and our modern culture. The erect phallus is a symbol of the power of men over women and weapons of war are simply extensions of this Freudian symbol. In this way our physical reality reflects our psychological one. All violence is ritualized and sexualized domination. Rape has been used by men throughout history as a conscious and intentional method of degradation and domination of women (and men) and is still employed in the same manner around the world today (Chowdhury, 2009;

Sommers, 1994). Male rape in prisons is employed as a similar form of social dominance in the absence of female victims. War and military conquest is still viewed as a male preserve where Alpha males do battle for pride dominance. Rape is simply another weapon in their arsenal to subordinate those they wish to dominate while carrying out a most primal act in a degrading and humiliating way.

In sub-Saharan African dictatorships and other unstable countries rape is employed as a military weapon of terror and degradation and as a way of brutalizing women to demonstrate total power and control over them. In the civil war in Libya there were reports of the dictator Muammar Gaddafi giving commands to his loyalists to murder civilians and rape women. Similar reports are now coming out of Iraq at the hands of ISIS fighters. Systematic military rape is never treated as a war crime although it is no different than the brutalizing and murdering of male and female civilians during conflicts. The ethos and the reality of military conquest throughout history is captured in just three words—not “god, king, and country” but “rape, pillage, and plunder.” Rape has been a key part of military conquest strategy for centuries whether in the Spanish conquistadores of Latin America or the comfort houses of Japan during World War II populated by Korean women. Rape was a common part of both World Wars I and II, with all armies participating in the practice, and continues to be so when female hostages are held by revolutionary groups. It occurred in Rwanda during the Hutu genocide and in Chechnya during the Russian occupation.

Rape is equally widespread in peaceful democratic developed nations despite legal sanctions and social disapprobation. Thanks to a decidedly blasé legal approach to rape resulting from a judicial common law written primarily by males, even today the vast majority of sexual assaults and rapes go unreported due to an insensitive male-biased legal system that still trivializes male behavior in this regard: the “boys will be boys” defense. Provocative dress, intoxication, and male implied sexual signals are still used as justifications for rape in civilized societies. In reality our courts turn a blind eye to sexual assault. In modern Western cultures rape is treated with mixed messages—sex is promoted and celebrated throughout society and in the media while forced sex is censured. Todd Akin, a 2012 Republican Senate candidate attempted to suggest there is “legitimate rape” which would not result in pregnancy (M. Williams, 2012). Women are expected to dress provocatively but are at risk for doing so. There is a clear double standard for women in this regard while there are no standards for males (Lerner, 1997). However it occurs, rape

is an expression of primal violence and domination of males over females and defies social control to this day. As O'Sullivan (2001) states: "Rape is not an illustration of passion; it is rather an illustration of the misuse of power. Rape is a desecration pure and simple" (p. 277).

Rape, then, is an expression of patriarchal domination and control (Chowdhury, 2009). Homosexual rape is no different (A. Johnson, 2005). Other forms of sexual violence are carried out through acts such as female genital mutilation (FGM), which is estimated to have been performed on a staggering 85–114 million women worldwide, an act of genital mutilation still practiced in many patriarchal African societies (A. Johnson, 2005; O'Sullivan, 2001). Monagan (2010) reports that the World Health Organization estimates that 100–140 million girls and women worldwide have been victims of FGM and an estimated 3 million girls each year are at risk of having the procedure done to them (pp. 180–181). Reich (1974) attributes the repression of normal sexuality to the development of patriarchal authoritarianism:

The history of the formation of ideology teaches us that every social system, consciously or unconsciously, uses the influencing of children to anchor itself in man's structure. If we follow the way in which the social order was transformed from matriarchy to patriarchy, we can establish the sexual education of the child as its central mechanism. (p. 249)

In opposition to the sexual evolution suggested within matricentric values dominating society, in contrast we are dominated by the repressive patriarchal psycho-sexual views of Sigmund Freud, the Catholic Church, and various fundamentalist Islamic beliefs (Lerner, 1986). The struggle for gender equity and against violence directed at women has not been easy or simple. Patriarchy operates in complex, conflicting ways that undercut resistance and change. As Lerner (1986) points out both sex and class are involved:

From the second millennium B.C. forward control over the sexual behavior of citizens has been a major means of social control in every state society. Conversely, class hierarchy is constantly reconstituted in the family through sexual dominance. Regardless of the political or economic system, the kind of personality which can function in a hierarchical system is created and nurtured within the patriarchal family. (pp. 216–217)

A final element of patriarchal cultural history that has had an ongoing and key impact on human development worldwide is racism. Fuelled by the elitism of patriarchy and religion, cultures since the beginning of time have

practiced racial bias in one form or another against other cultures (Miller, 2003; Lerner, 1997). Major Christian religions representing the white, Eurocentric worldview willingly assisted conquering nations in destroying active and vibrant indigenous aboriginal cultures around the world and are only the most egregious recent historical examples of this pattern of ethnic cleansing. Muslim and East Asian cultures participated in the same forced aggression and domination of various civilizations throughout the ages as well. Racism has not only been the purview of white races although they are most frequently and recently associated with its abuses. All races and cultures around the world have practiced their own forms of racism or ethnic cleansing leading to the maltreatment of minorities identified by dominant cultures or groups as different, subordinate, or sub-human. Racism is a subsystem of patriarchal attitudes. Lerner (1997) quotes the historian Dorothy Roberts (1993): "Racism is patriarchal. Patriarchy is racist. We will not destroy one institution without destroying the other" (p. 195). Whether the Publicans of the Bible, the South American Aztecs, Incas or Mayans, the Jews of Nazi Germany, the Romas of Hungary, the Muslims of Srebrenica, the unclean of India, the Aborigines of Australia, the Tutsi of Rwanda, or the First Nations and Inuit peoples of North America, all societies and cultures have been subject to racism and violence as a part of another culture's social dominance. In turn they have also participated in such racism as well. "Racism and patriarchy are used, privately and publicly, to rationalize people's dispossession of private or public autonomy" (Singh, 2005, p. 125). Racism is one of the many justifications for violent dispossession throughout history and continues to be so today (Lerner, 1997).

For the past several centuries the world has come to be dominated by the ascendancy of white European culture. No cultural group in history has had such a destructive and worldwide effect on the evolutionary progression of the human species as this group while also being responsible for tremendous advances. In addition, those whites who benefited from its ascension are also a tiny subset of the white race itself. From slaughtering bison to near extinction in the settlement of North America to committing genocide against the First Nations "savages" they encountered and destroying their societies and cultures, the white race has delivered horrendous arbitrary suffering to any other cultures that it came into contact with, many of whom welcomed them in peace and with open arms. However, the same can be said of the Spanish, Portuguese, and Chinese cultures as well. No culture is without blame. Currently the ISIS Islamic terrorists are carrying out a jihad to destroy Western infidels everywhere. Eurocentrism now saturates our global village with values

of whiteness that are reflected in media, government, consumer goods, social preferences, and geopolitical policies. Whiteness is the ethnic race that no one speaks of because it is the norm that all other societies and cultures are referenced against (Dickinson & Vasby Anderson, 2004). Apple (2006) speaks of whiteness as being the "absent presence" (p. 239). The same can be said of patriarchy. Lerner (1997) observes:

But "whiteness" as a constructed social category within a system of power bestows privileges on whites which are withheld from "Others." One of these privileges is that it is whites who do the defining of the social categories and who can remain unconscious of their own racial construction. (p. 194)

Patriarchy can be thought of in the same terms. Many early cultures such as the Chinese, First Nations, and the South American tribes were more highly evolved than the white Europeans who discovered them. They lived in sustainable harmony with nature and only took from it what they needed to feed their families (Lerner, 1997). They also had a more holistic and symbiotic relationship with nature and their gods. However, they were also highly patriarchal warrior cultures. The parallel evolution of patriarchal societies around the globe underscores the male-gendered nature of patriarchy that has arisen in virtually every hunter/gatherer and subsequent agrarian society despite geography, religious orientation, historical evolution, or political structures. It was the ascension and development of white society that changed the sociocultural landscape of history for the worse and combined with other coincidental historical developments to entrench its power across society. The problem for global society is that all cultures and nations are governed by patriarchal ideals so that no matter what social or governance structure is in place, it will be premised on male worldviews that result in the impoverishment of the many for the whims of the few.

Racism has also played a key part in the evolution of capitalism. As Moody (1997) states:

Though it is an old, unscientific way of viewing the differences among human beings, both ideologically and institutionally, racism played such a crucial role in the origins of capitalism and has been reproduced over these hundreds of years in many so different ways, it is virtually impossible to separate it from the geographic, economic, occupational, social, and ideological structures of modern capitalist society. The argument that capitalism, as a social and economic system, does not "need" racism to function is simply too abstract because the history of this social-economic system is too intertwined with the history of white-supremacist ideology and occupational

segregation—first and foremost through slavery and colonialism, and later under conditions of rural peonage and wage labor. (p. 155)

Force, violence, and domination are the tools of advancement employed by and endemic to patriarchy and thus to our present society. It is the only way to impose a social caste system that is both unfair and inequitable while rewarding a small male elite for doing so. The problem today is that while throughout history the gap between the rich and the poor, the rewarded and the denied has always been large, there was always a general sense (mostly misguided) that this balance was being redressed with each successive generation as society became more civilized and more and more people were benefitting from society under free-enterprise capitalism. The historical and economic data over the past centuries simply do not bear this out—quite the contrary. There is no factual evidence to support this and there is massive empirical evidence to refute it. Relative to the successful few, the majority have lived in squalor. In the past century following industrialization, however, the balance of deficits and benefits has become increasingly skewed in favor of a shrinking minority of extremely wealthy and powerful people at the top of the pyramid, leading to a general feeling that the majority in society are regressing, rather than progressing. Advancement for humanity has always been deceptively relative. The gains that have been made in the standard of living of more people around the world have been purchased at an enormous and growing cost relative to the benefits received, which are marginal at best. To improve the wages of working people by even a few dollars, billions must be earned in profits by the companies in return. The relative rate of exploitation of working people and the public has increased astronomically in the past half century as indicated by skyrocketing wealth/poverty inequality data (Wilkinson & Pickett, 2010). The health and well-being of the worlds' wealthiest and most powerful has skyrocketed exponentially to only produce modest gains in quality of life for the rest. The richest countries in the world such as the United States regularly rank last among developed countries in the amount of GDP they dedicate to social programs and have a tax system that heavily favors the wealthy (Hertz, 2003). In this sense, modern civilization is in reality more exploitative than in the past. With the massive growth in the global wealth and income of the top 1% and the relative stagnation of the rest, the world is moving backward in economic equity terms, not forward (Kersley & O'Sullivan, 2013). Because a larger number of people (still a small percentage of the world's population) lives a bit better does not mean that things are improving

for the majority. A Dutch statistician, Jan Pen, created a way of showing historical economic social position in the form of a parade that takes one hour and that demonstrates a society's relative wealth by the heights of the people marching by, beginning with the poorest and ending with the wealthiest. What is striking is how few people have significant stature until the last few seconds of the parade. Those at the end of Pen's economic parade become stratospheric giants (McQuaig & Brooks, 2010). The rest are all relatively comparable in height and income. This economic reality has led to growing tensions worldwide. What we are now seeing is the full expression and extension of patriarchal global capitalism in all its destructive potential.

Our contemporary world is an amalgam of leadership, racism, gender relationships, economics, politics, religion, education, and social culture all united under the banner of patriarchy that one cannot examine or change by critiquing any individual part of our global world in isolation. A multivariate approach is required that examines the interrelationships between social institutions and their origins if we are ever to unravel the complexities of patriarchy and violence (Lerner, 1997).

Beyond Patriarchy

Patriarchy is the apex of the ideological hierarchy—the over-arching umbrella ideology that governs all others and every aspect of human existence. Patriarchy subsumes all ideologies within it and was the core influence of all other ideologies as they evolved. It is the oldest ideology still in existence today and yet despite its pre-eminence, it receives only marginal attention in the social evolution of society or the daily events of humankind. It is and has been the most powerful transparent conceptual force since the beginning of time and has spawned all major religious traditions, economic philosophies, and social beliefs for the past 6000 years and beyond (von Werlhof, 2007). Despite this, it is rarely the focus of popular attention or scholarly discussion in relation to its seminal and continuing role in the development of the major social institutions of democratic society as we currently know it and the complex and integrated manner in which it forms a web of power and control over our daily lives. Patriarchy is accepted and as a result ignored as a background factor in leadership, economics, education, politics, and religion when in fact it is the critical part of all these institutions and every aspect of human awareness. It is the elephant in the room in every discussion or situation of social functioning.

Rather than being a mainstream topic of academic and popular study, it is relegated to the margins of academic research in such fields as radical feminist and other peripheral theories of human development that are dismissed as being extreme, biased, anachronistic, and irrelevant. Gilligan and Richards (2009) note this problem in their study titled *The Deepening Darkness: Patriarchy, Resistance & Democracy's Future*:

We are aware that our focus on patriarchy is controversial, both because the word itself has lost its root meaning, becoming something of a code word for men's oppression of women, and, we believe, because of a reluctance to confront the effects of patriarchal demands on men and the complicity of women in enforcing such demands on men, on one another, and on the next generation. We are struck by the fact that discussions of gender are often dismissed now as passé—that the darkness associated with gender, the patterns of loss, traumatic rupture of relationships, repression of an ethically resisting voice and also of what might be called sexual voice continue into the present, at times with increasing fervor, despite or perhaps because of the gains toward equality and liberation that women and men have made over the past decades. (p. 4)

Lerner (1986) expresses a similar concern regarding the millennial-long complicity of women in the evolution of patriarchy. Part of the reason for this is also the socialized normalization of gender relationships that privileges one form of academic and human knowledge over another and that idolizes traditional leadership research above critical leadership study. This social acceptance of gender relationships also leads even today's women to accept the subordinate positions they are in without significant self-awareness of the reasons for their situation and without questioning or challenging it (St. Pierre, 1999). This book would assert that rather than being passé, patriarchy is central to our understanding of who we are and who we must become.

Few historical or other forms of analyses put patriarchy at the center of the ideological universe and seriously confront, attribute, or hold it accountable for the evolutionary or current behavior of global society, nor do they give serious credence to the depth of its influence, the gravity of its implications for the future, or its pervasiveness in modern human experience. Patriarchy is the ideological Rosetta stone of humanity. For example, among the thousands of academic articles and theoretical pieces written each year on leadership, few of them even mention patriarchy directly and even fewer make it their primary focus, particularly among male researchers (Keamy, 2008). The study of patriarchy is restricted to developing or Third World cultures where traditional patriarchy is more explicit, but even here the research is limited

on this topic compared to that of, say, leadership. Patriarchy is an invisible and ignored backdrop to leadership research that is accepted and normalized (Bierema, 2003; Lerner, 1986). The very structure of academic institutions and study themselves mediate in favor of reinforcing traditional, hierarchal, and patriarchal views of leadership and other topics. Professors have superior/subordinate relationships with their students, limiting the latter's ability to think openly and creatively and socializing them into acceptable traditional academic discourse. Scientific research frowns on qualitative research while endorsing factually based empirical studies. Peer review effectively becomes peer censorship that restricts change and the free exchange of academic ideas. These analyses choose instead an insular silo approach to their area of study without making a causal link to the ideology of patriarchy or other arenas of society. Linking social institutions to patriarchy immediately problematizes them and makes them much more difficult to assess, rationalize, defend, and change. While many scholars, theorists, and researchers focus on specific theories or a particular discipline within social history, few examine their areas of expertise in the full context of patriarchy or even of other scholarly or popular topics that may be relevant to their discipline. Most scholars have their disciplinary blinders on. The influence of rational science and thought with its focus on compartmentalized, detailed data as the unit of focus encourages a consideration of the minutia of daily life rather than a more holistic view of social problems that would lead to a fuller understanding of the forces at work in our world. In reverse, we can see the trees but not the forest. It is much easier to dismiss scientific study that takes this approach because it is so particularistic that thousands of studies need to be assembled over decades to provide any reasoned direction. In many cases this process means many problems are never solved because by the time they are fully examined the problem has mutated—particularly when studying social phenomena.

A more holistic approach to research looking at larger issues from a historical perspective would trigger macro insights into problems that could then trigger more specific research to validate the assumptions. This would be much more efficient and effective than current scientific theorizing and study. It is easier to ignore the problems that the study of patriarchy brings to bear on a self-contained concept such as leadership. This fragmented and blinkered approach to academic study that is a derivative of rational scientific philosophy and method isolates and fragments research issues and de-contextualizes them from the full spectrum of historical significance that gives meaning to their implications. The discovery of nuclear fission is a clear example. Scientists

naively believed it would be used for positive purposes. Critical theory embraces this diversity in its analysis of society and considers it crucial to effective examination of social evolution and problem solving (Brookfield, 2005).

Any academic investigation that does not consider patriarchy within its study is left incomplete due to its compartmentalized focus on a specific phenomenon such as leadership, economics, religion, or education while the reality of social experience is that all these social institutions are integrated and interactive at all times. They are collectively governed and directed by patriarchy and its incumbent ideology. A multiple, comprehensive, and multivariate qualitative analysis must be employed to consider all these key social elements as outgrowths of patriarchy and analyze them in this context using quantitative analysis to complement them (Lerner, 1997). When we place it in its proper place at the center of social history, and at the apex of the ideological values hierarchy, with all other ideologies organized beneath it, the rest of social/historical development makes sense and becomes clearer. De-contextualized, irrelevant, and disconnected events are given meaning. The dominance of patriarchy also becomes much more problematic. We need to understand both the diachronic and synchronic relevance of patriarchy in social development and, more importantly, the social dysfunction it creates.

The reasons behind contemporary social phenomena and social problems are firmly rooted in the foundation of patriarchy upon which they rest and its iron grip on our conscious and subconscious intellectual development. Any reasoned assessment of this phenomenon must necessarily be a conclusive indictment of the society that permitted this evolution to occur and of those who profited from it. Prior to being able to introduce healthy changes that can transform society from a patriarchal culture to post-patriarchal and fully democratic one, it is necessary to understand the depth and complexity of the influence of patriarchy today. It is also necessary to begin to challenge and expose their accepted premises and ideological rationales. This process is akin to the courage of Copernicus challenging the accepted view of the universe as revolving around the earth in the Middle Ages (Lerner, 1986). As Lerner (1993) states of change in women's status in society:

While the development is uneven, depending as it does on the existence of women's movements, it is also irreversible. Once the basic fallacy of patriarchal thought—the assumption that a half of humankind can adequately represent the whole—has been exposed and explained, it can no more be undone than was the insight that the earth is round, not flat. (p. 273)

To accomplish this we must examine the history of patriarchy and its presence in our modern world. O'Sullivan (2001) observes that despite evidence of peaceful and democratic cultures in anthropological history, "we are nevertheless led to a very critical perspective on our own historical legacy which appears to be deeply embedded in a hierarchical conception of power that comes specifically from the structures of patriarchy" (p. 136). To study patriarchy and its effects on world history and social development is to call into question and attempt to fully understand the entire evolution of humanity, and much of what constitutes our current world, its purpose and its fundamental validity and sustainability. It is also to directly challenge the self-righteous arrogance of modern Western democracies to call themselves "the chosen ones." The study of patriarchy is beyond culture, leadership, politics, economics, religion, and education but also an integral part of them. They are the corpus of patriarchy. A critical analysis of this ideology calls into question the underpinnings of our modern social structures and beliefs and attacks the credibility of their moral claims of civilized superiority and advanced development for humankind. Critical approaches reveal the reality behind the rhetoric, thus providing a window of opportunity for change.

Until society understands, accepts, and acknowledges the key, pervasive, and ongoing role of patriarchy in social history, it cannot begin to move beyond it into a post-patriarchal society. Patriarchy has existed since the dawn of recorded time and has evolved to the present day as society has evolved, while firmly maintaining and enhancing its grip on social beliefs and development. As it evolves, its pervasively negative effects multiply exponentially. It is flexible and malleable but it does not relinquish its grip on this process—far from it. It operates in an invasive and pernicious manner, colonizing human consciousness and social behavior in ways that are subtle and insidious. It has become so advanced within contemporary civilization that it is virtually impossible to eradicate. It is possible, however, to expose its effects, challenge its premises, and change its path by revealing the duplicity and dangers of its position to humankind. Despite the struggles of society against patriarchy and its expressions, its dominance remains largely unquestioned and unchallenged in anything other than the academic community. Patriarchy is literally and figuratively the invisible ideological Big Brother of Orwell's 1984.

The philosophical theory of patriarchy has been completely ingrained in our deepest social psyche from the beginning of time (French, 1985; Lerner, 1986) and is driving us toward the end of human existence. This view is not irreversible or fixed in biological determinism, Biblical certainty, or political

apathy, but is a conscious choice we are making individually and collectively every day in every moment of our lives to support, ignore, or acquiesce to its influence. In our obsession with hedonistic “presentism” and materialism we are mortgaging and jeopardizing the future for generations to come (Lerner, 1997). We are debasing human morality, compassion, and cooperation in the process. Patriarchy is alive and well in our leadership models, workplaces, homes, shopping malls, on television, in sports and leisure activities, in our governments, religions, educational and legal systems, and in our economic institutions. It is the most insidious form of social control that has ever evolved because it is self-monitoring, self-regulating, self-policing, and self-replicating. The hegemony of patriarchy is pervasive. Each day that we turn a blind eye its damaging effects puts us a day closer to extinction.

We continually focus on the problem, not the cause, in many of our futile attempts to cure social ills, yet if we focus on the damaging influence of patriarchy we can simultaneously enhance the health of all our global social institutions and dramatically improve our world by endorsing the autonomy and freedom of the person and the inalienable right of all people to a fully enfranchised, active, participatory, and substantive democracy. By focusing on dealing with social issues in a manner that is consciously less patriarchal, we can immediately begin to affect significant real change in the world. This means thinking of everyone’s self-interest beyond our own but not to the exclusion of our own. Global society is slowly realizing the huge social democratic charade that is being perpetrated on the citizens of the world and they are resisting as they have for centuries. Global dysfunction is a clear signal that something is seriously wrong in how we run our societies and how we relate as genders. A change in philosophy will bring big changes in practice. Every decision made from a patriarchal base is a decision to deny other people human dignity, autonomy, and freedom. This requires both men and women to use their personal power to make change. As millions of years of evolutionary development have shown, the human species is nothing more than a small blip on a massive anthropological radar screen. We must all learn to view our role in human society as an integral part of every other on earth, however small or insignificant. Every act of neglect of this obligation comes back to us where we live. Half the planet cannot continue to use up the majority of its resources while the other half goes without. People cannot continue to live in wealth when people a few blocks away or a few countries away live in poverty. We are truly becoming Marshall McLuhan’s (Schafer, 2008) global village, with global responsibility to every person on the planet. We need to

globalize human compassion, not economics. We are a worldwide interrelated ecosystem and one part cannot ignore its responsibilities to the other parts that make it work. Moving away from patriarchal thinking opens the doors to the open and equitable sharing of the world's wealth and creates immediate, real solutions to intractable issues such as poverty, homelessness, health, and economic well-being.

To accomplish this requires changing the dominance of males in the social organization and operation of cultures around the world. This is an indisputable fact that cannot any longer be ignored and remains unchanged today. Men do not have the right to run the world. It is one of the most fundamental challenges that humanity must come to grips with if it is to move forward (Femea, 2003). If we are to ever reach a higher level of civilization, we will have to actively restructure our social psyche and development to create a more harmonious, equitable, and balanced future for the human race. To do this we must make a conscious, aggressive, and purposeful effort to forgo and actively censure all violence as the solution to problems, and begin an active, honest dialogue about violent, patriarchal gender relationships and their impact on social institutions and decision making. We must challenge unreasonable and ineffective authority that does not serve the collective needs of everyone and pays lip-service to the electorate, dismantle and restructure vertical organizational bureaucracies that buttress the ideology of patriarchy, and demand the development of participatory democracy in all governments and organizations around the world while working collectively to share the wealth of the earth in an equitable and sustainable way. This will require courage, fortitude, and action by leaders and governments who are not listening to the cries of their citizens to "let their people go." Socialism and social democracy are the right ideas ideologically—they have simply been hijacked by patriarchal authoritarian regimes such as Communism. Despite this, we do have some positive examples of working social democracies in the Scandinavian countries. We need to look to their positive social models to begin our journey.

In many ways this seems idealistic, but in reality it only requires changes in thinking and then policies to make massive differences around the world. While it is easy to do, it is an enormous challenge. We must demand open, democratic values from our politicians and leaders. Changing the mental and practical stranglehold that patriarchy has on society is a huge hurdle to cross. Self-realization and change is the most difficult act to carry out and must be done collectively as a shared mass of humanity. The era of the nation state, different religions, and opposing cultures is in the past and must be left behind

as we build a free global society. In a post-patriarchal, truly globalized, and democratic world these differences will gradually merge into one amorphous multicultural, multi-faith, tolerant human society where difference does not define social policy or geopolitical conflict and men and women are treated as equals. Realizing such a world is neither simple nor easy and will require difficult choices by governments and peoples everywhere for centuries to come and a serious effort to intentionally abandon practices and beliefs that have created the current inequitable world we live in. It also requires us to collectively realize and bring into being practices that create true equality, democracy, and freedom for every human being and every natural species on our planet. If we start from the premise that everyone has the right to own everything and negotiate what that means in real-life terms, we might be able to make a start. Private property has divided up the world as well as its people. Patriarchy is the biggest ideological terrorist threat facing humanity and we must confront it as aggressively as other forms of extremism. Patriarchy is a massive challenge but we must begin somewhere. This book attempts to do this. It will take real leadership, real collaboration, and real consensus to achieve this change, not the false domineering forms of these concepts that we currently practice.

We need to start walking the talk. As O'Sullivan (2001) points out regarding what he terms the "new socialism":

The new socialism is based on workers' and peoples' control of their workplaces and communities, of the important conditions and decisions that affect their lives. It means the end of double and dishonest discourse. Personal lifestyles should be in accord with public discourse. Intellectuals cannot critique neoliberalism and then engage in frenzied consumption of imported consumer goods. One cannot preach equality up to the doorstep of one's household and then practice authoritarian (patriarchal) politics within the family. The new socialism recognizes the complexity of the contradictions in the transition-foremost the need to democratize gender, ethnic and race relations, a key element in the transition from globalism to a new socialism. (p. 172)

The "new socialism" O'Sullivan speaks of is not a political but a social and cultural concept much like the age of culture envisioned by Schafer (2008) that moves beyond an "economic age" and the politics, gender, and economics of division to a new age of shared human collaboration and freedom. The "new socialism" that O'Sullivan (2001) speaks of is really the "new democracy" where the ideal of substantive democracy is realized for all people everywhere and becomes an inalienable global right of all citizens, rather than

the preserve of selected elites. It is the “work democratic society” referred to by Reich (1974) decades ago and the “deliberative democracy” described by Young (2000) (cited in LiPumaa & Koelbleb, 2009, pp. 203–204). This belief and desire for real democracy is not new, nor unique among people everywhere. The place to begin to change it is through education. Maxcy (1991) describes the belief in this form of democracy of the great American educator, John Dewey:

Dewey pegs his conception of participatory democracy to human nature. He proposes that we must have faith in the capacities of human nature, human intelligence, and pooled and cooperative experience. Dewey finds himself in direct opposition to the view that some autocrat or authoritarian scheme is better. The notion that a select superior few, because of inherent natural gifts, are endowed with the ability or right to control the conduct of others Dewey finds contrary to his ideal of democracy. Although his conception of democracy is relatively recent in history, he states, “men’s minds and feelings are still permeated with ideas about leadership imposed from above, ideas that developed in the long history of mankind” (Dewey, 1937, p. 458). (pp. 63–64)

Nothing has appreciably changed in terms of our conceptions of leadership since Dewey asserted this position. A century later we are no closer to the democracy that Dewey spoke of. Democratic societies and their leaders often spend more time denying and controlling democratic freedoms than they do liberating them. It is to this process that we now turn.

THE NEW PATRIARCHY

How does patriarchy or neopatriarchy become part of the attitudes of the individual? It is by the relentless domination of the older male. The inner structure of the patriarchal family is constituted by relations of authority, domination and dependency, which both reflect and are reflected in the structure of social relations. —Femea, 2003

Patriarchy in a Postmodern World

Postmodernism has revealed the layered complexity of the patriarchal paradigm and its unrelenting, intransigent effect on our social values. Patriarchy has proved much more resilient and difficult to eradicate than anyone believed. It moved from aristocratic and priestly elites to the current political, economic, managerial, and technological ones (French, 1985; Lerner, 1986; 1993). It is expressed through modernist rational beliefs in our society. Elkind (1995) describes the key reasons for the changing values from modernism to postmodernism that have dominated recent history and are expressive of the core values of patriarchy. They can be used to justify both good and evil acts:

Postmodernism has been germinating for a long time. However, it is not a revolt against the beliefs of modernity. Rather, it is perhaps best regarded as a set of attitudes

and efforts designed to modify and correct modern ideas that have been perverted and modern beliefs that have proved to be too broad or too narrow. For example, while modernism regarded reason as the engine of human progress, rational arguments have also been used to justify barriers to human progress, such as slavery, colonialism, imperialism, and fascism. Likewise, modernity stressed the freedom of the individual, but this freedom was often restricted to male, Anglo-Saxon, Christian individuals. The modern belief in the unmitigated benefits of scientific and technological progress did not anticipate the use of advanced knowledge to create ever more powerful weapons of destruction, nor did it take into account the contribution of technological progress to the degradation of the environment. Modern beliefs were not entirely wrong, but they were often idealized and blind to the dark side of human nature, of scientific discovery, and of technological development. (p. 10)

Within this modernist paradigm, *might has* always been right and continues to be the *raison d'être* of modern geopolitics. Postmodernism was the social awakening to the duplicity of the upbeat view of modernism. Under the pressure of postmodern challenges, modernism began to create a superficial cover for its more problematic views so that they could continue without challenge. Violence, conquest, and domination have defined history and leadership as they continue to define our contemporary life. They are now disguised beneath a thin social veneer of outwardly civilized conduct and lifestyles. Military warfare still pervades our global society as do more subtle forms of economic, social, political, educational, and religious institutional domination. Patriarchy is not a historical curiosity but a living, breathing, and dangerous entity that continues to be a palpable presence in all our lives and to expand, act on, invade, and influence our world in a host of negative ways—although its effects are currently most often masked by deceptively civilized superficial discourse and liberal democratic politics and policies. Much of the oppression of patriarchy is hidden, but some is obvious and dangerous. The more egregious examples of human barbarism have been transformed into civilized and restrained forms of the same cruelty. People are now slaughtered by accidental gas leaks in Bhopal, India, or radioactive nuclear meltdowns in Chernobyl and Fukushima, resulting from the pursuit of self-interested private economic success rather than through conquest on the battlefield. But the casualties are still the same. Ethnic violence continues to take thousands of lives around the world in places such as Serbia, Croatia, Rwanda, Iraq, and now Syria and across the Muslim world. No less horrific are those women such as Malala Yousafzai, an innocent girl who was shot because she spoke in favor of education for girls. Those who die or are injured in this way are the collateral damage of capitalism and of the barbarism of patriarchy—the

accepted attrition rate of wealth creation and superior cultural male attitudes and behavior similar to that of war—the cost of doing business required to ensure their dominance. As long as we continue to think in this manner we will continue to endure chaos and turmoil around the world. Patriarchy is a real and daily threat to human civilization.

The most powerful and negative expression of patriarchy has been and still is the tradition of male superiority and heroic leadership and the value structure they generate (Coulter, 2003). “To the victor go the spoils” is a representation of this flawed paradigm that continues to rule our world. Patriarchy continues to generate ambivalent feelings toward its expression—society is at once repulsed and attracted to its values, and therein lies the problem. We continue to believe that we can manage with patriarchy and it is the only way to manage. Thousands of years ago we made an evolutionary turn that we are unable to correct. But we can reshape it.

Despite points in history where apparent progress was made in more advanced democratic societies by oppressed groups such as the suffragette movement for the women’s vote early in the 20th century, the civil rights movement in the 1960s, and affirmative action and women’s liberation in the 1960s, 70s, and 80s, modern neopatriarchy has reabsorbed these anomalies into its control and regained its prominence (A. Johnson, 2005; Vavrus, 2002). Any gains achieved by the labor, feminist, or the civil rights movements have been rolled back and dismantled by the rise of the neoconservative backlash in the 1990s and are under attack again (Lerner, 1997). The ultimate gains have been minuscule in comparison to the level of exploitation and right-wing, conservative ideological dominance that continues to expand and occur under its banner. These important social gains have been eroded to reduce their impact to negligible levels of mythologized fantasy that serves to sustain belief that change is possible.

One example is the recent historical gains in women’s rights over the past 50 years in Western democracies, achieved through the advent of feminism and the women’s rights movement in the 1960s, that have been undermined by the gradual acceptance and acquiescence of women with neoconservative and neoliberal patriarchal expectations that reasserted themselves in the 1990s. Women have been co-collaborators through their silence and unawareness in the continuance of patriarchy and its social structure and this raises questions regarding future social change related to it (Lerner, 1997; Mackinnon & Bullen, 2005). After a period of apparent advancement and success from the 1960s to 1980s, women’s issues have been relegated to the back burner

across society with the resurgence of neoliberalism and neoconservatism in the 1990s and the silencing of the feminist movement as voices of change. As Brookfield (2005) points out, "patriarchy allows a degree of carefully managed feminist critique as a way of heading off a more sustained challenge to the system" (p. 310). This is consistent with Herbert Marcuse's term "repressive tolerance" where a certain amount of resistance and criticism is allowed socially to prevent open revolution (Brookfield, 2005; A. Johnson, 2005). It is a way of maintaining the status quo. Tan (2009) reports a similar strategy used in Singaporean governance. We are allowed to live with the illusion of dissent (Brookfield, 2005).

This theme of controlled dissent to ensure the continuance of the status quo is a familiar one to patriarchal societies. Advances for women in traditionally male areas of leadership and positions of responsibility have been rolled back and the relatively modest achievements of women breaking through the "glass ceiling" during this period have had the effect of lulling women into believing that equal rights and equity with males have been achieved across the broad spectrum of society. Nothing could be further from the truth for the majority of women. This vision of equity was premised on women (primarily white and middle-class) being considered equal by being allowed to take on and participate in the patriarchal power structures of most organizations and governments (A. Johnson, 2005). This was not the vision of black feminists, however, who were an exception to this pattern. Capper (1998) cites the work of Patricia Collins (1991) in making the point that this was not the goal of all women: "Black women's empowerment is distinct from existing models of power as domination. Black women have not conceptualized our quest for empowerment as one of replacing elite white male authorities with ourselves as benevolent Black female ones' (p. 224)" (p. 361). Black women understood that populating traditional male leadership approaches was not the answer to changing patriarchy.

These gains for women did nothing to change the fundamental relationships of patriarchy—in fact, they have had the effect of further entrenching it. In reality, women have been reabsorbed by patriarchy and are now willing and active co-conspirators in its oppression and continuation (French, 1985). Miles (1993) refers to this as "patriarchal clawback" (p. 279). For white women this is in effect what has occurred. Women have achieved socially superficial rather than deep-structure paradigmatic change. The reality is that women may be further away from real autonomy today than they were 50 years ago. They have been co-opted into the system by the small gains that

have been achieved and have been reabsorbed back into a resurgent neopatriarchal world dominated by free-market capitalism and right-wing neoconservatism (Femea, 2003).

The forces of neopatriarchal inertia in society are the forces of male power, money and might, or "god, guns, and greed" that control the governments, economic systems, and military of the world. Much of the violence of leadership in modern society is more often silently sublimated within social discourse and daily life and a rationalization for the excesses of patriarchy. This is clearly still in evidence in Middle Eastern and African countries where fundamentalist patriarchy continues to be unchanged and a deeply embedded part of the social culture of these societies (Celikten, 2005; Femea, 2003). Erdreich (2002) characterizes the complex and conflicted postmodern attitudes of young Palestinian/Israeli university women to the pull of their traditional family values in contrast to their awakening political and intellectual understanding of its unequal influence on them. These values are a continued source of sectarian violence worldwide as people struggle to free themselves from their bonds. Most research studies today focus on overtly patriarchal societies such as those in developing or Third World, Middle Eastern, or East Indian countries where traditional patriarchy is still dominant but tend to ignore the still virulent subliminal and diverse effects of neopatriarchy in developed nations and Western democracies (Afisi, 2010; Al-Jenaibi, 2010; Celikten, 2005; Ibrahim, 2010; Monagan, 2010; Nagar, 2000). We self-righteously believe we have accomplished more than we actually have to achieve social equality.

In reality, we are becoming more refined in how we enact violence on populations. It is subtly integrated within interpersonal relationships through domestic violence, in the economic violence of capitalism, and streamed in the subliminal messages that are contained in our daily electronic media—what Vavrus (2002) refers to as "social imperialism" (p. 368). All of these forces skew the natural human values of people away from equity, collaboration, compassion, honesty, ethics, democracy, and concern for one's fellow man or woman to gratuitous values of violence, stereotyping, self-interested greed, wealth, materialism, competitiveness, and hedonism. The latter values sanction self-aggrandizing violence for control and power of the few over the many. In our modern world they are almost without exception the values of the neoconservative and neoliberal right.

The constant onslaught of violence and adult sexual content in the media that is streamed without interruption into living rooms around the world

habituates and inures modern children and adults to violence and adult sexuality and their destructive impacts on our psychological values by depersonalizing their effects through the cool and passive medium of television. We have become blasé about their presence among us. The rising challenges of post-modern thought toward modernism have also been exploited by modernist forces to take advantage of the loosening of the conceptual bonds of modernist values. Corporate media controls our perspectives through its selection and treatment of social issues, creating a belief that materialist social beliefs are positive, widely held values rather than the creation of a small, self-interested corporate margin of society for their own benefit.

The exact opposite is true for the vast majority of people other than those who profit from the fiction of the latter value set. Positive and constructive human values are now manipulated within both corrupt corporate and democratic institutions and governments. They objectify and separate people into winners and losers and only place value on humanity if it has economic benefits (Schafer, 2008). These amoral economic values drive and determine “national interests,” “social entitlements,” and geopolitical decision making while ignoring any abstract, subjective, or human-oriented social needs or wants in their calculus unless someone can profit from them (Schafer, 2008). As soon as profit is introduced, someone is going to suffer to deliver that profit, whether it is people, animals, or the environment. Western nations invaded Iraq under the pretence of restoring “democracy” but primarily to privatize massive strategic oil reserves and secure restoration contracts (Klein, 2008) while countries such as Somalia, Ethiopia, and other sub-Saharan nations where starvation kills millions each year are ignored because their countries and peoples have nothing of economic value to Western free enterprise. In response, many of these countries have been taken over by highly patriarchal extremist factions such as Al Qaeda, Boko Haram, and more recently ISIS who find opportunities to grow their “business” of theological modernist dogmatism (Klein, 2002).

Within human society gender, leadership, and religion have been the most powerful and dominant expressions of patriarchy since the earliest recorded time and have created the conflicted social values and political institutions that we take for granted today. We are allowed to live at the pleasure of patriarchal dominance. These major forces are primarily responsible for the codification, socialization, and internalization of patriarchy around the world. It is ironic that in a society that prides itself on postmodernity, democracy, civilization, and progress, we continue to inculcate and perpetuate a stereotypical,

anachronistic, and archaic form of modernist gender dominance and leadership throughout our global world. We are currently living in postmodern modernism.

Both developed and underdeveloped countries around the globe may disagree on economic, geopolitical, and social values, but they all have a tacit agreement about the continuance of patriarchy. In effect we have parallel socio-psychological worlds existing one within another that continually cross-influence and conflict with each other. We experience social progression within ideological regression and stasis. While our societies have made major scientific, theoretical, and social advances, our gender relationships, leadership paradigms, economic theories, and religious traditions are still mired in the long-distant archaic, heroic, and patriarchal past. Whether it is the traditional father of the Western fundamentalist Christian family or the more extreme and unquestioned ruling patriarch of the Middle Eastern tribe or clan, the rule of patriarchal dominance is the same. As Lerner (1986) suggests: "The patriarchal family is the cell out of which the larger body of patriarchal dominance arises. Sexual dominance underlies class and race dominance" (p. 209). In essence we have been rewriting the same story for thousands of years. We can no longer see the forest for the trees (Eliade, 1976).

Despite progressive changes for women and other marginalized groups within our current civilized Western world, major gains in employment equity, voting, and domestic rights over the past century have not particularly conferred any more real social power over the lives of most women than they have had in past ages (French, 1985). While women in developed countries have increased their presence in the public workforce and taken on major political and corporate responsibilities, their numbers are still insignificant in relationship to the dominance of males in these fields. Women's participation remains token for the most part. For the majority of women around the world today the reality of their lives continues to be one of patriarchal dominance and subordination whether personally perceived or not. Their aspirations for equity are largely ignored, trivialized, or violently rejected. The much touted progress in women's rights in North America and Europe are false gains made generally by white, middle-class women who have done little to significantly affect the situation of the majority of the world's women, particularly women of color (A. Johnson, 2005). In the shift to extreme right-wing values in the 1990s most of the gains made by women have been lost. While they have set an example to be emulated, they have done little else.

What clouds this issue is the number of women who have assumed positions of responsibility and are believed to have brought a new style of leadership to these roles when, in fact, women who have broken through the glass ceiling have simply taken the reins of dominance over other women and men into their own hands without affecting the fundamental patriarchal dynamics of leadership. The subordination that women endure is now more subtle and applied within a civilized social framework by both male and female leaders, but it is enforced subordination nonetheless (A. Johnson, 2005). We continue to ignore the damage and destruction that occur as a result of its impacts and we continue to attribute other causes and remedies to issues that have their basis in patriarchal relationships, attitudes, and structures.

Patriarchy, leadership, education, gender, and religion are the powerful major symbiotic allies that have sewn together our cultural history for thousands of years and that together have defined it as well. This history has excluded the majority of participants in it and minimized their role in its evolution while extolling that they were part of the "grand design." This exclusion has extended to ignoring the massive and ongoing valorous resistance to patriarchal dominance while lauding the Machiavellian brutality of history's leaders. These traditions are male creations that reflect their cultural beliefs, values, and priorities. They cannot be untangled and segmented in our efforts to change them; they must be approached in a multivariate manner that influences all of these forces simultaneously. Examining leadership without the context of religion, gender, politics, education, or any other major social force is to de-contextualize it from its social environment and to render any discussion, criticism, or theoretical proposals within it as isolated, irrelevant, and meaningless (Eisenstein, 1999).

No other social factors in human society are as unchanged, interconnected, and intractable as patriarchy, gender, leadership, education, and religion. No other force in society is responsible for more of the human misery of history in one form or another while asserting it was elevating people to a higher level. If any other form of disease continued to re-infect and kill millions of people, there would be a worldwide response to find a cure, but we continue to ignore and coexist with the devastating impact of patriarchy at every level of our lives. Its values have poisoned our religious, political, economic, cultural, educational, and interpersonal beliefs and practices, all of which have their genesis within these dominant concepts that have molded society through their impact. They are inextricably woven in a complex social tapestry that has multiple components working together both additively and in

a complementary manner to orchestrate our historical social experience in a certain way. They continue to provide the template upon which our modern social value system and structures operate (Daly, 1978 cited in Walby, 1990). While society has evolved and progressed, patriarchy, gender, leadership, and religion have remained powerful, static, and negative diachronic constants within social and cultural progress—quadruple anchors of conservative male cultural ideology that have weighed down positive movement toward a more democratic age of culture that moves beyond gender to a new age of democratic human freedom (Lerner, 1986; Schafer, 2008).

Patriarchy, gender, leadership, education, and religion are anachronistic social gyroscopes that have fixated society within a male-dominated paradigm from which we have not been able to extract ourselves for thousands of years and with our present approach to changing them will take thousands more. It is clear from the many global indicators at every level of society that if this is the case humanity will not survive to be reformed. The reality is that slow change is no change. Incrementalism, which is the operational theory of scientific rationalism, creates critical social atrophy and serves to entrench the interests of the status quo (Lerner, 1993). While in postmodern society we have been able to temper their influence, we have not been able to reform it. Incrementalism is an inadequate theory of social or political change for a society that is rapidly outstripping the capacity of the earth to support it. We need quick, positive change for real democracy or we will quickly outlive our social relevance and human existence.

Patriarchy evokes values, beliefs, and attitudes of gender preferences and superiority, domination, control, power, and elitism enforced through violence, intimidation, sanctions, and threats. Patriarchy has created a global self-rationalizing dependency culture that relies on men to make all the decisions in our complex, conflicted world based on a misguided belief in the “divine right of men” to do so. Openly questioning or attacking patriarchy (or questioning males) is viewed as socially offensive to the dominant male hierarchy and brings immediate defensive responses. Deferential respect for males continues to be expected in our postmodern world. As this discussion will demonstrate, the existing social relationships and the ideology upon which they are built are powerful polarizing forces that are caustic to social and human development and hold no social legitimacy whether in democratic or despotic political regimes. We cannot deal with despotism without dealing with patriarchy; we cannot deal with sexism without dealing with patriarchy, and so on and so on. The price of the superficial success and

stability of our modern world is exacted at the high cost of human torment, bondage, annihilation, and poverty that is unnecessary. It is unsustainable and unjustifiable for the human species. As the governing social ideology of humanity patriarchy drives society in profoundly negative ways that are not supported or desired by the vast majority of humanity. It has been heavily resisted throughout history and the resisters have paid a steep price (McQuaig, 2001). It elevates one gender into a preferential position over the other, one leader over another, and one religion over another in a destructive, competitive, never-ending battle for supremacy while encouraging attitudes, values, and beliefs of gender elitism, arrogance, and favoritism that have created tension, divisiveness, adversarial conflict, domination, resistance, and violence throughout history. Nothing will change until we change patriarchy.

Neopatriarchy

Formerly blatant and unapologetic, patriarchy has now become submerged in our civilized social fabric—a subtle tapestry that powerfully colors all facets of our human life. Classical patriarchy has gradually evolved into neopatriarchy during this transition, becoming more and more sophisticated in its methods of indoctrination. It continues to evolve with society from its origins in domestic relations to its current expression as the sociocultural sea in which we swim every day. It has simply become less obvious but it is just as pernicious as before. For thousands of years it has created not only winners and losers but adversaries and foes and also the polarized, gendered perspectives and conduct of men and women, the racialized perspectives between races, the relationships of the victors over the vanquished, and the attitudes of economic superiority inherent in the uninterested and misinformed disdain of the idle rich toward the plight of the poor. It has defined what counts as knowledge and how people are valued as human beings throughout history. Patriarchy is a process of social indoctrination that is reversible. Initially it took the form of male dominance over women within the domestic family unit and other males in society, but it soon became a social ideology controlling all aspects of life through physical, religious, military, educational, and political forms that enslaved the conquered and lionized the victors (Lerner, 1986,1993; McQuaig, 2001). It has become amorphous like power in Foucault's interpretation.

Patriarchy is not new but the colonization of every aspect of modern existence by patriarchy is. Patriarchy has grown from a rather unsophisticated familial relationship dominated by the father in early societies (Gilligan & Richards, 2009; Lerner, 1986; Monagan, 2010) into a pervasive, invisible, and dominant socialization process of neopatriarchal ideology across our entire society. It no longer influences only familial relationships but all relationships. Patriarchy has become the fabric from which modern society is woven and its core value premise (A. Johnson, 2005; Lerner, 1986). The new patriarchy is a cancer that has invaded humanity at the social cellular level and is growing out of control while killing its host in the process (Dobbin, 1998). As O'Sullivan (2001) states of this phenomenon as expressed through wealth: "the lifestyle of privilege is the cancer of the planet" (p. 130). In its modern incarnation it is an amalgam of right-wing individualism, assumed male privilege, self-interested materialism, and greed. This "lifestyle of privilege" that O'Sullivan refers to has primarily accrued to men.

Rather than coming to a close at the beginning of the 20th century, patriarchy began its modern invasion during the dawn of the Industrial Revolution in England as powerful aristocrats, noblemen, and landowners were challenged by the newly rich and developing industrial business class. It was a changing of the guard in social terms, but for patriarchy it was simply a transition period. Like all infectious diseases, patriarchy simply mutated to accommodate its new host. It was another development in its long evolution in society. Dunleavy and O'Leary (1987) describe the views of the waning aristocracy toward burgeoning neopatriarchy and the fledgling industrial democracy. Rather than being a vision of a crumbling past and a promising future, it was more a changing of the face of patriarchy as it mutated in its effort to survive. It was a change from one form of male dominance to another:

Bitterly opposed to equality, whether equality before the law or equality of opportunity, conservatives feared mass democracy. The "idea of the modern state" that all citizens are equal before a sovereign, implied a fundamental human equality which they regarded as anathema (Sidenrop, 1983). The old right were therefore against the state, preferring a mythical vision of medieval feudalism, when society was believed to be an organic whole, unified despite its separate and unequal "estates" and when political power was chiefly dispersed and parceled up between the nobles, the church, and the king. Only the emergence of powerful nationalism and imperialism in the nineteenth century swung aristocratic conservatives behind the vision of a nation-state in which patriarchy, honour, rank and virtue could again find a place. (p. 73)

What both the old and new elites feared was true pluralist democracy despite the promise of the Magna Carta. Nothing has changed in modern times. With the development of free enterprise and imperialism the elite social order was preserved, albeit by a different aristocracy. The old one would provide the pedigree; the new one, money and power. While the location of the power in the new social order of the rich and elite was changing, the presence of patriarchy was a constant core belief of both the old and the new regimes (A. Johnson, 2005). Whereas in the past the separation occurred through lineage and titles that provided wealth, in modern society money and power became the source of social stratification without the former. The landed aristocracy shared the hierarchical social views of the new moneyed elite and thus supported their status in society while simultaneously looking down their noses at them. Effectively, there was nothing they could do about it. A new conservative, corporate aristocracy took over at the top of the social pyramid of world power and has since created or bought lineage and titles through marriage and money just as the wealthy and powerful have since the beginning of recorded history (Lerner, 1986). They have, in effect, bought their pedigree. The social and literary critic Raymond Williams (1973) describes this transition process and its impact on the majority of people:

A more settled and centralised order—a system of social and economic rather than directly military and physical control—was now fully in being, in a more prosperous and more populated country. Following the fortunes, through these centuries, of the dominant interests, it is a story of growth and achievement, but for the majority of men it was the substitution of one form of domination for another: the mystified feudal order replaced by a mystified agrarian capitalist order, with just enough continuity, in titles and in symbols of authority, in successive compositions of a ‘natural order’, to confuse and control. (p. 39)

This new class of entrepreneurs took wealth accumulation to an entirely new level unseen at the turn of the century by even well-heeled nobility and aristocratic landowners (McQuaig & Brooks, 2010). They ostentatiously showed off their wealth in the same way aristocrats have for ages—building massive opulent homes; buying their way into political office; marrying their daughters to men with titles and estates; influencing government policies, laws, and decision making, and beginning to dictate a new set of social values to society that would come to dominate our modern world and termed by Thorsten Veblen “conspicuous consumption” (Ferguson, 2011; McQuaig, 2001). All this was done to impose an air of legitimacy on their ill-gotten wealth.

The only difference was that they did this on a scale that was unheard of, even among the reigning landed aristocracy. However, as Williams (1973) again observes, it was not all wine and roses:

'Civilization' had produced not only wealth, order and refinement, but as part of the same process poverty, disorder, and degradation. It was attacked for its 'artificiality'— its glaring contrasts with a 'natural' or 'human' order. The values upheld against it were not those of the next higher stage of development but an essential human brotherhood, often expressed as something to be recovered as well as gained. (p. 18)

While modernism continued to focus attention on the positive elements of this and other periods, postmodernism attempted to reveal a more balanced interpretation and point out the failures as well. Today corporations have a direct line to government on virtually every issue that affects them much like the landed aristocrats did during the 19th century. While the old elites had no interest in broadening the appeal of their social state or offering any hope of entry to the commoners, the new moneyed elite made consumption the aspiration of everyone in society if not the reality. The individual pursuit of wealth became the carrot that still drives the social cart to this day. The stick was the legal system that punished anyone who resisted it.

The new patriarchy and the new patriarchs rapidly grew in power and influence during the 19th and 20th centuries as the wealthy, male, conservative, right-wing industrial class began to use their newfound riches and power to directly influence and control every aspect of social functioning. They gradually took over business, government, religion, education, the media, and society itself (Foster, 2004). Over the past century their influence has ebbed and flowed but always increased its grip on Western and subsequently global societies while pressing its agenda forward. The robber barons of the 1930s became the old moneyed elite of contemporary American and British society just as traditional aristocracies had before them and provided the foundation of values and finance that propelled us into the new information era of robber barons and with it even more obscene wealth. The Rockefellers, Gettys, Kennedys, and many more made their wealth in the ruthless and unregulated early 20th century when the line between legal and illegal was significantly blurred and often crossed (Kotz, 2002). The new globalized plutocracy made its money in the equally deregulated era of globalization through technology, software, and social media produced in Asian sweatshops and other offshore producers where the line between legal and illegal was also significantly blurred or

nonexistent (McQuaig & Brooks, 2010). This regular cycle of exploitation is the accepted currency of boom and bust capitalism.

The recent ideological face of modern neopatriarchy is neoliberalism and neoconservatism. Neopatriarchy is not so much an outgrowth of neoliberalism as its progenitor. Neopatriarchy preceded and gave rise to neoliberalism and neoconservatism near the end of the 20th century. It was a growing part of society from the dawn of industrialization but neopatriarchy, much like its two visible political ideologies, is markedly different from traditional patriarchy in the same way. While traditional patriarchy was a worldwide, loosely organized, gender-based phenomenon practiced by all cultures and societies in their families, neopatriarchy made it a globally unified universal social ideology through the instruments of government and capitalism. Neopatriarchy expanded the influence of what was primarily a provincial, localized, personalized, and familial patriarchal tradition into every social institution in society. The burgeoning industrialization, combined with scientific rationalism and developing industrial capitalism, gave rise to new ways of thinking and new advancements in production, military equipment, and communication technologies that were employed to further disseminate and justify patriarchal values and attitudes, allowing them to become institutional and international through the age of colonialism and imperialism but the virtual social air we breathe in the electronic colonial and imperial age we are currently in (Ferguson, 2011). They had the effect of intensifying the impact of patriarchy.

The increased production capacity created by the Industrial Revolution encouraged market growth and business wealth but also imperialist aggression by nation-states such as England, Spain, Portugal, and France and later Germany, Russia, Italy, and Japan to enhance their countries' fortunes. This capacity led to the devastation of indigenous cultures around the globe in the early stages of imperialism and colonialism and to two world wars that decimated the planet. Patriarchal colonialism and imperialism left the legacy of the developing world's poverty and instability that still troubles the Middle East, Africa, India, and Pakistan (Williams, 1973). These were only a few of the many events that brought destruction and death to billions of people over the centuries through the "benefits" of patriarchal leadership, political imperialism, and colonialism. Today, we are experiencing the modern hybrid of imperialism—globalization—that is nothing more than economic imperialism and is having the same effects as its predecessor on populations worldwide who are subjected to forced economic

takeovers of their countries and the subordination of their workforces to the demands of developed nations.

While patriarchy was an explicit, male-oriented system of power that was applied first to family and domestic situations and then to broader and broader social environments, neopatriarchy—like neoliberalism and neoconservatism—colonized the minds, hearts, and social institutions of people everywhere, becoming a powerful, pervasive, yet unrecognized and unacknowledged background control factor that has been assimilated into our modern consciousness to the point that it is for all intents and purposes invisible, much like being white (Acker, 2006; Brookfield, 2005; Giroux, 2004; Lerner, 1986; Reich, 1974). Neopatriarchy and white racism hold similar positions. Being white today is normalized and unquestioned just as patriarchy is (Apple, 1996). Dominant white males still control which aspects of social development are problematized. All other races and cultures are referred to as different from being white and so are made visible. Neopatriarchy has become so internalized that we do not even question its presence or its effects on our values, beliefs, and decisions. It has become the standard that people respond to whether in support or disagreement—but it is the standard. We have internalized its control and bias into every aspect of our modern psyche. As Lerner (1997) asserts: “Racism gives the illusion of superiority to lower-class whites, which convinces them to support the dominant elites, often against their true economic interests” (p. 141). We have become the perfect prisoners—no bars required; we police ourselves, as Michel Foucault intimated (Brookfield, 2005).

The social advancements produced in the last century give the impression that society has made tremendous progress, but they disguise the sinister growth of neopatriarchy and its real costs to humanity and democracy. At no time in our history has democracy been more at risk than today. The presence of neopatriarchy became most pronounced in post-war North America during an era of growth and prosperity and the development of the Keynesian “welfare state” of government social programs and supports such as Medicare and Social Security—concessions given to labor to head off fears of communist social unrest after the war (Schafer, 2008). Ironically, these concessions were the largest benefits achieved by workers and citizens. The patriarchal system was interrupted by the world wars and the massive devastation that they caused worldwide that led people to re-evaluate and question the traditional leadership, values, and social distinctions that had prevailed. The world wars were the “great levelers” both literally and figuratively. Concessions such

as those created by FDR under the New Deal were given to working people during the post-war, post-depression period to ensure there was not an open communist revolution against capitalism and its patriarchal structures. This period of rapprochement with workers and citizens did not last long, however, and as early as the 1980s during yet another recession the shift back to conservative, right-wing rule began again in earnest, culminating in the wave of minimalist neocon logic that currently grips the world.

It is during this period that the foundations of late modern society were laid. It is reflected most recently in the extreme right-wing views that have come to dominate in the past 20 years as the pendulum swung back to the right after a brief flirtation with social revolution and enhanced democracy in the 1960s. Neopatriarchy has come to be reflected in the views of neoliberalism and neoconservatism, two right-wing variations on a political/social theme.

Neoliberalism differs from classical liberalism in that while the latter similarly believes in individualism and the entrepreneurial spirit and seeks to keep government out of the lives of citizens, the former embraced government as a vehicle to create a neoliberal state by actively promoting neoliberal values and practices of market freedom and individual choice through government. In effect, while classical liberalism had a tenuous relationship with governments, neoliberalism embraced government as the ultimate vehicle of control to implement its agenda (Apple, 2006). The current neoconservative Canadian government is a working example of this philosophy.

Thus, neoliberalism uses government as a propaganda vehicle for its ideological agenda. While right-wing classical liberalism always had preferred access to governments, in the past 20 years neoliberalism has completed a coup-d'état on behalf of business interests everywhere and has *de facto* taken over government. Political government has become corporate government; they are the same. Governments have become simply an extension of corporate policy. The former merely carries on with the pretense of democratic rule by the people to cover up the fundamental unfairness of the entire system. The evidence of this in the United States is in the massive influence of paid lobbyists in Washington. Most people have a bad feeling that their democracy is corrupt but are too complacent to do anything about it as long as it doesn't directly affect them. This logic may in fact ensure the demise of real democracy as we idealize it.

In contrast, neoconservatism shares all the beliefs of neoliberalism but filters them through the lens of right-wing, white Christian morality and "traditional" values (Dobbin, 1998). Neoconservatism encourages universal moral codes, appeals to national patriotism and extremism, and believes that

these “traditional family values” should govern society (Apple, 2006). As Grayling (2010) notes:

Neocons have far more interest in foreign policy than domestic policy. As regards the latter the reflex nostrums of right-wing attitudes apply: less tax, less government, libertarianism about matters such as gun control, encouragement of individual responsibility in health care and education, ‘faith-based solutions’ to social and welfare problems, and so forth. (pp. 357–358)

These values are on display in the extreme right-wing Republican Tea Party where candidates disavow abortion, illegal immigrants, and a variety of other social-justice perspectives in favor of one-size-fits-all religiously based white conservatism oriented in free-market principles. The same holds true of the Conservative party of Canada, formerly the more right-wing Alliance party. Neoconservatism is well-disguised extremist, right wing, neo-fascist and racist at its core while being papered over with a thin veneer of polite civility and self-defining individualist logic. Neoconservatism has always believed in an elite, meritocratic view of society and power (Apple, 2006). Neoliberalism and neoconservatism strive to make their philosophies the only social belief tolerated in society.

In the past 100 years under the banner of neopatriarchy and more recently neoconservatism and neoliberalism, the conservative right has influenced the minds, emotions, psyche, and lifestyles of Western societies and those around the globe through their control of and influence over economics, government, business, education, religion, the military, and media. Employing the lucre of materialism they have finally convinced even Communist countries such as Russia and China to embrace corrupt free-enterprise values (A. Johnson, 2005). This invasion has been gradual, subtle, and continuous and has progressively transformed the values, beliefs, and habits of modern citizens from social to economic and from moral to amoral. It has convinced society that the only programs that are worthwhile are those with economic benefits (profits) for business while anything that relates solely to human life, social support, the natural environment, or infrastructure is of dubious value and is a drag on economic productivity. Everything in existence is subordinated to the profit motive. We are all dubbed “homo economicus” (McQuaig, 2001).

The new patriarchy has always had powerful communication tools at its disposal through which the benefits of the capitalist, consumer-driven, market-based system are subliminally extolled to the public. From the beginning of the Industrial Revolution and long before it, the control of the press

was important, but with the explosion of print media as a result of industrialization and the subsequent explosion of information technology in the 1990s, its power grew exponentially. The new patriarchy also has the power of governments, the military, and police behind it to repress any dissent against the injustices it creates. It also has control over what is covered and what is ignored. The public now views reality through the lens of both print and electronic corporate media. The society it produces is a benevolent but unbending conservative democratic dictatorship. All parties across the political spectrum now pay homage to the values of big business. With the rise of neoconservatism and neoliberalism in the 1990s the focus on security, control, and intolerance has escalated once again. We are living in an extremely complex “surveillance society” where our every move is monitored, surveyed, watched, and controlled. Under the guise of defending democracy we exist in an oppressive electronic oligarchy that is becoming obsessively invasive and controlling, best evidenced by the website releases of WikiLeaks and its founder Julian Assange and the revelations of whistleblower Edward Snowden.

Today the new patriarchy is going through a second renaissance—of technology. The information revolution of the past 20 years, much like the Industrial Revolution at the turn of the 20th century, has created a massive impact on world society as deep as and more far-reaching than any that has ever been accomplished by industrialization. As Williams (1977) observes:

Thus in advanced capitalism, because of changes in the social character of labour, in the social character of communications, and in the social character of decision-making, the dominant culture reaches much further than ever before in capitalist society into hitherto ‘reserved’ or ‘resigned’ areas of experience and practice and meaning. The area of effective penetration of the dominant order into the whole social and cultural process is thus now significantly greater. This in turn makes the problem of emergence especially acute, and narrows the gap between alternative and oppositional elements. The alternative, especially in areas that impinge on significant areas of the dominant, is often seen as oppositional and, by pressure, often converted into it. (pp. 125–126)

Williams’ concern has been magnified exponentially today. Never before in society has the need to be vigilant and critical in thinking about the meaning of our daily lives been more important. Once again workers are under attack. They are being more heavily exploited, their working conditions are declining, job stability and tenure are being dismantled, and their pensions and benefits are being eradicated. We are going back to the future of industrial England. Labor conditions are regressing into the early 20th century,

ironically in an age of increasingly massive wealth creation for corporations and the well-to-do. Kersley and O'Sullivan (2013) indicate in a recent *Credit Suisse Global Wealth Report*:

Taken together, the bottom half of the global population own less than 1 percent of total wealth. In sharp contrast, the richest 10 percent hold 86 percent of the world's wealth, and the top 1 percent alone account for 46 percent of global assets.

A. Johnson (2005) states: "In the United States, the richest 10 percent controls roughly 80 percent of all the wealth, including 87 percent of the cash and more than 90 percent of business assets, stocks, and bonds" (p. 45). Workers in the developing world are being mercilessly exploited by the new technocrats in the same way the English working class were in the 1880s while driving down the standard of living enjoyed by North Americans in the process. While the collective benefit of exploiting others around the globe was a shared enterprise before globalization, Western workers had little concern for their fellow humans elsewhere in the world but now that they are feeling its impact directly through a lowered standard of living they are now actively resisting global capitalism. Employment is shifting from full-time to part-time as companies cut costs to drive up profits and wealth. Just as during the Industrial Revolution, workers are being paid less and less while the new techno-industrialists make more and more. We are regressing into the early industrial age—in the midst of a wealth explosion driven by a technological revolution (McQuaig, 2001). We are creating a Third World reality within a First World economy.

The technology explosion has also created a new class of super-rich robber barons such as Larry Ellison, Bill Gates, Michael Dell, Mark Zuckerberg, and Steve Jobs who have profited from the massive demand for communication technologies (McQuaig & Brooks, 2010). The fortunes of these new information industrialists dwarf those of the early robber barons but the means of the creation of their wealth is the same: goods produced by poorly paid off-shore workers employed in sub-contracted sweat-shop factories halfway around the world turning out expensive communications technology at massive profit mark-ups (Robinson, 2004). As Kotz (2002) states, the new corporatists want freedom from regulation and control to do as they please much like the robber barons enjoyed in the 1930s. Their goal is always to socialize risk while privatizing wealth.

This is convenient and good business practice because it keeps the relationship of the workers and the employers impersonal. Modern industry treats employees as economic mercenaries rather than valued workers to whom they

have a social as well as business obligation. The exploitation of Western capitalist democracies has simply been exported offshore away from the prying eyes and media of first-world societies to countries where people are enslaved in the same way people were at the beginning of the Industrial Revolution. Under neopatriarchy the exploitation of workers has exploded and reached new levels as wages, benefits, and living standards have taken a precipitous decline under the deregulated and globalized employment environments after some modest advances in the 1960s while profits, growth, and returns to techno-industrialists have increased astronomically.

Destabilization is a key tool of capitalism to drive negative changes that affect workers or what Klein (2008) terms the “shock doctrine.” Many times it is intentionally created to provide an excuse for radical reductions in workers’ wages, benefits, and pensions (Dei & Karumanchery, 2001).

Today, neopatriarchy, neoliberalism, and neoconservatism have a stranglehold on the world, the media, and government that is threatening the future of civil society. It is for all intents and purposes an invisible and civil debate on the surface but one that cloaks a subversive attempt by elite right-wing forces to take control of everyone and everything everywhere in ways that were previously unimaginable. Right-wing policies and economics are only the initial phase of this progression. Once these elements have consolidated their power, governments and police forces everywhere will become increasingly, albeit slowly and unnoticeably, more controlling, repressive, and authoritarian and the quality of life of the majority will continue to decline amid a media fantasy of normalcy and success.

Historical Confluence

The new patriarchy was facilitated, intensified, and consolidated by several key historical developments that precipitated its growth, particularly over the last century: the Industrial Revolution, the growth of rational science and intellectual rationalism, and the simultaneous rapid development of capitalist free-market economics. They combined to create a new and growing group of industrial nouveau-riche elites that rapidly superseded the wealth and power of the waning class of traditional landed aristocrats and nobility who had become mere curiosities and irrelevant figureheads in modern society over the 20th century much like the monarchy. While discussing these historical occurrences is much like a chicken-and-egg inquiry, all three coincidentally occurred together and provided both the impetus and stimulus for their

respective evolutions and for the invasion of neopatriarchy into our social consciousness and our cultural practices in such pervasive ways. They are all interrelated and had both complementary and additive effects on each other's evolution.

Over the past century, we have been party to massive advances in science, technology, and industrial capacity. We have moved from being a subsistence economy to being a workaholic industrial economy. While that has brought many benefits to a certain strata of people on the economic scale and to a certain geographical strata of people in the northern hemisphere, it has had the commensurate effect of impoverishing almost half the world's population who live in poor and developing countries. One has happened because of the other. They are reciprocal and interconnected.

People in North American and Western societies have internalized the Protestant work ethic from their forefathers and defined themselves in terms of their careers, jobs, and employment successes. Their work is aimed at providing them with the ability to purchase as many material products as possible to make their lives supposedly more meaningful and enjoyable as a recompense for their work commitment—from dishwashers and fridges to flat-screen TVs and smartphones. Ultimately, people discover that materialism is an unsatisfying salve for human self-fulfillment. Life has transitioned from a religious focus to a materialist focus. While all societies retain vestiges of their former incarnations, materialism and consumerism are the new religion of the world, created with the eager help of free-enterprise capitalism.

No one can argue with the social value of these changes for many in Western societies, but at the same time we must also acknowledge and recognize the equally and often more pronounced negative role science, industrialization, and rationalism have had on our postmodern lives and our thinking. Science is in fact killing us much faster than it is saving us. The problem is that science, like capitalism, is amoral; it is consumed with objective, empirical facts but less so with the potential impact of those facts on people. Science and with it industrialization have brought the world the greatest period of human advancement in recorded history, but they have also enabled some of the most significant human disasters as well, the potential eradication of humans from the planet through nuclear warfare, and created a host of major global environmental problems as well that tend to be downplayed in our eagerness to applaud our achievements. In addition, the majority of these benefits have accrued to Western nations often at the expense of other developing nations (McQuaig, 2001). If we are to evaluate the cost-benefit analysis of modernism,

the conclusion must be decidedly negative. The downside has far outweighed the upside despite what appears to be a highly successful society.

The achievements in these areas have also had a negative social effect of serving to entrench neopatriarchal, white, conservative, right-wing values and structures deeply into our world and to reinforce them with power and money. The people who own the property, the industry, and the financial institutions and the millions of parasitic people who consciously and unconsciously live off their corrupt proceeds are defenders of a skewed and entrenched status quo of power and wealth. They are apologists for its abuses and its excesses—particularly through their control of the media (Roy, 2003). They are manipulative and deceitful. These are the people who will stop at nothing to ensure their ongoing personal and collective success at the expense of others while continually denying complicity. They have no interest in changing the system that clearly works to their advantage. They directly and indirectly control government decision making and policy for their own benefit, hire powerful lawyers to argue their cases, silence dissenters with SLAPP (Strategic Lawsuits Against Public Participation) actions (Dobbin, 1998), and avoid culpability for their conduct as corporate enterprises while actively using their power to hide their labor and environmental abuses. More and more these elements in modern society are controlling who we are, what we do, and why we do it as well as the declining quality of life around the globe. We are moving into an age of corporate democracy or “corpocracy” where the structure and values of our society are defined by the needs and demands of corporations for profit, production, and growth while the social well-being of humanity is ignored or more perversely blamed for the problems (World Economic Forum, 2011). The needs of people, the environment, minorities, children, the disabled, the poor, and women are secondary. Governments, rather than serving the public, effectively serve business exclusively. All other human values are being subordinated to these interests (Dobbin, 1998). Society has always been skewed in favor of the ruthless, wealthy, and powerful but modern society has raised the level of disparity and paradox to social dogma.

Viewed without a balanced critical perspective, they can appear on the surface to be positive developments for society but this has rarely been the case. These advances were in almost all circumstances actively suppressed negative collateral effects and were used to buttress the power and control of wealthy corporate interests while society was left wanting. Even today governments believe it is acceptable to hide, manipulate, or withhold the truth from the general public about various issues that confront them. This in itself is duplicitous

and manipulative—in a supposed democracy. Because we view all public issues through the restricted lens of corporate public media as our window on the world, we are automatically viewing the world's problems through a restricted and skewed worldview of corporate business. The focus is overwhelmingly on the positives in the social system rather than the incumbent negatives.

Modern science was one of three key historical developments that came together in the 18th to the 20th centuries that facilitated the rise of neopatriarchy. Patriarchy went from being a personal social phenomenon to being a political, economic, and scientific one over the course of several centuries as patriarchy burrowed its way into the social fabric of the world and into the psyches of its inhabitants. The last century in particular has been critical to the development of neopatriarchy and the growth of modern society and beliefs. The coincidental conjunction of industrialization, rational science, and capitalism created a perfect storm of historical events that conspired to produce the spread of neopatriarchy around the world. Modern science, capitalism, and the Industrial Revolution were generated under the umbrella of patriarchy. Patriarchy is Big Brother—both literally and figuratively. All three have interrelated and interwoven relationships that work together to validate the premises of the other two. As Wallace (2003) points out:

The dominant narratives (the pre-judgments) of liberal capitalist democracies are most often situated in ideologies that value competitive individualism, the concentration of power in the hands of owners of capital, and scientific rationality in which "truth" is a value-free commodity based on objective empirical evidence. These dominant narratives (or metanarratives, to use Lyotard's phrase) converge in a deeply entrenched belief in a liberal version of meritocracy in which social benefits are perceived to have been ascribed based on individual merit rather than one's social affiliations. (p. 8)

False assumptions are justified by equally false assumptions within the other two arenas, leading to such assertions being incorrectly viewed as valid simply by their own self-justifying syllogistic logic. The concept of blood-letting is only one of a long list of examples of this type of thinking that was considered an unquestioned cutting-edge technique in the 18th century but has now been abandoned as barbaric and useless. However, the doctors who used this technique were arrogantly certain that it was effective because their scientific logic had validated it. We should view our current faith in science with the same healthy skepticism that history provides. Science continues to hold this flawed sense of certainty in its views and approaches to medicine today without

ever imagining that they could possibly be wrong or have equally negative impacts. Today, profit and greed drive pharmaceutical decision-making, not human benefit, although the two are not self-exclusive. The litany of downplayed serious side effects of many drugs are a case in point. In contrast, the use of leeches and grubs to heal injuries as practiced during the Civil War in the United States is regaining prominence as a useful natural way of healing infected wounds. Chinese acupuncture has become an accepted treatment for pain. Much of scientific discovery is neither linear nor rational—in fact, much of it is accidental and random. The advances for humankind realized during the 20th century appear to be significant, leading many to believe that these developments must have been a good thing for society since many have significantly benefitted humankind—but at an enormous cost in human misery around the world. The advances of industrialization, capitalism, and rational science while appearing magical on the surface resulted in much more human suffering than benefit. Patriarchy often played a direct role in such abuses because science was developed and delivered by men in selective and discriminatory ways, particularly to women and other races (Lerner, 1997). Because more and more people's standard of living has risen during this period across the globe, the false assumption is that these advances have benefitted humankind as a whole while in fact they have been realized by expanding the scope of economic and physical exploitation of people globally, creating a false impression of progress and success, much like a Ponzi scheme. Many of the advances of society in the 20th century in particular are often viewed through a rose-colored lens that only recognizes their benefits to a specific group of humankind while ignoring the pervasively damaging effects their introduction often visited on the rest of humanity and the environment. Early in the 20th century John Dewey (1989) noted that one of the criticisms of modern science was its preoccupation with the problems of enterprise rather than society. This would become a common theme for science in the 20th century. The three historical developments of science, industrialization, and capitalism could have been used to improve the lives of millions of people over the past 100 years but instead they were primarily employed to make a small group of people extremely well-to-do and powerful while marginalizing the rest. Large multinational drug companies still withhold life-saving drugs from Third World countries because they cannot pay for them. Postmodern society has allowed the private sector to detach itself from the responsibilities of human morality. Any benefits scientific advances brought to society arrived coincidentally and were expanded only when businesses could profit from the inventions.

The progress for the majority in society has always been relative and negative. Massive gains in profits, wealth, and power have been necessary to spur even minor gains in the standard of living, wages, and lifestyles of the majority in society rather than wealth being willingly shared equitably. In modern neopatriarchal society this process has been even further exacerbated through deregulation and the de-structuring of employment from full-time to part-time and the advance of globalization. While banks, businesses, and speculators made billions of dollars in profits over the past 20 years within a deregulated, neoliberal environment that created the most successful climate for private enterprise in more than a century, the living standards, family incomes when adjusted for inflation, and relative wage increases have been stagnant or reversing during this period (Frenette, Hou, Morissette, Wannell, & Webber, 2008). This blatantly unfair and unequal system is considered normal in modern capitalist society.

Particularly over the past 20 years advances in the accumulation of wealth in First World countries driven by neopatriarchy, neoliberalism, and neoconservatism through the vehicle of capitalist corporatism occurred at the direct expense of working-class people everywhere, the Third World, and developing nations under economic imperialism dubbed globalization. Working people in First World, developing, and Third World economies alike have seen their standard of living, job security, and living conditions deteriorate and have learned the hard lesson that capitalism spares no one. In the West we cannot claim superiority or independent progress for our societies that require enforced slavery to their economic, political, religious, and educational ideologies and that are built on the backs of millions of others in our societies and those around the world. The civilized, intellectual, and genteel societies of the democratic West come at the price of exploitation, domination, and often brutal control and destruction of countless countries and economies. The industrial capitalist tsunami that had its epicenter in England during the 1880s continues to devastate places as far off as China and India in the new millennium—more than a century later.

The globalization of capital has been ongoing for more than a century—we are simply now witnessing its final assault on the world. The real face of its success is always kept well hidden behind the closed-door private meetings such as the World Economic Forum (WEF) in Davos, Switzerland, and of the IMF, the World Bank, and the OECD (Klein, 2002). These forums are the real global governance that we live under. As Dovey (1997) points out:

Modern capitalism has proved itself to be remarkably resilient over several centuries and across significantly different international contexts. From its origins (in modern form) in the West, in the sweatshops of the industrial revolution (a form of capitalism that has re-emerged in South East Asia where it is thriving in the absence of human rights, equity and social justice concerns in these countries), through its transformation into rational-legal form (social democratic or welfare capitalism) in defensive response to the rise of international socialism earlier this century; the masters of capitalism have been able to weather crises of all sorts. (p. 331)

Profit and how it is obtained is both the prime directive and the well-kept dirty little secret of capitalist democracies. The historical confluence of the Industrial Revolution, rational scientific study, and free-enterprise capitalism expanded and extended this process exponentially across the globe as the power of wealthy neopatriarchal elites took over the world. The modern information revolution that began in the late 1980s has provided a new impetus to these three original forces. Neoliberalism would have us all believe that everyone is living well and achieving their dreams and those who aren't, aren't working hard enough. This is an elaborate fiction created by corporate media spin-doctors who play up the bright side of modern economics while glossing over the massive exploitative dark side (Bates, 2006; Willower, 1997). Bankruptcies and plant closures are a much more frequent occurrence than solvency and success. All these people and their situations are interconnected and interrelated. The track record of capitalism can hardly be called a ringing endorsement for any economic system that purports to be the only viable one for the world. It has failed miserably to deliver basic human necessities to billions of poor people worldwide in First World economies, the Third World and developing nations, and has ruthlessly exploited workers in India, China, Bangladesh, Taiwan, and other Far Eastern countries while devastating the global environment with its industrial and business practices. This has all occurred as they simultaneously reaped trillions of dollars in profit that was never reinvested in these economies. It is a carefully coordinated, savage economic rape on a global scale that has been going on for more than a century since the dawn of the Industrial Revolution, rational science, and the growth of free-market capitalism, and it shows no signs of abating; on the contrary, it is growing by leaps and bounds. Despite this the lives of ordinary people continue to be marginal at best. Instead of images of brutality, we are treated to sanitized CEOs extolling the benefits of their latest wonderful products.

Gender Socialization

Within patriarchy, every experience we live is redolent with its values. The new patriarchy is everywhere. It is most prescient in the structure, processes, and values of contemporary society. Despite superficial advances for women over the past 50 years neopatriarchy continues to increasingly dominate the consciousness of men and women everywhere and restrict the freedom of women around the world. One of the most telling signs of the new patriarchy is contained in the “progress” of women. The signs of success in modern society for women under the banner of feminism have been women entering and colonizing male roles, professions, and pursuits while continuing to be feminized and patronized in every other way and continuing to willingly allow this to occur (Bolton & Muzio, 2008). It is important to note that women have not relinquished any domestic responsibilities in this transition but have taken on another entire set of responsibilities through paid work, unlike men who have always held only formal public work responsibilities in society (Chowdhury, 2009; Lerner, 1993; Tan, 2009). Despite token acknowledgments to their need to take responsibility for the children they sire, men have for the most part continued on as before in their gender attitudes and behaviors. Effectively neopatriarchy has convinced women that global social progress means doing things like men do them (P. Johnson, 2005). This process is still saturated with deferential delicacy (Tan, 2009).

Such approaches have merely created an illusion of progress as many women enter male-dominated professions and are required to behave according to male expectations to succeed in their roles—effectively becoming women behaving like men rather than women acting like women (Bolton & Muzio, 2008; A. Johnson, 2005; Lerner, 1997; Sanal, 2008; Tan, 2009). Women have unconsciously internalized the patriarchal male leadership code in their pursuit of equality and in the process have failed in their goal of liberating themselves.

The rules of neopatriarchy also demand that women continue to function in their traditional subordinate domestic roles within their families despite their work-world successes, and women have continued to do so (Lerner, 1997). This leads to paradoxical contrasts and double standards such as the high-powered female executives who have nannies to look after their children and still cook Sunday dinners for their families and feminist women who return to their homes to carry out traditionally female duties after publicly advocating for women’s liberation. They all reflect this living paradox of

a neopatriarchal society that continues to give deference and preference to men. It is reflected in highly educated, mature, and successful women such as Hillary Clinton, Michelle Obama, Carla Bruni-Sarkozy, Kate Middleton, and others who take deferential, subordinate public roles and positions to their spouses while they are in office because that is the traditional expectation of a male-dominated society where the most valued quality in women is not rocking the patriarchal boat but instead rocking the patriarchal cradle. Rather than breaking down these gender stereotypes, they continue to unconsciously reinforce them in their acquiescence to social expectations (A. Johnson, 2005). This is not entirely the fault of women but a reflection of the subtle and insidious effects of neopatriarchy in our social conscience. This is also not to say that there are not many women who are well aware of these social incompatibilities between their domestic behavior and their public politics and actively resist such stereotypes, but the number of such women (and men) is small in comparison to the number who willingly participate and collude in the continuance of a patriarchal society, and willingly compartmentalize the contradictory dichotomies within their own self-talk and social behavior. As Lerner (1986) points out in her seminal work *The Creation of Patriarchy*:

While all women have been victimized in certain aspects of their lives and some, at certain times, more than others, women are structured into society in such a way that they are both subjects and agents. As we discussed earlier, the "dialectic of women's history," the complex pull of contradictory forces upon women, makes them simultaneously marginal and central to historical events. (p. 234)

Neopatriarchy is also reflected in the large numbers of women who continue to choose to stay at home to care for infant or young children in place of their male spouses and to defer their career aspirations until their children are older, allowing their male spouses to pursue their careers unrestricted by family responsibilities (Bolton & Muzio, 2008; Lerner, 1993; Walby, 1990) and in the gender division of labor in the home that continues to favor men who contribute relatively little to these tasks (Gazso-Windle & McMullin, 2003; Lerner, 1997). A 2014 OECD report titled *Work-Life Balance* indicated that "Men in Canada spend 160 minutes per day cooking, cleaning or caring, more than the OECD average of 141 minutes but considerably less than Canadian women who spend 254 minutes per day on average on domestic work." It is reflected in the number of working women who hold demanding full-time and highly paid jobs outside of the home and continue to take full responsibility for the care of the couples' children, even into their teen years (Acker, 1999).

It is working moms who drive children to doctor and dental appointments, soccer, skating, and ballet practices and ensure lunches are made, while allowing their spouses to abdicate these responsibilities. It is reflected in the overwhelming presence of women in elementary school education from teachers to principals and vice-principals, school council members, bus drivers, volunteers, and child-care providers and to the overwhelming silence of all social activist groups on this issue. It is in the persistence of female employment ghettos for women such as clerical, retail sales, service industry work, teaching, and nursing that continue to underpay women for domestically related work and services that refuse to implement employment equity in thousands of jobs done by women, where men are paid more for the same work. Lerner (1997) points to U.S. statistics that demonstrate that women are paid less and get the less valued work in society:

Among the nine occupations with the highest mean earnings, ranging from physician to medical science teacher, women represent from 1 percent—17 percent of the practitioners. Among the five occupations with the lowest mean earnings, ranging from child-care worker to domestic, women represent from 83 percent to 98 percent of the occupation, with 93.4 percent the average. (p. 99)

It is present in the lack of demands by these groups for pay equity without reservations. The Ontario Government Pay Equity Commission (2012) reports that the wage gap in Ontario was 26%, improved from 36% in 1987 but still fully $\frac{3}{4}$ of the pay of men where it has remained for more than 40 years. Lerner (1997) notes a Rand Corporation study that predicted women's wage gap to be 26% by the year 2000. Walby (1990) cites a virtually identical figure based on statistics in Britain in 1986. She states: "There have been important changes in the position of women in paid employment, but the wages gap has remained tenaciously over the last decade" (p. 28).

Neopatriarchy is reflected in the limited progress in breaking through the corporate "glass ceiling" in both the private sector and government made by women over the last 50 years of women's liberation and affirmative action, despite the apparent increased presence of women in these fields (Cubillo & Brown, 2003). Their representation continues to be statistically limited given the total numbers of jobs available, particularly at the senior levels in private organizations (Stegemann, 2009). Breaking through the "glass ceiling" has been the hallmark of the modern women's movement, yet fewer and fewer women are actually doing that despite the massively increased presence of women in the workforce and society (Grogan, 2005). Worldwide women

still represent a distinct minority in senior government and business positions. The International Labour Organization reports that only 5% of CEOs of major corporations are women (Allen, 2015). In addition these numbers are being rolled back within neopatriarchy—often with the tacit support of neoconservative women themselves. It is reflected in a massive pornography industry focused almost exclusively on the sexual domination, degradation, and merciless exploitation of younger and younger women and children by a ruthless industry that continues to be tolerated by modern neocon capitalism and governments, whether left or right and particularly by self-righteous Christian neoconservatives (Lerner, 1997; Walby, 1990). It is pushing back the boundaries of what is defined as “adult” in our media through the paradoxical portrayals of women that continue to reinforce stereotypical sexualized representations of them in domestic roles while ironically celebrating the liberated powerful fictional female leader in legal, police, and reality TV as the modern archetypal mythology of equality. It is reflected in the rape chant scandals at a number of Canadian universities and in the horrific domestic violence perpetrated by Ray Rice. This silent acquiescence by women and their willing acceptance of these disparaging disparities and stereotypes is the face of the new patriarchy and reflects the internalization of oppression by both genders in Western societies. As Eisenstein (1999) asserts:

All of the processes involved in domestic work help in the perpetuation of the existing society. (1) Women stabilize patriarchal structures (the family, housewife, mother, etc.) by fulfilling their very roles. (2) Simultaneously, women are reproducing new workers, for both the paid and unpaid labor force. They “care” for the men and children of the society. (3) They work as well in the labor force, for lesser wages. (4) They stabilize the economy through their role as consumers. And this role is perpetuated very specifically through patriarchal institutions and ideology. If the other side of production is consumption, the other side of capitalism is patriarchy. (p. 210)

We have a superficial veneer of social progress overlaid on the unchanging neopatriarchal society just beneath it. It operates at the subconscious level of relationship taboos and is the unspoken elephant in the room in all social interactions between men and women. Both men and women have developed an extraordinary capacity to compartmentalize their consciousness and ignore patriarchy in their personal actions, leading to curious paradoxes in virtually every dimension of life. As Lerner (1986) points out:

Women, more than any other group, have collaborated in their own subordination through their acceptance of the sex-gender system. They have internalized the values that subordinate them to such an extent that they voluntarily pass them on to their children. Some women have been "oppressed" in one aspect of their lives by fathers or husbands, while they themselves have held power over other women and men. (p. 234)

This all appears innocent enough and "the way we do things around here" as the traditionalist organizational culture often intones, but it is insidious in that it ensures that patriarchy will continue to control society generation after generation. The socialization of patriarchy begins in the home, continues in the school, and is reinforced by religion and society. Women and men both collude in its continuation (Lerner, 1986). As women have discovered, reforming patriarchy is more than changing roles. From an early age children are socialized by their well-meaning but misguided parents into gender stereotypical role models that they also experienced. As adults, even though they understand the problems of many stereotypes, they are practically unable to do anything to change them. Boys play with trucks and girls with dolls, etc. The irony of this socialization is that it continues despite major advances in understanding the stereotyping of the genders and similar advances in liberating women from the superficial patriarchal social restrictions that dominated previous generations. Even so, the majority of society continues to re-socialize children into commonly accepted stereotypical ways that ensure that neopatriarchy will prevail and flourish because our social culture immerses them in socialized roles from birth to death. While there is a superficial effort to socialize children more neutrally, the majority of children still adhere to these stereotypical roles. Although there are exceptions, boys learn how to build and play rough, while girls learn how to cook and focus on their appearance. Boys become involved in competitive sports while girls' interests turn to makeup and personal grooming to attract boys. The focus on appearance by women, despite its irrelevance to ability, skills, or intelligence, continues to permeate the judgments of women throughout their lives with no similar expectation applied to men. While a broader range of socializing opportunities exist that cross gender lines, the vast majority of boys and girls settle into stereotypical roles as they grow older, and the subtle pressures of neopatriarchy prevail on their psyche and their social network. These are heavily reinforced by electronic media, our education system, parents, and adult society.

Jingoism and Sport

Sport is perhaps one of the most powerful examples of neopatriarchal socializing agents in modern society and as a result is an important area for reform. It is only one component of a massive, complex, and diverse socialization process that ensures the dominance of the male in our society. Around the world, male sports dominate the attention of fans everywhere while women's sports are treated in tokenistic ways. Male sports are big business. Sport defines and reflects who people are, what they believe and how they act—in many areas unrelated to sport. Sports are historically acceptable jingoistic substitutes for military aggression, where armies battle on sports fields rather than battlefields and spectators urge their teams on to victory through vicarious voyeurism. The consequences of failure are much less devastating than war. Hobson (1971) provided the essential definition of jingoism more than a century ago that still applies today:

Jingoism is merely the lust of the spectator, unpurged by any personal effort, risk, or sacrifice, gloating over the perils, pains, and slaughter of fellow-men whom he does not know, but whose destruction he desires in a blind and artificially stimulated passion of hatred and revenge. In the Jingo all is concentrated on the hazard and blind fury of the fray. (p. 214)

Anyone who has seen video clips of soccer hooligans rioting or crowds gathering and participating in mob violence can relate to Hobson's description. Anyone who has played the thousands of violent video games on the market today is participating in jingoism. While many advocates argue that these sports and activities are a healthy release to aggressive tendencies and a normal part of society, mere escapism and harmless fantasy, they persistently ignore or downplay their powerful negative socializing influence in desensitizing society and fans to violence—particularly young fans who later become young adults and then older adults who harbor these values deep within them. The polarized fan violence related to soccer matches in Europe or following the Stanley Cup final in Vancouver in 2011 and the inherent violence of the gladiatorial combat of the currently popular mixed martial arts (MMA) and professional wrestling subliminally validate violence and machismo in society while projecting and sanctioning values that influence everyone watching. The morals of the fan are those of violent voyeurism. It is the same situation when a group of young people will gather around a high school fight and jeer the participants on while not intervening. This is the "bystander apathy" well

documented in the psychological and sociological literature. The violence that is part of hockey is repeated by young children in minor leagues at much younger ages as they act out the aggressive behavior of their role models in the NHL with the willing parent bystanders urging them on and often modeling intimidating and disruptive behavior for their children. It is not hard to find examples of the negative impact of patriarchy that are generally accepted and ignored by mainstream culture.

In Western societies we live in a constant state of daily paradox where we decry violence when it occurs but promote it at every turn. We cannot have it both ways. With one breath we say don't be violent and with the next we encourage violence in our sports development, domestic situations, sexual relations, economic practices, and geopolitics. We have lost our collective moral and social compass. We constantly send mixed messages to our young people and society and then wonder why we aren't making any progress on eliminating violence. Until society at large pushes back against negative role-modeling in a serious way, things will continue to get worse. This necessarily requires confronting corporate power and wealth. We allow cigarettes to be sold and then spend billions more on health care to combat the diseases this produces. These blatant paradoxes are accepted and compartmentalized. Bullying is the contemporary problem that is an outgrowth of these mixed messages. It does not have to be this way. In terms of violence, it is much like alcoholism: one drink is too many. We need to start matching our actions with our words instead of mouthing platitudes.

Male sports play a significant diversionary role in our modern capitalist world, providing an outlet for millions of fans worldwide from the drudgery of their daily existences while creating massive profits for multi-national corporations. While many sports and athletic pursuits have a legitimate and positive role in society there are many other aspects that ensure the persistence of patriarchal values and control, particularly overtly violent sports such as mixed martial arts, professional wrestling, and boxing that have not only become hugely successful aggressive blood sports but are also successful financial ventures for private promoters who encourage the violence and heroic drama-turgy associated with them. While commercial sporting pursuits have many positive qualities, they also come with a heavy downside: an increasing tolerance for violence is inculcated into young people at an early age and becomes an inextricable part of their psyches and daily lives in society as these young people grow up to be adults. Society then begins to pay the price for what were considered innocent and character-building activities in youth. The

patriarchal, heroic values that these sports promote are further reinforced by graphically violent sports and war-related video games in the interconnected free-market world. Sexuality, violence, aggression, and death are big business in the gaming and sporting industries primarily played by young people (mostly men) during their formative years—often with the tacit permission of their parents who downplay the effects they have on their children.

Sports have always been a symbolic substitution for conflict. In sports men can challenge each other without killing each other as they do in war. In medieval times sparing your opponent's life in a joust or other combat was a sign of chivalry, honor, and integrity. Sport and its related morals are male pursuits. If sport actually acted as a safety valve we would expect that other forms of violence would diminish, when in fact this is not the case—if anything, it is getting significantly worse. In modern society the vicarious violence of sports has become linked with corporate economics and become big business, bringing in millions of dollars to corporate owners who sponsor them. Fans are indoctrinated in their allegiance to their teams who vicariously do battle with other teams for supremacy without any real risk. In times of real war this sport allegiance can be easily diverted into nationalistic hatred of another aggressor, and so is useful for governments, the military, and business.

Sport has become an athletic surrogate model of imperialism. It serves the more general purpose of indoctrinating fans into actual conflict and battle. It habituates society to violence and lowers their tolerance for it. It is also the vehicle for a new corporate hyper-nationalism. Fans wear their consumer products for their teams and bond around their colors. Leaf Nation is an independent country of fans living in Canada who support the Toronto Maple Leafs. Players are paid huge salaries and massive profits are made by corporate team owners. However, both the fans and the players are victims of the rich, capitalist owners who profit obscenely from the high-priced tickets for these events and the brand merchandizing—the latter of which are made in East Asian sweatshops for a few dollars. Canada can conquer the Soviet Union in hockey rather than in real life where the outcome would be much less certain and far more devastating. Sport is sublimated war, and war is the ultimate expression of violent male domination.

While all this seems innocent and a positive release valve for societal frustration, its real effect is to create a society of diversions and sideshows put on to entertain the people who are the fans. Rather than being an innocent entertainment for the public, in fact violent sports encourage, support, and condone violence in other areas of our lives. Clearly violence is not

diminishing in the general population; it is growing. Sports stimulate citizens' appetite for violence and conflict, rather than reducing it. The fans are most often people who earn modest incomes and have lives that are miles away from those of their sports heroes. People live more and more vicariously rather than in reality. Escapism through video games or mindless evening programming is endemic in our consumer culture and maintains a passive, subordinate electronically medicated populace for governments and business. Sports and entertainment are about escapism so that people can forget the drudgery of their lives and the grinding inequality of the world. While escapism is normal in society for brief periods of time, our entire society has become obsessed with escaping rather than living in reality and facing its problems.

Sport and entertainment also set up unrealistic personal expectations for young people that distract them from more worthwhile pursuits and job training that may seriously compromise their future life and success. Only a miniscule number of players make the NHL, NFL, or PGA tour. Millions of young people waste much of their lives and energy pursuing a dream of becoming a professional sports or entertainment star only to discover they will never achieve this and are left rebuilding their lives later in life. The media glosses over this dark side of sport. As in capitalism, there are a few winners and many, many losers. As is typical in our materialist society, the focus is on enriching the lives of a small select minority and then holding them out as the role model for success rather than enhancing the lives of the majority through free enterprise activity.

Sporting pursuits have always been a parallel and integral part of social expression and interest. They have also been an instructive element of the social realities of various societies throughout history. They have reflected the underlying attitudes, values, and beliefs of societies throughout the ages. Hitler attempted to make a statement about his Aryan principles at the 1933 Olympic Games that failed miserably when the African American runner, Jesse Owens, won a number of gold medals against German athletes. Male sport is a substitute for real combat. Sport is war—civilized. Some sports are violent, physical confrontations such as hockey, football, and MMA, while others are more focused on the competition of the game and the skill of the athlete rather than the aggressive dimension of them. Many sports such as tennis have developed into much more acceptable physical skill matches rather than matches that highlight their aggression. In tennis the latter is channeled into the tennis ball and through it to the opponent. Overtly aggressive male sports mimic the macho patriarchal tradition of the domination

and control of the heroic warrior while other sports mimic the concept without the testosterone-driven direct confrontation (A. Johnson, 2005). Chess is a civilized, intellectual war game but a healthy one in that the only casualties are pride and chess pieces. Chess is an example of a positive, nonviolent, and intelligent game that provides productive values to those who play it. Tennis, baseball, soccer, golf, bike racing, squash, table tennis, and Greco-Roman Olympic wrestling, to name only a few, all provide physical release without open violence and aggression—in fact, in these sports violence is abhorred and unacceptable.

So we have many alternatives at our disposal; we simply choose not to focus on them. The only reason blood-sports continue to be celebrated is because of their profit potential to big business. We make moral decisions today based on amoral capitalist ethics that only value money and profit instead of social ethics that value a broader spectrum of human values. These are the sports that should be endorsed, supported, and funded by governments and the private sector to promote positive human values. The physical skill and endurance of the athlete is rewarded—not their ability to injure their opponent. Sports such as football, hockey, and even MMA could be made acceptable if the body contact was taken out of the game (i.e. touch football, non-contact hockey, and protective headgear for martial arts). While these changes would be heresy to the rabid fan and corporate owner, they are necessary to alter our social value structure by deemphasizing violence. Whatever our individual beliefs about sport may be, we must realize they send powerful social value messages to everyone in society, and we cannot as a civilized society ignore these any longer. Many sports were and are social diversions; all forms of sport also have a more universal, symbolic meaning connected to the societies in which they are enjoyed. The symbolism of neopatriarchy is reflected in the jingoism of male sports that are sublimated vicarious outlets for male aggression that has been endemic to patriarchy, leadership, and history (Connell & Messerschmidt, 2005). Their attraction is also a distraction to the multitudes of voyeur fans who follow various sporting pursuits and often take on the violent, aggressive posture of their sports heroes more than the athletes who play it, such as in soccer.

A reduction in sporting violence would have a multiplier effect and should only be a beginning, however. A reduction of sporting violence would create deep-structure socio-behavioral change across society, and through this we can make significant changes to interpersonal violence around the world. This includes limiting overt violence, exploitation, and degradation

but more importantly re-socializing our next generations into nonviolence. This has change implications for religious beliefs, economics, politics, leadership, education, and gender identities. In short, it is not a simple task but still a critical one.

For most capitalist societies around the world, the meaning of individual freedom is distorted to mean the unrestricted freedom to do anything one wants to make money, whether it brings harm to another person or group or not, but clearly this type of hedonistic amorality is ultimately self-destructive. Thus a more restrictive, morally defensible, and sustainable democracy must be endorsed. That is why violence in modern society has transitioned into sport and so is kept at the nation state, local, and community level to keep it manageable. In a truly democratic society decisions to eliminate gratuitous violence in sports in favor of less aggressive and equally competitive alternatives would promote values of healthy and positive competition rather than unhealthy and negative confrontation. Societies have a moral right and responsibility to promote positive human social values and development that are supportive of the goals of collective freedom, nonviolence, and equity. These choices are no different than punishing someone who takes a life. If we want to build a nonviolent and democratic society we must build it on a foundation that recognizes that everything is an object lesson for values—what educators call “the teachable moment”—and everything matters in terms of what we do and what we model as an adult society. Adults have a serious responsibility to model positive conduct at all times.

Democratic societies have a right and a duty to censure violence and other self-destructive human behavior in every form, including sports, to develop positive, peaceful values in society as we already do with many forms of violence that are legally sanctioned. This simply needs to be extended. Violence cannot be condoned in one sector and tolerated in another. We must be consistent as a social culture. Parents who swear have no moral authority when their children do the same. Morality and ethics simultaneously must exist in the most personal and inconsequential to the most significant and global moments of life (O’Sullivan, 2001). Ethical behavior is a continuous, unrelenting personal demand on everyone to do the right thing—for one’s self and others. We must find a balance between individual autonomy and collective social responsibility. Currently the latter is under attack by capitalism, materialism, and social hedonism that implies that anything is acceptable as long as it feels good.

In a democratic society less competitive and nonviolent sports should be the encouraged and allowed norm. Any violence that is unnecessary to the skills of the game itself should be reduced or eliminated. Cooperative, not competitive, sports should be encouraged, particularly when children are young and certainly in elementary schools. Just like we stop young children from fighting lest they hurt themselves, we also need to stop our older children from playing sports that encourage violence lest they hurt themselves psychologically as well. Hockey could still be played without hitting or fighting as it is in Europe but this would affect its marketing and profit value to big business who would oppose this change. It would be unlikely to change fans' allegiance to their teams; in fact, most fans would welcome it. Many fans and adults who have been socialized into this patriarchal mindset would also argue against this, but collective common sense and shared positive values must prevail if we are to survive as a species. Sports such as baseball, golf, tennis, squash, badminton, table tennis, billiards, cricket, skiing, running, skating, cycling, and a host of others are healthy, non-confrontational, competitive athletic pursuits that do not involve direct physical aggression between competitors and would be positive sports to promote, while sports such as boxing and mixed martial arts should be banned or at least required to use protective headgear to prevent serious injury. Steroids should be banned substances. Eliminating the violence from sport would involve only a minor adjustment to many sports and none to most. Wrestling is a perfect example. Violent, macho, steroid-laced professional wrestling—which is primarily a fraudulent act rather than a sport—should be banned and replaced with Olympic style Greco-Roman wrestling that is just as competitive but inherently nonviolent and far more skill-based.

"Free enterprise" should only be free if the enterprise contributes to a healthy society and healthy social values and does not harm more than help. It should be free only if it does not harm someone in the process. Totally free enterprise is unregulated self-destructive amoral chaos allowing anything to go on as long as it makes money. Video games, other media, and violent sports such as MMA are only a few examples of areas that directly promote and socialize violence vicariously into society, something recognized by Hobson (1971) over a century ago:

But still more important than these supports of militarism in the army is the part played by "war" as a support of Imperialism in the non-combatant body of the nation. Though the active appeal of "sport" is still strong, even among townsmen, clear signs are visible of a degradation of this active interest of the participant into the idle

excitement of the spectator. How far sport has thus degenerated may be measured by the substitution everywhere of a specialized professionalism for a free amateur exercise, and by the growth of the attendant vice of betting, which everywhere expresses the worst form of sporting excitement, drawing all disinterested sympathy away from the merits of the competition, and concentrating it upon the irrational element of chance in combination with covetousness and low cunning. (p. 214)

Hobson believed that professionalization and commercialization of sports debased the values of competition and cheapened it by placing a monetary value on its practice. Capitalism had already begun to commodify and sully sport even in Hobson's era. We see this in the current invasion of millionaire professional athletes into the Olympics that was the last bastion of pure amateur sport but has become corrupted by the presence of professional athletes and big business. As a society we have abdicated our moral responsibility to our children by allowing economics to dictate our morality. It is economic social Darwinism. Whether it is sport or commerce, society—through its elected government—has a right and a responsibility to make social regulations that improve society as a whole, not degrade it. Business does not have a waiver on social responsibility. A free-market, unregulated society is an Orwellian world of winner-take-all and win-at-all-costs that is neither viable nor sustainable as we are currently seeing. It places money, greed, and aggression (in no particular order) atop all other human values and is destructive to society. All societies have a right to place legitimate restrictions on violence in any form—and by doing so to control and mediate the influence of patriarchy and capitalism. Just because we can make money from something doesn't mean it is right. We need "fair market capitalism" not free-market capitalism, to deemphasize the dominance of patriarchy in our economic system.

To take society to the next level of democratic evolution, we need to eliminate the contradictions and excesses that have given rise to violent and damaging beliefs and practices related to free enterprise that promote the dehumanization of humankind. Free enterprise constantly comes into conflict with collective social morality and ethics. In most cases the latter is the loser. Free enterprise is a misnomer because it is actually based on imprisoning people in an economic system of servitude and removing their freedom of choice. The only choice they are allowed is that which the marketplace provides.

The substitute for war that allows aggressive tensions to be released in sports has a huge downside. The violence that is endemic to many male sports is destructive to social values and a peaceful and democratic society. Violence also favors males who are stronger, more aggressive, and more inherently

predisposed to violence through their socialization. National belligerence and patriotism of adversarial nation states is acted out on the playing fields of sport. They are the vicarious substitutes for making war. In Rome spectators watched gladiators compete to the death and Christians being eaten by lions in an acceptable social pastime of a debauched Roman Empire. Today we watch football players compete for trophies in massive modern coliseums. Most male, competitive team sports inculcate aggression and macho gender stereotypes as the primary core values of the pursuit. Whether it is hockey, football, or more violent sports such as boxing and mixed martial arts, boys are socialized from an early age to be aggressive, dominant, and competitive. In the new patriarchy the heroes are macho males who exude testosterone, wealth, and power rather than compassion, charity, and sensitivity. Whether Ben Johnson, Carl Lewis, Lyle Alzado, Vasily Alexeev, Hulk Hogan, Roger Clemens, Mark McGuire, or Lance Armstrong, the role models are extra-macho males who have resorted to steroids to overachieve in the unforgiving and win-at-all-costs world of elite modern, corporate, male sports. There is clear evidence that free-market values corrupt human ones. One cannot forget that massive profits and salaries are driving these values and corrupting them at the same time. In hockey the role models are aggressive and violent players who drop their gloves and beat each other senseless in acts of aggression that are condoned and rationalized by commentators and the jingoistic public alike. The result is the elimination of skilled players such as Sydney Crosby and others due to the increasingly violent head shots that now dominate the game. The best stars' careers are now at risk by the lowest level of violent goons. Violence reduces social mores to their most bestial and primitive level. The NFL is now dealing with a growing scientific outcry surrounding serious brain injury in football and domestic violence among players. Real leadership entails those in authority taking a stand against violence in sport, society, and geopolitics and disavowing it as a viable or valid part of any part of civilized human society. This is required if we are to survive as a species and evolve to the next level of higher civilization that we claim to be.

The Role of Media

Leaders throughout history have understood and gained control over the most powerful weapon a leader can possess—ideas themselves—skewing their

interpretation and understanding toward idealizing and romanticizing the male gender, singular leadership models that emphasize violence, domination, control, and free-market capitalism as the preferred natural vehicles of social organization. The earliest form of this was through the recording of history that was done by males about males (French, 1985; Lerner, 1997). In modern neopatriarchal society the use of electronic media has become a sophisticated science of psychological propaganda that is actively employed to create carefully crafted effects that benefit specific segments of society (Williams, 1977). Herman and Chomsky (2002) in their book *Manufacturing Consent: The Political Economy of the Mass Media*, document in great detail the clearly evident propaganda role that media play in support of Western, democratic societies such as the G7 and the clear corporate bias they possess in under-reporting corporate malfeasance and government corruption. The management and media control of information are also used by every government of whatever ideology to selectively convey their particular message and consolidate their values (Lerner, 1997).

Currently the use of media for psychological purposes is the most present danger to social independence and democracy. The development of rational science and its related disciplines and the modern processes of leadership and domination that have evolved through the centuries were refined and re-focused on the subliminal internalization of control within individuals rather than the external imposition of domination (Williams, 1977). Michel Foucault, the French philosopher, writes extensively about this concept in his book *Discipline and Punish: The Birth of the Prison* (1995).

Through the vehicles of education, science, and psychology, society was socialized to accept the values of the new industrial ethos. With the advent of technology such as the radio and telecommunications, mass propaganda became possible, and the assault on the minds and hearts of people everywhere was renewed in earnest by private and governmental interests. It continues today in the particularly pernicious form of modern commercial advertising (Petras & Veltmeyer, 2001; Roy, 2003). Even the best leaders employ this strategy to gain cooperation and support for their goals. From Winston Churchill's radio addresses during World War II, to Hitler's use of the airplane to barnstorm cities prior to his election as the Chancellor of Germany in the 1930s, to President John F. Kennedy's use of new electronic media to create a positive image of his candidacy in the first televised presidential candidate debate in the 1960s, leaders have used mass communication methods to control their message and their image. Whether the message is good or bad, the

medium and the facts are always being manipulated, leading to a social state where no one can be confident of anything.

Unfortunately, in most cases the new technology is used for instrumental and self-interested purposes rather than broad social good. As Hertz (2003) points out regarding capitalism's use of media:

We are drip-fed images that reinforce this capitalist dream. Studios and networks beatify the very essence of capitalism. Prevailing norms and mainstream thoughts are recorded, replayed, and reinforced in Technicolor, while any criticism of the orthodoxy is consciously quashed. The peaceful element in the protests of Seattle, Gothenburg, and Genoa hardly made it to our screens. Proctor & Gamble explicitly prohibits programming around its commercials "which could in any way further the concept of business as cold or ruthless."⁴ Programs are sought that reinforce the advertisers' message. "Each time a television set is turned on, the political, economic, and moral basis for a profit driven social order is implicitly legitimised." (pp. 6–7)

Hertz's description harkens back to George Orwell's 1984 where Big Brother monitors and propagandizes the public through an interactive television set in each home. This technology is now a reality. The vast majority of our information about the world we live in comes from what are purported to be "free" and "independent" media (the "Free Press") but in reality our news, information, and political ideas are highly scripted and censored by the corporate media who control what, how, why, when, and if we see information at all (Herman & Chomsky, 2002; Roy, 2003). This phenomenon is neither new nor unique. Early in the 20th century Hobson (1971) expressed his concern about financiers in England controlling the media in his seminal work titled *Imperialism*:

The direct influence exercised by great financial houses in "high politics" is supported by the control which they exercise over the body of public opinion through the Press, which, in every "civilised" country, is becoming more and more their obedient instrument. While the specifically financial newspaper imposes "facts" and "opinions" on the business classes, the general body of the Press comes more and more under the conscious or unconscious domination of financiers. (pp. 59–60)

Hobson's concern has been magnified a thousand-fold since he wrote it. Leaders have always used media propaganda to advance their political agendas. John Dewey (1989), an eminent American educational thinker and philosopher, in his book *Freedom and Culture* discusses the growing influence of new technologies in the service of Nazi propaganda between the two world

wars. Gerth and Mills (1953) discuss the use of mass media for instrumental purposes as well. Herman and Chomsky (2002) quote Walter Lippmann writing in the 1920s who coined the term *propaganda* as the “manufacture of consent” and who “claimed that propaganda had already become ‘a regular organ of popular government’ and was steadily increasing in sophistication and importance” (p. xlvix). In the 1960s Joe McGinnis’s (1969) book *The Selling of the President* was a seminal work on the first use of media manipulation and propaganda employed to subconsciously change the image of Richard Nixon from negative to positive and to get him elected to the White House after a failed previous attempt. Nixon was “repackaged” by a media consulting firm to be perceived in a more positive way and became president, only to later resign in disgrace after Watergate.

In today’s world, social media and other electronic means of communication have become highly sophisticated, insidious, and refined active propaganda vehicles for neopatriarchy, leadership, and free enterprise, subtly reinforcing its values, beliefs, and practices or distracting the population from thinking about these issues. Nothing has changed since Hobson (1971) raised his concerns about the independence of the British press under imperialism. The concern is even greater today because electronic media are pervasive and now controlled by massive sophisticated multinational conglomerates. Almost a century later Herman and Chomsky (2002) describe the propaganda function that the American media played in distorting coverage of the Vietnam War, Ronald Reagan’s firing of 11,000 air traffic controllers in the 1980s, and the attempted assassination of Pope John Paul II. As they state in the introduction:

It is our view that, among their other functions, the media serve, and propagandize on behalf of, the powerful societal interests that control and finance them. The representatives of these interests have important agendas and principles that they want to advance, and they are well positioned to shape and constrain media policy. (p. xi)

Modern technology and the information revolution have enabled people to communicate instantly with anyone around the globe, creating a huge and convenient vehicle for social interaction as well as massive negative potential that was acknowledged by Dewey (1989). Two things are happening: first, there is the active use of media for propaganda purposes; and second, there has been an explosion of information on the Internet that often makes it impossible to discern reliable fact from fiction. The quantity of information is overwhelming.

Propaganda is not simply reserved for totalitarian regimes and despotic dictators. Modern corporations and governments of all political stripes and agendas regularly use media propaganda through advertising not to convey the truth but to convince people of their message, which means giving a certain favorable interpretation of the information being presented to those who receive it (Herman & Chomsky, 2002; Willower, 1997). Modern society is more about the dissemination of willful disinformation than the provision of reliable factual information. Full disclosure is rarely practiced.

Propaganda is viewed as a pejorative term implying manipulation; today it is more often called advertising or political “spin” (Willower, 1997). It is still manipulation, but more user-friendly. It is so widespread that it is difficult to discern where the truth lies any more. The line between fact and fiction or propaganda and advertising has blurred to the point that it is impossible to tell which is which. The word *propaganda* has virtually disappeared from the North American vernacular much like *patriarchy* unless it is referring to some despotic dictator the West wants to demonize. This is what Herman and Chomsky (2002) describe as the most effective propaganda—that which is invisible and unconscious but subversively effective. Millions of people worldwide can be influenced in an instant by a single commercial, tweet, blog posting, report, or event; witness the recent meltdown in the financial markets of 2008 causing a worldwide panic and recession. We are far more vulnerable today to a *War of the Worlds* scenario than ever before. The thinking and decisions of millions of people everywhere can be subliminally influenced by a well-placed ad or story without them even knowing. Most of the commercials, infomercials, and information that we receive from our electronic media have a deceptive, subliminal, controlled message as the key part of their intent. That message may be one with an economic, political, gender, or religious bias but all are intended to subtly massage the beliefs of the public in a certain way. This is in contrast to providing the public with the full and balanced information related to a product, event, or idea and allowing them to arrive at their own conclusions (Herman & Chomsky, 2002). And even if the truth is self-evident, official governments will deny its existence and assert a different interpretation. Constant deception breeds social cynicism.

Many of the commercial messages that proliferate in the media are stereotypical of male gender, power, and leadership and are subtle in their action. Media companies are also large corporations that censor the world that we see and how we see it through the lens of their “objective” journalism while ensuring that events or people critical of corporate business or politicians do

not receive coverage (Roy, 2003). In our modern media what is omitted is just as important as what is covered, but we are never made aware of the former. Our view of the world is always censored and controlled through the biased business-friendly lens of corporate news. Censorship is practiced by omission rather than commission (Herman & Chomsky, 2002). One example is the continued privileging of medical doctors by press policies while marginalizing all other qualified and well-educated professionals. In newspapers, for example, only medical doctors are referred to as "Dr." while all other professions are not acknowledged. Anyone else, despite their qualifications in their particular field, is simply published with full name, denying the reading public of the expertise and knowledge of writers regarding a particular topic. This press policy is a patriarchal centuries-old throw-back to a time when all doctors were male and rational science was the preserve of men.

We cannot evaluate the impact of neopatriarchy and leadership today without understanding and factoring in the pervasive influence of media in our modern society and on our modern democracies and the power of individuals and organizations to foster mass brainwashing on a global scale. It is not innocuous or harmless but is always presented with a specific intent and bias in mind—to influence us to accept the world as it is presented—rather than the way it may actually be. The movie trilogy *The Matrix* is premised on this dark vision of the future, but in fact the future is now. Image and message control is everything in modern corporate communications. Today, imperialism has moved from overt, physical conquest of others for private gain to internal, mental, and psychological conquest to ensure the same goal. As Gilligan and Richards (2009) point out the experience of trauma often results in identification with the perpetrator of the trauma in a paradoxical reversal of result. All of these methods are the practices of disciplining the populace (Foucault, 1995). Such is the way with capitalism and its operation in society. The battles for the domination of people today are fought internally at the level of values, beliefs, and attitudes and the weapons are computers, television, smartphones, Facebook, Twitter, and newspapers.

The new patriarchy has moved into the background of society and exists as an invisible, unspoken backdrop to the daily comings and goings of humanity just like the electronic universe. Nonetheless it is much more powerful and dangerous than its more overt expressions in previous centuries where it was exposed to more direct criticism and attack (Herman & Chomsky, 2002). The new patriarchy expresses itself in subtle, normalized, and subliminal ways that encourage us to internalize its message. Today neoconservative attack ads

warn of socialism and communism, appealing to patriotism, God, and traditional white moral values as a smokescreen for racism, intolerance, and right-wing extremism. The overt message is always a carrier for the implicit one. We must be vigilant to analyze the implicit demands of the various messaging in society. In contrast, however, there are few left-wing response ads warning of the fascist and extremist dangers of neoconservatism because the majority of the world's wealth is held by neoconservative forces. Conservatism, neoconservatism, and neoliberalism are the ideological expression of the core values of neopatriarchy: power and control.

Liberalism, socialism, and other left-leaning views of social organization take a more balanced and democratic approach to social structuring but they lack the wealth and power to effectively communicate their message to the world and ironically the majority of the public are suspicious of their message. They are fighting a nuclear ideology with small arms. The new patriarchy is the new fascism and is pervasive in our society, our newspapers, electronic communications, and television news media to one degree or another. Some of the most powerful modern capitalist myths and symbols are created by media in the service of globalized corporate interests. The appeal of the capitalist dream is equivalent to the appeal of buying a lottery ticket; mass self-deluded optimism. Whether it is the golden arches of McDonald's, the classic shape of the Coke bottle, the simple swoosh of Nike, or the iconic Olympic rings, these images are instantly recognizable everywhere around the globe and just as powerful as the Nazi swastika but more benign in their apparent message. While these corporate symbols are connected with positive corporate messages of responsibility and quality, we are carefully shielded by the media from the exploitation of child labor used to create Nike products; the excessive calories, fat, salt, and sugar contained in McDonald's and most other commercial fast foods; the empty calories and sugar of Coca-Cola; the destruction of water tables in producing the product; and the political infighting and corporatization of the Olympic organization. Today we are presented with a superficial veneer of reality papered over the ugly truth that lies beneath our cutthroat social and corporate worlds. The reality is that we are all being conquered by capitalist economics and theories that benefit the few at the expense of the many while being besieged by a full-court press of media airbrushing of social reality.

The majority of our modern myths and symbols are derived from corporate sources focused on consumerism and materialism. The corporate brand has become the religious mythology of modern culture and reflects the new consumer-based values of modern materialist society. Media plays a large role

in developing, marketing, and reinforcing these myths through television but now this has expanded with the World Wide Web, smartphones, and wireless computer technology. Corporations today literally have access to the entire global world at the click of a button. While H. G. Wells' Big Brother may not have television monitors placed in our homes to supervise the population, we willingly accept these technologies from the corporate Big Brothers of Panasonic, Sony, and LG and by attaching webcams to our computers so that the world can peer into our lives and through interactive media monitor them for private gain. Everyone with a cell phone can be located through GPS. A young university student in Toronto was raped and murdered while her boyfriend watched helplessly from China on the webcam in a surreal example of the horrors of modern technology and the false sense of safety that they provide. Two young Canadian girls committed suicide after being bullied and threatened about sexual behavior posted online. Millions of young, vulnerable children have been armed with cell phones by their misguided parents under the guise of increasing their personal safety while actually exposing them to a world of risk by doing so. Children and young adults now have instant communication capabilities to coordinate anything from parties to sex and drug use or to anonymously abuse their peers. They are also the most mobile generation in history, having access to vehicles to travel long distances at will, with or without the knowledge and consent of their parents. Parents have no idea what children and young people are doing today yet they regularly ignore the dangers. Our advanced technological society is also our biggest curse.

Parents have effectively lost control of their children due to social media and corporate nannies. They are oblivious of the dangers giving a cell phone to their child creates and often give in to the social pressure their young children put on them to own such devices. It is more to absolve the parents of responsibility for supervising their children and setting clear guidelines for their development than keeping their child safe. We spend our money to be controlled every day of our lives. We are eager prisoners begging for more control.

We have become anaesthetized and desensitized to the subtle and negative potential of electronic media. Modern media have the power to create persuasive and biased myths and symbols within our modern society and as well to fabricate consent by skilful use of images and ideas, particularly for young, naive, and impressionable youth and children. One example is the egregious marketing of candy-flavored cigarettes to teens. Both the media and the tobacco companies are the *real* danger to our children. Media organizations are large, complex, predatory corporate bureaucracies and thus have tremendous

power to inform, deceive, and create propaganda that influences society. They are funded by large corporations to promote their businesses not the public interest. We now have the potential to create a computer avatar for a human that could replace a president or CEO without the awareness of the viewing public. We must approach any media claims with significant cynicism and caution and far more skepticism that we currently do. Much of their affect seems counter-intuitively positive and harmless but much more of their impact socializes us to subconsciously believe in and validate a neopatriarchal universe including its horrendously violent global subtext. Their goal is to make money, increase share price and shareholder returns, while ensuring a passive and compliant populace that includes the massive subordination of women.

Significantly, corporate media control all our access to information about events in our world, and although media outlets often tout themselves as independent and objective journalists, most media have a clear corporate bias that censors what is reported, how it is reported, and why it is reported. While CBC, CTV, ABC, NBC, and CBS may present professional and polished corporate images, their journalistic content is tightly controlled (Dobbin, 1998). Other outlets such as FOX and Sun News present the same corporate image but with an openly right-wing and extremist bias. There are no media organizations that reflect a left-wing socialist or democratic activist perspective. While public television portrays the image of being more in the public interest, their political position is status quo and conformist.

All of the information that the civilian population receives is filtered through that conservative, right-wing corporate lens. In media, money controls advocacy. Herman and Chomsky (2002) identify five media "filters" as part of their propaganda model of news decision making:

The essential ingredients of our propaganda model, or set of news "filters," fall under the following headings: (1) the size, concentrated ownership, owner wealth, and profit orientation of the dominant mass-media firms; (2) advertising as the primary income source of the mass media; (3) the reliance of the media on information provided by government, business, and "experts" funded and approved by these primary sources and agents of power; (4) "flak" as a means of disciplining the media; and (5) "anticommunism" as a national religion and control mechanism. These elements interact with and reinforce one another. (p. 2)

If it passes these five filters it may make it to the evening news; if not, such as with criticism of corporate behavior, the function or validity or structure of democratic governments and laws, or other openly contentious topics or

views, they will never see the light of day. News reporting has also been sanitized of real critical political commentary and is more often a reporting of a series of facts without comment on their meaning for society. Media criticism is largely about civil problems, natural disasters, or despotic regimes. There is little or no attention paid to corporate malfeasance or the impacts of capitalism on workers or the environment or problems with the democratic process in society. There is little media urgency for change communicated to the audience. Revolution is not in the script. As Brookfield (2005) states of Herbert Marcuse's idea of repressive tolerance in the media: "By allowing a certain amount of social criticism in the name of free speech, the dominant group convinces the rest of the people that they live in a democracy" (p. 60). So the media controls public opinion not only by what it reports but by what it also excludes or absorbs. The illusion of dissent in the media masks the lack of change at the political or corporate level regarding the issues of concern. Permitted dissent is a palliative for real change. What it does not do is engage in any sustained discussion of the problems with our social or economic structures on anything other than a superficial level. Regarding the effect of media on society Lerner (1997) states: "Present-mindedness, a shallow attention to meaning, and contempt for the value of precise definition and critical reasoning are characteristic attitudes produced by mass media culture" (p. 123). Media are neither objective nor unbiased, yet few people give what they watch on TV each day a second thought. They generally accept what is reported as fact. Just enough criticism is allowed to take the edge off real revolution, just as Marx once noted. While we believe we live in a democratic society, we cannot state with any confidence that our social behavior reflects that reality.

We witness the new patriarchy and male domination daily in our geopolitical events, news media, sports, music, and entertainment programs, all of which express a clear bias toward men and male pursuits while stereotyping or ignoring women, minorities, and the poor. We idolize heroic male figures such as John Wayne, George Patton, and Napoleon. We give star status to Tiger Woods, King James, and Roger Federer. The news and sports media anchors are typically men with an attractive, young, token female companion newsreader. Most celebrities and media spokespersons are young, good looking, and articulate, reflecting the rampant ageism in corporate media decisions. Token minority media persons fill out the roster of white-oriented corporate staff. TV ads for domestic products still stereotypically feature attractive women in domestic roles and men as the young, strong, handsome, silent types (Walby, 1990). There is an obsessive focus on youth. Male sports dominate television

coverage and men often have the significant and lead roles in movies and television. The vast majority of CEOs in the private and public sector continue to be men. The highest political offices continue to be populated almost exclusively by males. Males permeate and saturate modern society and modern media (Lerner, 1997). There is a daily onslaught of subliminal gender propaganda on television that socializes us into accepting male values (Giroux, 2004).

Male status is the unquestioned element in society much like being white. Hegemonic masculinity (Beasley, 2008; Connell & Messerschmidt, 2005; Harper, 2005; Paechter, 2006) saturates our culture, media, governments, legal system, religions, workplaces, leisure, and personal relationships. Patriarchy is the Big Brother of our modern world. It is accepted as the normalized standard of society to which everyone must aspire and compare themselves. It is the hidden curriculum of life (Bierema, 2003). Anything else is seen as an anomaly to be questioned and analyzed unlike traditional heterosexual male behavior and white racial characteristics. The socio-psychological effects are often subtle and pervasive. A curious example of this is the number of African American women who unconsciously straighten their naturally curly hair to appear more acceptable in white culture. Whitening products are now being marketed to lighten the skin of darker races. During the 1960s the natural, black Afro was not only a fashion trend but also a political statement and a sign of black pride in their heritage and a symbol of resistance to the racial oppression of white culture. We are continually asked in subtle ways to aspire to idyllic, heroic, white, Eurocentric role models that are completely unattainable for most people and continue to problematize critical understandings of patriarchy (Brookfield, 2005; Seidman, 1994).

Media are the propaganda wing for the male corporate sector masquerading as objective, unbiased journalism while filtering and focusing the news coverage to provide a business-friendly slant to stories and primarily to promote consumer products through advertising that is often more prolific than the news. They also have the function to demonize those who might want to change how we live in our highly touted democratic societies (A. Johnson, 2005). Protestors, dissenters, and even presidents are stereotyped as radicals, terrorists, socialists, or communists by the "righteous right" while the underlying reasons for people who resort to such measures are never explored, many of which have to do with racism and the predatory role that our patriarchal culture and Western capitalism plays in exploiting other countries and cultures worldwide and the deep subtext of racism in countries like the United States. Media companies are themselves large corporations making billions

of dollars each year with a vested interest in maintaining the dominance and control of big business over society and industry. They are not neutral, objective observers of the world exposing wrongdoing as we are often led to believe (Herman & Chomsky, 2002).

While historians decry the purposeful propaganda that led to the tragedy of Nazi Germany and World War II, little is said about the same role of the U.S. government in keeping casualty figures out of the U.S. media during the Vietnam War or the role of IBM with Nazi Germany during the Second World War or the use of Nazi scientists to develop the space program in the United States after the war. Equally overlooked is the role of German capitalists who supported Hitler to crush the labor unions or the enriching of Monaco with Nazi money at their casinos during the war or of German businesses creating products using human remains (Laxer, 1999; Lerner, 1997; Petras & Veltmeyer, 2001). Today we are besieged daily by corporate media propaganda that is far more insidious in its effects than any perpetrated by various dictators through the ages and that has the same intent—to socialize the masses into being willing and compliant supporters of their corporate goals of profit and greed. The manipulated support of modern corporate brands is far more powerful than anything ever accomplished by any other dictator throughout history. This has only become possible in the past 25 years due to the explosion of the information revolution.

Many will say, So what? This is simply corporate marketing. Today, millions of people buy GAP, Campus Crew, and Old Navy or Gucci without any conscious justification to do so other than the fact they believe (falsely) that by purchasing these brands they will become part of an elite corporate consumer family rather than corporate consumer dupes. This is simply harmless fun. However, mindless fun has a real price. Those who are purchasing these “name” brands are participating in the exploitation of workers in developing and Third World countries such as Bangladesh and Taiwan who are paid pennies an hour to produce these garments that are then sold for massive mark-ups by the corporations that make them (Dobbin, 1998). Young teenagers use clothing as a status symbol in school where those who cannot afford expensive corporate brands are ostracized and humiliated because they don’t wear this clothing. Materialism is socially divisive and destabilizing. Parents support this kind of “kiddie competition.” This is exactly what media want us to do and think.

Community is redefined through consumer materialist terms rather than human ones. Every child who goes to school and is bullied because his or her parents cannot afford designer clothes is a victim of values promoted by

capitalism. The same message is created by gated communities, high-priced vehicles, exclusive restaurants, and private clubs. It is all economic and social elitism. Although this consumerism seems innocent enough, there is an underlying, unspoken affluent tone to the entire consumer discourse that creates a constant competition between consumers to appear to be better than their neighbors by buying more expensive goods.

There is also a hierarchy of exploitation that everyone from the producer to the consumer participates in. Our personal values and worth have become defined by our material possessions more than ever before, pushing human values into the background and creating human hardship in the process.

It is when consumption is linked directly to production that the problem with this apparently innocent system driven by capitalism and created by media fantasies is exposed. The designer jeans that sell for hundreds of dollars in the store are made by workers earning poverty-level wages hidden in off-shore developing countries in most cases. The media rarely focus on this exploitation and its link to consumerism, nor do they demand corporate change or government regulation. The real cost of the jeans may be a few dollars but they are sold at outrageous mark-ups to oblivious consumers and sold by poorly paid staff. In effect, both the worker and the consumer are victimized by capitalism.

In addition, supposedly democratic governments are passive bystanders and enablers of this system rather than active interveners and regulators. The most important part of capitalism is the secrecy of the cost-profit continuum. The entire Western consumer lifestyle is built on exploitation of workers abroad who produce the goods and compliant, unquestioning consumers who purchase these goods to produce astronomical profits for corporate businesses. Both of these latter results of consumerism are kept wellhidden by media, privacy laws, biz-speak, and off-shore contract production. Consumption is marketed as an innocent, victimless crime, but in reality it is based on the criminal exploitation of consumers, workers, and the natural environment all over the world (Dunleavy & O'Leary, 1987). In many cases these products are also made by harvesting endangered species such as snake or alligator skin or old-growth forests or by irreparably damaging the ecosystem where endangered animals live. Corporations take no responsibility for the collateral damage they cause in producing their goods to ensure maximum profit and ROI (return on investment) while playing up their positive role in job creation and wealth production. It is wealth without responsibility and governments are willing enablers of this system. All of this greed for goods creates massive

over-production and enormous waste—all of which is built into the costs to the consumer. In the West, we are a selfish and self-interested and spoiled society, spoiling society for everyone else who has yet to live.

Today, more than ever, people live vicariously in an electronic and consumerist fantasy world that is disconnected from reality. Life is filled with daily employment and banal, humdrum existence punctuated by electronic escapism. Electronics are the opium of the 21st century. People today cluster in small, glassy-eyed groups playing video games for endless hours in a self-induced euphoria much like the opium dens of an earlier era or the gin houses of industrial England. The addiction and the purpose are no different. People wearing GAP and other brand clothing imagine they are important people just like those who own and run Nike, Adidas, and Gucci. We watch movies such as *Star Wars*, *Terminator*, *Avatar*, and *The Hunger Games* and play computer games that simulate people who we are not and will never be. We spend hours of our personal free time watching TV, playing video games, and texting on smartphones or updating our Facebook pages while people around the world starve because of our consumerism. We give to charities at Christmas to soothe our liberal consciences, believing we are helping the less fortunate while we ignore them the rest of the time. We have become narcissistic fantasy people.

Our lives are becoming inundated with meaningless electronic diversions and irrelevant information that fill our lives and absorb our attention while distracting us from the real problems in our lives and society and the impact capitalism as an economic theory has on the world and its values (Lerner, 1997). How profit is created is the dirty little secret of free-market economics. We give little thought to why we are how we are—to our own detriment. We are engaging in a global fantasy world where everyone lives vicariously in some other fabricated reality that does not exist to escape the grimy, tawdry nature of their real lives and the dysfunctional economic world we inhabit.

Instead of paying attention to the causes of this situation, analyzing the reasons for it and doing something to change it, we are instead frittering away our lives in self-absorbed pursuits encouraged and sold by corporate media. Where previous generations marched on Washington, today's millennials line up at Apple stores and gather for music concerts. Social networking sites such as Twitter, Facebook, and YouTube are all expressions of the pervasive influence of neopatriarchy in our modern society. We are desperate for meaning and relevance in our lives and will do anything to achieve it—even if it means living vicariously through others in their reflected shadow. We are now

global voyeurs watching with passive fascination the foibles of others. We are a shadow society. This situation is reflective of the narcissistic, inward, and selfish focus encouraged by Rome during its decline and the current capitalist neopatriarchy toward ourselves, our lives, and our interests. This focus absorbs our attention and our daily living in meaningless trivialities and senseless hedonistic interests while taking our focus away from serious political issues such as the role of media propaganda, our personal circumstances and why they exist, wealth and poverty in the world, the erosion of democracy and democratic rights, and the creeping environmental destruction created by globalization and global capitalism. We have become passive, willing bystanders and victims in life. Social networking sites and meaningless comedies, reality TV, and heroic dramas that provide vicarious pursuits are all intended to keep us as compliant and passive consumers—the modern electronic equivalent of heroin or the Roman “bread and circuses” (Corson, 1993). The impoverished and subordinated Roman public watched gladiators kill each other in the Coliseum; today we witness modern gladiators compete in the Octagon in mixed martial arts fights in a global electronic coliseum on Pay-Per-View. The Romans had bread and circuses; today we have the Acme Bread Company and reality TV.

People escape with the help of corporate and electronic media. The same media and corporations that are contributing to the negative reality that is experienced by the majority of people in the world are also the ones providing the electronic drugs to keep us happy and shape our view of events. They are extolling a vision of corporate capitalism, consumerism, materialism, and hedonism for profit, and we are buying in with little critical attention to how this all happens. Good and evil have become indistinguishable in modern society. Live for today, for tomorrow we die. The good guy is also the enemy. The terrorist could also be your neighbor. Do we trust what the commercial food producers tell us, or do we believe the research data that indicate that our food supply is unhealthy? Do we believe the mining companies who say that mining creates jobs and stimulates economic growth or the scientists who say it destroys ecosystems and watersheds and pollutes the groundwater we drink and the air we breathe? Do we believe drug companies who say that life-saving drugs are safe or independent tests that show that they are harmful? Are they trying to find a cure for cancer or just ensure a huge profit stream from cancer drugs? Can we trust our governments when they tell us that they have our best interests at heart or the evidence of their big-business bias in government decision and policy making? (Dobbin, 1998). In contrast, the

discourse of capitalism has convinced us and our governments that social responsibility and corporate responsibility are separate. Every day people must make difficult, conflicted personal decisions about who to believe in society in the face of well-disguised corporate organizations that present one image while conducting business in an opposite, negative, and ruthless way within this. In most cases those who we should be able to trust are our worst enemies. We live in a paradoxical, inverted world reality where truth and fiction are interchangeable, making understanding what is reality exceedingly difficult for the everyday citizen. Sadly, as a result we all mistrust everyone.

We live in a society where we cannot depend on what we see, hear, or experience because our perceptions are always being deceived, both intentionally and randomly. Subsequently we stop trusting anyone—even ourselves. It is this psychological, perceptual, and sensorial destabilization of our inner psychic world that is the insidious part of neopatriarchy and capitalism and the values they promote. We have become, in essence, neohuman.

Owners of corporations and their shareholders are the real elites in society who use workers, consumers, and the media as the tools to create their wealth primarily by deception and chicanery. George Orwell may have missed the year in 1984 but Big Brother has arrived as a reality in society, with massive electronic surveillance, police and government monitoring of the general public, and an increasingly sophisticated, paranoid, and biased corporate media and technology controlling ideas and politics (Lerner, 1997).

Modern democratic capitalism is neither democratic nor effective in delivering human rights and collective benefits to society; it is simply the best of a bad lot in today's world. It is the highest evolution of patriarchal social control. What is delivered to people is democratic capitalism and consumerism packaged by electronic media spin. Any attempt to assert the right of citizens to real democracy, real information, real dialogue, or real issues or real challenges to this operation is quickly suppressed. Democracy is disruptive to the smooth flow of global commerce and trade. We live in a world of little hope and much cynicism. It is the world of chaos theory, a world in constant transition and change where movements to resist or support issues coalesce and disappear like the Occupy movement: flash-mob change that effectively accomplishes little. We live in the world of Andy Warhol's 15 minutes of fame.

The focus of our news and media is always on the successes created by industrial capitalism and lionizing traditional leadership, not on their significant failures, environmental damage, or on the massively negative social effects as a result of our consumption on the environment and developing countries

around the world. The media business rarely calls out business for their ethics, business practices, or profits. We are never given the full, true picture of the cost of our consumer lifestyles or cost-benefit analyses from production to consumption from investigative journalists who infrequently objectively analyze capitalism and operate on 10-second sound bites. Reality is a shell game and we are the marks. We are never given the details of costs, environmental impacts, workers' pay and benefits or profits. There is a constant effort at obfuscation. In short, we are never given the complete picture to fully contextualize our perceptions. These things are all "private," part of the well-disguised secrets of capitalism and global economics that media work hard to cover up and smooth over with a tsunami of electronic information that overloads the senses of society. We are all living a global lie and deceiving ourselves that the economic system that runs our world is fair and effective. The ongoing devastation of the environment worldwide, global warming, the collapse of fish stocks, the loss of endangered animal species, and clear-cutting of the rainforests in Brazil are all dismissed and ignored by a self-interested corporate world unwilling to take responsibility for the damage their production causes (Schafer, 2008). These problems are passed off as being unsubstantiated issues, distortions of radical fringe activists, or the bias of left-wing socialist elements in society or a coincidental and necessary by-product of economic success. In fact, corporations are corporate terrorists; they have little concern for whom or what they hurt as part of their maniacal pursuit of their bottom line. News has become a packaged, meaningless consumer product like any other—factual information in neat sound bites to be consumed by viewers without judgment or exploration. Corporate media objectively report the facts without making linkages to the capitalist free-enterprise system and those who benefit from it or judgments about its morality along with its culpability and corruption.

So we live in an ongoing socio-technical Orwellian paradox much like the inhabitants of the movie *The Matrix* where media, leadership, religion, education, governments, business, and the military are all directed toward convincing us that everything we are doing is for the purposes of furthering our democratic societies when the exact opposite is happening. They are all patriarchal fictions of patrimonial structures and relationships. Nationalistic jingoism is stirred up by sentimental tributes to fallen soldiers—who themselves have been exploited and duped into fighting wars of control for capitalist free enterprise rather than any ideal of democracy and by our obsessive fascination with male sports, heroic fantasy figures, and conflict and competition. As the great social and literary

critic Raymond Williams (1973) points out in his seminal book *The Country and the City* of 19th-century English society during the imperial period:

This, indeed, had been the developing system. Millions of slaves; millions of indentured and contracted labourers; millions of rural workers kept at wages so low that they could barely sustain life. Out of these 'country' areas there eventually came, through blood and struggle, movements for political independence. At various stages, to protect such an order, young officers from the country-houses led other Englishmen, and the expropriated Irish and Scots and Welsh, to the colonial battles in which so many died. It is a strange fate. The unemployed man from the slums of the cities, the superfluous landless worker, the dispossessed peasant: each of these found employment in killing and disciplining the rural poor of the subordinated countries. (p. 283)

The national interests they were securing were the corporate interests of the large businesses of the world, not those of their citizens. This image could be just as easily painted in 2014 to describe the impacts of globalization. The people who went to war were the working classes while the upper classes took officer positions and avoided the uglier carnage. In any war, the poor fight for the rich to preserve their interests, not those of the public. Ironically, the way of life working people are defending is the right of privilege and elitism to exploit them, not for their right to equality and democracy. A. Johnson (2005) notes that 80% of the soldiers who fought in Vietnam were from working or lower-class backgrounds. Anyone who questions war or is opposed to participating in it is immediately marginalized and derided as unpatriotic, un-American, socialist, or a subversive as the jingoistic frenzy around it builds (Herman & Chomsky, 2002; Hobson, 1971). Herman and Chomsky (2002) point out the effect of this on media and those who wish to practice journalism: "The result is a powerful system of induced conformity to the needs of privilege and power" (p. 306). It is like living in *Alice in Wonderland* where logic is illogical. Each day, subliminal media technologies of control are employed to persuade the public of the value of our corrupt social institutions. The media all pump out the message of success, wealth, and power while the reality is that few in Western societies experience that and even fewer in societies around the world. There is also a growing awareness of this reality. The experience of those who come in contact with capitalism is that there are massive numbers of losers required to create a shrinking number of winners.

The role of media is to create a charade of success that justifies and validates the brutal underbelly of predatory capitalist free enterprise while promoting its products to the unsuspecting public. While only the lucky few speculators, lottery winners, movie and TV stars, sports figures, wealthy corporate elites,

or other randomly chosen individuals who benefit from the corrupt system are the focus of the media's attention, the reality of the more mundane and, in many cases, dismal lives of the remaining 99% of society are glossed over, ignored, or mocked in reality-TV shows. People are consumed under capitalism in the same way as the products it produces. These people are the forgotten 99% who protest on Wall Street. The protestors give voice to a faceless majority that suffers in silence to allow a few to enjoy astronomical wealth.

We are in serious danger of losing touch with reality and our ability to think critically and independently in the face of an onslaught of sugar-coated messages that extol the virtues of compliance and consumerism, distort reality, and manufacture consent. The majority don't agree, support, or condone the neopatriarchal universe we inhabit but have no way of expressing that in any powerful manner to their fellow citizens, despite the explosion of media to do so. Corporate media employs divide-and-conquer diversionary propaganda to effectively silence dissent. Anything is excusable if it is in the service of capitalism and business interests; nothing is excusable if it is not. Cooperation, compliance, consent, and consensus have become code words for neopatriarchal subordination. The more we demonstrate these values in society, our work, organizations, and political systems, the more accepted we are, but the less real freedom we have. Compliance has been twisted to be positive and dissent or disagreement as negative when both should be equally valued. We are allowed to be economic observers of the success of capitalism but never full participants. That right is reserved for a select and often randomly chosen few.

The reality is that the success of those portrayed in the media is directly related to and the cause of the situations of the remaining majority. The role of media in modern society is to create an escapist fantasy world that will take the public's mind off their own depressed situations and the reasons for them. We are presented with ironic images of isolated tribes in the Amazon with a television set in a squalid mud hut in the jungle as a symbol of the reach of the modern world and civilization, not as a pitiful symbol of our electronic and economic colonization and debasing of everything human by capitalism and its mantra of discrepant materialism (Lerner, 1997). As Lerner suggests, progress has been monumental but consistently uneven. Clearly this is a system that needs to be dramatically reformed and reconstructed before it is too late (A. Johnson, 2005). Ironically, the explosion of information technology may open a window to accomplish this as people around the world are now becoming globally aware of the travesties of globalization and free enterprise and are mobilizing as a human community to protest the amoral exploitation of the citizens of the world.

LEADERSHIP

Sacred authority and emotion are neglected and often ignored; when acknowledged, they are thought to be weak, impressionistic concepts, and more myth than reality—ideas to be avoided, if not scorned. Sense experience and intuition, while acknowledged, do not enjoy equal standing with secular authority, science and deductive logic. What results from not giving equal attention to all modes is an impoverished management theory and a leadership practice that may not be leadership at all. —Thomas Sergiovanni (1992)

Leaders are the co-conspirators of patriarchy. If patriarchy is responsible for the social pyramid upon which society is built, then leadership is the mechanism that built it and one of the most powerful universal mythologies. It is one of the key pillars of the democratic gulag and the most tangible expression of its ideology. Examining leadership reveals how patriarchy has worked in our human history. Leadership is the enforcement arm of patriarchy. As Hatcher (2005) pointedly expresses: “In the academic and policy literature the relationship between ‘leaders’ and ‘followers’ is often justified in instrumental, elitist, and patronising terms” (p. 261). Leaders are the commandants who maintain and run the democratic gulag. They have been and continue to be unrelentingly male despite superficial gains by women and minorities over the past century. Under the guise of freedom they deliver oppression and imprisonment, and under the charade of democracy they deliver benevolent dictatorship. As

Bennis and Nanus (1985) state regarding the misuse of power by leaders: "Historically leaders have controlled rather than organized, administered repression rather than expression, and held their followers in arrestment rather than revolution" (p. 16). Leadership has been male, dominant, authoritarian, and controlling. Leaders have for the most part been narcissistic, indulged, and mythologized, self-styled figures who projected and imposed their personalized worldview on all others most often to the general detriment of their followers and society. Their accomplishments were always inflated and yet are Pyrrhic in nature. They conquered rather than created their wealth and lineage.

Leadership and Power

In whatever form it is conceived, power is the essence of leadership and the essence of leadership has been male. In societies around the world power is largely conceptualized and analyzed in male terms as "power-over" (Brunner, 2002). Crippen (2005) describes the common characteristics and beliefs regarding leadership:

The old leadership paradigm of the 19th and early 20th centuries suggested three particular beliefs: (1) that leaders were born and not made (your lineage or pedigree class endowed you with the look and personality of a leader—a hierarchical position); (2) good management made successful organizations; and (3) one should avoid failure at all costs, a belief that promoted risk avoidance and fear (Block, 1993; Hickman, 1998). Popejoy (2004) further characterizes power as follows: "Power is often viewed as a function of formal authority, position, role, or control over resources. Many people view power as the imposition of will to persuade others to do something they wouldn't ordinarily do." (p. 13)

In this definition of power and leadership Crippen (2005) has characterized the real problem with leadership and leaders—top-down, forced power and control of society. The unchanged modern traditional corporate view of this model is reflected in Bennis and Nanus's (1985) description of leadership:

Our concept of power and leadership, then, is modeled on the Iacocca phenomenon: power is the basic energy needed to initiate and sustain action or, to put it another way, the *capacity to translate intention into reality and sustain it*. Leadership is the wise use of power: Transformative leadership. (p. 17)

All of our leadership models cherish and embrace power and control as part of their basic premise. Bennis and Nanus do not clarify what the “wise” use of power means except in traditional patriarchal terms. Power and leadership in their view are employed together to make things happen, and leaders are benevolent, effective, decisive, and paternal. As history has shown, they are also petulant, indecisive, and ruthless. Power is linear, one way, and direct. This position is also easier than attempting to do the difficult work of critiquing leadership as a multifaceted, dialectical, interactive concept between leaders and followers and developing new forms of democratic leadership and social organization (Collinson, 2005). Peter Senge (1990) further points out:

Our traditional views of leaders—as special people who set the direction, make the key decisions, and energize the troops—are deeply rooted in an individualistic and non-systemic worldview. Especially in the West, leaders are heroes—great men (and occasionally women) who “rise to the fore” in times of crises. Our prevailing leadership myths are still captured by the image of the captain of the cavalry leading the charge to rescue the settlers from the attacking Indians. So long as such myths prevail, they reinforce a focus on short-term events and charismatic heroes rather than on systemic forces and collective learning. At its heart, the traditional view of leadership is based on assumptions of people’s powerlessness, their lack of personal vision and inability to master the forces of change, deficits which can be remedied only by a few great leaders. (p. 340)

Senge underlines the fundamentally disempowering nature of traditional leadership models. Despite Senge and others’ appeals for more democratic, energetic, and effective models of leadership for the 21st century however, (Bennis & Nanus, 1985; Blackmore, 1989; Brodeth, 1996; Giles & Proudfoot, 1994; Sergiovanni, 1992; Starratt, 2004; Stern, 2002) we are still mired in the era of the archetypal hero leader (Olsson, 2002; Sinclair, 2004).

The sense of “powerlessness” of those affected by leadership that Senge speaks of has given rise to the accompanying widespread deficit model that is inherent in most organizational and societal approaches to leadership (Maxcy, 1991). Followers are viewed as less skilled and more deficient than leaders and in need of direction to function effectively (Casey & Apple, 1989; Reister, Pursch, & Skrla, 2002). It is a companion of Douglas McGregor’s Theory X theory of organizations, viewing people as lazy, unmotivated, and in need of strong direction to motivate them to accomplish tasks (Handy, 1981). These theories are negative, elitist, and demeaning male views of people and organizations, and in an increasingly informed world they are a source of conflict and frustration for a growing army of followers who see little leadership in leaders

that exceeds their own capabilities and who witness the enormous collateral costs of failed leadership as well.

Patriarchy has created a comfortable (albeit unfair) vertical social and organizational pyramid that everyone understands and complies with—even if they don't always agree with its premises or practices. It is assumed to be better than some unknown state that might disrupt comfortable, well-understood inequities (Harrison, 1991). We need to abandon the anachronistic, patriarchal, rationalist notions of leadership as power, domination, and control that continue to underpin leadership theory and embrace a new inclusive view of leadership that is democratic, open, and egalitarian not only in the way it views leadership and practices it but also how it actually distributes formal power and authority within the system (J. Ryan, 2006). We need to practice models of leadership that engage in self-critique of leadership itself and indeed all of our social concepts that we adhere to. In essence, does leadership do what we think it should do and does it produce the results that we think it should? The same applies to democracy and all other salient concepts in society. We need to embrace these models because they will result in far better outcomes for all of society than anything we experience now.

Despite this latter democratic view benefiting the majority of people, most do not view power in this way (Brunner, 2002). We fear change more than we fear its result. The more we abandon power and control for real equality, consensus, and collaboration, the better our society and our education systems will be. At the same time we must accept that they will become less "efficient" because democratic processes are more contested, diverse, and consensual—they will take more time. This is the price we must pay for democracy, and that is not necessarily a bad thing, since decisions will be made more slowly and with greater deliberation and broader support leading to fewer missteps. We must also always be vigilant to root out corruption and dysfunction that would affect democratic practices and slow down its application. However, the critical part of this is that without the equalization of formal power and control and the simultaneous restructuring of the hierarchy of bureaucracies to reflect this, little democratic change will happen in any areas of society.

Ackerman and Maslin-Ostrowski (2002) further convey the key yet purposely overlooked role power plays in education, leadership and elsewhere, even in traditional views of power: "Power, strength, and competency are traditionally sought after as important qualities in leadership. Balanced use of power is critical to school life, creating common goals and giving meaning to work. A school functions through power structures of one design or another."

(p. 22). They reinforce the need for power to be balanced, which it rarely is but this should be the ultimate goal if power must be a part of social life. Patriarchal leadership has only generated flawed, imbalanced, destructive, and problematic models to date which can only be expected of a top-down authoritarian ideology. Ackerman and Maslin-Ostrowski (2002) also describe the age-old belief that "power is essential to a leader's success in leading change and realizing goals" (p. 22). They express a common contradiction with many models or theories of leadership in that power must be balanced to be effectively used, yet power in organizations is most often the opposite of that.

The belief that power for dominance is the only way for leaders to succeed is the prevailing patriarchal fallacy that still governs all traditional leadership theory, models, and practices (even the seemingly democratic and egalitarian ones) and underpins leadership practice worldwide. No matter how consensual and collaborative a leader may appear to be on the surface, power underlies the leader's authority, behavior, and organizational structures and is the real essence of the leadership—not charisma, vision, or humility. The latter are simply accoutrements that are ascribed to leadership enhanced by the leader's underlying power and authority.

The real test of leadership and its power to inspire and motivate people is revealed when formal power is not part of the equation, as with Mahatma Gandhi or Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. These leaders created nonviolent social change movements with nothing more than the power of their ideas and words. Power came to them—they did not go out and necessarily seek it. Despite their positive contributions to nonviolent leadership, both operated within a benevolent patriarchal perspective. Power skews the democratic debate and masks real creativity, ideas, and concerns, leading to a suppression of real issues that can hold back organizational and societal success. It is exactly this belief that leaders cannot accomplish goals without the use of traditional power that must be banished from the lexicon of leadership theory and organizations.

Truly democratic leaders work by real consensus based on fully equalized formal power and authority that empowers and encourages those involved to speak freely and directly to issues of concern without fear of reprisal or reprimination from a superior in organizations that reflect flattened, rather than hierarchical, structures (Fitzgerald, 2009; Hornstein, 1996; P. Johnson, 2005; S. Ryan, 1999). Democratic leadership in organizations is open leadership that encourages the full and frank exchange of ideas and expression of concerns to ensure quality decision making. Only by fully vetting all issues can decision making be improved. A balance of power is the essence of democracy

and personal freedom, but there is not a single organization of any significance that operates in this way anywhere in the world. We live in political oligarchies, not democracies. We have accepted power as a given in human relations rather than a learned behavior that is socially reinforced and can be changed. We need to give power away to others and retain it ourselves for collective, rather than individual, use.

Unfortunately the primary applications of power are rarely for constructive collective benefits and often for self-interested personal achievements. While Ackerman and Maslin-Ostrowski (2002) point out that "Power, strength, and competency are traditionally sought after as important qualities in leadership" (p. 22), power is rarely the focus of sustained critical study in leadership research or popular assessments—particularly power in education. When it is investigated it is often approached as a naturalized, accepted, and lionized quality of leadership that is to be emulated rather than a problematic and negative component. Leadership is repeatedly viewed and asserted as a positive construct despite significant evidence to the contrary. Power as force to accomplish a leader's will against the objections of others is an accepted norm in leadership and as such is not held up to scrutiny (McNay, 2003). Power is politely avoided by most academics and pundits because it gets at the distasteful core of all leadership models and is an uncomfortable and provocative topic for research or comment in a supposedly civilized and democratic social structure. At its core leadership is a form of politely disguised domination. We do not want to admit that our society is at its core authoritarian and repressive. The focus is most often on the amorphous romantic leadership qualities of personality, behavior, style, and situation or other such factors without connecting controlling power to them (S. Maxcy, 1991).

Much research attempts to dislocate power from leadership and term it something more innocuous and productive such as influence rather than control and authoritarianism (Vescio, Snyder, & Butz, 2003). We are continuously attempting to sanitize power of its distasteful qualities. Research often gently skirts the issue of power in these assessments while acknowledging its existence. Invariably all leadership models that rely on power imply a male conceptualization of the term since males have exclusively wielded power historically. As Christopher Hodgkinson (1997) observes:

In principle or in theory the accomplishment of administrative goals, targets, aims, purposes, plans, and objectives is no more than the imposition of a putative collective will upon the resistant and countervailing forces of matter, circumstances, materials, resources, and contending wills. To be without will would be to be without power and,

conversely, to have power is the ability to impose will. Of course the more tender-minded might prefer the term “influence” to “impose” but this is only to say that the imposition may be accomplished by more congenial or politically correct means. (p. 3)

Will only needs to exist because of power. Without the imposition of power, will is unnecessary in relationships. Will is the expression of the id. Will becomes human expression filtered through the superego rather than imposition. All traditional views of power assume and encourage the leader's use of that power in a moral and ethical manner, but invariably the leader in question falls victim to the attraction of negative power and uses it manipulatively (Stewart, 2006). Power corrupts and absolute power does corrupt absolutely. The reason it does this is that patriarchal power has socialized our world to be monochromatic in its view of its use and because the checks and balances that exist when more equalized democratic power relationships prevail are absent. Power is always an abuse. These checks and balances are most evenly distributed in real democratic leadership models, which are rare while they are most skewed in dictatorships, resulting in widespread abuses of that said power (Ferguson, 2011). Patriarchy intentionally restricts the abrogation of power to ensure its use. This is why democratic leadership models that formally embrace shared formal power are the only way to ensure that decisions evolve and are made collectively, fairly, and free from corruption.

Ackerman and Maslin-Ostrowski (2002) underscore the key role that power plays in leadership success and the need to examine both its constructive and destructive capabilities in assessing its real value to society. The patriarchal, authoritarian, and controlling paradigm of leadership that has dominated the leadership landscape, history books, and academic literature for centuries has clearly proven its destructive capabilities to society, yet these are rarely the focus of leadership study that most often focuses on their achievements—only the end results of the victorious are evaluated—while the democratic approach to leadership that focuses on shared authority and power has never been credibly considered or promoted as an alternative despite its significant positive and constructive potential for creating change (J. Ryan, 2006).

Too often we only assess what we perceive as the constructive influence of traditional leadership power while ignoring its dark, unsavory side. As Brookfield (2005) notes of the French philosopher Michel Foucault: “Foucault argued that power is exercised in all social situations (including adult education) and that it is inextricably intertwined with the ability to define what counts as knowledge” (p. xii). Everyone possesses power in various forms

and intensities, resulting in continuous struggles to use that power in human relationships. Society itself demands the use of power by leaders. The human reality is often that socially perceived power has a clear and consciously employed application; however, it is defined unlike the amorphous, interactive power Foucault refers to. The panopticon of Jeremy Bentham that Foucault (1995) describes in *Discipline and Punish: The Birth of the Prison* is a facility constructed with conscious intent to express and employ social/psychological power in a one-directional way to control others. It presages the use of modern technologies of mind control and surveillance that have exploded in our present information society (Lerner, 1997).

The traditional dysfunctional and Pyrrhic approach has dominated leadership for centuries and is long overdue for a critical review and overhaul. Leadership is primarily defined in the literature as being hierarchical, patriarchal, coercive, and related to wealth and influence despite many models and theories that claim more democratic and consensual approaches (Crippen, 2005; Leithwood & Mascal, 2008; Mayrowetz, 2008; J. Ryan, 2006; Stern, 2002). Even though this is the view of leadership and power that dominates our common societal understanding of the concept, arriving at a working definition of power is still a challenge as there are multiple perspectives and approaches to understanding it from modernist to post-structuralist and many others (Braynion, 2004). The reality is, however, that this academic fragmentation and compartmentalization of definitional approaches serves to obscure the practical reality of power and authority in people's lives and its daily practice by leaders everywhere, which should be the focus of our attention. Academic hair-splitting is a distraction from the reality of power. Power can be described as power-over (Sergiovanni, 1992), power-to (Wright, 2008), power-with, and power-within describing the use of power when it is hoarded, shared, and internalized as character strength (Heineck, 2003). Because of the domination relationship with men, women's power has historically been described as the "power of the weak" because men's power has often been employed to supersede women and subvert their goals, aims, and dreams (Fennell, 2002). As Rosalind Miles (1993) states:

Traditionalist arguments of masculine supremacy have been remarkably resilient over time—all democratic experiments, all revolutions, all demands for equality have so far stopped short of sexual equality—and women, seen as biologically determined continue to be denied the human rights of full self-determination. (p. 14)

As Miles points out, the world has a history of resisting patriarchal leadership, not accepting it, and of wanting more democratic rather than despotic societies (Ferguson, 2011). Given these assertions, it is intriguing how little sustained focus there is on the negative effects of male power in organizational leadership. Instead of focusing on the real issues of power and control in organizations such as education (who has it, why, who benefits, how is it employed, and for what reasons) and the attendant impacts on organizational effectiveness and professional autonomy, there is little real discussion of the power behind the leaders and how this shapes leadership and followership behavior in education and other fields such as economics, politics, and religion in negative and undemocratic ways. Instead it is the collaborative, consensual, or the mythological personal qualities that become the focus of great leaders who get things done and motivate followers in their organizations in a societal rationalization that ignores the reality of power. In addition, the primary recipients of leadership outcomes—employees, citizens, and followers in general—are rarely, if ever, meaningfully consulted about the pitfalls of leaders and leadership. Ironically, while leadership is touted to be about leading followers, the latter are ignored in the evaluation of leadership success. Leaders are lauded for controlling people, not liberating them.

Whether or not there is agreement on the meaning of power, one thing cannot be denied: power in some form or understanding is a concept well-known to humanity and a force that influences our lives in major and minor ways every day. It is then surprising that so little sustained critical attention is paid to leadership and power and in particular its presence, use, and effects in education and elsewhere by leaders.

The Leadership Paradigm

Leadership is perhaps the biggest hoax ever perpetrated on humankind. It is nothing more than rule by capricious force either literally or figuratively. It is romantic deception on a grand scale. Leaders are most often portrayed as a power for good when the entire paradigm of leadership mediates against this. Leaders fail far more than they succeed. Putting all your eggs in one basket is never a good idea, but this is exactly what we do with singular leadership models that have dominated history. More often than not this ends with disaster. Traditional patriarchal leadership has remained remarkably impervious to fundamental change. Our current understanding and practice of it has grown

out of a long mythical history of male domination that affects every other aspect of our social experience. It is simplistic and based on the principle that "might is right"—a singular, male, heroic, messianic, and charismatic conceptualization that romanticizes and mythologizes leaders as aggressive, decisive, ruthless, and powerful elite male individuals who inspire others to follow them through their personal charisma, vision, and strength of will (Gilbert & Matviuk, 2008; Gilligan & Richards, 2009; Manz, 1999; Maxcy & Nguyễn, 2001; J. Ryan, 2006). They rarely fail at their task and when they do—they do so heroically. Our leadership mythology implies a world made up of essentialized linguistic binaries—good/evil, rational/irrational, leaders/followers, success/failure, and wealth/poverty, to name only a few that frame the world in simplistic, marginalizing ways (St. Pierre, 1999). The world is easier to deal with when it is black and white rather than shades of gray. We see the expression of this leadership model lionized in history books and in the elaborate staging of police and military funerals (Klein, 2002; Sommers, 1994).

Most of the more liberalized and less threatening modern conceptualizations of democratic forms of leadership and organizational culture such as strategic planning are false prophets that promised collaboration but did nothing to change the status quo of either organizational structures or leadership power within them (B. D. Maxcy, & Nguyễn, 2001). In one form or another, they continue to recycle singular leadership as the panacea for society and organizations everywhere. Many academics, politicians, historians, and economists have built their entire professional careers on this concept and have a strong vested interest in not rocking the theoretical boat when it comes to leadership reform. Maintaining the party line is comfortable and lucrative as these individuals profit academically and financially from the constant appetite for advice on how to actualize traditional leadership and control people better. The entire discourse is oriented in a subtext of finding ways to deceive people into doing what leaders want without the former realizing it. It is patronizing and demeaning.

Leadership fundamentally operates on the deficit premise that people are less capable and less intelligent than we give them credit for, particularly women (Biklen, Marshall, & Pollard, 2008; Casey & Apple, 1989). In reality, followers always know the game that is being played and respond with obstructive practices or passive resistance to manage the unspoken manipulation that is occurring (Collinson, 2005; Sinclair, 2004). It makes for a singularly less productive and tension-filled relationship, because followers don't trust leaders and leaders give them little reason to do so.

Traditional leadership models are inherently negative because they set up a value difference between leaders and followers that creates hostility between them. It is at its core a dishonest, manipulative leadership discourse (Collinson, 2005; Pellegrini & Scandura, 2008). While leadership is frequently portrayed as a benevolent, non-threatening, constructive, and necessarily critical element in modern democratic society, politics, organizations, and business, its ultimate thinly disguised underlying belief is no different than leaders thousands of years ago—to dominate and control others using whatever methods possible and necessary. Its goal was not and is not to collaborate or reach consensus or to empower others as the false rhetoric of many leaders and experts might suggest, but to control others to achieve the desired goals of the leader and of other elite groups in society to the detriment of all the rest. To do anything less would be contrary to the fundamental spirit of traditional leadership.

The concept of leadership is a powerful tool in the hands of the corrupt, misinformed, misled, or greedy but also the committed, moral, well-intentioned, well-informed, and frugal. All these groups have used it to their advantage for centuries—some for positive good, most for personal gain and evil purposes. A contemporary example is the emotional appeals of thousands of charities for donations that bombard our airways every day to solicit funds. The historical reality is that patriarchal conceptualizations of leadership have not created altruistic or morally benevolent leaders or followers. Singular leadership attracts those who desire control and power over others. Not all leaders will go to all lengths to control their followers, but many will and do. Leadership—whether for positive or negative intentions—obliterates rational thinking and morality and replaces it with blind allegiance in one form or another much like religious belief (Manz, 1999). The dominance of traditional leadership practice also suppresses democratic and consensual leadership that is viewed as weak and indecisive while in reality being openly consensual.

Despite being covered by a socially acceptable veneer, this pattern and conceptualization of leadership is fundamentally unchanged in our modern world. It exists in every aspect of human life and has colonized the psyche of our modern mentality and organizations to such a degree that we do not question its premises nor challenge its authority. Patriarchal leaders throughout history defined the values, beliefs, knowledge, social structures, and politics of their respective societies and entrenched violence or the threat of violence as a socially sanctioned way of dealing with problems. The real problem is the actual archetypal tradition (Olsson, 2002) of male leadership and conflict itself—not

its myriad expressions. The entire ideological construct is seriously dysfunctional and leads to similarly flawed leadership and predictably similar social results in other areas such as religious belief.

Regrettably, in modern society, we have become so socialized into this concept that it has become normalized and we do not give it a second thought. This process is what Crow (2007) refers to as "serial socialization": "An interesting feature of serial socialization methods is that they tend to emphasize maintaining the status quo. The most powerful way of reproducing what currently exists is to use current incumbents of the role to train newcomers" (p. 53). Everyone believes they know exactly what leadership is and how to practice it without ever considering if there are or should be different ways of leading and following, or whether the actual concepts of leadership and followership and the dependent relationships they generate are healthy or have ethical validity. Necessarily, empowering models of leadership imply empowering models of power, and this is the roadblock.

Leaders of democratic societies rarely reflect on whether they are enhancing the state of democracy in their nations; they simply assume they are. Most people just want to be told how to lead and then do it. They do not do much theorizing about whether what they are doing is effective or right. Much like democracy, leadership is a heavily socialized, normalized, and little scrutinized concept similar to parenting. Leadership research is a self-fulfilling prophecy that extols the benefits of great leaders while ignoring their many shortcomings. As Gunter (2006) asserts: "What is needed is a rethinking of what we mean by leadership, and hence who or what leaders are and what leading is about" (p. 262).

The problem is that we have put leadership on a pedestal despite the fact that there is no reliable formula to it—other than brute force—and there never has been. When in doubt, force someone to do what you want and then claim it was for the good of the cause. Aggression and power have been clothed in the mantle of leadership and sold to an unsuspecting humanity for generations. Leaders have come in all shapes, sizes, characters, and qualities and in all eras throughout history (Bennis & Nanus, 1985). Humanity has always had a propensity to inflate their accomplishments in order to increase leaders' significance in history, when in fact most were simply opportunistic or accidental individuals with both positive and negative qualities whose achievements or successes have subsequently been romanticized by adoring and often self-deluded male and female followers. This is particularly true of religion. Historians (primarily male) recorded the exploits of these leaders to document

and romanticize their achievements. The leadership lie was repeated and embellished throughout history resulting in the massive delusions and distortions of formalized religion and other forms of global belief in leadership success.

These became the social role models taught in schools and used by the military, governments, religious and business leaders, and academics as examples to aspire toward. Their reality—if revealed—is that of a pedestrian, normal, flawed human existence that was no different than any other. The only difference was the time and situations they found themselves in that magnified their actions and choices to others and their willingness to employ violence or other means to achieve their goals. Messianic leaders created revolution by passive resistance. Either way, destabilizing violence occurred. Such leaders happened by accident of birth or circumstance to find themselves in unique situations that they were required to cope with in the best manner they could. Sometimes they guessed right, but many times, like Hitler, they got it horrifically wrong. Their responses were neither particularly heroic nor special but more the acts of desperate and often mentally unstable individuals in impossible events or of charismatic individuals who held their societies under their spell. Their larger-than-life personas were more the result of the desire of others to inflate their sociocultural value and embellish their stories to mythic proportions than due to any relationship with reality. In almost all cases ceding power to one individual or individuals created huge problems for humankind. From Jesus to General Patton, leaders have been idolized and mythologized since the dawn of time, and their adherents have suffered and died in droves for them with little observable real benefit to humanity. Can it be considered coincidental that they were without exception invariably male?

This hero worship—whether secular or religious—created a historiography of these individuals that exaggerated their positive achievements while downplaying or completely ignoring their negative attributes or debacles. In our eagerness as individuals and as a culture to believe that humans are better than they actually are, we are willing to suspend our disbelief about the negative actions of other humans to bask in the reflected glory of the Nobel Prize winner or the Super Bowl champs. The world always pays a price for such trust. We need to debunk these myths and live in the cold, hard, difficult, and complex reality of life to make it successful for all. We give far too much credit to leaders and far too little to followers and employees who often are more responsible for their greatness or failures. We spend far too much time focusing on the leaders in the spotlight; we need to appreciate the darkness that surrounds such light.

What is problematic about this dangerous cultural propensity for the positive is that the desire in all cases to idolize, romanticize, and mythologize leaders and life distorts our sense of collective reality and leaves us open and subject to the negative potential of leadership—manipulation, exploitation, and mass propaganda—that has become particularly dangerous in our modern technological times (Blase & Blase, 2002; Manz, 1999; J. Ryan, 2000). Mythologizing individual leaders leads to core values of unthinking commitment disconnected from reality and unhealthy, oppositional, and distorted behavior. While we purportedly live in a democracy, our social institutions are riddled with antidemocratic organizations that supposedly protect it and we support a nondemocratic private economic system that is run on an authoritarian basis.

The singular, heroic leadership paradigm creates dysfunctional dynamics between individuals, in groups, organizations, societies, and countries and inflicts massive collateral damage through its practice (J. Ryan, 2006). At the least it promotes unhealthy dependency behavior in followers (Clements & Washbush, 1999; Moloi & Bush, 2006). The paradigm only works if the intentions of the leader are honorable and positive and those subject to the leader willingly accept the relationship. Unfortunately, we have no way of knowing whether or not this will be the case. This is still no guarantee of a positive outcome—quite the contrary (Allix, 2000). In more situations than not the leader is revealed to be dishonorable and negative, leading to horrendous consequences for humanity and followers who are unwilling or unwitting accomplices driven by self-interested motivations or fear. The Wall Street billionaire investment trader and his associates who defrauded people without concern during the 2008 financial crash and the CEOs of Enron, Worldcom, and Tyco are contemporary examples of this.

The patriarchal leadership paradigm does not even function when it is positive because the superior/subordinate relationship that it creates is fundamentally inequitable and unhealthy even if it is stable. It also serves to alienate the majority in every situation as individuals are singled out for merit or recognition—which they often do not deserve or earn—while dozens or even thousands of others are rejected and frustrated by this biased vetting process rooted in cronyism (Petras & Veltmeyer, 2001). This hierarchical valuing of one individual over another is the foundation of dissent in patriarchal society that is entrenched in pyramid leadership theory. By celebrating one individual we create resentment toward that person in a host of others who are not chosen and in the organizational culture of the group. The dozens of people who are passed over for promotion are left feeling cynical, alienated, and angry

while one person feels affirmed and valued. Neither the candidate nor the rejected applicants have any idea how the person was selected despite formal selection criteria. Most often the sense of favoritism, cronyism, and bias is still strong and warranted (McQuaig, 2001). How can this be a constructive process for creating positive social results in an organization or society?

We are enamoured with the mythology of larger-than-life figures that conquer complex problems easily and gain success and wealth, while in reality this hardly ever happens honestly, and if it does it is completely accidental. The reality is that this is social fiction. Leadership is messy, human, difficult, conflicted, and disruptive, and progress is often slow, nonlinear, and unpredictable (Blackmore, 2006; Fitzgerald, 2009). Leaders would be much better advised to openly acknowledge the ideas, concerns, and issues of their peers and employees in organizations at whatever level and work with everyone in the system to solve them rather than attempting to impose solutions on individuals or groups. Most leaders resort to formal power and authority to drive decision making because they become frustrated with democratic and consultative processes demanded by society. Imposing change is what creates push-back and resistance leading to bureaucratic gridlock. These leaders are in reality a small minority and the circumstances through which they have achieved their success are most often arbitrary and suspect. These individuals are no more capable, heroic, intelligent, or wise than the next person in line, but political circumstances and stylized, often corrupt formalized decision making combine with the propensity of the human race to lionize leaders and create a history filled with singular, heroic figures who are overwhelmingly male and whose legacies are invented, not earned. The mythology of the one great leader and visionary, charismatic saviors, and heroes is exactly that—mythology (Collinson, 2005; Gilbert & Matviuk, 2008). It is a figment of the imagination of a society desperate for meaning and validation that has been debunked but continues to flourish unchallenged (Macneill, Cavanaugh, & Silcox, 2005). The act of mythologizing is one of humankind attempting to rationalize the irrationality of the universe.

Leadership as we know, practice, and conceptualize it is the deification, reification, and personification of patriarchy and power in organizations and society as are the organizations leaders populate (Greenfield, 1986; Hodgkinson, 1991; B. D. Maxcy & Nguyễn, 2001). Throughout the ages leaders have been eulogized, mythologized, and romanticized while their reality has been megalomaniacal, amoral, and violent. Leadership and its theories continue to dominate our social, political, economic, religious, and educational landscapes to such an intense degree that it is perhaps the most important concept to be

deconstructed if society and education is to evolve (Elmore, 2000). As Hoy and Miskel (1996) express of the persistent archetype:

Leadership continues to be an elusive but fascinating topic to students of administration. During the past several decades the sheer volume of writing devoted to leadership attests to its prominence in our collective efforts to understand and improve organizations. Romanticized heroic images of leaders—what they do, what they are able to accomplish, and the general effects they have on individuals and organizations—have developed among both scholars and lay people (Meindl, Ehrich, and Dukerich, 1985). When we think of specific leaders names such as Gandhi, Churchill, King, Mao Zedong, Napoleon, Roosevelt, and Thatcher come to mind. The term itself projects images of powerful, dynamic individuals who command victorious armies, build wealthy and influential empires, or alter the course of nations (Yukl, 1994). Stated succinctly, people commonly believe that leaders make a difference and want to understand why. (p. 373)

The ultimate critical question in Hoy and Miskel's observations is: What is the price of that success? They unfortunately overlook the fact that the same leadership qualities associated with the positive leaders (which is debatable) can also be applied to vicious leaders and despots throughout history (Allix, 2000; A. Johnson, 2005). Even the leaders they cite have questionable legacies of success and human rights abuses—particularly Chairman Mao. Leadership theory is not helpful in sorting the wheat from the chaff. They do correctly identify the problem but they do not provide a remedy. Their only answer is to study why such leaders are successful without challenging the reality or morality of their success.

While it is widely assumed that there is agreement about what leadership is and how it should be practiced, in reality leadership remains one of the most contested and misapprehended concepts upon which there remains little substantive consensus or definition (Bennis & Nanus, 1985; Leithwood & Riehl, 2003; Leo & Barton, 2006; Stewart, 2006). Despite this, the practice, theory, and models of leadership that dominate our world are of the consistently narrow and simplistic traditional variety described by Hoy and Miskel (1996), characterizing leaders as singular, male, heroic, messianic, and visionary individuals who single-handedly conquer insurmountable odds—including female leaders such as Margaret Thatcher (Gronn, 2003; A. Johnson, 2005).

In our unstable, unreliable postmodern world we have become even more obsessed with the surety that leadership mythology and leaders promise to deliver as we seek stability and reassurance in an increasingly chaotic, diversifying, and unstable dystopic future. As Willower (1997) asserts:

The problems faced are many, varied, complex and difficult. Furthermore, what some disconnected academics call the “real world” can be a malevolent place. History is replete with examples. One can start with the seven deadly sins and move on to evil-doing of the worst sort, sometimes committed on a large scale. So we continue to see what John Dewey called the quest for certainty, along with a host of simplistic smoke-and-mirrors solutions offered by assorted authority figures and aspirants to that status. (p. 446)

The belief that a single powerful, visionary hero-leader will save the day is compelling and reassuring although misinformed. In our modern, complex, and conflicted postmodern world, these models are destined to fail and could fail catastrophically. There is intense pressure from all quarters of society including leaders themselves, academics, politicians, and others to comply with and defer to fictionalized traditional concepts and practices of leadership and power (Sergiovanni, 1992)—to conform to their status quo and to resist questioning and challenging their dominance. Leadership models as they are traditionally practiced create a dependency culture among followers that is disempowering and counterproductive (Moloi & Bush, 2006).

The conceptual paradigm of leadership is rooted in patriarchy and as such has operated in this remarkably consistent manner for millennia. It has shaped our military, social, religious, political, economic, and educational thinking and framed our gender relationships. Most human interactions can be construed as leader/follower interactions in some way. We continue to be immersed in various forms of what Manz (1999) calls “strongman” and “visionary hero” leadership (pp. 154–155). The warrior/gladiator, military general, king or queen, powerful CEO, world government leader, successful coach, gifted athlete, or charismatic revolutionary or resistance fighter are the models we all relate to, but they are all created from the same basic and unchanging, romanticized, dysfunctional, and indefensible historical paradigm of the macho male hero leader or messianic visionary that is the biggest threat to human survival (Eldstrom, 1992; Lerner, 1997). This model implies that those who lead are thus imbued with strength, vision, and heroic male qualities that others lack, whether they possess them or not (Pellegrini & Scandura, 2008). It also invests the total responsibility for leadership in one person and attributes all results to this leader, providing little recognition or reward for organizational followers and making all others dependent on this leader’s actions or inaction (Russell, 2003).

Thus, much of leadership is random circumstance, not conscious action. Leaders are simply opportunists who seize upon situations to take control. The

desired effect of most traditional leadership is to make followers passive, compliant, and subordinate, not creative, autonomous, and assertive, so leadership as we have come to frame it is fundamentally antithetical to democracy and human freedom despite the fact that leaders throughout history have promised to deliver this to followers. Even distributive leadership has no real intention to distribute formal power equitably despite its assertions to the contrary. Leadership is intended to make leaders look good and to enhance this effect, followers must be made to look incompetent and tertiary despite the fact that there is no basis to this logic in reality. There are many false prophets but few real saviors.

The Leadership Industry

Leadership has become big business, and business is the biggest promoter of traditional leadership in addition to the military. Private sector interests are most often authoritarian in their operation. The interest in it has become obsessive and is growing exponentially each year. Ironically, the more dialogue there is about leadership, the less we seem to understand the concept, and the less real leadership there appears to be and the less real democratic leadership seems to be in evidence or valued; leadership for change, equity, social justice, and democracy are only catchphrases on leaders' lips. As Peter Gronn (2003) notes, "There is now a vast leadership industry out there of truly staggering proportions (in which governments, corporations, academics, schools and school systems have a huge material vested interest), such that the discourse of 'leadership' has become ubiquitous" (p. 269). The constructive qualities appear to be in short supply, while control-based mythologized leadership approaches abound and are becoming pervasive in our culture, media, electronic games, social structuring, sports, and geo-political realities. There is a massive dislocate between theory and practice. There is no shortage of more open-ended, democratic models but a significant shortfall in their application. The leadership we see is leadership supporting authoritarian compliance, the status quo, inequality, and heavily restricted capitalist democracy. It is leadership for control and management of people, resources, money, and things not leadership for autonomy, equity, and equality in anything more than a token manner. The latter cannot exist with the former. Thus leadership, business, the military, and sports are all integrated vehicles for patriarchy.

Leadership consulting, theorizing, and in-servicing has become a massive growth industry that has taken on a life of its own apart from the reality of organizations and society (S. Maxcy, 1991). Universities are the most prolific leadership factories, constantly cranking out new versions of the age-old concept for the eager consumption of organizations everywhere desperately seeking the “next big thing” in leadership that they can sell to the waiting public and employees that will make them gurus of modern management theory and bring them wealth and prestige. The leadership industry is much like the diet and the fitness industry, marketing an idealized myth of human well-being that is desperately desired by millions but realistically achieved by few. It matters little any more whether a particular leadership model or theory works or has been tested; it only matters that it is marketable and profitable. There are as many conceptions and misapprehensions about leadership as there are people on the planet. By the time the current panacea has faded, the money has already been made and the leadership entrepreneurs and academics are moving on to the next marketing idea. Leadership has become a means to an end rather than an end unto itself—management by objectives (Hoy & Miskel, 1996), management by walking around (Heller & Firestone, 1995), total quality management (Hoy & Miskel, 1996), strategic planning (Cook, 1990), learning organizations (Senge, 1990), value-added leadership (Sergiovanni, 1990), servant leadership (Crippen, 2005; Sergiovanni, 1992), professional learning communities (Dufour & Eaker, 1999), co-leaders (Heenan & Bennis, 1999), etc.

The incarnations of management and leadership theory are endless, confusing, and unrelenting but curiously unchanged at their core. The store shelves are jammed with books extolling how to become a great leader with creative advice for aspiring leaders, but few of these books talk about the negative influence of power and its use and abuse by leaders. We are inundated by leadership advice to the point that the over-choice becomes meaningless and de-motivating. We have lost the understanding that real, positive leadership is evidenced in the measure of its positive impacts on humanity and collective freedom. We are drowning in a sea of leadership without a drop of leadership to drink.

Leadership is the most salient example of the commercial colonization of modern culture by neopatriarchy and its obsession with leadership and leaders in politics, economics, sports, religion, and almost every walk of life (O’Sullivan, 2001). Leadership identification and development has become a major growth industry in itself with a plethora of academic and self-trained

gurus hawking the next flavor-of-the-month of leadership that is eagerly lapped up by the adoring consuming public eager to find the Holy Grail of perfect control. Leadership seminars abound. The word *leadership* is one of the most worn-out, overused, least understood, and most invoked terms in modern life (Bennis & Nanus, 1985; J. Ryan, 2006). It is bandied about with such regularity and ease that its application and understanding have become meaningless yet widely assumed. Leadership has become nothing more than a tradable commodity in the capitalist marketplace. Invariably each new leadership model is embraced, put in place, and abandoned in a never-ending cycle of leadership consumption. It has become a consumer product, packaged and sold repeatedly to its eager buyers in all walks of life. Many academic, political, and other writers have spent their entire careers on this leadership life-cycle of producing traditional patriarchal leaders. Even a cursory examination of any of these “new” leadership theories reveals the core paradigm of singular, heroic leadership is unchanged.

The real problem has become that all of these leadership models don’t work—people realize that in their own organizations leadership is not mythological, romanticized, visionary, or larger than life. Their experience with leaders and organizations is frustratingly mundane, artificial, human, conflicted, and problematic and oriented more in positional power than consensual activity. Most organizations exist in a malaise of begrudging acceptance of the status quo. The leaders who lead them are most often unremarkable people who have played the leadership game and risen through the ranks to their positions and who more often play at being a great leader rather than actually knowing how to be one. They have been formally designated leaders but lack leadership credibility with their followers. That is why authority always comes with leadership. When stripped to its core it is in most cases top-down, authoritarian, and bureaucratic (Fitzgerald, 2009). It is do-what-you-are-told, my-way-or-the-highway, and like-it-or-lump-it leadership layered with a thin veneer of cooperative, collaborative, consensual rhetoric. It is false and disingenuous, and this is the main reason leaders fail and the change processes that leaders champion also fail; even people with a limited understanding of leadership can appreciate that leadership is glorified manipulation and they resent it, even though they tolerate it. The repeated failure of large-scale school reform due to the lack of involvement and trust of teachers is a salient example (Dufour & Eaker, 1999; Giles & Proudfoot, 1994). People look at the leadership theory they are sold and the leadership they get and see a huge gap between the theory and practice. As Ryan (2006) points out about educational leadership:

For all the current talk of instructional leadership, transformational leadership, or even distributed leadership or of closing achievement gaps between the advantaged and the rest, the theory and practice of educational leadership have little to say about the pernicious and pervasive processes of exclusion. (p. 2)

Leadership rarely lives up to the hype. Many people from all quarters of society have their entire lives, value systems, careers, and beliefs wrapped up in traditional concepts of leadership—indeed, our entire social structure is imbued with its values. Academic careers have been staked on traditional leadership. Everyone has become an expert in dissecting, refining, and re-working the old, tired, broken model of traditional patriarchal leadership—not on creating anything new. As Michael Fullan (2001) observes of the most popular conception of leadership—charismatic—the search is most often futile:

Charismatic leaders inadvertently often do more harm than good because, at best, they provide episodic improvement followed by frustrated or despondent dependency. Superhuman leaders also do us another disservice: they are role models who can never be emulated by large numbers. Deep and sustained reform depends on many of us, not just on the very few who are destined to be extraordinary. (pp. 1–2)

Fullan expresses the need for a democratic and distributed form of leadership but is silent on the structural and formal power changes that must accompany this style to make it work. The current incarnations of distributed leadership seek to distribute the values of traditional leadership more widely through the current organization with few changes in organizational power relations, hierarchy, or procedures, which is quite different (Blackmore, 2006; Grant, 2006; Mayrowetz, 2008; L. Wright, 2008). To change leadership one needs to change bureaucracy and power relations as well.

In fact, as this book would argue, these models are not only failures in their own right but roadblocks to real leadership change and social reform. We continuously talk about leadership in terms of social change impact when what we really need to talk about is changing the leadership paradigm itself. Over the millennia, leadership has delivered little true social reform and much social repression. It will also argue that unless we embark on both theoretical and structural reform of organizations and governments, leadership change will not succeed. In short, the singular, heroic model of leadership is unworkable, unsuccessful, unstable, and unsustainable as is our entire current society (Lerner, 1997). So why are we so addicted to it despite a large body of literature arguing for more liberated leadership concepts? Part of the answer is

the global culture of patriarchal power that force-feeds traditional leadership to everyone on a daily basis. We are not allowed to think of different leadership models, let alone enact them.

Business, academics, and politicians continue to recycle these tired, outdated leadership models for a reason. The traditional leadership model is based on a historical paradigm of singular, heroic, male authoritarianism that maintains control of society and governments and rewards their success in this endeavor for the selective benefit of leaders who model this approach. That is why traditional leadership is the currency of neoconservatism and neoliberalism. Truly democratic models of leadership whether in the military, government, business, or organizations are antithetical to the goals of traditional leadership and traditional social organization and economics (Hatcher, 2005). Any system that encourages shared participation in decision making, social justice, the sharing of wealth and social benefits, and true empowerment of people by sharing political, economic, and social power as democratic models do is dangerous to the status quo of elite neopatriarchy. Portelli and Solomon (2001) quote Scheffler (1973, p. 137) on democracy and dictatorship:

The democratic ideal is that of an open and dynamic society...antithetical to the notion of a fixed class of rulers, with privileges resting upon social myths which it is forbidden to question. It envisions rather a society that sustains itself not by the indoctrination of myth, but by reasoned choices of its citizens, who continue to favour it in the light of a critical scrutiny both of it and its alternatives. (p. 16)

Ironically it is the neoliberal and neoconservative groups that will cry "antidemocratic" whenever emancipatory leaders (J. Ryan, 2006) attempt to change the system or the organization in more democratic directions when it is exactly the status quo that is firmly antidemocratic. Other than the window dressing of formal elections, a "free" press, and "free" speech—all of which are controlled by vested corporate entities and provide only token input—businesses, governments, and organizations both public and private are ruled by arms-length un-elected big-business interests and narrow-minded individuals and their values that dictate the rules of the game for all of society. Our democratic lives are tightly scripted. Ironically, "free" enterprise is the most restrictive economic regime ever conceived.

Neopatriarchal leadership reveals itself in a myriad of ways in our modern world. It is present every day in our interpersonal relations, our organizational cultures, our political and educational institutions, and our religious beliefs (Walby, 2007). It is everywhere but is nowhere. It is taken for granted

and unchallenged. It is accepted by most as “natural” and part of the genetics of humanity (Gunter, 2006; Hay, 2004; Schafer, 2008). Today, patriarchal military leadership values and philosophy are employed by business, government, educational leaders, and sports coaches alike. They underpin all the social and economic challenges we face and are directly responsible for many of them. No one questions the massive bureaucracies that pervade our organizational life and heavily influence our organizational cultures; few raise any alarms about how business actually makes their profits, how their profit margin is determined, and how much profit they make. Fewer yet question the imperialist military decisions of their countries or actively oppose them. People would prefer not to know about the abuses of capitalism and to not question or challenge the motives of leaders they experience in their lives until it is too late. Apathy is part of the indentured social culture created by capitalism and patriarchy. It is this exact condition that led to the Holocaust (A. Johnson, 2005).

Today, we are besieged by competing, seemingly benevolent leadership theories that urge us to be servant (Sergiovanni, 1992), transformational (Stewart, 2006), collective (Leithwood & Wahlstrom, 2008), and distributive (Elmore, 2000) leaders, to name only a few. These theories are well-meaning but superficial adornments that attempt to make traditional leadership fresh and new to another generation of naive aspirants while still adhering to the heraldic leadership profile (A. Johnson, 2005). The real, long-term sustainable answer is to deconstruct leadership and power as singular concepts and practices and allow collective leadership—something I term *peoplesh* (Bahlleda, 2008) premised on equalized formal power and authority that emphasizes truly distributed leadership in the manner of “people centered development” that is part of the principles of Third World development articulated by the Dag Hammarskjöld Foundation in Sweden (O’Sullivan, 2001) and of deliberative democracy described by Young (2000) (LiPumaa & Koelbleb, 2009).

Contemporary theories such as those above present themselves as an evolution away from patriarchal leadership models; however, they are simply variations on the same singular leadership paradigm that has been prevalent for centuries. They remain mired in a linguistic and conceptual quagmire that cannot create change. They are a carefully crafted façade to disguise the underlying reality of traditional leadership. While they portray modern leaders as charismatic and transformational individuals and servants to their employees with the best interests of followers and society at heart, they do not speak to unchanging relationships of formal power, organizational structure, and procedures. They are superficial window-dressing to ensure the endorsement

of the leader's visions and directions. Each day, in organizations and governments around the world, we go through an elaborate charade of fawning over leaders and their dubious abilities in an age-old ritualized deference to the dominant male (or female). We also do nothing to address massive inequities in formal authority, structure, power, rewards, and control that continue to be the foundation of these approaches that bedevil society.

In addition, leaders who present themselves in this manner are often self-deceiving bigots who primarily act and lead in traditional ways while mouthing collaborative platitudes that are evident to everyone in the organization except to themselves. They talk the talk but do not walk the walk. Their false humility is disingenuous and actually works as a roadblock to real organizational cooperation and progress in achieving goals and creates resentment among followers. While portraying leaders in modern organizations as humanist servants, the reality is that these leadership concepts are simply skillfully disguised and subtle methods of leadership control much like the more obvious forms of paternalistic leadership practiced in Chinese organization and businesses (Cheng, Chou, Wu, Huang, & Farh, 2004). They are the most repugnant to those who work for these leaders because of their ethical and professional duplicity. Even those who cannot articulate their understanding of the leadership culture of their organizations understand this on an implicit level. In any organization, everyone knows who "the boss" is—and that is exactly the problem. Leadership is about "tell and sell" self-promotion. "Best is defined as what gets subordinates to do what the leader wants and be happy about it. If enough subordinates respond appropriately, then the organization presumably will be more effective" (Sergiovanni, 1992, p. 2).

These new leadership concepts hold out the false promise of being more consensual and democratic, but in fact they are subversively manipulative and ultimately even more dangerous and offensive than explicitly controlling leadership approaches; all these theoretical styles are thin overlays that cover the same, singular traditional model of patriarchal leadership that has held sway for centuries (Leo & Barton, 2006). It is a model that believes that imposed hierarchical power is the only route to leadership success. These are wolves in sheep's clothing. Leaders actively create and generate a mythology surrounding them that is the public fiction of their reality as leaders. Anyone who works in a modern organization knows that the real face of leadership lies just beneath the surface of these false veneers. What happens under this kind of leadership is that all relationships are essentially false and artificial rather than being real, authentic and open. Real interpersonal communication is

blanketed by a surface of polite professional dialogue. Real organizational or leadership issues seldom or rarely get addressed.

We have developed civilized and respectful protocols for dialogue in organizations and society that mask real communication on real issues. Honesty and ethics are the least valued qualities in modern organizations despite protestations to the contrary because real honesty would entail difficult questions of the competency of leaders and challenges to their decision making and authority. This virtually never happens. Everyone plays the “political game” of navigating the organizational bureaucracy and becomes part of this manipulative ecology. People are invited to collaborate and work together as long as they follow the unspoken template of directions and come to the conclusions already reached by the senior management team—or else. This is aptly parodied by the sadistic boss of the chain gang in the movie *Cool Hand Luke* who ironically intones in his Southern drawl, “What we’ve got here is failure to communicate,” implying the prisoners are not listening to what they are being told. Luke is told to “get his mind right.” This is not far from the truth regarding what happens in most modern organizations on a subliminal level (Hatcher, 2005). Complete and utter compliance to the marching orders of the senior leaders’ vision is ultimately although subtly demanded and reinforced with positional authority. The evidence of this lies in the spectacular failure of strategic planning initiatives that promised organizations more say in decision making and goal setting.

This has become particularly true during the last 25 years of neoliberalism and neoconservatism that has reinforced a new culture of managerialism in organizations and education (Fitzgerald, 2009). The real test of traditional leadership would be to remove all these formal protections and see if followers still followed. As Braynion (2004) states:

Handy (1993) observes that many leaders have believed that their success has been achieved by their own personal characteristics such as charisma. However on removal of their position they are exposed to the realisation that perceptions are changeable. “Charisma is brittle” and the leader with no other power base is a nice person to whom you may send a Christmas Card but wouldn’t bother to invite to meetings. (p. 450)

It is not true collaboration or consensus that is being sought or practiced but a forced, duplicitous version of these concepts controlled and manipulated by leaders. As Christopher Hodgkinson (1991) further asserts:

Likewise, if a leader is defined by the attitudes of being a gentleman and a man of honor, and if our leaders in fact are liars, rogues and Philistines, then we should cease to call them leaders and instead call them what they are, say, manipulators. Or we should require them to cease being manipulators. Or we should embrace the linguistic shift so that henceforth leader means manipulator. (p. 111)

Equality cannot exist in an organization where there is a hierarchy of authority that can override decisions on a whim or impose orders on subordinates while claiming to provide professional autonomy to its members particularly in fields such as education. While this may be the status quo in most organizations, it certainly is not democratic. Without equal and balanced formal power, democracy is a sham, in organizations or society on whatever level it is invoked. This is what the failure of strategic planning clearly revealed. Traditional leaders consciously use bureaucracies and their web of policies, procedures, and hierarchical authority as a cloak to imprison democracy. It is only the leaders who proselytize these deceptive leadership styles and organizational structures that are actually deceived into believing they are any different from their traditional predecessors. They do nothing to change the organizational power structure that lies behind them or their use of leadership power—the vertical bureaucratic pyramid of authority that is the real face of patriarchal leaders and leadership—and more importantly they do little, if anything, to change the circumstances of those working within their organizations for the better. While followers are crying out for recognition and affirmation, what they get is repression and recrimination.

In our modern world, we idolize, mythologize, and romanticize leaders and air-brush their faults out of our consciousness. We move on to the next myth or star rather than engaging the problems with this view of leaders. We look for leadership in all the wrong places rather than identifying it in normal, everyday people who are the real co-leaders (Leo & Barton, 2006) with others in their organizations (Darling-Hammond, 2007). We celebrate and mythologize those whose contributions to society are often superficial and have little social value while nurses, educators, social workers, and activists who create real social value-added contributions are taken for granted, undervalued, and underpaid (Burman, 2005). Our entire value structure in society has been inverted to reward those who do the least, contribute the least, and change the least but bring in the biggest profit and ignore those who contribute the most and deserve the most and desire the most change in the structure of our leadership relations and organizational cultures.

Our value reward structure in society is a materialist and monetarist one rather than a social one. Leadership has skewed our social value structure in negative ways away from reality and toward an unrealistic fantasy. It has dislocated social reality from economic practices to ensure the exploitation of the latter is not revealed. We suspend our belief that people are simply human and are not something superhuman as much as we want to believe that they are. We want desperately to believe that the make-believe world of our imaginations is real because the reality of our existence is mundane, irrational, arbitrary, and dysfunctional. As a result, we live in an elaborate, self-created, essentializing fantasy world of mythic heroes and evil anti-heroes where good always triumphs and entrepreneurs get rich honestly and through hard work. We have decoupled our social existence from reality on a massive scale. We need to stop placing people on pedestals in all areas of organizations and life and begin to relate as realistic equals rather than superiors and subordinates.

While some may argue that this is a random development of a complex and diverse society, this view masks a deeper and more disturbing truth: that these values, beliefs, attitudes, and escapism that we revel in are intentionally constructed and exploited, although not always an efficiently coordinated system of control and domination that works to serve the interests of a powerful, small (and growing smaller) group of wealthy, elite individuals in our global communities. The leadership industry works to ensure that leaders benefit at the expense of everyone else. The massive gap between CEO and employee salaries is a current example. Patriarchy, leadership, religion, education, politics, and history are all dominance models, not democratic ones. Our entire social structure is tilted to favor a small group of powerful and wealthy individuals/leaders who have priority access to the reins of power and government. Wealth is continuously being concentrated at the top of the social pyramid and bequeathed to subsequent generations, and with it comes power. We see the negative and destructive influence of traditional leadership in the structure of gender relations, education, economics, politics, governments, and religion, where throughout the world men continue to control the corridors of power and the dynamics of the lives of millions worldwide as well as social policy and practice while we cling to the belief it is all by accident and not by design.

Patriarchy, Gender and Leadership

Patriarchy has found its most pervasively negative expression in the relationships between men and women. Throughout history, it has actively dominated, suppressed, subordinated, abused, murdered, and arbitrarily disenfranchised more than half the world's population. As Lerner (1986) asserts: "As long as both men and women regard the subordination of half the human race to the other as 'natural,' it is impossible to envision a society in which differences do not connote either dominance or subordination." (p. 229). This is qualitatively different from any other form of dominance and our terminology should make that clear (Lerner, 1986). This is the unconscionable reality of human history. Over the last 50 years Western and other women have made what appear to be significant strides in education and other areas of society to break through the "glass ceiling" and take on positions of responsibility traditionally relegated to men (Al-Jenaibi, 2010). In retrospect, the gains of the feminist movement may have been a Pyrrhic victory much like gaining the vote by the Suffragettes at the turn of the 20th century or the freeing of slaves in the United States after the abolition of slavery in the 19th century. Women found that gaining the vote resulted in little real change in their social treatment and was only the start of a struggle for real equality that continues to this day. While gains have been made, there is a long way to go (Armstrong & Armstrong, 1984; Biklin, Marshall, & Pollard, 2008; Gilbert & Matviuk, 2008; Miles, 1993). Neither change has led to a significant alteration in how society stereotypically views women or how leaders handle power and authority. In our media-savvy world, we create the illusion of women's empowerment and liberation while continuing to oppress them around the globe (A. Johnson, 2005).

To get at the core of social change we must go much deeper. In fact, in the last 20 years under the worldwide resurgence of neoliberalism and neo-conservatism we have witnessed what Young (2000) terms a "reprivatisation discourse" on gender equity that seeks to roll back the clock for women: "With the political ascendancy of neoliberalism, the political discourse on social welfarism and gender equity is being replaced with a 'reprivatisation discourse' which seeks to repatriate the social to the former domestic and private enclaves." (p. 83). Erica Burman (2005) points to the paradoxical neoliberal encouragement of the self-exploitation of workers (primarily women) through a feminization discourse of flexible work hours and family-friendly work-from-home practices that appear so positive and progressive and that are

now encouraged by many corporations. Under the guise of supporting women such policies are re-victimizing them by making contract workers invisible and politically powerless in society and returning to the days of home-based cottage industries and piece work of the 18th and 19th centuries. We also see this in the resurgence of neoconservatism and the growth of extreme right-wing ideologies in the Muslim world.

This resistance to change indicates how deep and intransigent the culture of patriarchy is (Lerner, 1986). Even with the support of a growing number of men who recognize the patent inequality of the current situation, progress is slow to glacial in reforming general crystalline male patriarchal attitudes, awareness, and practices (Brookfield, 2005; A. Johnson, 2005; Walby, 1990). The pace of gender equity change reflects the deferential approach taken by society, governments, and the media toward changing the male status quo. In fact in recent years we are seeing the resurgence of hardline Islamist extremists (males) who want to devolve society to archaic, patriarchal Islamic rule under Sharia law and the rebirth of extreme right-wing conservative political views in the West. While there have been many surface acknowledgments of the equality of women, the subtext of male social culture is still powerful, traditional, and conservative in its views toward them.

Over the past several decades, the cause of women's equity has been regressing. Gender equality has been a Trojan horse containing the values of patriarchy in its belly. Western women who have sought to achieve equal status with men have been drawn into the attraction of patriarchal power and sought it for its own reasons without making a concerted effort to change the fundamental paradigm that underscores all leadership theory and practice. As S. Acker (1999) observes, the drive for professionalism in education and other fields may have led women teachers to misrecognize exploitation. Women sought to grab the brass ring and possess power like Bilbo Baggins in *The Lord of the Rings*. As in Tolkien's trilogy, wearing the ring of power corrupts the wearer in ways that he or she is not aware of and is so dangerous that it must be destroyed. So too is the mantle of leadership as it is currently conceived under patriarchy. Women have been corrupted by it in the same way that men have. Power as a social concept is the ring that needs to be destroyed in the crucible of social change. As Gerda Lerner (1986) powerfully points out:

The social cost of having excluded women from the human enterprise of constructing abstract thought has never been reckoned. We can begin to understand the cost of it to thinking women when we accurately name what was done to us and describe, no matter how painful it may be, the ways in

which we have participated in the enterprise. We have long known that rape has been a way of terrorizing us and keeping us in subjection. Now we also know that we have participated, although unwittingly, in the rape of our minds. (p. 225)

While women in Western societies have accomplished their primary objective of obtaining positions of responsibility in society and raising awareness of gender issues, their presence continues to be token in these roles in relation to the total number of women and men in the world. While there have been improvements, they continue to be superficial and insubstantial. The aim of changing male culture and its underlying values toward women has failed to materialize. Rather than attempting to create equity for women by changing the leadership/power paradigm to reflect less power and control and a truer consensus through democratic collaboration, women have instead opted for mimicking men in their approach to leadership and power leading to a re-entrenchment of patriarchy now reinforced by both genders (Blackmore, 2006; A. Johnson, 2005). Women have moved into the workforce in increasing numbers and made breakthroughs in employment and leadership advancement. In their understandable desire to accomplish this goal they were required to confront, but also to play by, the rules of what was (and still is) a male-dominated social culture and employment environment that imposed certain patriarchal expectations on women who wished to take part in society, politics, work, and leadership (Gilbert & Matviuk, 2008). Women were forced to compete with men in all these areas within formal and informal rules that were established and enforced by men (the old boys' club) (Merle, 2004). As a result women had to take on male leadership qualities and employment expectations to become administrators, bankers, lawyers, doctors, firefighters, police officers, construction workers, and elected officials or leaders of private and public sector companies or organizations. They were forced to compete with men on equal men's terms, not equal terms (Bolton & Muzio, 2008). The playing field was tilted then and it still is now.

Unfortunately for the majority of women around the world the goal of equity is still a distant reality, but now there are not only men but also women standing in the way. Superficial equity has only been achieved in a limited way by a few elite women, most often white and middle class (Brookfield, 2005; Freire, 2001; St. Pierre, 1999). As Paulo Freire (2001) cynically suggests regarding the goal of neoliberalism: "After all, even the most conservative cultures require self-justification by picking out a few subalterns to promote as emblems of the system's flexibility" (p. 14). The small percentages of women

who have been able to achieve this goal have taken on this role in our modern neopatriarchal society (Lerner, 1997; J. Ryan, 2006). They have been heavily socialized into the Eurocentric male paradigm of leadership that has dominated the globe for centuries. To achieve their gains, women were forced to accept and play by rules as they were established and defined by men, and as a result they have taken on the leadership role with few variations in the ways that men have for centuries (Blackmore, 2002; Franzway, 2005; Nebenzahl, 2010). They still hold an unwavering belief in decisive, proactive, heroic, charismatic, and messianic leadership, which they attempt to emulate and have merely attempted to humanize and feminize its application with women's personal qualities rather than reform its core values. They are still trying to prove to men that they are worthy instead of creating an entire new meaning for the word.

While female leaders are suggested to bring different values of collaboration, nurturing, and caring to their theoretical approaches to leadership (Coleman, 2003), these qualities are merely applied as a surface veneer of their leadership, which still complies with manipulative male norms and practices (Coleman, 2005). The culture, style, and values of gendered, patriarchal leadership continue to dominate, socialize, and influence society throughout our modern world more than ever before (McGee Banks, 2000). Both male and female leaders aspire to and practice the same fundamental, traditional approaches to leadership that are unchanged after thousands of years (Eagly & Johnson, 1990; Lerner, 1986). Major figures throughout history have been almost exclusively male, and women who have become great leaders have been overwhelmingly upper-class and have also done so in the same patriarchal mold that remains intact despite superficially permitted alterations (Lerner, 1986). Whether the religious zeal of St. Joan of Arc, the beguiling Cleopatra, the dour Queen Victoria, the "Iron Lady" of Margaret Thatcher, or the successful former CEO of HP Carly Fiorina, the leadership of women still conforms to the singular, elitist, charismatic male model acted out within expected female norms of sexuality and maternalism (A. Johnson, 2005; Lerner, 1993).

Women have been heavily socialized by a patriarchal paradigm of stereotypical gender relationships, family values, and leadership models that has left them conflicted and ambivalent about their public/professional and domestic/private personas (Loder, 2005). To resolve this psychological quandary women have been forced to compartmentalize their understanding of the conflicted position they are placed in that separates the two elements to allow them

to function without self-recrimination. For the vast majority of history women have been forced to play a submissive and subordinate role in society whose primary responsibility was to bear and take care of the children of the family and the domestic work related to the home as the spouses and consorts of men (Lerner, 1986; Miles, 1993). Little has changed. As Gaskell and McLaren (1991) observe regarding this patriarchal reality that has traditionally divided the private and public realms:

The allocation of household labor to women is a social and patriarchal construction (Gittens, 1985; Mandell & Duffy, 1988; Rich, 1977; Thorne & Yalom, 1982). Further, rather than being separate spheres, the so-called public realm of waged labor and the so-called private realm of unpaid labor in the home each affect the performance of the other (Jagger & McBride, 1985; Maroney, 1985). (p. 21)

Until recent history, women were confined to the undervalued and unreported private sphere of domestic care while men dominated the public one and the majority of important decisions. While many more women are now employed in modern society outside the home, these fundamental relationships have not changed in the world of work (Cubillo & Brown, 2003). Women continue to do the majority of the domestic care and housework despite what are supposed to be major advances in the attitudes toward domestic duties and after having taken on full-time employment to support their households (Gazso-Windle & McMullin, 2003; Walby, 1990). A 2011 Statistics Canada report on domestic work concluded, "Despite the narrowing of the differences, men continue to have an overall greater involvement in paid work than women, and a lesser involvement in housework" (Milan, Keown, & Robles Urquijo, 2011). Men continue to populate the highest corporate and government levels where major decisions are made (Coleman, 2005; Hubbard & Datnow, 2000). The domestic subservience of women has simply been extended to the workplace in one form or another in a recent historical wave of patriarchal accommodation (Burman, 2005).

In the "new normal" around the world women have taken on two full-time jobs with little change in either their status or the traditional role of men (Afisi, 2010; Celikten, 2005; Walby, 1990). Women are still expected by their male counterparts to look after the domestic affairs and play submissive, deferential, and subordinate sexual roles while now also being expected to work full-time outside the home. Men have no such similar expectation placed on them and despite social encouragement continue to take responsibility for domestic work in largely token ways with the tacit agreement of

women (Tan, 2009). Society appears on the surface to be more equitable, but like television our viewpoint is framed by the lens of the observer who provides it. Media create the illusion that because more women are represented in general visible social roles, the overall status of women everywhere is improving as are attitudes toward women, which is not necessarily the case and is more often a media illusion.

Superficially, contemporary female leaders present a softer, more humane, collaborative, nurturing, and consensual image (Lad, 2002) although many scholars contest this as stereotypical as well, but they too conform to the strong, patriarchal, single leader theory—whether Margaret Thatcher, Golda Meir, Eva Peron, or Hillary Clinton (Blackmore, 2002; Celikten, 2005; Coleman, 2005, Tan, 2009). The fact remains, however, that beyond recent advances by selected, highly visible women into positions with political power and their presence in various monarchies, female leaders in key roles in history are minimal due primarily to the dominance of men and the persistence of patriarchy. In addition the benefits that have accrued to a small percentage of women have not been generalized to women overall (Tan, 2009). Whether assertive or pacifist, democrat or demagogue, male or female, the static leadership model is identical: individual people doing great things.

In addition, women are in essence uniquely caught in a double-bind when it comes to leadership and power; they are damned if they do and damned if they don't when it comes to being assertive. As Langford, Welch, and Welch (1998) state:

Researchers point out that this creates a no-win situation for women. A leader must be assertive and take-charge; therefore, for a woman to be leader, she must also be assertive. But if she is assertive, she will be "devalued" by both men and women because she is acting out of her role (see Eagly, Makhijani, & Klonsky, 1992). However, if she senses the possibility of devaluation if she behaves like a male, she may choose less obvious strategies to influence others, involving inclusion and the way in which she speaks (Gruber & White, 1986). These strategies are not consistent with perceptions of leadership, therefore the woman is devalued for using a "female style." (p. 2)

This cultural stereotype ensures the continuing dominance of the patriarchal leadership myth. The answer is not to change women or men but to change the paradigm that they both believe in and are dominated by. The problem is that the same male qualities are required of both good and bad leaders of both genders, but these expectations create paradoxical demands on female leaders and create a perplexing personal conflict for them regarding

social expectations to be women, mothers, and caregivers and be an assertive, take-charge leader within the unforgiving male form (Ekman, 2002; Gilbert & Matviuk, 2008; Sherman, 2005; Sanal, 2008; Tan, 2009). Men are also caught in the same demands of living up to the male expectation of leadership but without the demand to be involved with the significant burden of domestic care, which relieves them of a major social responsibility. It is a web in which we are all caught. Langford, Welch, and Welch's observations describe this "double bind" (Coleman, 2005; Schieman & Reid, 2008) that women are caught in. Tiessen (2008) describes how women in developing countries are caught in a "triple role" or "multiple burden" of productive, reproductive and community labour that extends and fragments their day preventing them from being involved in public life (p. 208). In many other areas, as well, women are held to an unwinnable double standard that effectively ensures their failure and their ongoing domestic subordination and undervaluing within a patriarchal social structure (Lerner, 1997; Sanal, 2008). Women are required to conform to the "rules of the game" or risk being excluded and marginalized (Chowdhury, 2009; Tan, 2009). Men who desire to change the patriarchal paradigm are as well. This applies to personal relationships, child-rearing, and sexuality (Miller, 2003). Women exist in what Court (1997) describes as the "cult of domesticity" that places strong expectations on women to give priority to their nurturing roles within marriage and family, forcing them into a conflict between home and work expectations that women have yet to resolve to this day (p. 20). These expectations do not leave women when they enter the workforce.

Gazso-Windle and McMullin (2003) conclude that domestic work distribution is a dynamic and complex matter influenced by time availability, resources, and gender ideology contextualized by patriarchy. A 2014 Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development report entitled *Work-Life Balance* (OECD, 2014) confirms this:

The distribution of tasks within the family is still influenced by gender roles: men are more likely to spend more hours in paid work, while women spend longer hours in unpaid domestic work. While on average men in OECD countries spend 141 minutes per day doing unpaid work, women spend 273 minutes per day cooking, cleaning or caring.

Chowdhury (2009) indicates that women in developing countries spend two-thirds of their time on unpaid work. We see the clearest impact of this reality in women's role in the modern family. For most women, including those

who are employed outside the home, their innermost psychological feelings are conflicted as they relate to their domestic responsibilities often referred to as “work/life balance.” This concern is primarily expressed by women in relation to their work-home continuum. Most women continue to feel guilty about neglecting their role as the primary caregiver for their children and the primary person responsible for the domestic care in the home (child care, meals, cleaning, etc.) while deferring to their spouses the traditional male role in the family despite decades of affirmative action and consciousness-raising among women and men (Chowdhury, 2009; Loder, 2005; Walby, 1990). Men consistently reinforce this expectation of women whether the latter are educated, accomplished, mature, and successful or not. This is the reason research indicates women enter positions of responsibility in education and other fields much later in life than men—after their families have grown (McGee Banks, 2000). Chowdhury (2009) reports similar experiences for female politicians and other professionals in Bangladesh.

Women are caught in a double jeopardy of work and home life where they now have two full-time jobs—one inside and one outside of the home with little commensurate compensation or adjustments for this by men both in developed and developing nations (Afisi, 2010; Celikten, 2005; Chowdhury, 2009; French, 1985; A. Johnson, 2005; Walby, 1990). Ekman (2002) found that women teachers who declined promotion felt that being high school principals would require them to be “superwomen” (p. 71). Even extremely well-educated, highly accomplished, and intelligent professional women continue to carry out stereotypically traditional female roles in their families and continue to see themselves as responsible for the direct care of their young and even adult children (Rimm, Rimm-Kaufmann, & Rimm, I., 1999). Some anthropologists and historians have referred to relative advances by women to improve their condition as representing women’s “freedom” but Lerner (1986) indicates that such assessments are illusory and unwarranted and that ameliorations of women’s situations are fragmentary and will not change patriarchy. This willing compartmentalization (Hobson, 1971) of these conflicting realities is a coping mechanism for women who realize that their actions do not match their intellectual understanding of the issue. Most women ignore or give no indication of being aware of the paradoxical double standard they are living in their daily lives.

The most telling current example is the First Lady of the White House, Michelle Obama, who was a successful and powerful attorney prior to the election of Barack Obama as president of the United States in 2008 and has

now taken on a secondary and subordinate role as the stay-at-home mom of the White House. Her main accomplishments as reported by the media are the dresses she chooses for various functions and her support for various children's charities—all traditional and stereotypical, infantilizing roles for women in the male White House culture. While these services and behaviors have a role in society, it is the way they are negatively viewed in a patriarchal society that is problematic and the marginalizing of women that undercuts them. Michelle Obama's performance at the Democratic National Convention illustrated that she is more than an equal to her husband as an orator and would be an equally viable candidate for president as he was. Hillary Clinton was also forced into the same role after her attempt to assert some independence in the health care portfolio during the Clinton administration. This reflects what Young (1994) refers to as a "limited liberation" for women (p. 361). Similarly Tan (2009) describes Singapore's public culture as infantilizing women while asserting male masculinity.

Thus, rather than reforming traditional leadership, women were forced to accept it, internalize it, and subsequently practice it. Patriarchy absorbed and incorporated women's liberation into its superstructure. Bolton and Muzio (2008) for example, found that female attorneys' careers were handicapped by a male-dominated conceptualization of the legal profession stressing billable hours and revenue generation. Wilson, Powney, Hall, and Davidson (2006) report that female teachers are similarly hampered in their careers by traditional expectations of caregiving. Loder (2005) found that black female school administrators used a variety of support strategies to assist them in carrying out their traditional caregiver roles in their lives. Many relied on mothers, parents, and other non-spousal supports to juggle their dual roles. Lerner (1997) indicates that despite advances women are still seriously under-represented in the areas of science and technology. The higher the salary in a particular job or profession, the more men will be represented; the lower, the more women who will be represented (Allen, 2015).

During this period of immense social struggle and change for women and other marginalized groups their goal was understandably to be allowed to engage in society in the same way as men do and to receive the same respect given to men. While they have accomplished this primary goal to a degree, the aim of changing the male culture of society and its underlying values toward women has failed to progress beyond those who have broken through the glass ceiling or achieved superficial success. In fact, under the last 20 years of neoliberal and neoconservative resurgence as reflected in the Republican Tea

Party and the current Canadian Conservative Party, it has regressed. Rather than attempting to create equity for women by changing the leadership/power paradigm to reflect less power and control and more humanism, social justice, consensus, and democratic collaboration, women have instead mimicked men in their approach to leadership and power, resulting in a re-entrenchment of patriarchy now reinforced by both genders (Blackmore, 2006).

As a result, most women who have entered positions of responsibility continue to lead in the same way as men have before them; the gender of the leader has simply changed. While women have succeeded in their goal of respect and equality with men on a superficial level, they have failed in creating a more equitable leadership environment and in creating an entirely new paradigm of leadership that benefits the majority of women and men for the future. It is ironic that a historically marginalized group within society that has been so oppressed by the dominance of patriarchal leadership for so long has so quickly become willing participants in the same system in such a short time. Women have fallen into the trap of colluding in their own subordination and justifying their complicity in authoritarian leadership as success in achieving equality with men and enjoying the trappings of power (Lerner, 1986; Mackinnon & Bullen, 2005).

In this way, neopatriarchy has absorbed women leaders into its ideology and used women to further entrench the values of patriarchy and the practice of traditional leadership even deeper into our social and educational environments (French, 1985; A. Johnson, 2005; Miles, 1993; Sinclair, 2004). Women have been unconsciously manipulated by their eagerness for equality and desire to lead into a leadership double-entendre that has made them unwitting promoters of the same system that oppressed them prior to their involvement. As Lerner (1986) asserts:

The androcentric fallacy, which is built into all the mental constructs of Western civilization, cannot be rectified simply by "adding women." What it demands for rectification is a radical restructuring of thought and analysis which once and for all accepts the fact that humanity consists in equal parts of men and women and that the experiences, thoughts, and insights of both sexes must be represented in every generalization that is made about human beings. (p. 220)

Female leaders are now questioning the influence of traditional leadership expectations on their values as leaders. Hackney and Runnestrand (2003) describe one women's leadership support project and the unease many women leaders felt about their feelings of inauthenticity about their traditional

leadership roles and a subsequent loss of self that led them to withdraw from leadership roles and their organizations altogether. Conforming to the male leadership style had forced them into a chameleon role that after lengthy careers they began to have serious doubts about.

Women have squandered a historic opportunity to change power and authority forever in their eagerness to prove their equality with men. Women who have entered the workforce in education and other professions and taken on positions of responsibility have been socialized into a patriarchal, top-down leadership paradigm that has trained them to be effective, controlling leaders in a male leadership style and thus has socialized them to be leaders in the male mold while expecting them to continue in full-time domestic roles as well. In their eagerness to professionalize they have been exploited (Acker, 1999). Women have not challenged, questioned, or altered this oppressive and authoritarian model but have instead embraced it with a slightly feminized spin and declared victory for women. Women now accept the demanding, unrealistic fictionalized stereotype of the modern women as attractive, accomplished, intelligent and domestic all at the same time. They have become part of the oppressive system that dominated them for centuries and are now using it to further their own self-interest. As French (1985) noted almost 30 years ago:

It is not an exaggeration to say that although feminism in capitalist states has freed many women and improved the lives of others, it has had little effect on the patriarchy, which has simply absorbed a few women who appear acceptable to its purposes, and barred the door for the rest. (p. 462)

Three decades later the situation is unchanged. Patriarchy knows no gender, geographic, cultural, economic, or employment boundaries. Professional women continue to carry out the majority of domestic family care and take on traditional female roles in both developed and undeveloped countries in most cases (Chowdhury, 2009). Occupations such as law, teaching, and management reflect the "masculinization" of employment in these and other fields where women are forced "... to comply with behavioural and interactional norms that celebrate and sustain a masculine vision of what it is to be a professional thus marginalizing the 'feminine' and devaluing, ignoring and unsupporting the work that women do (Davies, 1996; West and Zimmerman, 1987)" (Bolton & Muzio, 2008, p. 283). Women who wish to aspire to positions of responsibility in business and the professions are still required to do so according to male norms of conduct and achievement.

This characterizes the depth and strength of the patriarchal context in which women are immersed and the invisible paradoxical and conflicting demands it places on them. Jobs such as teaching, nursing, and clerical work have historically been low-paid, professional work ghettos for women, and this continues unchanged today; but even highly paid professions such as medicine, law, and university academia are not immune to becoming gender silos (Allen, 2015; Bernard, Hill, Falter, & Wilson, 2004). In all professions there is a hierarchical valuing that places men above women, creating "occupational ghettoization" where women work in less prestigious roles than men including the professoriate, the school principalship, and corporate management. Tallerico and Blount (2004) describe this phenomenon:

Occupational ghettoization by sex can take a variety of forms. In all its varieties, however, it essentially masks genuine integration by relegating one sex (typically females) to the less valued, lower paid, less desirable sub-contexts or to part-time rather than full-time hours within a nominally identical, desegregating field (Redclift, 1988; Reskin & Roos, 1990). (p. 637)

Thus, rather than actually challenging and changing this power structure, women have instead chosen to accept its reality and become part of it (Cubillo & Brown, 2003). The laudable but misguided goal of liberal feminism was to make women who were equal to men but not to create a new equality based on reformed gender neutrality and economic parity, which led to heavy criticism of liberal feminists' compromise stance on patriarchy from other disciplines (Middleton, 1989). The empirical evidence would suggest that they have failed in their mission. The goal of breaching male-dominated social arenas was an ephemeral one because it was a pursuit that led women to ultimately aspire to become men rather than creating a new equity that was not premised on the male model. Feminism became caught up in proving to the world that women were just as good as men according to male standards, which ironically demonstrated that men still controlled the game. The recent addition of a Canadian female bobsledder to the men's team and events is a current example. Women fell into the trap of validating male values as the benchmark for society. This resulted in a social problematic where women aspired to and pursued male occupations and privileges and in the process became absorbed by them. It has led to requiring women to operate by male norms regarding leadership and power and to believe that this equates to greater equality, when in fact it simply further ensures male dominance and patriarchal authority into society for everyone. As Bierema

(2003) states: "The few women who break through the glass ceiling do so by emulating men and reinforcing patriarchal systems that discriminate against women and people of colour, and, essentially, 'keep women in their place'" (p. 3). Women have given gender credence to patriarchal power and leadership in their eagerness to aspire, which is one of the main criticisms of liberal feminism (S. Acker, 1994; A. Johnson, 2005). As Bierema (2003) points out regarding women's lack of response to the "glacially" slow progress on employment equity in the corporate field:

Women work and learn in a context that has been largely created, maintained and controlled by white men where they lack voice, visibility and power. How do women learn to deal with such marginalization? Although one might assume that working in a patriarchal system would galvanize a woman's feminist perspective and desire to change organizational culture, often the opposite is true. Previous research has shown that some women actually exhibit low levels of gender awareness when reflecting on their career experiences (Caffarella et al. 1997) even when reporting experiences of gender-based hardship, discrimination and harassment. (p. 3)

A 2011 Catalyst Research report titled *Women in U.S. Management* indicated that merely 14.4% of executive officer positions were held by women in 2010 in the United States. The figures for Canada are similar (Catalyst Research, 2011). While there has been an increase since 2002, the gains are glacial compared to the overwhelming numbers of men who continue in these positions. Coleman (2005) quotes *Guardian* figures that merely 114 directors out of 1,400 in total of FTSE 100 companies are women (p. 5). If women wish to achieve they must emulate male cultural codes to do so (Femea, 2003).

As French (1985) further points out, the influence of patriarchy reaches far beyond simply oppressing women; it permeates all social organizations and structures: "Not only unequal degrees of status but also the ideas that sustain and perpetuate male control over females are institutionalized in patriarchy. Thus the fundamental nature of patriarchy is located in stratification, institutionalization, and coercion" (p. 72). Miles (1993) comments on the historic role of monotheistic religion in this process:

In his dealings with the Mother Goddess and her worshippers, Muhammad was content with nothing less than 'the historical liquidation of the female element' in the words of the Muslim historian Fatmah A. Sabbah. Even this, though, was not enough to ensure the perpetuation of the father god's victory. Women and men had to be brought to believe in women's inferiority, to know that her rightful place was, in

every sense, beneath the male. Accordingly the patriarchs of the One God embarked on a strenuous and hysterical myth-campaign to account for and enforce the subjection of women. (p. 95)

Thus patriarchy is not simply related to gendered relationships in a family or work but also in society at large, in economics, religion, education, and politics, to name only a few where it extends the relationship of the family to global relationships (Walby, 2007).

While there are many more women working, social values are dramatically more accepting of women taking an active role in Western society, and laws have erased many of the more egregious discrimination against women, the unwritten, unspoken social attitudes of males still control the ultimate decision making in organizations and society and ensure that patriarchal control prevails. Male values continue to dominate the abortion debate around the world, women's dress and fashion, their marital choices, and their sexual freedom, restricting women's rights as humans. In addition, many of the gains realized by women do not exist in many other parts of the world such as Middle Eastern, African, and East Indian cultures where the status of women is extremely marginal and strictly dictated by men. Gilligan and Richards (2009) point out that patriarchy in India and the physical dominance of women by men has modern roots in British imperialism. Afisi (2010) also asserts that Nigerian women enjoyed more equal and highly valued status with men in traditional times despite the existence of patriarchy prior to the advent of colonialism when sexual hierarchy was introduced into Africa.

Western women have become complacent with their superficial social gains and as a result have put real gender change in jeopardy. Patriarchal male leadership and its incumbent values continue to pervade and dominate every aspect of modern life while the formal changes for women are minuscule in comparison. While women have injected feminine qualities of consensus and collaboration into the social milieu of leadership, they have done so as an overlay to what is still a primarily patriarchal hierarchy and practice. The fundamental structures of organizations, leadership expectations, and political decision making remains firmly grounded in the top-down, command-and-control, authoritarian patriarchal paradigm (Sherman, 2000). With just a slight shift in global sentiments all the gains of the last five decades could be wiped out.

The Dark Side of Leadership

The less exposed dimension of traditional leadership is its accompanying intimidation, violence, or threat of violence. This can range from mild pressure to mass genocide. For women this means sexual and domestic violence and economic marginalization. Violent, aggressive images and culture are redolent in the history of leadership and a critical part of its meaning and use. Leadership is and has been about conquest, domination, control, power, and intimidation by primarily male leaders (Pellegrini & Scandura, 2008). Those few who appealed for peace and harmony were in the large part ignored or eliminated. History romanticizes, mythologizes, and eulogizes victorious military leaders as part of its process of deifying leaders and indoctrinating successive societal generations into their unwritten patriarchal and warlike code (Lerner, 1986, 1997). We valorize the victors (Klein, 2002). This method of what Crow (2007) refers to as the phenomenon of "serial socialization" continues in modern organizations to this day within the process of mentorships and networking (p. 53). From the swashbuckling sea-going hero or Sir Lancelot in medieval times, to the brave cavalry officers of the Light Brigade and General George Custer, to the five-star, no-nonsense general of World War II or the blustering English bulldog politician or the screaming megalomaniac, the caricature is varied but the same. Great men do great things (Muijs & Harris, 2007; Stewart, 2006). To the victors go the spoils; to the vanquished, ignominy. Our leadership models enfranchise the few and disenfranchise the rest. The "Great Man" modernist theory has dominated scholarship and the public mind to this day and is stubbornly resistant to change (Gronn, 1997). Only recently has it been brought into question, yet it still garners widespread acceptance and support in society (Heenan & Bennis, 1999; Muijs & Harris, 2007). All that has really happened is that leadership has improved its public image somewhat.

Historically, patriarchal approaches to leadership have been violent, exclusionary, controlling, and negative. The concept of leadership is by its nature inherently elitist. The idea of elevating one person above all others and designating him or her as "the leader" with full power and authority over all others is inherently fraught with problems and danger and immediately ostracizes everyone else involved, placing them in the subordinate category of followers rather than equal partners in the social or economic enterprise.

While we idolize the conquering hero-leader we neglect to remember that for every successful leader there has been an unsuccessful one. The patriarchal leadership model has a 50% success rate at best. Rather than being a force for

motivation it is a recipe for mediocrity since followers comply through fear and resentment of the leader rather than commitment to the cause (Braynion, 2004). Leaders are portrayed as an elite group; followers are a faceless, forgotten mass (Collinson, 2005).

"Might is right" still rules our geopolitical and interpersonal relationships. Physical aggression, intimidation, manipulation, conflict, violence, and militarism have been the response of last (and first) resort and the watchwords of patriarchal male leadership for centuries. They have now been extrapolated through the nation state and the global world (Marchbank, Letherby, Lander, Walker, & Wild, 2003). Machiavelli's *The Prince* continues to be the sourcebook of these manipulative leadership values or what Knuth (2004) refers to as "cheap leadership." Business continues to look to military models and analogies for inspiration as do sports and many other areas of society (Dobbin, 1998). We expend a significant amount of the world's economic resources defending or promoting aggression while denying the world's peoples a high quality of life in the process.

Life and society are defined in terms of the victorious male conquest. Leaders quickly resort to force: physical or psychological violence, intimidation or coercion, and threats when dialogue and collaboration break down. Leadership is not about allowing democratic solutions to evolve but in forcing leader-driven solutions on those involved. Leaders (particularly in self-espoused democratic societies) employ civilized, collaborative, and consensual behaviors as a façade for pre-determined agendas. While they may not regularly employ aggression or violence to advance them, they do employ political, economic, and social intimidation and pressure to achieve their goals. They are simply more benevolent about their methods. The psychological environment is identical, however. The subordination of the masses is still the end result. Leaders employ these methods only as long as they produce the results they want—when they cease to do this, they quickly resort to subtle or overt tactics under the guise of "national security," "the public interest," "system needs," "insubordination," or a "threat to our way of life." Police forces are a clear example of our obsession with society-wide social compliance with authority. Police forces have taken on a public role of protection of society while carrying out a subliminal role of protecting corporate interests and controlling the restive public. The general public is monitored and managed daily by forces of security. White-collar crime is a low priority for police although it does massively more damage to society than petty crime. We focus on guns on the street rather than the manufacturers of guns.

Throughout history rulers have used a variety of direct and indirect methods to control their subjects. The historical basis of this philosophical approach is detailed by O'Sullivan (2001) in relation to the operation of organized religion and the Catholic Church that reflected the structure of most traditional hierarchical organizations with a powerful emphasis on "law and order" with order and harmony as the basic social virtues:

Thus we see, within the workings of traditional hierarchical organization, a very powerful emphasis on "law and order," with order and harmony as the basic social virtues. Holland and Henriot give us a very clear example of the working structure using the traditional western Catholic Church:

A landed aristocracy hierarchically structured through nobility, high clergy, constituting a ruling elite. At best, this form of leadership served as a paternalistic guardian of the "common good" exercising a noblesse oblige toward the lower classes. At worst, it collapsed into despotic absolutism. In either case, its reaction to a challenge to the status quo was the same—absorption or suppression. Such rule was justified on ideological grounds by appeals to the "divine right of kings," demands of "social order," the preservation of "tradition" and "sound doctrine," and the assertion that "this is the way things have always been done." (Holland and Henriot 1984: 34). (p. 61)

An example of the power and corruption of the Catholic Church is further provided by Lerner (1997) in discussing the reasons for the introduction of celibacy:

Noble families, instead of enriching individual priests, would now have an incentive to leave their property to the Church. The connection between sexual regulation and economic power is evident: in enforcing the celibacy of the clergy, the Church vastly increased its landed property until it held nearly half of the land in western Europe. (p. 167)

This philosophy promoted by the Catholic Church is the same one employed by governments, businesses, religious organizations and educational institutions everywhere in modern society over the years (Lerner, 1986). Armies and police forces have been employed to ensure its implementation on behalf of ruling elites. Little has changed over the centuries. Until we can overcome this supremacist evolutionary shortfall, democratic societies, cultures, ideas, philosophies, and practices will remain suspect and at risk, being nothing more than utopian pipe dreams (Dewey, 1989). We continue to live in a patriarchal, authoritarian, and right-wing world overlaid with a thin coating of meaningless, civilized, democratic rhetoric, and human

consumption. In short, we live in a global interpersonal war zone. It is a dangerous and threatening world filled with political intrigue, deception, and hidden agendas all oriented on the deception and domination of the majority by a small self-interested minority and their beneficiaries in whatever institution it is manifested, whether these be religious, economic, political, or social.

We do not aspire to the highest moral order; we aspire to the lowest common denominator of deception and deceit. Charles Handy (1981) clearly described the key differences between authoritarian and democratic leadership in management decades ago with the former being oriented in leadership control and the latter in distributed leadership. The latter is still a distant pipe dream. They are not difficult to understand but particularly with the latter appear to be exceeding difficult to operationalize. Handy indicates that under democratic leadership the assumption is that people will produce more. Even if people do not produce more, they are definitely happier under the latter system, yet fully democratic organizations as described by Handy cannot be found. What we get are variations of authoritarian hierarchies and bureaucracies that severely limit the freedom of participants. To make a significant gain in human satisfaction, a loss of productivity is a small price to pay—if human happiness is our goal. Leadership styles over the centuries and into current times cluster on the authoritarian side of the leadership continuum, however, with few if any falling on the fully democratic side. We must ask ourselves as a society why we appear to fear real democracy so much and why we have achieved it so little.

We have rarely, if ever, engaged in fully democratic leadership, government, organizational structuring, or personal relationships throughout history. The core beliefs of the leader must be democratic and they must be operationalized, but they rarely are. If leaders are democratic at their core everything else flows from that. We still describe leadership as manipulation—whether authoritarian or democratic—to further the interests of the leader (S. Maxcy, 1991). As Cheng, Chou, Wu, Huang and Farh (2004) indicate in their description of the similarities of traditional Chinese paternalistic and Western transformational leadership:

With regard to PL, although it is a leadership concept couched within the Chinese cultural tradition, it is highly relevant in modern organizations. All leaders' in modern organizations have almost identical goals: to command, to organize, to influence, to decide, and to control, which are independent of cultural influence. (p. 93)

The vast majority of our leaders choose the authoritarian style for their preferred method of leading because it is easier and more efficient, even if it is not ultimately effective or desired. Few, if any, choose a democratic approach to leading. We all give in to the Darth Vader inside each of us: the dark side.

Democratic leadership is threatening to most leaders because it intimidates them as leaders and problematizes leadership itself. It is also the most difficult because it requires constant negotiation and collaboration to achieve results rather than unilateral action. Democratic leadership is slow, laborious, fully collaborative, and honestly consensual while operating in an environment of equalized power and authority of all members (Leithwood & Mascall, 2008). Gilligan and Richards (2009) speak of democratic manhood as opposed to patriarchal manhood that "protects the exercise of free and equal voice from violence and intimidation and gives expression to a sense of honor and even heroism" (p. 266).

Conquering victorious leaders throughout history almost universally expressed their patriarchal in opposition to their democratic manhood. They also gained power and control not only of territories, wealth, and people but more importantly of history and belief itself as they documented their exploits while demonizing, eliminating, or making transparent those whom they conquered (Franzway, 2005). As a society we only seem to know how to lead in this way. History is the story of the victors (McQuaig, 2001). It mythologizes the courageous leader and conqueror (most frequently white and male) above all other forms of leadership (Gronn, 1997).

Even modern, supposedly transformational leaders are no different from traditional leaders in that they use charismatic methods to motivate adherents to follow them. The real difference is moral, but even this is problematic because morals can also be dogmatic and oppressive, so each leader must be carefully assessed in regards to value stance in relation to its positive impact on society. In reality this proves to be exceedingly difficult (Begley & Associates, 2000). The only way to ensure that intentions are discerned before it is too late is to have a rigorous and open continuous democratic dialogue and challenge regarding any views, beliefs, or attitudes voiced by particular individuals or groups in society including governments and to deemphasize leadership as control and singularity while emphasizing leadership as negotiation. The more widely power is disseminated the less potential for abuse. This is a far cry from the "show democracy" and "pretend leadership" that we currently accept. The modern propensity for assuming a benevolent intent of leaders is naive at best.

Transformational leadership is another in a long line of traditional leadership theories that attempt once again to justify traditional, singular charismat-

ic leadership styles. We seem entranced or blinded by the allure of the singular leadership paradigm and appear unable to conceptualize leadership or followership in anything other than traditional dualistic, adversarial terms (Grant, 2006). Transformational leadership (McCroskey, 2008) advocates positive moral intentions in the leader when there is no evidence to support this assumption and at least an equal potential for harmful consequences that are frequently ignored. Allix (2000) exposes the fundamental problematic flaws in transformational leadership theories that fail to address the equal potential of the concept to produce despotic as well as democratic leadership: "Without sufficient intellectual and institutional safeguards, Burns' leadership formulation pays the price of failing to meet its own test of adequacy, namely, in being able to draw satisfactorily a clear distinction between Adolf Hitler and Mahatma Gandhi" (p. 18; A. Johnson, 2005). There are in reality far more bad, incompetent, and mediocre leaders than good ones, but only the successful leaders get recognized and at least half of leaders are failures at any given time. But that is not the point: the entire paradigm is broken. The problem with charismatic leadership is that it is not easily generalized. The core leadership/followership relationship remains unchanged and problematic.

What binds historical leaders together is that they are shaped by the same flawed mythic historical and patriarchal archetypal mold (Sinclair, 2004). All possessed the capacity to galvanize their people into action—some misguided, some just. Some ended up on the negative side of history while others on the positive. We shake our heads at the actions of the despots and eulogize the peacemakers, but we continue to groom leaders in the same fundamental and problematic manner that we have for eons—a model that has a significant downside potential to create a continuum of megalomaniacal leaders from the mildly despotic consultative and collaborative "servant leaders" of today's managerial culture to the vicious and destructive leaders such as Slobodan Milošević in Serbia and Idi Amin in Uganda. As Sergiovanni (1992) indicates of modern managerialism:

In practice, the managerial mystique represents a tacit compact among too many policymakers, administrators, and academics, which places process before substance, and form before function. So strongly does the mystique adhere to belief in the right methods that the methods themselves become surrogates for results. It also holds firmly to the belief in management controls, as the way to overcome human shortcomings and enhance productivity, that the controls become ends in themselves. The result is an emphasis on doing things right, at the expense of doing the right things. (p. 4)

As long as we adhere to the belief in a singular leadership model based on manipulation, we guarantee conflict and problems around the world (Gronn, 2003). The assertive patriarchal archetype results in devastating results for society far more often than it creates leaders who are altruistic, inclusive, and create widespread benefits. Many leaders project this pretense but their inner motivations remain control-based. In more benign terms it creates cultures of systemic malaise rather than productivity. Even in the world of modern business and society leadership is a controlling and manipulative exercise intended to use people for various self-interested purposes (profit, personal gain, fame, etc.) while often wrapping itself in the flag of high moral and ethical purpose or the goals of organizations or governments. What this model of leadership does not do well is tolerate dissent or the acceptance of diversity within the organizations or society or create full transparency regarding its actions. It is a control, not a consent, model.

This patriarchal archetype of leadership is a model that puts its trust, belief, and faith in the single, white, heroic, messianic, charismatic, and visionary leader (Brookfield, 2005; Freire, 2001; Sinclair, 2004) to solve the problems of the world and deliver happiness to all through intimidation, threat, violence, and domination despite massive anecdotal and empirical evidence that it rarely, if ever, has succeeded in accomplishing this without massive collateral damage and when it does this success is sharply relative (French, 1985). This romantic, unrealistic fairy tale drives leadership models, theories, and practices in modern society and is flawed and unreliable (Gilbert & Matviuk, 2008). It is a self-fulfilling failure prophecy since no individual can live up to the inflated and mythologized expectations of his or her role, nor are they realistically achievable in democratic ways. Whether this pressure is created through influence, encouragement, intimidation, threats, or fear, it operates by coercion nonetheless. Positive, open, and honest organizational relationship models of democratic leadership simply do not exist.

While some scholars claim leadership is an influence process and want to separate leadership and power to soften its image, this is an artificial and untenable approach. Leadership and power are the same. Influence is power and power is influence. One cannot lead nor have influence without exercising some form of power within our traditional leadership models. The result of this type of leadership is compliance, not commitment, which is what exists in the vast majority of organizations, societies, and groups (Sergiovanni, 1992). While compliance is a most complex concept, most followers do so

simply because they have no other choice given the circumstances they find themselves in or to achieve a goal they are pursuing. They subordinate their independence in the hopes of achieving what they view as a more valued personal goal. There are no democratic businesses, organizations, or groups in private or public sector employment. Students comply with professors to gain academic degrees. Whether due to a need for employment, allegiance, or commitment, they are inextricably tied to the dominant leader in their group or organization. It is a social game everyone plays where the rules are predetermined by authority before one enters. This is the only choice they are given; there are no other models operating in the world that emphasize democratic and truly consultative and consensual processes with balanced power and authority among members. As Lerner (1997) states: "Such collective forgetting of the dark side of events is hurtful to the individual as well as to the entire society, because one cannot heal nor can one make better decisions in the future, if one evades responsibility for the consequences of past actions" (p. 52).

We gravitate toward hierarchy as a way of organizing our social relationships. This is the only way that certain individuals can gain power and wealth. If these decisions were made collectively and democratically, they would never gain assent. One person being extremely wealthy and another desperately poor would never be supported by a democratic society, but we do. People are not given any real democratic options when they join the army, the company, the government, the police force, the fire department, or the academic institution. They are invited to join an authority-based bureaucratic and leadership hierarchy and to follow its rules or be put out of the organization; there is no independence or democracy in bureaucracies led by patriarchal leaders, which is the irony of politically democratic societies. Democratic leadership, government or organizations are a patriarchal fiction. It is this type of organization that comprises virtually all the private, public, and government sector organizations today. To make the leap of faith to suggest that this can produce a democracy or democratic societies or governments is specious when everything about them is antithetical to the concept including the legal system and government organization. Ironically in our Western societies, one is hard pressed to find real democratic practices. Our progress as a civilization is circumspect.

Traditional leadership also creates a dependency relationship between leaders and followers where leaders take all the responsibility for decisions, allowing followers to abdicate their responsibility in these situations in a patrimonial bargain (Macneill, Cavanaugh, & Silcox, 2005; Moloi & Bush,

2006; Pellegrini & Scandura, 2008; Sergiovanni, 1992). Most followers quietly acquiesce to this relationship. We live in a dangerous era of passive acceptance of authority and informal electronic auto-suggestion much like existed in Japan and Germany before World War II. Thus we valorize the war hero, the spiritual leader, the powerful general, the CEO, the football or basketball coach and place them on social and economic pedestals for conduct that, when held up to scrutiny, falls far short of this ideal. The hero leader is a myth that we treat as reality. Despite this, there is a growing unease with leadership and its results that is creating more disaffected citizens who see through the charade but feel powerless to do anything about it. We live in deeply troubling and dangerous times.

Leaders, whether successful or not, good or evil, are revered and reviled for their exploits, but we continue to put our unwavering belief in the single leader paradigm. This is the real problem. Dominant patriarchal leadership is the real god that we worship. It is the singular, male conceptualization of leadership and life that is being immortalized and idolized. Leadership based on the annihilation or subjugation of one's perceived or real enemies and the absolute rightness of any individual or society's decision process is a recipe for disaster. We are socialized to believe that this type of leadership works by movies such as *Batman* and *The Avengers* where the powerful force for good conquers evil, but in real life this is simply fiction. It is an unsustainable and destabilizing social mythology. This is not to say that truly collaborative and consensual leadership is not required to direct and act to benefit large groups of people in organizations or nations but not in the patriarchal form. Our current understanding of leadership is restricted and leads to unhealthy competition, conflict, exclusion, and damage. It is a disincentive to followers to create effective organizations by making a concerted effort to provide ideas and change strategies because they are generally never seriously considered. Curiously, there is little real sustained criticism of the patriarchal leadership paradigm in scholarly or other circles.

The traditional approach to leadership is also imbued with a number of significantly unsavory characteristics that are infrequently the subject of leadership study. One is that it demands allegiance and deference from followers to the leader. In traditional leadership theory this is valued, but in democratic leadership theory it is a liability. Followers are immediately put in a demeaning compliance relationship with the leader who is viewed as superior or the chosen one (J. Acker, 2006). People may comply, but they will not commit, nor will they feel valued or empowered. Peter Senge (1990)

points out the pervasive and progressive socialization toward authority in families and schools and its effects that create acceptance of authoritarian leadership: "This mentality weakens them as individuals, and the organizations as a whole. At some level it absolves them of responsibility in the organization's learning. It also predisposes them to cynicism when events eventually reveal that the people at the top did not have all the answers" (p. 282).

Another major problem with this model is that it is based on a "deficit theory" of human valuing described earlier (Reister, Pursch, & Skrla, 2002; Reynolds, White, Brayman, & Moore, 2008). The idealized leader is viewed as the consummation of leadership and his or her qualities, characteristics, and vision are glorified and held out as a model to be emulated by all others—in particular, women—who are necessarily assumed to be less worthy and competent than the designated leader and are thus expected to emulate his or her behavior (Cubillo & Brown, 2003). Thus, those who follow are perceived and treated as though they are never worthy enough to be called a leader. They are perpetually viewed as unfinished, inexperienced, and inadequate in comparison to the ideal of leadership being portrayed by the individual who has been designated—even though this may not be the case. Followers are also continuously trained, in-serviced, and lectured about how to be this type of leader in an unending cycle of aspiration toward some fictitious understanding of leading that is never achieved (S. Johnson, 1990; Stewart, 2006). Deficit model leadership is the carrot on the stick held out to motivate the donkey as its fundamental approach—the carrot may be money, position, fame, or acceptance, but they all work the same way.

Leadership theory is a constantly moving target. The perception of leadership desired by followers is rarely sought within this system (Weaver-Hart, 1995). It is a self-fulfilling prophecy. Those selected as leaders are *de facto* leaders; those who are not are similarly not leaders. Followers are not allowed to reject leadership for some more equitable relationship. Traditional leadership is the mirage of water in the desert—the more one pursues it, the more impossible becomes the task of achieving it. Even the most experienced middle managers are still treated as leaders-in-training, even though they often have far more knowledge, experience, and skills than the formal leaders who supervise them. In taking this approach we waste an enormous amount of human capital that could energize and motivate organizational success by frustrating everyone other than the few designated senior leaders. Traditional patriarchal leadership is extremely inefficient in this regard. As Petras and

Veltmeyer (2001) suggest there is a bit of charlatanism and medicine-man fakery in this process (p. 44).

Far more time is spent in modern organizations learning how to be a fictitious leader than actually translating that knowledge into actual leadership practice and results or just letting people lead in their natural style. Instead we opt for control style leadership that demands perfection in a fragmented, conflicted, and chaotic world. Most leaders rarely consult in meaningful ways, nor do they wish to hear what followers actually think about their own performance or abilities. This is evidenced by the complete absence of employee or follower performance reviews of leaders anywhere in the private or public sector. Once one has been appointed a leader, one is permanently anointed as a leader with little real direct accountability to anyone. Leaders and superiors evaluate, judge, and set the direction for followers, not the other way around. Valuing is a top-down hierarchical process that followers are not entitled to participate in. When followers are studied about their perceptions of leaders it is framed to validate the traditional leadership model, not criticize it. Research most often looks for the salutary effects of leaders rather than their shortcomings.

The language of leader and follower itself is also deprecatory and divisive, expressing relationships in essentializing dualisms such as master/servant, superior/subordinate, employer/employee, and king/subjects. This entire linguistic structure has been colonized by Aristotelian patriarchal terms and focuses on reinforcing difference and place rather than sameness, creating adversarial exclusionary relationships of tension between groups and people rather than real collaboration (Bolton & Muzio, 2008; Lerner, 1986). This concept of leadership fragments the leader from all followers and places different and often unwarranted value on a single individual (Wright, 2008). Talk of collaboration in this kind of environment is disingenuous.

Additionally, the way leadership is conceptualized as separating the leader from all others and placing him or her on an idealized pedestal creates a dangerous sense of self-importance and infallibility that often overrides ethical behavior and is dangerous in leaders (even good leaders) who become convinced that the way they think, act, and lead is the right way and everyone should follow them. Leadership arrogance can be extremely dangerous in certain situations where leaders have significant power, such as nation-states, or extremely embarrassing, such as leaders caught in compromising personal situations like Silvio Berlusconi (Thoms, 2008). As Paulo Freire (2001) observes:

One of the most objectionable errors of political militants, especially those of the messianically authoritarian kind, has always been a total ignorance of grassroots comprehension of the world. Seeing themselves as bearers of the "truth" that no one can refuse, they regard their sublime as one not of proposing such truth for consideration but of imposing it without question. (p. 77)

In one form or another, this is what leaders in organizations and governments everywhere do. They impose vision, collaboration, consensus, and cooperation rather than allow it to evolve naturally and allowing followers to accept or reject its validity. Fully distributed leadership and power or "peopleship" (Bahlieda, 2008) is a failsafe mechanism to ensure that there are always active checks and balances in leadership, not just political ones. Spreading leadership and formal power across a large number of people in flattened organizations (Clark & Koonce, 1995; Hornstein, 1996; P. Johnson, 2005) ensures good decision making just like democratic government should work as well, but this must happen in conjunction with equalized formal power to be effective.

Finally, one of the immediate problems with traditional leadership concepts is that the process of becoming a leader does not follow the declared steps provided and is often perceived as corrupt. There is no linear path to becoming a leader despite having followed formal procedures or having assembled a group of supportive adherents. There is no real formula or set of steps; it is still an amorphous, mysterious, idiosyncratic, and chaotic process disguising a thin veneer of personal bias and cronyism, although scholarly research and popular opinion would have us believe otherwise. People who do all the things that they should still find they are not formally or informally recognized as leaders for some undisclosed shortcoming. Leadership is ultimately a forced shell game. Leaders are ultimately those who are best at "gaming" the system and using power and political intrigue to pave the way for their ascension in the organization. We reward those who are the best manipulators of the system, not those who are best at allowing the system to create itself. We need real democracy that de-structures and decentralizes power, not hierarchies that concentrate it. What followers discover is that the process of being designated a "leader" is quite arbitrary, random, biased, and fickle. These types of leaders are probably the last kind of leader that we want for our future society.

Formal rules and policies are only highly stylized, superficial window-dressing to validate leadership selection as objective and unbiased—the internal biases, values, and beliefs of incumbent leaders or those in power are what really decide who is "anointed and appointed" (Darling-Hammond, Bullmas-

ter, & Cobb, 1995) and who is overlooked. There are general guidelines, but in reality there are no rules to the game except those of patriarchal privilege. As Wong and Sunderman (2001) state:

Under patrimonial leadership, legitimacy derives from the political and social networks connecting various officeholders and political leaders, rather than from a written set of rules. It may involve personal or professional networks among actors or devotion to tradition; that is, to the way things have always been done. It is a mutually beneficial relationship because both parties receive something of value—expediency, trust, loyalty, jobs, protection, or contracts. In its more disparaging forms, patrimonial organization serves to satisfy political obligations and demands. Both bureaucratic and patrimonial organizations have continuity as one of their most important characteristics (Weber, 1978, p. 1111). They both provide permanent structures, with bureaucracy based on a system of rules and patrimony on a network of social, political, and personal relationships. (p. 30)

Patrimony and bureaucracy go hand in hand with patriarchy, leadership, and power. In some cases people make their own rules and self-designate themselves as leaders as in the case of dictatorships. All these problems are directly related to patriarchy and its view of social relationships. We continue to be held hostage by the idiosyncratic, megalomaniacal paradigm of leadership.

In modern society, the negative aspects of leadership and leaders have been sublimated within a civilized overlay of behaviors while underneath this thin veneer, leadership operates with the same ugly dynamics that it has for centuries. We have moved away (although not entirely) from the more offensive, disturbing, and morally repugnant uses of direct force and control by leaders in Western societies that have characterized its past and attempted to gloss over the more brutal aspects of traditional leadership with more civilized and palatable incarnations of its practice (McQuaig, 2001).

Leaders have simply become more skilled at disguising their dark core of authority and power. In many ways this is more dangerous than in the past. We are all becoming unsuspecting victims of leadership beliefs and values. Leaders today do not primarily lead by fear and intimidation, although they can, but more often by political and personal guile and artifice under the guise of being democratic. The former is still invoked, however, if the latter are unsuccessful in the hierarchy of methods employed by leaders to get their way. The fact remains that our leadership models and culture revolve around the leader getting his or her way. The only difference today is that force is employed by politically or legally sanctioned bodies such as police and the military or organizational procedures to ensure that real change is prevented

under the guise of public order and organizational efficiency. Overt domination has been sublimated beneath layers of false civility, but it is domination nonetheless. The expected results, however, are the same: ensuring that those being led do what they are told, or what the leader, employer, or government official tells them to do or believes they should do. Leadership is becoming less and less trustworthy as a concept.

In addition to the patriarchal, gendered male bias toward leadership, leadership models for the past 1000 years have been rooted in a Eurocentric, racist, white, male tradition of leadership that has permeated modern society and promotes the white race as superior to all others (Gaskell & McLaren, 1991; McKellar, 1989; Seidman, 1994). Since the ascension of European society prior to and during the Industrial Revolution, white, racist values have become normalized and have come to fully dominate our global culture. Being white has been and is the standard by which all other races and cultures are measured, whether visibly or subliminally (Dickinson & Vasby Anderson, 2004). As the economic and political fortunes of Europe rose with industrialization, elitist arrogance regarding white culture grew. With might and power (militarily, politically, and economically) European society was in a position to impose its patriarchal white values and beliefs on the rest of the world. The power and control of patriarchy was then extended through the economic, political, legal, and religious values that gained primacy first across Europe and then around the world during the colonial and imperialist periods (Apple, 2006). In the past century Eurocentric, white patriarchy has become globally dominant as a result of the coincidental development of a number of other historical events such as the rise of scientific and intellectual rationalism, capitalism, and the Industrial Revolution during the 18th, 19th, and 20th centuries that consolidated its influence (Lerner, 1993).

For the past several centuries our history has been dominated by this worldview that has permeated society at every level from individual to global (Singh, 2005). It has been supported by the gendered leadership, economic, educational, political, and religious traditions of society throughout the ages and continues to have a deep and lasting impact on our modern world. In today's society, racism, like many other aspects of patriarchy, has become more sublimated and covert in its effects. Discrimination by gender and race are still a real issue around the world where the vast majority of promotions, jobs, and prestige continue to go to white, male individuals (Alston, 2005).

The goal of leadership theory is to produce people to control society, not to liberate it, and herein is its fundamental flaw. It is not intended or designed

to empower people but to disempower them. This is the fundamental premise and endemic dark side of traditional leadership itself (Begley & Associates, 2000; Blase & Blase, 2002). The leaders take responsibility away from followers and hold all the real power themselves. Whether benevolent or despotic, leadership is oriented on leading (manipulating) people to do what the leader wants. This can be done subtly or directly but the desired result is the same. This relationship sets up an immediate conflict scenario with followers who often resent the little disguised orientations of many leaders with their assumption of correctness and their blind allegiance to their own visions. This leadership myth is particularly problematic in the professions where each individual possesses a high level of qualification for his or her field. History is filled with the repeated efforts of successive societies to perfect the ability of leaders to control their followers and resultantly their environments. The better they do this, the more successful they are viewed, and the more famous they become.

This immediately sets up a superior/subordinate relationship with followers and a fundamental antagonism around the relationship in which followers react to the efforts of leaders to control them. There is no movement, theorizing, or examination of an alternative paradigm of leadership that would engage followers as equals and produce more open, shared, and democratic models focused on cooperating rather than disagreeing, which would support the sharing of power, authority, leadership, and ultimately wealth. This thinking is actively suppressed and attacked by the leviathan of traditional leadership and its hordes of believers and zealots. While leadership for control has become an obsession of modern society and big business, real leadership for democratic change is virtually nonexistent. Wealthy and powerful elites have defined democracy for us in their own terms. Leadership for conformity is heavily marketed. Leadership for the status quo is everywhere.

Neopatriarchy and the institutionalized leadership of the gulag that underwrites it are responsible for most, if not all, of the strife, disillusionment, dissatisfaction, and dissent that saturates our modern world. If we are looking for one cause for the structure of our modern world, patriarchy and the male leadership models it engenders are it. They are together a patronizing, elitist, sexist, and racially biased cultural value system that has an iron grip on our global consciousness. Fundamentally, however, neopatriarchy is contrary to the basic human desire for personal freedom and autonomy—freedom from authoritarianism, domination, and unreasonable control that

is imposed on anyone by anyone else whether in personal relationships or global politics. It is also in direct opposition to social justice and collective human aspirations of sharing, support, and equity. Most of the conflicts throughout the centuries from the interpersonal to the societal level since the dawn of time have revolved around defense of these core beliefs in the personal and collective democratic freedom of human beings. Unfortunately, in almost every case the cause of the powerful minority has prevailed over the resistant majority. They have also been fought by the efforts of one leader, people, or country to dominate another. Human history is the record of the efforts of the few to subdue the many led by patriarchal leaders and is the record of the resistance of people to that domination (McQuaig, 2001). This elemental patriarchal antagonism lies at the heart of the resentment and conflict that is pervasive in our modern world, between countries, between religious traditions, between individuals, men and women, employers and employees in organizations, and leaders and followers everywhere. All these leadership and economic relationships are rooted in adversarialism, domination, control, and conflict rather than respect, sharing, equity, cooperation, and freedom. They are the values of polarization, not unification. The former qualities are the reality of the majority of social and economic organizations, the latter the paradoxical and ironic ideological veneer employed to promote them.

Leadership Reform

Leadership reform is one of the most compelling requirements for changing our image of patriarchy and democracy. The various incarnations of leadership theory are nothing more than a thin layer covering what is at its center a failed, centuries-old patriarchal control paradigm that has brought nothing but devastation, impoverishment, war, pestilence, inequity, and famine to billions and billions of people worldwide throughout history while enriching and idolizing only a small minority by pillaging the majority. The perpetrators of this exclusionary, selfish vision have been almost exclusively men. The collateral damage caused by leaders and their visions has been staggering but largely accepted and ignored as “the cost of doing business” in the romantic renderings of their lives that dominate the leadership and historical literature. The excruciating horrors of centuries of forced servitude, exploitation, and slaughter for billions of people are swept away by historians

who focus only on the survivors and the conquerors while making passing reference to the victims of their abuse. Leadership has been bad for society, not because leadership in itself could not be inherently positive, but because leaders invariably choose to control through conquest and domination and for self-aggrandizing reasons rather than through liberating democratic and fully consensual approaches.

Virtually every leader in history, who promised to free his or her followers from oppression and slavery, subsequently imposed their own forms of domination on their surviving followers. *Freedom* is an overused and relative term. We must ask, freedom to do what, be what, and believe what? In most cases, leaders use their power and authority for negative, controlling, or self-serving authoritarian purposes that support their personal or political plans instead of creating more democratic, empowering, and socially just societies. While there is much rhetoric, there is little substance. There are few if any leaders throughout history who have employed democratic methods to achieve their goals. Many have used the guise of democracy to rule in autocratic ways and this still continues in Western democratic countries to a large degree, structured on historic male legal and social traditions. A significant number of males in society have the critical flaw of being egocentric, amoral individuals who only value their own gratification. Domination is efficient; real democracy and human respect aren't.

The concept of leadership should be reviled, not revered. While leaders have achieved some apparent successes and advancements for society, these have always been achieved at a huge human cost in a Pyrrhic victory and cannot be a template for the future of human society. The swashbuckling, courageous, visionary hero is a destructive patriarchal myth that only serves to perpetuate authoritarian social structures and elevates the leader onto a romantic pedestal that is unrealistic and unrealizable (Macneill, Cavanaugh, & Silcox, 2005).

That leaders in Western societies present formal public images of collaboration and consensus does not change the fact that their core leadership approach is still to control and manipulate their followers to achieve some narrow and idiosyncratic vision of the future. Benevolent leadership simply masks this ugly reality and is ultimately duplicitous. Even in the most open and collaborative organizations, followers understand their position as subordinates and the required role that is demanded of them. Our current leadership models squander the human capital under their control and exploit and waste the human and material resources of the earth at a rapacious rate.

This leadership process is not sustainable. We need leadership that is decentralized, deemphasized, and distributed across a large number of people at any level rather than concentrated in one ultimately flawed individual (Leithwood & Mascall, 2008; Mayrowetz, 2008; Portin, Alejano, Knapp, & Marzolf, 2006; Stern, 2002; L. Wright, 2008). While this model has its dangers if authority and power are not also distributed, it has theoretical potential to improve organizations (Leo & Barton, 2006).

We seem to be unable to actualize leadership models that depart from the singular, dominant, heroic model. The traditional paradigm and its influence permeate every aspect of our civilized world and drive the values we live by. As J. Ryan (2006) asserts: "Supposedly, followers need others to tell them what to do because they cannot be trusted to perform tasks on their own. This remains a popular view, despite evidence that points to the efficacy of other arrangements" (p. 100). Ryan underscores that our traditional leadership model is paternal, contradictory, and openly hostile to democratic principles and committed to power and control. It has a paternal and demeaning view of followers. The majority of the world's organizations continue to be structured by top-down leaders in equally top-down hierarchical pyramids of organizational power and authority that reinforce the values of traditional leadership while professing to be democratic in their ideals (Hatcher, 2005).

Traditional leadership is a thinly disguised charade that promises democracy while delivering oligarchy. Even benign institutions in society such as universities and churches are structured in this way; heavily cloaked under polite and reverent intellectual and moral male elitism and deferential relationships. Most scholarly academics who write critically about leadership and organizations happily coexist within rigid academic and institutional authoritarianism in their own faculties while compartmentalizing their situation to preserve their professional position. They are largely cuckolded academics. MacKinnon and Bullen (2005) describe Pierre Bourdieu's impatience with the restriction of this academic status quo: "Bourdieu's reflexive sociology 'tends to a kind of heroic stance against what he sees as the blindness and ahistoricity of an homogenized field of scholarly practice that insists naively upon its own singular and objective authority, oblivious to the perspective of "others" (p. 33; Sinclair, 2004). Gerda Lerner (1986) asserts this ahistoricity is the key to the exclusion of women from history, which is one of the major props of patriarchy. They embrace and enjoy its elitism to allow them to critically theorize about leadership and often repress radical scholarship through the weight of traditionalism in peer review.

Despite a number of leadership models that promote a more humane and democratic leadership vision and practice in theory (servant, distributed, professional, etc.), and the expanded participation of women as leaders in the world, the fundamental core paradigm and practice of leadership as power and control remains unchanged and rests firmly in the hands of men (B. Maxcy & Nguyễn, 2001). As Woods (2002) notes regarding Michael Fullan's (2001) view of the democratic leader:

Influential writings in leadership and management—both generic contributions to the field and specifically educational—tend to conceive democracy and democratic leadership in the narrower vein, in the sense that they are divorced from deeper philosophical and political questions. In Fullan (2001: 35, 42) for example, the democratic leader is brusquely defined: he or she “forges consensus through participation”, which includes “seeking and listening to doubters”. In this, Fullan parallels Goleman (2002). (p. 4)

Woods makes the important point that even democratic leadership is narrowly conceptualized within the singular, assertive traditional model that essentializes its complexity. Leadership cannot be decontextualized from the larger philosophical and political questions within society, as O'Sullivan (2001) argues, that bring its efficacy and ethics into question. It continues to be a negative and corrosive force while being presented as a required quality of anyone who wants to take on any level of responsibility in society. Despite its violent and destructive past, leadership is ironically revered in the history of civilization and is an obsessive modern organizational icon (Pellegrini & Scandura, 2008). We idolize those who dominate. We should be deeply suspect of the motivations of leaders and individuals who are drawn to this type of leadership. They are Type-A personalities ill-suited to empowerment and democracy.

In contrast, truly open and democratic leadership is driven by values that believe in real formal and informal (not token) shared decision making and power, equity, equality, and consensus and the peaceful resolution of differences in social interactions (Hatcher, 2005; Stewart, 2006). Such a democratic society also transitions into a social democratic society that values equity of wealth distribution as well as opportunity and outcome distribution. Bates (2006) underscores the need for social justice values to underpin leadership and education: “Social justice in education, as elsewhere, demands both distributive justice (which remedies undeserved inequalities) and recognitional

justice (which treats cultural differences with understanding and respect)” (p. 154).

We have excellent evolving examples of this type of society in our world today in the Scandinavian countries who model successful social democratic principles that are for the most part ignored by the rest of the world, which is resolutely mired in competitive, destructive, free-market social organization. These are not sinister, malevolent forces that are attempting to control society but benevolent societies that are seeking the best way to bring substantive and deliberative democracy and freedom to their people in every manner possible within a free-market system (Blackmore, 2006; Giroux, 2004; LiPumaa & Koelbleb, 2009; Reid, 2005). They place their priorities in different places. In Scandinavia they actually believe that society is a shared enterprise for everyone and they back it up with policies and laws that reflect that. In the rest of the world we believe that society is designed for the many to serve the few to satisfy individual needs (Woods, 2004). Scandinavian societies are by no means perfect but they are far advanced in terms of their social architecture and should be a model for the rest of the world (A. Johnson, 2005).

Societies in the West studiously ignore the successes achieved by the Scandinavian social democracies because their success itself is a criticism of Western capitalist democracies and their lack of progress on social issues such as poverty and wealth (Hertz, 2003; Wilkinson & Pickett, 2010). The social philosophy of these countries is diametrically opposed to the style of traditional leadership and produces completely different outcomes. Democratic leaders do not force issues to closure to efficiently get a decision as frequently happens under traditional leadership; they allow the democratic process to come to a natural conclusion (Woods, 2004).

Despite our claims of living in democratic societies, truly democratic leadership of this kind is in little evidence. Modern leaders will allow decision processes to continue as long as they are proceeding within the parameters of outcomes that they personally endorse, but if they appear to be deviating from these the leader will move to force closure on the process and ignore the direction established by shared dialogue. Traditional leaders are constantly manipulating the situation to meet their target outcomes. The system of traditional leadership is bankrupt and fraught with problems. It fosters a lack of trust, which is fundamental to constructive human relations.

Democratic leadership creates an entirely different template and socialization process for the world than the leadership models we currently practice and advocate (Hertz, 2003). It also operates politically in a diametrically

different way from current governments that function like democratically elected partisan fiefdoms. While we use the words *democracy* and *democratic nations* liberally in Western society, there is little that is democratic about these countries or their leaders when they are placed under critical scrutiny (Berger, 1982). They are simply relatively more benevolent and benign dictators in relation to other political institutions around the world but they do not even begin to approach a truly free and democratic system. As Carole Pateman (2004) points out:

Individual freedom as autonomy or self-government has been neglected in the academic debates about stakeholding, but it is central to democracy. Modern (universal) democracy rests on the premise that individuals are born, or are naturally, free and are equal to each other. That is to say, they are self-governing or autonomous. If their self-government is to be maintained they must become citizens with rights, and interact within institutions that further autonomy. In this conception, freedom includes not only individual economic (private) opportunities, and the opportunity to participate in collective self-government, but also individual autonomy. The latter tends to be over-looked, in part because "democracy" has become identified with collective (national) self-government, especially through "free and fair elections." (p. 91)

Modern democracies and their leaders continue to create a reality that promotes individualism over collectivism, adversarialism over cooperation, subordination over autonomy, domination over freedom, competition over collaboration, conflict over consensus, and acquiescence over resistance as the primary enduring values of Western societies. In the ongoing paradoxical deception of capitalist democracy the latter are formally encouraged while the former are the real values-in-use. Cooperation is only encouraged as a support for the status quo and in competition with others. Traditional leadership and politics in Western democracies coexist and are in direct conflict with peaceful, nonviolent democratic values of equity, equality, autonomy, and freedom that most people support and desire. Any attempts to create the latter will produce an authoritarian response from the former. The outcomes of democratic protests at the G20 Summits are a case in point. Peaceful demonstrators are always confronted with riot police, security fences, and tear gas to provoke violent confrontations that are employed to demonize dissent (Herman & Chomsky, 2002). Representative governments no longer represent the will of the people—simply the will of the partisan ruling party. Government, even in democracies, has become a well-orchestrated charade (Roy, 2003).

Traditional leadership and the social culture it has created have actually promoted violence while professing to abhor it. Democratic leadership promotes openness, transparency, social equity, and justice for all and would result in dramatically less violence as disparities in income, employment, and wealth were reduced and eliminated by policies that sharply limit violence, control the ravages of capitalism, and actively redistribute wealth through taxes and government policies such as during the Eisenhower years of Keynesian economics following World War II (Ferguson, 2011). Free enterprise would be converted to "fair" enterprise under democratic governments where the needs of society supersede the need for individual wealth accumulation. These changes are also extremely threatening to the status quo. If we are to change our world, we need to reform not only our patriarchal leadership culture from a violent to a nonviolent one but we also need to change our entire approach to education, economics, and socialization in society to produce citizens who believe in and practice nonviolent and fully democratic approaches in their daily lives, and particularly in the sharing of wealth (A. Johnson, 2005). The majority of society already understands this but the top 1% of elites in society need to be taught these values and required to adhere to them.

This means radically altering our personal, community, and national social development, structure, and process to create future generations of citizens who think, believe, and act differently than those under our current model and this is the important role of education. As Femea (2003) asserts, changing familial social upbringing to respect both genders in Middle Eastern societies is the only real long-term process that will transform patriarchy to equality.

The same is true of patriarchy in the West and around the world. Real change can only occur by re-socializing society away from patriarchal leadership and family and societal relationships and values and toward balanced, equitable, and respectful personal relationships between men and women and people everywhere. We can do this gradually or have the world descend into a human conflagration that will teach us the lessons of peaceful coexistence the hard way. It is a case of pay-me-now or pay-me-later.

The only way to accomplish that is to begin with a serious and protracted dialogue about this process to begin to raise awareness of this global issue. Rather than an economic forum we need world forums on patriarchy and its impact and what to do about it. If we solve patriarchy, we solve everything else. If we change patriarchy, we will change the world. A myriad global problems will improve if male patriarchal attitudes are changed. This is the

responsibility of men worldwide to begin this process of self-awareness because it is men who are primarily responsible for the destabilized, conflicted, violent, and inequitable situation that the world finds itself in; it is they who must begin to fix it. As an entire human species we must begin to speak truth to power. Men who abhor violence must begin to speak out loudly for change against patriarchy in all its forms and this includes church leaders and the traditional patriarchal societies of the Middle East and East Indian cultures. Men need to begin walking the talk. The patriarchal caste system must be dismantled around the world with the same commitment that ended colonialism. (Lerner, 1993).

By taking a neutral or a positive approach to violence, we endorse it. Clearly, if violence was uncontrollable we would all be dead. Violence is a human choice that can be managed with a concerted social effort to do so. In contrast, modern materialist society revels in both vicarious and actual violence of all kinds through sports, video games, music videos, movies, television programs, gun violence, domestic abuse, and human conflict around the world. We also have a "violence economy" that generates great wealth by silently enslaving workers around the world to produce massive wealth and profits from producing consumer goods and the weapons and tools of war. Patriarchy and capitalism are deeply interwoven. If the violence economy were transformed into a "peace economy," poverty and inequity would be a thing of the past. If profits were redirected to support working families with full-time work, benefits, and pensions and if the war economy was diverted into social justice causes, humanity would flourish. We need to start beating our swords into ploughshares instead of the other way around. If all the money and effort that currently goes into designing and producing weapons of more and more efficient destruction were put into eradicating disease and poverty, the world would be transformed in a short time. A significant portion of many G7 domestic economies come from some form of arms manufacturing, particularly the United States. We worship violence as the way of solving problems as well as a profitable enterprise. We profit from death every day. The NRA is the most powerful lobby in America that defends arms producers. In reality the NRA should be declared a terrorist organization since it actively contributes to massive human carnage each year in America. We idolize leaders whether good or bad and we promote the habituation of violence in our culture through our movies, sports, electronic games, and media. If we cannot get our way through discussion, we force our view on others through violence. Whether in the home through domestic abuse, the community through gun violence, or the

world through armed conflict, we constantly use violence as the final arbiter of disputes. We are still in many ways an uncivilized, barbaric society.

We cannot have it both ways. We either commit to eliminating violence in all its forms from our society or we accept a continuing spiral of destructive aggression in our global culture leading to a catastrophic disaster in the future. We cannot keep talking out of both sides of our mouth. This means closing arms factories, sharply reducing the military, controlling police and security forces, ending the "space race" as well as aggressively sanctioning violence of all kinds and enforcing it through a strong democratic and just global legal system. It means creating an entire new nonviolent socialization process from the cradle to the grave and a nonviolent, non-aggressive competitive sports culture. If we commit to getting rid of violence we must also commit to getting rid of traditional leadership. The latter is not an option. Violence can and should be actively suppressed in individuals, communities, and governments worldwide in real and active—not token—ways. There is no redeeming or uplifting element in witnessing or glorifying violence in any way. We need to engage in some deep soul-searching to begin a global change process that reforms our economic processes and our corporate values to support constructive, collective social development toward positive human interaction.

A key part of violence reduction is the equitable distribution of the wealth and power in society to create stable social structures and reduce the main sources of conflict: greed, wealth, and power. This means reforming free-market capitalism to become fair-market capitalism. Whether in the home, organizations, governments, or between nations, balanced power offers democracy to all participants and creates truly consensual decision making. Wherever there is a power imbalance, there can be no legitimate consensus.

Violence reduction must become the number one priority of democratic societies but not by treating the result through incarceration, but by treating or controlling the cause at the source. This is not only efficient but cost effective as well. Violence appears overwhelming and pervasive, but with some simple and global legislative changes violence can be sharply reduced. Guns must be treated like drugs and have their production and distribution carefully controlled. It is time for the United States to cede their Second Amendment rights for the good of their own society. Nothing and everything will change if they do so. If we are the civilized society we claim to be like the U.S. then the need for self-protection should be declining yet instead it is increasing. We seem to be regressing to a deregulated, lawless future much like the romanticized Wild West of the past in economic, personal, and political terms.

This does not mean that violence will be eliminated overnight, but the overriding formally promoted philosophy must be nonviolent and will require the re-socialization of these values into each generation, leading to a gradual change in attitudes regarding violence. We live in a world where distrust is a core value. In short, we need to start taking violence and its influences seriously if we hope to survive into the next millennium. This means re-examining our entire social and economic culture from sports to parenting to movies and entertainment to eliminate the psychological modeling of violence in our society. We need to restructure our thinking about the responsibility of business to not only economic activity but also social justice. The private sector creates the vast majority of all wealth produced and as such has a global responsibility to distribute that wealth directly to citizens, employees, communities, owners and shareholders. We need a new social contract.

Making weapons production illegal except in the case of the military and police would cut off the supply of weapons flowing into society and significantly reduce violence and death around the world. The strict control and close tracking and monitoring of arms production, sales, and distribution would prevent violent individuals and organizations from gaining access to weapons that fuel conflicts while also sanctioning those who profit from misery through arms production. Nuclear non-proliferation treaties need to be followed by weapons non-proliferation treaties as well. Death by instant annihilation has no different result than death by a thousand rounds. Gun violence is no less dangerous than nuclear war. All of this requires a new global commitment from adversaries and allies to work together to forge a new global community with shared values, aspirations, and goals. The alternative is extinction.

In addition, the major religions of the world must stop proselytizing male theology and encouraging violent behavior toward other faiths and begin the process of de-structuring the male control of their institutions. They must start actively realizing the peace they so often speak of. Major religions must also critically examine their male beliefs systems that entrench inequity and gender violence daily. If we are truly serious about violence, these steps would make immediate and long-term improvements for society to create the real contemporary vision of full gender equity their religious deities supposedly promote. It must be a concerted effort across the world. Exposure to violence raises one's tolerance of it. There are some core human moral positions that are required to continue to develop a healthy and positive social culture.

The most important thing society can do is to carefully monitor the social development of young people to ensure their experiences are as positive,

equitable, and nonviolent as possible. Exposing young people to all forms of adult language, behavior, and misbehavior at an early age is wrong and distorts their psychological development at a critical time when it is in its sensitive formative stages. Once these changes are made, they become part of who that person is as an adult. We need to embrace a morality not based on theology but humanity.

This will mean a radical change to our leadership and gender models, education, economics, culture, parenting, politics, sports, and most importantly religion. Democratic societies must be willing to take a stand on fundamental, shared, and collectively supported moral and ethical issues and make difficult decisions to restrict free enterprise and free choice for the greater good of society to protect social development and democracy from the invasive effects of commercialized violence. "Free" enterprise doesn't mean that anything goes; it means a qualified freedom subject to the limits of shared collective censorship in a fully functioning democracy. Free enterprise needs to become redefined as "fair enterprise." This would work to regulate the economy through the active intervention of a new, reinvigorated fully democratic government. The private sector has convinced society that they are exempt from financial, social, or moral responsibility in any sustainable form unless they decide what that responsibility will be. Anything that has a destructive impact on society cannot claim democratic rights. Tobacco companies do not have the democratic right to kill millions of people every year. The production and sale of tobacco should be more strictly controlled just like any other hard narcotic. The industry must be phased out. Alcohol should be similarly regulated. We need to be equally active in pressing the case for a moral humanity as well as a democratic society that has a legitimate right to restrict economic and human activity that is harmful to that society. Our current view of corporate freedom is a distortion of democratic principles. It is freedom without democracy but by the law of the jungle. Rather than deregulation, we need aggressive regulation by governments, but regulation based on democratic, pluralistic values, not self-interested corporate ones (Schafer, 2008).

We cannot excuse violence of any kind as a harmless diversion or a necessary evil. The amoral approach of competitive individualism heavily promoted by capitalism has corrupted our society from the inside out. Actively restricting violence in the media, electronic games, music, and other socially sensitive areas is important to creating a society that is psychologically sound, well-balanced, moral, and accepting of nonviolence. This means we must radically change the gender socialization of boys away from macho chauvinism

toward a nonviolent, neutral gender identity. This doesn't mean changing who boys are but simply raising less violent men. Reducing or eliminating violence and violent male activities may infringe upon the civil rights of certain commercial interests and the traditional domain of macho sports, but they must be subordinated to the greater good of a democratic society and particularly the next generation if we are to have any hope of changing our violent social culture. While a few hunters' rights may be abrogated by a gun ban, a number of sports fans might have to find new, less-violent pastimes, and children may be denied participation in some violent contact sports or video games, the lives of billions of people worldwide who die in wars and human violence far outweigh these selective rights. Once changes have been instituted, they would become accepted as the "new normal."

We cannot hope to reduce or eliminate violence in our society when we socialize every generation into a patriarchal and violent male-worship culture and base our economic success on arms production, exploitation, and war. Democracy is not about anything goes; it's about anything goes that creates positive outcomes for the vast majority of society—there's a huge difference that we seem to have lost sight of. Weapons reduction and harm reduction go hand in hand. The less exposure to violence we have, the better. Changing this starts with adults accepting responsibly for changing their practices at the familial to global levels. We should be as vigilant and attentive to the signs and symbols of violence and poverty in our daily cultural activity as we are about Ebola and SARS.

In the same manner, we cannot hope to reduce violence and social unrest when we do not provide satisfying employment for everyone who wants it, food for those who need it, and water for those who are thirsty or share the wealth that is currently being created in fully equitable ways with employees and their communities around the world. This cannot be a voluntary commitment by the private sector but an imposed requirement by governments who truly believe in a democratic society and have the courage to stand up for society rather than corporate self-interest. Predatory free-enterprise capitalism must come to an end and be replaced by a carefully managed post-capitalist economic system. There is much about capitalism that has inherent value, but unrestricted profit is not one of them; it is the main source of the problem. Profits must be actively managed to control and stabilize the economy. We need to manage the reward/motivation profit curve just as aggressively as we do the wages for workers. Only these types of changes will ensure an economically sustainable and stable future for citizens around the world.

We need to revise economics into a system that actively encourages and demands the sharing of wealth and the creation of reasonable, clearly defined returns on investment. We cannot provide fuller employment and satisfying outcomes without controlling profit at the source, eliminating violence at the source, and distributing wealth across people in society rather than to a few selected elites. The modern Robber Baron era must end. We have been held hostage long enough by the purveyors of greed and self-interest. Real leadership will be required to accomplish this, not the superficial pseudo-status quo leadership that currently masquerades as such.

We need a new vision of leadership to accompany a new vision of democratic society that will enfranchise people rather than controlling them, free people rather than enslaving them, enrich them rather than impoverishing them, that will abandon private-sector privacy for full public disclosure and share the wealth of the world equitably and openly rather than hoarding it and hiding it (Niggle, 2003). We need a commitment from people worldwide to share the collective wealth they create and to create a society with laws based on that principle—a new Magna Carta of a future democratic society. This means that those who have benefited and been responsible for the corrupt system of the past will no longer be able to exploit, pollute, and pillage the earth and its peoples for their own benefit and will be held in contempt if they do. We need to reverse the enclosure of wealth and return to freely and willingly distributing wealth.

Rather than leadership we need “peopleship”—a new leadership paradigm that focuses collectively and equally on people as leaders rather than special individuals and makes a clean break from its previous practice and its historical linguistic legacy of meaning. Peopleship is leadership without elite leaders, authority without position, organization without hierarchy, change without formality or coercion, and democracy without politics or power. It is about people living, leading, working, deciding, and acting together and peacefully without fearing potential domination or discrimination—not in competition, but in concert and through consensus where all at the table are real equals and all share in the positive discussion and collective decisions that are being made. Under such a system formal organizational authority would be abandoned in exchange for the authority of ideas, reasoned argument, and debate (Lerner, 1997). The consensual rule of the open, democratic majority would prevail, not the elite, authoritarian minority as has been the case. Organizations would become hubs of positive discussion and creative decisions as everyone would be empowered to engage in a new way of making decisions and running organizations without

fear of recrimination, intimidation, or career damage—for the people, by the people, and with the people—both literally and figuratively. For once in society, individuals would feel they were truly equal partners in a group, organization, or country. This would be real and not fake empowerment. In order to succeed, it would require a new era of openness and transparency in all social engagement and particularly in economics. The age of private-sector secrecy and confidentiality must end for positive shared humanity to begin.

Such democracy would be immensely enhanced with today's electronic communication. Electronic plebiscites, referendums, and votes that harness the positive potential of social media can be solicited daily on a wide variety of topics to direct leaders in organizations and governments to pass policies and laws that improve society through increased participation of those affected. Partisan political parties must give way to unaffiliated, collective governments that vote on all issues as individuals representing the wishes of their own communities. Every vote would be a free vote. The privileged lobby status of business or anyone else in this relationship would end with all parties having equal ability to influence their governments, their organizations, their workplaces, without repercussions.

Government should be insulated from formal lobbying and influence to maintain its democratic objectivity. All votes should be equal with no veto or caucus control. Whenever there is an impulse to concentrate or focus leadership, power or wealth, democracy is at risk. Peopleship is congruent with the ideals of democracy described by Lindeman as cited by Brookfield (2005):

At its root, living democratically was seen by Lindeman as an adult learning process. It required its participants to study and become increasingly adept at practicing a number of democratic disciplines. These included learning to honor diversity, learning to live with the partial functioning of the democratic ideal, learning to avoid the trap of false antithesis (where we are forced to choose between either/or, mutually exclusive options), learning to accept the compatibility of ends and means (where we avoid the temptation to bypass the democratic process in the interests of reaching speedily a decision regarded as obviously right and necessary), learning to correlate the functioning of social institutions (health, education, and social services) with democratic purposes, learning collective forms of social and economic planning, learning to live with contrary decisions, and learning to appreciate the comedy inherent in democracy's contradictions. (p. 62)

Rather than elite government leaders meeting to discuss the economy, a diversity of groups concerned about social justice issues should also be present or available through video conferencing, and their views should be taken

seriously in decision making. Divergent views would not be spurned, mocked, or demeaned but welcomed and celebrated. Such a model would be truly democratic, enfranchising, and liberating and would result in a radical restructuring of society along the lines of shared, collective goals and realities rather than adversarial, restricted, self-interested, short-term, and utilitarian ones. As positive as these changes would be they require overcoming the hurdle of democratic capitalism and our current corrupt democracy. In effect, we must break out of the democratic gulag.

The More Things Change, the More They Stay the Same

Regrettably what has occurred is that we now have organizations that formally appear more open, collaborative, consensual, equitable, and fair on the surface but whose underlying reality is unchanged (Brown, 2006; Cambron-McCabe & McCarthy, 2005; Colvin, 2007; Stewart, 2006; Wright, 2008). They are now populated with more women who are leading like men, more women who are acting stereotypically like women, and more men who are acting stereotypically as men always have. We are regressing in the midst of progression. Nothing has been done to change the meaning and dynamics of gender relationships or leadership dynamics in any significant or meaningful way. Women who have broken through the glass ceiling are portrayed as successful at breaking down gender barriers because they have won at the men's game, when in reality they have lost by replicating male institutions and values (Woodd, 1997). The liberation of women has led to their further enslavement—now to the cultural ideal of patriarchy.

Women have become convinced that equality and success are achieved by beating men at their own game rather than reinventing the game with a new set of fair and equitable rules for *all* players. Real, lasting, deep-seated change in the nature of power, gender relationships, or understandings has not occurred. The only real changes for women have been superficial ones for white, middle-class women who were the primary beneficiaries of women's liberation and changing social attitudes in the 1960s (Brookfield, 2005). Only the future will tell whether men, women, and minorities in society will be able to advance beyond this phase of polarized, segregated, and divided social development to one of more balanced equity between the sexes and social groups.

We continue to be primarily a neopatriarchal society now dominated by both men and women that presents the façade of being more fair and equitable while in reality continuing to be rooted in traditional, stereotypical, male chauvinistic values. These values have also made a strong resurgence over the past 20 years as neoconservative and neoliberal values have reclaimed our social, political, and economic landscape. We have come full circle to a time preceding the 1960s. We are in the midst of a period of modern historical regression within progression as society advances in the areas of science, technology, quality of life, and intellectual successes while regressing in social and gender relations and global equity as patriarchy reasserts and confirms its ongoing dominance. This happens not only actively through women who have assumed patriarchal roles in society but also through men who continue to maintain their own role in the gender status quo and also by both women and men who acquiesce to patriarchy in their personal relationships and domestic environments. Males continue to dominate family relationships and females continue to take unconsciously submissive roles by deferring to their male partners, despite years of affirmative action and consciousness-raising by feminist groups and society at large. The effect is to socialize both women and men into an entrenched patriarchal view of society (Davies & Carrier, 1999). Both genders must change their approach to gender socialization to achieve change (Grogan, 2005). This is what Rosalind Miles (1993) refers to as the "patriarchal clawback" that reduces women's gains over time (p. 279).

Gender relationships and roles are also not the only area in a period of stagnation or regression. Many areas of social progress have been rapidly eroded during the past several decades. Union membership, rights, and participation are dropping, wage settlements, Medicare, and pensions are at risk, and working people are under attack around the globe (Hertz, 2003). A similar situation has occurred in the area of civil rights in the United States and elsewhere since the death of the charismatic leader Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. The civil rights movement dissipated and has become a mere shadow of its former self. Many of the gains in awareness and changes in practices that were pioneered by the protests during the 1960s have been reabsorbed by U.S. and world society. We live in a pretend democracy with carefully orchestrated structures to create the appearance, not the reality, of democratic life. As Petras and Veltmeyer (2001) note, capitalist democracies' support for democracy is contingent upon the continuance of the economic system as it is and will respond with violence if the traditional economic basis of profit and property are threatened and with elite policy and legal responses if society is not compliant.

In addition, women are not the only ones required to submit to the patriarchal regimen. Patriarchal cultural values are structured in a hierarchal pyramid of importance in which aggressive white male dominance is most valued and rewarded and in which other males who are less powerful and aggressive take on secondary or subordinate roles to other men. While all men have preferred status in our society, the majority of men also take on a submissive, subordinate role relative to more aggressive, dominant, and powerful males. White males have higher status than black or Asian males, who have higher status than white women, who have higher status than women of other cultures, and so on (McGee Banks, 2000). Patriarchy sets up a vertical pecking order based on Darwinian survival of the fittest values rooted in aggression, violence, and control that is unsustainable practically, morally, or ethically as society evolves (O'Sullivan, 2001). We are currently seeing the destabilizing influence of these values in conflicts around the world and in the economic imperialism of globalization.

Male leadership dominance is still revered in Western countries and around the world to the exclusion of all else. Openly patriarchal cultures still actively exist in many African, Middle Eastern, and East Indian cultures where the male role is unquestioningly dominant and women are openly subordinated as reflected in "honor killings" of young women by their fathers or families and the dismissive attitudes of men toward women in the East Indian countries where various horrific sexual assaults have recently occurred (Al-Jenaibi, 2010; Sanal, 2008). The most visible examples of this today are the burkas worn by many Muslim and Arabian women and the primitive practice of female genital mutilation still carried out in a number of African nations (A. Johnson, 2005; Monagan, 2010). In developed First World countries patriarchy has become sublimated within society and its presence only implied or suggested without being directly in evidence.

Women as a group have colluded—as do all those who perpetuate social systems—in their own subordination through an acceptance and tolerance of this pattern, particularly modern women who are fully cognizant and yet compliant with the structural inequities of a patriarchal society despite having the positions and the power to change it (Lerner, 1986; Mackinnon & Bullen, 2005). As Seymour Sarason famously said of his pessimistic projections of the failure of school reform, the more things change, the more they stay the same (Gitlin & Margonis, 1995).

EDUCATION

One of the most important functions of a vibrant democratic culture is to provide the institutional and symbolic resources necessary for young people and adults to develop their capacity to think critically, to participate in power relations and policy decisions that affect their lives, and to transform those racial, social, and economic inequities that impede democratic social relations. — Henry Giroux, 2000

Education, leadership, religion, and economics are the core pillars of the democratic gulag. Education is the institution that is most evocative of the methods and influences of patriarchy and leadership and their role in socializing each generation into their values. They work in conjunction to ensure the continuance of the status quo. Education is pivotal and emblematic of the invisible power of patriarchy. It is the incubator of the patriarchal reality and the prime socializer of society after parents. Thus, understanding the role of patriarchy and leadership in education is critical to changing the status quo of society. It is the vehicle through which the values that a society wishes to imbue in its future citizens are inculcated in its people. It is also the key disseminator of the social and cultural expectations of the public, governments, and the corporate sector. The values of the rest of society are condensed in the educational enterprise. Every aspect of patriarchal society is heavily invested and directly involved in carrying out its important mission.

Education is the most powerful force in social development and evolution whether it happens formally or informally. This is why it deserves our full attention at all times to ensure it is consistent with the aspirations and democratic desires of all of society, whether they are able to articulate those desires or not. Education should be the greenhouse of democracy, modeling the fundamental tenets of its promise as well as challenging its presentation in our social organization. As a result, education and its functioning are an important and revealing area of study. It is also a microcosm of the effects and problems created by the democratic gulag. It is a model example of how it works and the pervasive subtleties of its effects. It is always highly politicized despite presenting itself as being apolitical because it is through education that patriarchy reproduces itself.

Because of its important role in sustaining ideologies and power, education is always closely controlled by governments and, through them, the private sector. Because education leads people to question their circumstances and to understand them, including their injustices, fundamentalist groups of all kinds like ISIL despise education because it threatens their power and position. This is why unlike other professions such as medicine and law, teaching is highly bureaucratic, regulated, and monitored. It conveys the social capital that is required to ensure the uninterrupted continuance of the system. The intents and effects of education are rarely questioned or challenged—especially in democratic societies such as North America and Europe. We rarely examine the insidious influences and structures of education and their negative impacts on social development or its regressive impact on the development of democratic life from a critical perspective. The values of a particular society are inculcated into the next generation of citizens through it, for better or worse.

Ironically, education is the place where there is the least substantive critical discussion, debate, and focus on the negative influence of power and control in democracy and education itself and how that power influences the values, attitudes, and beliefs that each represents. There is also little critical discussion about the effects of a ponderous, unwieldy bureaucracy on the ability of education to deliver a critical democratic citizenry. There is a definite inertial bias toward power and control and the status quo in both (Hodgkinson, 1991; White, 1989). Bascia (2001) points out how this social context has negatively influenced the evolution of democratic practice in education. Attempts to establish democratic schools have been marginalized by the traditional authoritarianism and bureaucracy of most education systems and their white, male bias toward the management of education that has restricted the role

and authority of women: "Such systemic inequities perpetuate the primacy of particular points of view within the educational system, serving to reinforce dominant interests in the larger society and to ensure that educational processes reproduce rather than challenge the social status quo" (p. 249).

Patriarchal, white, authoritarian, hierarchical thinking and administration; private sector values; scientific rationalism; and the Industrial Revolution have all worked in conjunction to deeply influence both democracy and education in specific ways along with all other areas of society. These forces skewed both away from a democratic structure and toward an educational, economic, and political oligarchy (Dunleavy & O'Leary, 1987). Rather than being liberating as education should be, it is and has been constricting and restraining. In structure and operation education mimics the impersonal, hierarchical, bureaucratic, and authoritarian organization of Max Weber and the Scientific Management philosophies of Frederick Taylor. It was designed to serve the needs of the economic system and its elites, not the aesthetic or autonomy needs of its citizens or workers (Pateman, 2004).

In contrast, a democratic system would have significantly different human priorities and structures that would reflect different collective values that interrupt the flow of publicly trained workers from the education system. The job of a democratic education system should not be primarily to educate students for employment but to educate students to be responsible, critically thinking adults—there's a major difference. One is utilitarian, the other is humanitarian. The former without the latter led to the atrocities of World War II in Germany. While many educational mission statements and provincial and state documents assert the latter, the former is more often the case. The former is narrowly focussed on the moving target of employment prospects and skills to the exclusion of all else—the latter is focused on providing a wide-ranging liberal arts educational experience that encompasses a broad range of disciplines and creates intelligent, critical, and balanced citizens who can take their place in a democratic society. The present drive for utilitarianism in education threatens this goal.

Unfortunately, our economic system has no interest in this outcome and only desires dutiful employees who will fit in and not question the values or actions of the system they work in. A system based primarily on creating employees for the economy can become a system that is sharply narrowed to technical skills only, leaving citizens without the critical acumen or knowledge to question and challenge the society they are living in. This capacity is critical to the survival and development of democracy. Education under this

system becomes utilitarian instead of communitarian. To a large extent, this is how our current education system functions.

In short, a democratic education system would be a serious liability for the status quo of the private sector because it would operate and be structured democratically with values and employment directions that often would be in direct opposition to those of capitalism (Barlow, 1995). A fully democratic education system requires a fully democratic economic system to realize its ideal and a fully democratic political system as well. One cannot occur without the other. Thus it is impossible to understand the issues and problems related to education without fully considering the implications on its operation of economics. Capitalism sets the standards to which education speaks. Education functions within the context of free-market economics and the larger context of social patriarchy. Capitalism operates on values of individualism, competition, greed, and egocentric self-satisfaction and trains its leaders in these core beliefs to become self-satisfied "homo economicus" or economic man despite evidence that this model is fiction (McQuaig & Brooks, 2010). These ideals are diametrically opposed to true democratic values. Education was originally structured to meet those specific needs more than a century ago. It is fundamentally influenced by these values, beliefs, and attitudes. De-contextualizing education from this environment makes change irrelevant, ineffective, and isolated within its particular boundaries.

One also cannot ignore the issue of leadership, power, and gender in the educational and democratic debate. The impress of patriarchal male values and culture that pervades society continues to heavily influence the structure and values of education and socialized gender relationships (Walby, 2007). The patriarchal values of leadership are expressed directly in the educational establishment. Education employs large numbers of women as the majority of its teaching and support staff workforce (particularly at the elementary school level) throughout the world as it has throughout the 20th century since its inception (Bernard, Hill, Falter, & Wilson, 2004; Burman, 2005; Cubillo & Brown, 2003; Sanal, 2008). It is a reflection of the anachronistic value set that dominates society to this day. Women have traditionally held a subordinate and submissive position in the hierarchy of the domestic and public sphere and have been the handmaidens of patriarchy and leadership in elementary and secondary education. Custodial care and instruction of children were the assigned social roles of women in the home. As an extension of domestic care, teaching was considered suitable work for women in the early 20th century as much for economic reasons as for social ones and

continues to be a professional ghetto for women to this day (Danylewycz, Light, & Prendice, 1991, Parsons, 1964).

This has ensured that education was (and still is) controlled from the outside by largely male forces and by the private sector, including a variety of "experts" without serious challenge. It is the only profession that is so heavily top-down and controlled by a large, authoritarian bureaucracy designed specifically to dictate virtually every aspect of its structure and process (Young, 1994). This remains unchanged despite the increasing number of women in positions of responsibility. Their presence has provided a false reassurance that women's issues are being considered and the impression of progression within stasis that has characterized political change for women for centuries (Lerner, 1993).

Traditional professions such as medicine and law are equally bureaucratic and hierarchical but without the directly politicized organizational control that is exhibited in education where the public, governments, and the private sector regularly inject political demands on educators under the guise of economic needs, accountability, and involvement. They have also been largely dominated by men (until recently) but have not evolved in quite the same interventionist manner, although their treatment of women is equally patriarchal as are all job categories. Although they do have large bureaucracies of their own, they are far more professionally independent and self-directed than educators and much better remunerated. This reflects the undervaluing of women's work to society in the home and in education. Teachers are at the bottom of a professional valuing and pay hierarchy, both of which are interrelated within capitalist democracy. They are given the least respect and acknowledgment of all professions and this is closely related to the high percentage of women who work in this field. Because education is not based on hard science, it is also not given the same level of respect as other professions despite its modern complexity and massive academic research base.

Women as a group in education are far less likely to demand professional autonomy as the other professions have as a result of their history of subordinate socialization. Schools around the world continue to be filled by women teachers and were run by men until only the last 20 years or so when more women became school administrators (Anderson & Grinberg, 1998; Gitlin & Margonis, 1995). This change has been a double-edged sword for women who have successfully moved into positions of responsibility in elementary schools although their numbers dwindle as one proceeds up the educational hierarchy while entrenching an even stronger female presence in a field already saturated with women (Lerner, 1997; Sanal, 2008). This has led to

declining numbers of men interested in elementary teaching due to their view of elementary teaching as women's work and being underpaid (Bernard, Hill, Falter, & Wilson, 2004; Bolton & Muzio, 2008). Despite the growing number of female administrators (particularly at the elementary level) there is little real change in the leadership paradigm that governs their roles; they have simply replaced men in these positions. Male dominance, economic values, and a hierarchical bureaucratic structure do not bode well for the professional autonomy of female teachers, the development of democratic education, or the development of a democratic society.

The Historical Context of Education

Education is one of the major consumers of leadership theory, models, and advice. It is the most archetypal and openly symbolic of the influences of social control that govern our democracies (Osbourne, 2001). The history of mass public education and its organizational structure has been modeled from its earliest inception over a century ago on industrial factory models and authoritarian business leadership concepts. Modern education was set up to run like a factory, much like all the others at that time in England and North America, and to mimic a traditional family of the time where children should be seen and not heard, women were subordinate, and discipline was harsh. Spare the rod and spoil the child was taken literally and persists to this day in debates about corporal punishment and parental spanking.

The assembly line of the factory and the domestic subservience of children and women were replicated in education in the early 20th century and have remained with few changes as the model we still employ (Gallagher, 1995). Students were crammed into large urban public schools with small, overflowing classes run by a single teacher who was predominantly female (at the elementary level) because of simple economics—women could be paid much less than male instructors and teaching was considered the only appropriate work for a middle-class woman in the early 20th century (Newton & Zeitoun, 2003, Parsons, 1964). At the turn of the century a similar feminization of clerical positions from male to female occurred (Walby, 1990). Upper levels of education were solely populated by men and the cane was the primary method of discipline. Schools were to be run like businesses, with the lowest costs and highest return on investment. Conformity was the expectation. After a period of “progressive” change emphasizing educating the whole child, students were taught *en masse* using a heavily scripted curriculum.

In Ontario at one point, this was called *The Grey Book of Studies*, introduced in 1937. It virtually told teachers what to teach, when to teach it, and even what time to teach it. It was scripted because most teachers were female, unqualified, had limited training, and were considered incompetent—thus the scripted curriculum guide. This was the first “teacher proof” curriculum document (Kretovics, Farber, & Armaline, 1991) that was followed by many others, despite the increasing qualifications and training of modern professional educators. Male school inspectors would visit classrooms and criticize any deviation from the Grey Book (Young, 1994). Standardization and a consistent product were the goals just like factory production. Students were to be produced like widgets on an assembly line using the same principles as industrial assembly lines. These industrial theories were most popularly articulated by the efficiency theories of Frederick Winslow Taylor in his *Principles of Scientific Management* (Dufour & Eaker, 1999).

Schools, like factory assembly lines, were rigid, unrelenting, authoritarian, and demanding. For the last century, with occasional forays into more liberalized approaches such as open concept schooling in the 1970s in Ontario, formal education has been structured more or less on this “factory model.” Schools have been organized into segregated classes taught using the Socratic Method by teachers in a grade progression education system supervised by a large, conservative, and primarily male bureaucracy until recently (Gitlin & Margonis, 1995). It was an educational assembly line where a worker (the teacher) added a certain number of parts to the unfinished product at each stage of the production line, or at least that was how it was supposed to work. Education is a clear example of the difficulties of applying scientific principles to human development and behavior.

Schools employed a grading system much like industrial production to certify the quality of their products at the end of the process. Students were sorted into various social working classes based on their achievements in school. This sorting became their social class in society and their lot in life (Maynes, 2001). Education grades became the currency by which people purchased their quality of life, their social respect, professional or blue-collar status, and their value to society. Much of the expectations of students in this system were self-fulfilling prophecies. This is still the case today. Education came to be structured for the purpose of gaining employment, not for human development, personal advancement, or fulfillment as it had ideally been for the wealthy in the romantic period of the Enlightenment (Lerner, 1993).

Education for the masses (public education) was considered to be targeted at basic literacy and unskilled jobs that were abundant and in need early in the 20th century. In short, it was utilitarian and focused on producing workers with basic education for the factories of England and North America (Lerner, 1993; 1997). The type and amount of education you acquired became the admission into various social classes. Education was commoditized like any other item being produced. As part of this process, knowledge itself was commoditized and broken into collections of objective, rational “facts” related to individual topics (Portelli & Solomon, 2001). Scientific rationalism governed intellectual inquiry with empirical (statistical) studies replicated to prove hypotheses. These facts became the knowledge learned by students and tested by teachers. The entire system reflected the view of science, rationalism, and capitalism—powerful social concepts that were by and large conceived, developed, and implemented by male politicians, business leaders, thinkers, scientists, and academics. The worldview was one of knowable facts, objective and passionless analysis, control of the universe, and rational thinking governing behavior. They all reflected the dominant patriarchal modernist worldview held by men and imposed as normal upon the rest of humanity (A. Johnson, 2005; Lerner, 1993).

Rationalism and science were two of the major influences on modern education at this time. In conjunction with industrialization, they ushered in the era of modern public education, thinking, and theorizing that continues to dominate our social architecture. These developments reflected the new view of burgeoning science that the world was an uncontrolled and unpredictable place that could be tamed and ordered by the rational thinking of modern scientific study and could be understood, quantified, and controlled by rational thought and industrial processes (Parsons, 1964). This reflected the larger view that humans were superior to nature. It deeply affected subsequent theorizing in science as well as economics, education, literature, politics, and leadership theory. As Tetenbaum (1998) states:

When we entered the industrial era, the lens of Newtonian science led us to look at organizational success in terms of maintaining a stable system. If nature or crisis upset this state, the leader's role was to re-establish equilibrium. Not to do so constituted failure. With stability as the sign of success, the paradigm implied that order should be imposed from above (leading to top-down, command-and-control leadership) and structures should be designed to support the decision makers (leading to bureaucracies and hierarchies). The reigning organizational model, scientific management, was wholly consistent with ensuring regularity, predictability, and efficiency. (p. 22)

Scientific rationalism reinforced and justified already existing metaphysical, aristocratic, and ideological beliefs about power and domination with an objective and defensible base of social theory that created structures and practices of control and authority that have populated modern society (A. Johnson, 2005). In many ways men were searching for justifications for their power and authority in the world, and it is little wonder that they developed theories and knowledge that validated their perspective in a self-fulfilling prophecy of social development (Lerner, 1993). In effect the theories were created that fit the worldview that patriarchy promoted, leading to intellectual and scientific theorizing and social organizing that reinforced that presumption. These structures emphasized elite control over nature, people, the economy, politics, education, and personal social relationships permitted by divine right (Lerner, 1986). They justified social behavior that had formally existed based on belief and social tradition alone.

The dawn of rationalism and scientific study that accompanied the Industrial Revolution and with it the division of labor on the industrial assembly line changed the social focus from a holistic view of life to a compartmentalized, segregated, competitive, individualistic, and fragmented one. This had profound effects on the development of societal values and education that are still evident today. The way people worked deeply influenced how they felt, behaved, and acted in their personal and working lives as we shifted from an agrarian to an industrial society based on production and consumption. Work moved from being satisfying and self-fulfilling to being simplified, repetitive, and uninteresting even if it continued to provide subsistence living.

Scientific research came to be known by its focus on rational knowledge stressing observable facts, replicable studies to determine scientific laws, and a focus on the miniscule and the detailed as a way to understand the whole and reaching conclusions about the world. Deductive rather than inductive reasoning was prized by public choice theorists and others in society (Dunleavy & O'Leary, 1987). This meant that throughout the 20th century knowledge became shredded into innumerable simple facts that when collected together demonstrated patterns or laws of the operation of the natural universe, physical sciences, and human behavior. Obvious natural phenomena were not considered validated until they had been investigated and proven by extensive empirical science despite the inherent validity of extensive human experience. This development in science mimicked the effect of the division of labor on assembly lines within capitalist industry and deeply influenced other social behavior and decisions.

Scientifically rational study continues to drive our scientific and medical world today. While scientific rationalism worked most logically and effectively with natural phenomena, its application to human behavior and social policy was far more problematic and less predictable, or reliable (Fris & Lazaridou, 2007). Critical theory, in contrast, advocates the use of praxis or the movement between reflecting and acting on the world in a dialectical relationship with reality (Brown, 2006). Another pivotal change came with the publication of the seminal study *The Origin of Species* (1859) by Charles Darwin about evolutionary survival, which became the popularized foundation for modern psychology, anthropology, and sociology as well as modern free-enterprise capitalism and many personal values systems (Parsons, 1964; Schafer, 2008).

Education was the way of conveying this new way of viewing and understanding the world to the next generation of citizens. Its structure, values, attitudes, and beliefs reflected these larger values. Each level of education was like a miniature social production plant. Those with the least education were streamed into the lowest classes and ended up in the lowest paying and least stable jobs, while those with increasing levels of education were streamed into employment with more power, authority, and stature. Financial remuneration tended to rise with one's level of education. During each level of education, values are inculcated into students to prepare them to take their place in the class-based world they would live in. All this was done in a process that seemed quite rational, innocuous, normal, and logical. Praxis was not encouraged; learning information was.

Viewed from a critical perspective it also has a more sinister covert purpose consistent with other patriarchal institutions that provide the social structure of modern democracies. The industrial assembly line not only changed how we made goods but it also changed how we thought about ourselves, our society, and our future. The division of labor on the assembly line resulted in a fragmented subconscious psychological view of how relationships, communities, and the world should work. Competition and consumerism became the watchwords of society. The process and psyche of producing goods employing a chain of simple skills and independent parts assembled by a chain of low-skilled workers in a mindless series of simplified tasks requiring limited skill and creativity on an unrelenting mechanical assembly line shifted from one of creative, multi-talented, and intellectually stimulating processes completed by one skilled person under the guild system. Conditions that were poor under the guild system became unbearable under burgeoning capitalist industry. Education focussed on dry content and knowledge acquisition (Bolman & Deal,

2000; Seidman, 1994). It was the ultimate dehumanization of humankind—people as slaves to machines and knowledge as parodied by Charlie Chaplin in *Modern Times* and *I Love Lucy* in the chocolate assembly line episode. In *Modern Times* Chaplin is a worker in futuristic society that has enslaved humanity to the demands of machines and made human relationships secondary. In the *I Love Lucy* episode, Lucille Ball is employed as a factory worker on a chocolate assembly line where chocolates come out of a door and she is required to package them up. The assembly line soon overwhelms Lucy to hilarious effect. We have been slaves to machines ever since despite their many benefits to human life.

The production line created enormous increases in capacity, profits, and wealth for the owners of the factories but the opposite for their workers, who were paid less and less and often mercilessly exploited by rich industrial owners. The gap in wealth between the rich and the poor widened dramatically. For workers it resulted in a de-skilling of their labor and an increase in competition for jobs that drove wages down as more people (including women and children) competed for work to maintain a subsistence level of existence in the growing number of English factories (Hartmann, 1981). This in turn drove profits up as production increased dramatically. This economic consequence was directly related to the burgeoning capitalist free-market system that focused on individual property, wealth, consumption, and greed.

It is important to understand the interconnectedness of these developments in history that coincided and were coordinated by the growing new business class that developed with industrialization. Everything in life is interconnected and contextualized, and one must look at the linkages between developments in society to unpack their meaning for humanity much as post-structuralists would suggest. With its emphasis on individualization and simplification of skills, capitalism has deeply embedded this psychology in the human mentality. The compartmentalization of the assembly line and the fragmentation of knowledge into individual pieces of information individualized our psychological approach to social relationships and made economic competitiveness the bedrock of human behavior. Self-interested, self-satisfying “homo economicus” or economic man as foreseen by Adam Smith in his landmark work *The Wealth of Nations*, published in 1776, came into full being as a social, economic, and personal reality for people in the late 19th and early 20th centuries. Capitalism as conceptually described by Smith has deeply influenced and changed who we are, what we value, and how we relate to each other despite the generally selective and biased reading of Smith by

many free-market believers. Adam Smith validated the economic ideas of the wealthy toward wealth creation in the industrial age. We have fully internalized the values of individualism, consumption, and materialism as the only viable mode of social existence, personal fulfillment, and economic structure, despite its destructive self-consuming side effects.

Free enterprise establishes predatory, competitive, and adversarial relationships among people as its credo that intensifies the effects of patriarchy on society. The earth is a set of finite resources, a closed system that operates or not on the basis of the inputs into it. Early in the 20th century the availability of resources (both human and material) appeared to be endless and so industrial growth proceeded at a breakneck pace that continues to this day. The availability of the earth's resources vastly outnumbered users. In the past century this equation has reversed. Over the course of only 100 years we have consumed the vast majority of many of the world's finite natural resources (Schafer, 2008). This view of the earth has produced a serious threat to the survival of the human race. The by-products of industrial production continue to destroy the delicate balance of nature in ways that increase exponentially each year. Like a snowball rolling down a hill, the pace of production and population growth has been increasingly rapid and with it the damage being caused to fish stocks, animal species, and the water, air, and soil. The environmental damage that was previously localized and within the capacity of nature to survive it early in the 20th century has overloaded the ecosystem and become massive and catastrophic (Schafer, 2008). The survival of humanity is in real question if we continue to pursue this direction. In almost every case, new developments in production and education were not put to work to enhance the standard of living of the people who were producing the goods and services that factories began to create, but to increase the personal wealth of a few individuals who, often through an aristocratic lineage of cronyism, came to own the industrial factories of the turn of the century. This process continues unbroken today. The divine right of kings that was the hallmark of medieval royalty has now become the divine right of corporate kings in the new age of corporate monarchies. It could be aptly name the "divine right of things." For centuries, education has mimicked, reflected, and produced this reality for society.

Traditional factory education is of pivotal importance to the continuance of a patriarchal society and antithetical to the development of real open democracy in society. As a system, patriarchy and capitalism place a high priority on education, and thus it has been shaped and designed to support it.

Education has always been highly controlled by central governments because it is too important a propaganda tool to be left independently to any specific group of people such as educators (and particularly women) or to the will of the people who use it. This is why education remains highly bureaucratized, authoritarian and scripted to socialize citizens into industrial capitalist values. As Dobbin (1998) notes of the modern neoliberal corporate approach to education:

No area of policy escaped the zeal of the marketeers, but, of all the areas transformed, the effects in education are perhaps the most revealing. Because public education is such a critical area for creating an egalitarian society, neo-cons and market liberals focus a great deal of attention on reforming it. The free-market revolution is not just indifferent to social equality; it is hostile to it, believing it to be a barrier to rewarding those who excel. (p. 262)

Educators are expected to inculcate students into this belief structure without passing judgment on it in a neutral and objective way that does not impart any rebellious or critical consciousness within students. Passive compliance is both reinforced and rewarded in education and society. Even universities employ a rather sterile intellectual approach to issues that rarely encourages or models open resistance or revolution against the injustices being studied or real challenges to the presentation of democracy in our society. Ironically, in education—a field that is highly politically charged and influenced—political behavior of any kind by teachers is suppressed and forbidden. While neocons and neoliberals want educators to act like assembly-line employees, they are in fact highly educated, skilled, reflective, and experienced professionals who dedicate their lives to advancing the pure goals of education as praxis and resist such pressures, creating continuous conflict between the overriding authority of patriarchal institutions and the desire for autonomy of educators who work in the profession (S. Maxcy, 1991). These frictions have been steadily growing for decades. Political action by teachers or students is immediately sanctioned. Teachers are expected to be apolitical and unbiased in their dealings with students, and education is always sanitized of contentious political discussion or teaching critical of status quo society to ensure the proper compliance and submissiveness is socialized into students and teachers as they progress. Solomon and Allen (2001) make this point: “Teachers and others in the position of power are reluctant to unpack the invisible knapsack in a racialized society (McIntosh, 1990). Instead they unproblematically present success in school and society as meritocratic; as achievement based on

ability and hard work" (p. 234). The recent debate about the rights of students in schools to form gay/straight alliances is a contemporary example of this ongoing values struggle. With the current easy access to global information about issues, students can quickly see the irrelevance of the traditionalism of education and can also simply go around it with social media and other ways of communicating what they really believe.

Education Today

The control of education continues to serve a narrow authoritarian and patriarchal political purpose of reflecting and maintaining a widespread white, male status quo in society. For more than a century, our modern neopatriarchal, neoconservative Western society has used education as a sophisticated and indispensable tool of indoctrination into right-wing, democratic, capitalist values and more recently into the values of modern neopatriarchy while publicly espousing the values of democracy and autonomy. The real goal underlying business is the management of the business of society. Its ideology is not open to criticism or debate; it is only open to ceremonial discussions and what Herman and Chomsky (2002) refer to as "manufactured consent" created by media bias to maintain the pretence of democracy for the public while in reality operating in autocratic ways (Dobbin, 1998).

Our current education system is designed to serve the needs of this system. These commercial values are viewed as the unshakeable foundations of our social structure and thus are held sacrosanct. Competition is actively encouraged for marks, in sports and between schools. Particularly in the past 20 years, it has become increasingly corporatized and utilitarian. As the social pendulum once again swung heavily to the right in the 1990s, a renewed priority on accountability and training students for employment to fill the needs of private enterprise reasserted itself—marking and grading them like eggs became the mandate once again. The goal of a broad-based liberal arts education was all but abandoned leading to a narrowing of the curriculum to meet these needs (Fullan, 2001). The subjects that are now given primacy are those that can be empirically tested such as reading, math, and science as we go *Back to the Future* of the 1950s provincial exams while the "softer" subjects of the arts, physical fitness, social sciences, religion, philosophy, and even history are given less focus, funding, and interest because they are viewed by business and governments as having less relevance to the growing technological and utilitarian future of society. The goal of producing adult democratic citizens

that think critically and act responsibly toward democratic human goals guided by their conscience of social justice and fairness is viewed as a low priority or a waste of time and is fading with the focus instead on all-out amoral, rationalized competition for jobs in an unregulated private sector marketplace. Ironically, society and the job market are changing so rapidly that the goal of job preparation is illusive and impractical. Students would be better served to receive a broad liberal arts education until university or college or job placement where more specific skills can be learned.

Education, leadership, and economics all work in harmony to ensure that citizens comply with the social norms of patriarchy and democratic capitalism. It is a complex and convoluted system that has woven its tentacles around every aspect of society and thought to the point that it has disappeared from our social consciousness. We are now living in the world of *The Matrix* where reality is a manufactured product created by another darker reality.

Social concerns most often have an economic source so capitalism is heavily implicated in the shortcomings of our current world, yet it is rarely seen as the primary origin of these problems; nor is patriarchy. The goal of the system is to train people to be compliant and submissive to its social norms. Lack of order, routine, and expectation is dangerous to capitalism (Herman & Chomsky, 2002). It is exactly this type of situation that reflects real democracy, which is highly undesirable and threatening to Western countries. The goal of capitalism is to standardize outcomes, while the goal of democracy is to randomize them. The two forces are incompatible and constantly at odds with each other. The social mythology of free marketers is that capitalism promotes democracy when in fact the opposite is true. Capitalist democracy is dramatically different from, and has significantly different goals and beliefs than, a substantive democracy (Portelli & Solomon, 2001). The former believes in restricting democracy and social decision making to the interests of capitalist economic activity and its values, while the latter believes in liberating the same processes in the interests and values of the social goals of the majority of society and harnessing economics to achieve them. This was a view promoted by economists such as Karl Polanyi (McQuaig, 2001) and others (see Schafer [2008] for an excellent discussion of these concepts). True democracy does not restrict its function to any particular subset of democratic ideological beliefs but in fact is constantly striving to find new ways to allow these views to surface and determine what ideology is best for creating equity, equality, balance, and fairness in the world. Paradoxically, the more we embrace real democracy and freedom the less strife there will be in the world.

Our education system does not focus on democracy as one of its core tenets as the education system in Sweden does (Johansson, 2004). People such as teachers who support the concept of substantive and deliberative democracy have no difficulty with the sharing of power or working in flattened organizational structures (S. Ryan, 1999). They realize that this is the only road to true democracy, whereas opponents of this believe in traditional leadership, education, and economics that create hierarchical structures and power in society.

Rather than suppressing a diversity of discourse as capitalist democracy does, real democracy encourages it. True democracy mediates the discussion among all alternatives without giving precedence to any one alternative. It protects against ideological agendas, individuals, or groups dominating the decision making while still encouraging a full and enfranchising debate among various ideologies that have as their goal the sharing rather than the concentration of power and ensuring that decisions involve full, fair, and honest consultation leading to the most equitable and broadly supported conclusions. Real democracy thrives on full disclosure, capitalist democracy on restricted disclosure. Real democracy welcomes dissent to the table at G20 meetings and incorporates concerns in the discussion to defuse problems and break down barriers. It does not kettle and beat peaceful protesters. Capitalist democracy puts up security fences and promotes confrontations by deploying riot police. Real democracy suppresses ideologies that concentrate power and control to allow shared power and diluted control to flourish. This requires real leadership, real education, and real economics to achieve. It is slow and complicated, convoluted and difficult. Real democracy is inclusive; capitalist democracy is exclusive.

Education serves the values of our prevailing economic system. At all levels it heavily socializes compliance and the acceptance of the prevailing norms of the democratic capitalist state. Schools are highly bureaucratic and authoritarian. These methods are most often subtle and frequently invisible within our dominant social systems but they are effective nonetheless because they convince people of their veracity without requiring them to think about the issues they represent (Herman & Chomsky, 2002). Education needs to train students to always have a cautious and critical sense of their world perspective in 3D much like *Avatar*. We need to have a sixth sense of the context of our social, intellectual, moral, and psychological place in the world and its events and be aware of the forest and the trees at the same time. In short, we must practice praxis. It is much like the psychic awareness created by the Australian Aboriginal myth called *The Dreaming* where aboriginal people live in the past, the present, and the future all at the same time.

Today, the modern democratic gulag works through an increasingly powerful array of psychological, technological, and educational depersonalization tools at its disposal: economics, technology, the media, formal education, religion, politics, social pressure, sanctions, etc. to incrementally erode and overwhelm resistance to the dominant patriarchal capitalist mythology, practices, and beliefs. We are assaulted every day by the blitzkrieg of patriarchy comparable to the invisible waves of UV radiation that bombard earth each day in sunlight. Education is a society-wide conditioning of young people into the values of competitive capitalist democracy and away from real substantive, deliberative democracy (LiPumaa & Koelbleb, 2009) and critical thinking.

As it is currently, a minority of powerful and rich elites determine what is best for the rest and force their self-interested agenda on society just as they have for thousands of years. They have gained absolute power over society and are a dangerous threat to humanity. Corporate, military, academic, and religious leadership elites and business groups dominate the discussions and decision making of governments and school systems and have preferential access to government themselves, while the majority of citizens, educators, doctors, nurses, and other working people are disenfranchised from real democracy and have access to few tools to change the system. They are observers of democracy, not full participants. Elites and experts define the knowledge base surrounding leadership, economics, and education and police its practice worldwide (Apple, 2006). Self-interest and self-preservation dominates their positions and their actions.

We are immersed in the values of capitalism, consumerism, materialism, self-interest, competition, and greed from the time we are born and become habituated to its norms. Capitalist democracy is deceptive because people around the world aspire to achieve the kind of limited democracy that Western societies have achieved, but this form of democracy is only appealing relative to the other, more negative alternatives in the world today. It is the best (and some might argue the worst) of a bad lot, not the best it can be. It is the worst because it has perfected using people for utilitarian reasons. Capitalist democracy is a deceptive and insidious form of social control that in many ways is more dangerous than overt political organizations, and education is the vehicle that transports it.

The Educational Bureaucracy

Traditional leadership and bureaucracy are symbiotic. Bureaucracy reflects the power hierarchy of leadership and patriarchal values. Education is one of the

most exemplary institutions of this concept. As Sinden, Hoy, and Sweetland (2004) observe:

School structure is inevitable. Schools have boards, superintendents, assistant superintendents, principals, assistant principals, teachers, and students. In spite of all the discourse about flat structures, empowerment, teacher participation, and reform, schools like all organizations have hierarchies. Regardless of the reform rhetoric, hierarchy of authority in schools persists. In fact, the accountability movement itself demands more, not less, hierarchy. (p. 198)

Weberian bureaucracies are the abstract visualizations of the hierarchy of leadership and power. They are reflected in charts, policies, and ways of doing things that structure life in organizations in a hierarchical, compartmentalized, and exclusionary way echoing the division of labor within capitalism and the fragmentation of knowledge and reason within rationality (Dunleavy & O'Leary, 1987). While change in education is driven by economics, politics, and leadership, it is imposed and solidified through bureaucracies. Bureaucracy and leadership are partners in the domination and control of organizations and people, and education is one of the primary vehicles through which this is accomplished.

One of the foremost hallmarks of all patriarchal organizations is their pyramid structure reflecting the power hierarchy. Education is a highly bureaucratic, top-down, patronizing system that follows the now familiar pyramid shape as do all organizations worldwide. Bureaucracies have become so pervasive that they are completely normalized in our consciousness and we cannot conceive, nor do we try to imagine, other ways of structuring our businesses, schools, and governments (Fitzgerald, 2009). We see bureaucracies as obstructive but benign instead of active subliminal socializers of students and employees. What we forget to remember is the deep and lasting impact bureaucracies have on the innermost psyches of people who work in and deal with them (Hall & Tittle, 1966). People come to accept hierarchy, authority, power, and control despite the fact they dislike it. Bureaucracies are a key part of that learning because we encounter them everywhere. The presence, the role, and the power of bureaucracies in reinforcing acceptance of authority and control is largely underestimated and ignored. They are the "natural" socializers and organizers of society, deemed to be superior in the Darwinian sense. They are an invisible background to our social and working lives.

Bureaucracies are an organizational control structure that reinforces and operationalizes the philosophical and theoretical conceptual structure

of leadership, where the authority of the organization flows from the top to the bottom—from the CEO to the employees, from the director to teachers and students (J. Ryan, 2006). By their nature bureaucracies are conservative, ponderous, and slow to react due to their vertical command-and-control organizational structure (Hoy & Miskel, 1996). We experience this every time we line up at a bank or wait in an emergency room or attempt to change a curriculum policy. They are highly inefficient and resistant to change. S. Acker (1999) states of educational bureaucracies, “The associated need for order and predictability is thought to support a preference for the status quo and suspicion of innovations that would disrupt it (Doyle and Ponder, 1977)” (p. 22). Bureaucracies also insulate the elites at the top of the hierarchy from those at the bottom. This depersonalizes their relationship and makes people more like objects that leaders and managers are acting upon rather than real people.

Education reflects these same qualities. Each level of education is nested within another, larger pyramid structure that supersedes it beginning at the preschool level. Thus schools themselves are mini-bureaucracies with principals and teachers nested within board and provincial or state bureaucracies that are progressively larger and more powerful, unwieldy and inefficient. It is a massive managerially based system that restricts autonomous action (J. Ryan, 2006). Power and control are relative to one’s position within the series of nested hierarchies that people work in. Each level of education is highly conservative and controlled through rigid policies and authority regimens at each level. Christopher Hodgkinson (1991) points out the characteristics of educational bureaucracies and some of their unsavory side-effects:

Modern state-financed education is essentially bureaucratic in its structure. The characteristic features of such structures are a hierarchy of personnel, tenure and careerism, role formalism, recordkeeping and paperwork, impartial and impersonal rules and regulations, professionalism and technical competence, committees and collective decision making, judicial process and unresponsiveness to changes in external or internal environment. Educational administrators as leaders have to work within such a system and it follows they should understand it, especially its powerful impress of ethos, mores and norms, whereby the system itself can constrain and delimit all ethical action. (p. 54)

A large, highly bureaucratized system such as education is oppressive and sluggish. It influences the values, beliefs, and actions of those who work within it in a similar manner. It is not an environment structured to foster democratic freedom, free speech, critical thinking, or independent autonomy—quite the opposite. As Hodgkinson (1991) notes, it can “constrain and

delimit all ethical action.” It can also encourage unethical action by its impersonal value structure that promotes “objective” and “rational” decisions. The endless lines of authority override any dissent, creativity, or real change from below and make the system conservative, stagnant, and unresponsive to change. Formal authority makes it unnecessary for those in higher positions to listen to concerns from below or to lead with knowledge and expertise rather than force. In almost every case, change is implemented from the top down by experts, board superintendents, their professional organizations, or outside government officials who create, devise, and publish curriculum documents, leadership guidelines, professional codes of practice, and board policies to govern how education is delivered (Sheathelm, 1991). Curriculum innovation is rarely driven by working teachers and principals who are viewed as implementers, not producers. The implicit message is always that those in higher levels of the hierarchy are more important, more intelligent, and more capable than those in the lower levels who should know their place (Collinson, 2005). Invariably, they have more formal power and authority over them, but this syllogism is rarely true. The combination is often lethal to real creative change and leads repeatedly to “expert error” due to the lack of practical grounding of academics.

In almost all cases educational change is imposed on teachers and principals by leaders through this bureaucratic system, despite their concerns or protests (Dufour & Eaker, 1999). Change in education is particularly subject to the tyranny of the expert and the formal authority of leaders because educators are generally viewed as semi-professionals, lazy, and somewhat incompetent by the public and governments. Not coincidentally, most of these educators just happen to be women (Barlow & Robertson, 1994; Fitzgerald, 2009; Gitlin & Margonis, 1995). They are invariably the passive recipients rather than the active drivers of change. Those who do want to change the system are often ostracized, alienated, and vilified for their efforts, not because their ideas are bad but because they are challenging the status quo of organizational power and authority of patriarchal leadership (L. Wright, 2008).

Ironically, real emancipatory change leadership is neither rewarded nor encouraged (J. Ryan, 2006). Such leaders are a threat to the system that is a tremendously elitist, arrogant, and imperious organizational culture that preserves a clear pecking order within a supposedly professional organization while maintaining a carefully managed public persona of positive collegiality and pleasant professionalism. It is all a charade to cover viciously polite political infighting, careerism, and cronyism (Giroux, 2004; Shields, 2005).

Despite being highly educated, motivated, and experienced professionals, educators (particularly in the elementary panel) today are treated like the children they teach in a patronizing and paternal way by almost every level of administration from board to province or state, male or female, and by the public as well. As Lieberman and Miller (1990) point out:

School based management and new decision-making structures are not ends in themselves; they are means to achieving more effective environments for learning and teaching. Changes in instructional practices do not take hold in schools that infantilize teachers and push them into patterns of defensiveness and conservatism. (p. 761)

Our educational bureaucracies, the leaders that populate them, and the theories they are based upon continue to operate on a deficit model that creates a dependency culture—particularly for women (Cubillo & Brown, 2003; Moloi & Bush, 2006). That is exactly what they were intended to do and they are completely unsuited to a modern professional organization charged with the production of democratic citizens like education. Education is stuck in a distant industrial past where education was modeled after a factory assembly line. The relevance of this model disappeared decades ago, but we continue to cling to its vestiges as though it still has meaning in a post modern, instant-communication information society. Even at the university level, mature and experienced adult students are still referred to and treated in a patronizing way as much younger undergraduates rather than adult learners or in some more respectful relationship of co-learners with professors. They are often treated like post-secondary undergraduates even at the post-graduate level despite the fact that many of these mature adults have more relevant life experience and professional knowledge than many of their instructors.

The environment created by this outdated organizational culture is one of constant inadequacy and stress and is hardly conducive to quality education. In a field where definitive knowledge of practice is hard to come by due to the subjective and qualitative nature of the undertaking, expectations are routinely slavish and unbending. Rather than having a significant amount of latitude to teach and implement curriculum in whatever way they can do it best as autonomous professionals, teachers and principals are locked into theoretical and practical straight-jackets by the most recent popular theory being promoted. Since teachers are not required to learn these theories themselves and determine whether they work in practice, they are often implemented

without thought and create the resulting failures that have populated educational reform (Dufour & Eaker, 1999; Fullan, 2001; Toll, 2001).

Schools are random, political, and contested environments today where stability and certainty do not exist, where political whims of a single parent can drive major decisions, and where personal battles often rage between parents and teachers and parents and principals over the daily operation of schools. Yet the education system demands that principals impose expectations on their schools in what amounts to an impossible task that leaves them feeling constantly inadequate (Blackmore, 1989; Gray, Fry, Bottoms, & O'Neill, 2007). What they are expected to do is to manage their schools, manipulate their staff, and placate the public within the traditional, perfectionist rational leadership model that adheres to the traditional organizational structure while working in an irrational world that does not lend itself to rational solutions but instead some amalgam of common sense, experience, and qualifications (S. Maxcy, 1991; N. Wright, 2001).

In most schools the majority of circumstances are out of the direct control of principals and vice-principals because they deal with unpredictable people and students in unstable environments, leaving administrators feeling terrified when things spin out of control as they often do as a normal part of the function of even the most well-run schools. What is valued in the current politically correct educational environment is for principals and teachers to deliver seamless and un-conflicted education to students and parents that will not pose any difficulties for senior administrators or trustees. No matter what the validity or relevance of a particular complaint, principals are generally held directly responsible for its outcomes—good or bad. In a non-tenured environment that principals now work in, this creates a recipe for compliance administration and not professional and creative administration. Principals live in fear of the third-party call to the superintendent or the trustee that will result in a chain reaction resulting in a disciplinary call to them. Placating parents and the public has become the new mantra of directors and school systems, often to the detriment of good decision making. Offending parents or the public are rarely held to account for their often abusive and frequently slanderous actions or intimidating and aggressive behavior toward principals and teachers. Schools are highly complex, contested workplaces and they are almost constantly challenged about everything they do; unlike the workplaces of lawyers, doctors, and engineers, whose knowledge and decisions are generally accepted and respected by the public (Brown & Wynn, 2004). The public and governments still have an idyllic and romanticized view of schools

as places of positive learning for all rather than war zones. Ironically, it is elementary schools where the problem is most severe.

Despite this, if principals do expose any flaws, concerns, or problems in their schools to superintendents or colleagues, they are immediately caught in a Catch-22 and at risk of being considered incompetent or weak leaders by the system and their superiors; they rarely raise these issues because they know they will not get support from them and their professional abilities will be brought into question instead. This is the Superman/woman leadership mentality that currently reigns in educational bureaucracies. It is often a Kafkaesque environment, particularly for principals who are caught in the middle. Despite growing in qualifications, experience, and knowledge throughout their careers, this is never acknowledged, nor can they ever feel confident in their abilities at any time. No matter how qualified principals or teachers are, they are treated based on their positional place in the hierarchy. Their decisions are regularly overridden by superintendents and other board bureaucrats with little respect for their capabilities, qualifications, or experience. It is an overwhelmingly debilitating and disempowering experience. The pressures on principals are enormous in this political meat-grinder. Independent principals are often isolated psychologically by senior leaders and given the silent treatment for challenging authority. Many principals have their professional reputations seriously damaged by aggressive, spontaneous, and unsubstantiated random attacks by enraged or political parents and domineering superintendents who will deride them with impunity to get their way or to enhance their leadership persona. This has occurred with disturbing regularity since the dawning of neoliberalism in the 1990s, the removal of tenure for principals, the institution of school councils, and the opening up of education to direct public input. These are the unspoken problems in education that no one will address (Blackmore, 2006; Kelders, 2009; Lacey, Thompson, Vaillancourt, Keon, Brawfor, Doctrow, & Winville, 2008; Mitgang, 2008; Wahlstrom & Seashore Louis, 2008).

Similarly, principals rarely if ever reveal to colleagues that they are having difficulties in their schools for the same reasons. There is a "code of silence" in which principals always say things are great at their schools and they are not having any problems; the reality is that all schools are conflicted and contested environments every day, and no principal escapes this reality (Brown & Wynn, 2004). It is extremely isolating, leading principals to work without support for serious stress-related problems in their schools. It is this increasingly hostile administrative situation that is the source of the significant increase in the difficulties school systems all over the world are having recruiting people to take

on the principal's role, particularly women who express deep concerns about work/life balance (Davis, Darling-Hammond, LaPointe, & Meyerson, 2005; Ekman, 2002; Grimmer & Echols, 2000; Sherman, 2005). What school systems are now looking for are compliant educational managers, not educational leaders. There is a huge difference. Education is an environment that has a surface veneer of prestige, professional control, and collaboration and an operational reality of subjective and intense interpersonal conflict and controversy. Within all of this, senior management support for principals has become non-existent and often hostile as directors and superintendents attempt to satisfy politically driven parents and eagerly offer up principals as sacrificial victims leading to debilitating wounding for many principals (Ackerman & Maslin-Ostrowski, 2002). For many principals it is like screaming under water. They work on personal services agreements that provide no tenure, preventing them from speaking out, even though they are often drowning under a sea of exponentially increasing expectations, pressure, and problems. This leads to undisclosed burn-out and extremely high stress, which is for the most part largely understudied and under theorized (Brown & Wynn, 2004; Grimmer & Echols, 2000). Ignoring this problem exacerbates the difficulty of creating quality education in schools. Post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD) is an undiagnosed and unexamined problem among principals, but that is what is happening to thousands of principals and vice principals who suffer in silence every day, afraid to expose any weakness in an unforgiving and unsupportive managerial leadership culture. Overall, the bureaucracy that used to work in favor of hierarchical authority to support principals in their schools has now turned inward on itself and is attacking them instead. The system itself now works actively against principals and teachers as a restraint due to its growing political nature.

In addition, principals' professional associations provide tepid and limited legal support for them in such situations, leaving principals feeling even more isolated and exposed. In an environment of complex and difficult decisions, this level of ambiguity is caustic. The result is often professional psychological paralysis, where making decisions becomes extremely high stress. Unlike senior managers, superintendents, or CEOs who are a step removed from the public and thus insulated from direct controversy, principals are front-line leaders who hold little real authority to make decisions and run their schools but hold full responsibility for their performance while their decisions are second-guessed and overruled by micromanaging superintendents, trustees, directors, staff, parents, and even students who all work against the principal to get what they want. Principals feel powerless having been given responsibility

without authority, and it is a major unaddressed problem in education today (Portin, DeArmond, Gundlach, & Schneider, 2003).

This is particularly true at the elementary school level where principals and teachers are infantilized like the children they educate (Barth, 1989). This makes being an ethical, effective principal virtually impossible and highly stressful (E. C. Campbell, 1996). It is a perfectionist superman/woman model of leadership that drives this culture where leaders are expected not to make mistakes and always present a controlled professional image, no matter how superficial that is. It is irrelevant and unsuitable to the conflicted reality of modern educational leadership, yet it continues to prevail in school systems across the country and around the world much to the detriment of hard-working school principals and the students they serve (Mitgang, 2008). The educational bureaucracy actively disempowers principals while placing them under extremely high stress.

There are many unrealistic myths associated with bureaucracies and the leadership theories surrounding them. One is the unchallenged assumption that each formal level of the bureaucratic hierarchy and its incumbent is superior to the next below them in expertise, knowledge, leadership capacity, and personal qualities. Particularly in education this is a deeply problematic fiction because there are not significant differences between each level of the organization in formal training, experience, abilities, and skills. The craft of education is for the most part a subjective, intuitive process made more consistent by experience, training, and knowledge generally held by most educators to a high degree. Each level of formal leadership in a bureaucracy is automatically assumed to be superior in every respect to the levels below it and possesses additional power and authority to impose on the levels below it, despite the fact that in the past 30 years the professional qualifications of principals and senior administrators in particular have narrowed to the point that there is no significant difference between the various levels in knowledge, formal training, and experience. Yet the senior administrators continue to run education as though there were. Most principals and superintendents hold master's degrees in education and were once teachers and principals. Few hold doctorates or other specialist qualifications. Many teachers are now just as qualified in their areas of specialty as principals and senior superintendents, yet they also are given little real independence in making decisions relating to their students. Both principals and teachers are treated like line employees rather than real professionals. In addition, the subjective personal interactive circumstances that are the working environment

for educators at all levels mediate against clear and expertise-driven decisions. Thus superintendents and principals are constantly in conflict about decisions and leadership in schools with principals being subjected to what Hodgkinson (1991) refers to as the impersonal "bureaupathology" of the bureaucracy (p. 61).

This patriarchal attitude is a throwback to the time when all senior administrators were male and qualified and all public school teachers were female and unqualified but continues to persist in educational organizations that are now led by both male and female leaders and both male and female teachers who have significantly more educational qualifications for their job than ever before. We mistakenly assume benign, yet positive motives and actions from the educational bureaucracy, and that bureaucracies are more of a nuisance rather than a threat to our democracies, yet there is limited evidence to support this and substantial evidence that we should be highly skeptical and concerned regarding the motivations, effects, and influences of those who use the power of bureaucracies to carry out their work. The tight, top-down, paramilitary control that ushered in modern education and that we have been enamoured with in the private sector over the past century has worked well for governments, the business community, and the military, but not for education, democracy, or society (Bowles & Gintis, 1976). As Boyd (1992) observes:

As a result of education's vulnerability to the "cult of efficiency" (Callahan, 1962)—that is, the values of businessmen and scientific management—school administration became far more concerned with hierarchy, control, and efficiency than with issues of curriculum, pedagogy, and educational values. (p. 509)

Another problem with traditional hierarchies is that they allow educators to abdicate professional responsibility for education since they are only "implementers." This creates a dependency culture and a sense of powerlessness that emasculates educators and reduces their desire to be fully professional and responsible for their own body of knowledge and practices (S. Maxcy, 1991; Moloi & Bush, 2006). This system is a holdover from the early 20th century and is incapable of producing a professional democratic culture or independent, empowered democratic citizens. In this system dissent is not welcomed, encouraged, or tolerated—compliance is. Students are disciplined by the authority of teachers, principals, and the school system; teachers and principals are disciplined by the authority and power of leaders and the bureaucracy. No one is free in education. Education is—like most other organizations—a

well-run oligarchy (Laxer, 1999). Free speech is limited and controlled, particularly for educators. Ironically, the only place citizens have free speech is outside of formal institutions where their right to free speech has little impact on changing the formal social status quo. Free speech is a placebo for real change. Rather than the open, autonomous, consensual, and collaborative professional environment that one would expect to find in an education system that is the wellspring of democracy populated with highly qualified professionals working together, we find a tension-filled repressive, authoritarian regime cloaked in a velvet glove of consensus and collaboration that rules with an iron fist (albeit an apparently benevolent one) over all those within it and a carefully managed public image of professionalism and calm. Our entire education system, like our larger society, exists with a thin veneer of social civility that masks the authoritarian and conflicted core of its operation. This is the essence of what Pellegrini and Scandura (2008) describe as "paternalistic leadership." This is a leadership practice typical of Chinese Family Businesses (CFB) and society that arose from Confucian patriarchal cultural ideals that promoted the authority, benevolence, and morality of the patriarch or leader based on paternal dominance of the male in the family (Cheng, Chou, Wu, Huang, & Farh, 2004). It is a concept that they seriously suggest might be a viable form of leadership for Western education in the future given the recent return to right-wing views in society (p. 566). While having more control and autonomy than educators, traditionally respected professions such as doctors, lawyers, police officers, and engineers also operate within self-directed but no less rigid top-down hierarchies of power that control the organizational culture of the particular job. Wheatley (2000) reflects on the failure of traditional leadership and change models in education and elsewhere noted by educators who report a deep cynicism and increased stress regarding the endless change efforts and fads of which leaders report two-thirds fail.

These problems arise in education when students, teachers, principals, or anyone inside or outside the system tries to change it or challenge its core legitimacy and operation. Questioning patriarchy, bureaucracy, leadership, democracy, or education is not permitted. Many people spend their entire careers attempting to change the system away from its authoritarian and bureaucratic roots with little success and finally give up trying (Brookfield, 2005). The inertial force for stasis in large bureaucratic organizations is significant. The sanctions for anyone who resists, questions, or attempts to change this process are immediate and punitive (Busher & Barker, 2003; J. Ryan, 2006). There are hierarchies of sanctions for anyone who questions or challenges the

authority of educational bureaucracies or traditional academics to indoctrinate in the manner that they do. Students, parents, teachers, principals, and senior administrators are expected to simply do their job—not question the job they are doing or the organization of education that they work in, which is critical to keeping education professional and democracy vibrant. It is the same in every walk of life. They are expected to sacrifice their morals, ethics, and professionalism at the altar of promotion, bureaucracy, and tradition (Hodgkinson, 1991).

To a large degree most educators abdicate their professional rights to question and challenge the system and acquiesce to its demands because resistance is precarious (Collinson, 2005; J. Ryan, 2006). The suppression of democratic autonomy in education for teachers and principals is far more critical and serious than any other sector of society because education is the last wellspring of democratic thought for the future, and censoring or restricting educators hurts democracy. Muzzling educators muzzles democracy. It affects and controls what every single person will be in the future and so its role is pivotal in determining the future of society. This is why we must give special attention to ensuring that education is free, democratic, and independent of controlling social forces that do not represent the best interests of society at large. Educators, who make a lifelong commitment to the profession for altruistic reasons much like doctors or lawyers but without the promise of substantial financial rewards, are best suited to make the decisions about what the best practices are for education and democracy (Guarino, Santibanez, Daley, & Brewer, 2004). We have to trust them to make the best choices possible just like doctors or lawyers, not question their every decision and professional values and commitment while hyper-regulating them in an obsessive desire to control their work. The result is the opposite of what we want. We rarely question the intentions of medical or legal professionals regarding their professional work and decisions with the same intensity. Why should teachers and principals be any different?

Intimidation and coercion are effective tools to force compliance and silence dissent. It is used regularly and every day in organizations around the world and it is used in education as well. These are the tools of patriarchy, leadership, and power. As French (1985) notes the intimidation and threats can be subtle or clearly obvious, but they are a pervasive part of our organizational functioning in modern bureaucracies. Whistleblowers risk being fired. Those who challenge the status quo have their careers damaged or destroyed (Eden, 2002; Hoy & Miskel, 1996; Laxer, 1999; J. Ryan, 2006). The threat of job loss is a powerful deterrent to dissent and works effectively

throughout society and within education to keep people in line. This is one reason why the Conservative government in Ontario removed principals and vice-principals from their teacher unions in the 1998. It is a stultifying and regressive system that cannot take society into a democratic future; it is only capable of reinventing the past. Education is a ponderous, unresponsive, unreformed, and deeply conservative bureaucratic behemoth that shapes our post-modern reality and is primarily run on economic and utilitarian rather than broad socially liberal or fully democratic values. It pays only lip-service to the latter to assist with its primary work. We have gotten it wrong for decades and centuries and we cannot envisage a society without power as its foundation of societal institutions. It has an inertial status quo that has been highly resistant to change. It more closely resembles a prison than the source of democracy, and although it has the potential to be a key change agent, it rarely is. It is in need of a major structural and theoretical overhaul with a goal of introducing democratic practices and structures throughout the system and building a new professional respect among the public for school educators.

Leadership and Education

Like all the pillars in the democratic gulag, education is based not on collaboration, consensus, team-work, or skills as it is often presented, but on power and authority. Leadership in education mimics and models the traditional patriarchal approaches pursued throughout society. In education, the concern with leadership has become obsessive in the past 25 years as it became the answer for all its problems, when in fact it was leadership itself that was the source of the problems. As S. Maxcy (1991) states:

Given this cultural condition, it is not surprising that school administration currently is beset by the "leadership panacea". As a one-shot solution to educational problems, the expert leader is seen as both an insurance that programs in educational administration may be sustained and enhanced and also as a means of control of the chaotic situation into which our public schools have fallen. (p. 6)

Everywhere in educational philosophy is the fictitious and unrealistic belief that if leaders could only control all the factors, anticipate all eventualities, and head off all the problems, they would achieve excellence. It is the ultimate no-win deficit model. Underlings can also be blamed for any problem that occurs under the guise that if they had been a better leader, the

problem would have been solved. Principals and teachers live in a perpetual professional Catch-22. It is an extremely negative and dispiriting culture to work in that punishes people for issues that are beyond their control and most often not of their making. This perfectionist, superhuman ideal belief is a self-fulfilling failure prophecy since no leader can control all of the factors related to any situation, let alone just a few (Gronn, 2003).

Rather than acknowledging that, we grimly cling to the expectation that leaders should solve everything. Teachers, principals, and other employees are perpetually inundated with advice about perfecting their leadership from superintendents and directors, whether they are new, mid-career, or experienced educators ready for retirement, while being besieged by irrational and spontaneous problems and demands every day. Chaos theory best represents the daily lives of principals. As Tetenbaum (1998) describes it: "Chaos theory and its spin-off, complexity theory, argue that relationships in complex systems, like organizations, are nonlinear, made up of interconnections and branching choices that produce unintended consequences and render the universe unpredictable" (p. 21). Chaos theory has similarities to poststructuralist views of the world as diverse, conflicted, indeterminate, and dialectical (Collinson, 2005).

Ironically, despite an explosion of leadership literature, seminars, books, advice, theories, and innovations, the core of educational leadership remains mired in traditional, top-down bureaucratic practice and structures that are virtually unchanged in the last century (Allix, 2000). We have paid too much attention to the theory of education and too little to the practice and reality of it. There is a huge disconnect today. The leadership models that are promoted are the same traditional patriarchal, heroic, messianic, visionary, and authoritarian idealized approaches borrowed from the military, business, and politics that have been *de-rigueur* for centuries (McCroskey, 2008; Wright, 2001). They are now employed by both male and female leaders in conjunction with rigid and conservative bureaucratic organizational hierarchies that reinforce their authority and create a system of civilized autocratic oppression within a superficial veneer and rhetoric of cooperation and consensus that is unrivaled in its comprehensiveness and its duplicity (Gilbert & Matviuk, 2008). The clash between bureaucratic stasis and chaos theory could not be more startling than in education. The leadership culture of education never questions or challenges this system. Peter Gronn (2003) describes its side effects:

Exceptionalism also generates some unintended and unhelpful consequences, two of which are potentially toxic. First, while highlighting the presumed superiority of leaders, the idea of exceptionalism serves to residualise non-leaders as 'followers' and

to infantilise them, sheep-like, within a culture of dependency. For this reason, some critics of leadership (e.g. Gabriel 1997) highlight the experience of non leadership as conducive to a sense of learned helplessness and disempowerment. (p. 282)

Gronn accurately characterizes the prevailing culture of most education systems and those who work in them, particularly elementary school educators where female teachers and support staff continue to be treated in patronizing and infantilizing ways by a system that takes their critical and difficult work for granted and stereotypes the women who work in them. Educational leaders have an organizational culture—a “way of doing things around here”—that is ingrained in each succeeding generation of teachers, principals, and staff employees (Giles & Proudfoot, 1994). It formally and superficially stresses professionalism, consensus, and cooperation but is in actual fact a thin overlay for cronyism, patronage, and an old-style top-down, command-and-control organizational approach that values compliance, deference, and submission to the formal authority of the hierarchy even when implementing concepts such as distributed leadership (B. Maxcy & Nguyễn, 2006). As Elmore (2000) notes:

Contrary to the myth of visionary leadership that pervades American culture, most leaders in all sectors of society are creatures of the organization they lead. Nowhere is this more true than in public education, where principals and district superintendents are recruited almost exclusively from the ranks of practice. As in the military and the church, one does not get to lead in education without being well socialized to the norms, values, predispositions, and routines of the organization one is leading. (p. 2)

Followers are caught in a no-win Catch-22 where if they comply, they become part of the corrupt hierarchy and must live by its values, and if they maintain their ethics and professionalism, they are ostracized and their careers damaged. Women as a group are all in this position (Lerner, 1986). Teachers are often in the position of being told one thing only to experience another. Superiors in higher positions are viewed as having more expertise, knowledge, and ability than others lower in the organization and slavish adherence to written policies and procedures is demanded. In this way organizations around the world, including education, are remarkably similar. This power-oriented structure and culture is a sacred hand-me-down from previous centuries where the culture of dominating male leadership was an imposed norm—and still is. This model is particularly unsuited to education, which is expected to be the creator/protector of civilized society and individual empowerment in the workplace for skilled, well-educated professionals in the 21st century.

Curiously, power and authority in education are infrequently mentioned and directly confronted when discussions of leadership arise, whether in the academic leadership literature, leadership seminars, governments, or operating school systems. Force is the accepted currency of leadership. Senior leaders and experts regularly cloak themselves in the mantle of professionalism, collaborative rhetoric, and high-minded public ideals while imposing a thinly veiled draconian and authoritarian regimen on subordinates to ensure they achieve the goals of the leader. Leaders are expected to present one professional persona while harboring another, sometimes completely different one within, resulting in a schizophrenic leadership model that demands fundamental bigotry of its leaders. Our leadership paradigm is all about the leader—followers are the unwashed masses, although more distributed models do acknowledge that followers contribute equally to organizational and leadership success (Heenan & Bennis, 1999). While research on leadership is voluminous, research on followership is scarce despite the fact that leadership requires followership to function (Clements & Washbush, 1999; Gilbert & Matviuk, 2008; Russell, 2003).

Leadership in education, as in most fields, is a self-fulfilling prophecy where leaders always live up to their own self-perceived potential but rarely validate this success through the eyes of others, particularly those of their followers, upon whom they have the largest impact and who are rarely consulted about their performance. True responsibility and accountability would be created if followers in education (principals and teachers) directly evaluated the performance of their leaders in a peer review process (Hatcher, 2005; S. J. Maxcy, 1991; Weick & McDaniel, 1989). More importantly, leaders are never evaluated on teacher/principal satisfaction or positive-attitude creation among followers. Followers are never part of the performance review process or criteria upon which leaders are assessed, which is ironic since leadership can only be acted out through followers. A person without followers cannot be a leader within the traditional definition of the word. The performance review process is a top-down power exercise where “superiors” evaluate “subordinates” but never the reverse, reflecting its underlying patriarchal values of power and authority that still pervade educational and other organizations. It is ironic that individuals who are touted to be great leaders of others are never evaluated by the people they are purported to lead but by an isolated, detached group of individual trustees or boards of directors who primarily use arm’s-length paper accomplishments and personal relationships to determine competence without surveying the principals and teachers that senior

administrators are supposed to lead. This is just rubber-stamp power that is never evaluated for its real effectiveness. As Doyle (2003) points out: "As discussed, building democratic community involves both cultivating a moral purpose and ensuring processes that shift power" (p. 360).

There is a major disconnect between leaders and followers in school systems and between followers and leaders everywhere that has its origins in patriarchal adversarialism. For the most part, educators dutifully comply with the system out of fear of job loss, career damage, or simply out of belief in the traditional system, not out of any support for the particular leader or the directions being promoted. In fact, most followers resent leaders at a visceral level. In a number of cases they also have fewer skill sets, training, qualifications, or experience than many of the people they purportedly lead or may be much younger than other professionals below them that they must lead. This is a seriously problematic system. Occasionally, formal leaders are discovered to have lied on their résumés to get their jobs. Hiring and promotion in education is still a patriarchal process based on personal preferences and bias (Thom, 1993). Competence often comes way down the unspoken list.

Followers trade off significant professional autonomy, respect, and control over education for security and a comfortable dependency relationship with leaders, and they should not have to. Followers adhere to the unwritten social bargain of organizations—stroke the ego of leaders, show respect and deference, always check with superiors before doing anything, and never question the leader or the leader's ideas and you will be a good follower and perhaps be promoted yourself one day. Unfortunately, this climate leads to employees who are afraid to take risks, conservative, and anxious about anything they do, leading to stagnation in the organizational culture and the pushing of boundaries in education, which is critical to its relevance and cogency. These are the unwritten codes of all organizations. They are broken and must be broken if leadership and organizations are to progress forward and deal with contentious issues affecting the health of organizations and society and give people the kind of free democracy they all want.

Of all social institutions, leadership in education is perhaps the most self-serving and moralizing oligarchy of any organization because of its professional self-righteousness. Educational leaders begin to believe they are actually different and better than others in the organization because the rest of the organization regularly fawns over them. They begin to believe their own hype. Many develop or have a Napoleon complex. There is a widely assumed and unquestioned underlying assumption that educational leaders are positive

individuals and know what leadership is and what one must do to lead, so the only thing remaining is to find out the best way to go about it despite the fact that there is little real consensus in the research literature or elsewhere about what leadership is or how it should be practiced (Leo & Barton, 2006; Russell, 2003). This research for the most part is conveniently ignored by those who proselytize in favor of traditional leadership. As Heenan and Bennis (1999) indicate, "It is a fallacy that dies hard" (p. 4). There is a significant and underestimated inertial resistance to changing the status quo. In many respects education is one of the most repressive and least self-reflective organizations operating today because of the moral duplicity of its value structure. Despite wallowing in leadership models and theories, education seems incapable of exercising any real leadership for change to change leadership. As Bennis and Nanus (1985) stated 30 years ago of this perpetual pursuit:

Today, we are a little closer to understanding how and who people lead, but it wasn't easy getting there. Decades of academic analysis have given us more than 350 definitions of leadership. Literally thousands of empirical investigations of leaders have been conducted in the last seventy-five years alone, but no clear and unequivocal understanding exists as to what distinguishes leaders from non-leaders, and perhaps more important, what distinguishes *effective* leaders from *ineffective* leaders and *effective* organizations from *ineffective* organizations. (p. 4)

If this is the case, then why do we continue to valorize lone-wolf leaders in all fields today? Bennis and Nanus make a strong case for doing away with leadership and forging ahead with a new fully distributed or professionally democratic model instead (Stern, 2002). Unfortunately, since Bennis and Nanus made this statement, dozens of additional models have been added to this endless, growing, and confusing list. The task of knowing what leader we are supposed to be is truly overwhelming for educators who are constantly inundated with this literature and held up to its unrealistic standards. The reality is that there is a formulaic method for becoming a leader that is in essence random, arbitrary, and fickle. We are no closer to consensus on leadership today despite bookstores, the Internet, electronic academic sources, and university library stacks packed with leadership material. However, despite a myriad of definitions we continue to promote the same narrow singular, heroic, authoritarian, and messianic core paradigm in one form or another as the only answer to the problems of education and the world.

We are repeatedly disappointed by the results because it is the underlying paradigm that is at fault, not the particular model or manner of its

implementation. The leadership continuum runs from autocratic to democratic, but if all the leadership theories and models of the past century were plotted on such a continuum, the vast majority would cluster on the authoritarian side. Why is this? Why are we unable to experiment with truly democratic and empowering forms of leadership, education, politics, and economics? The answer is patriarchy, power, and control. As Manz (1999) asserts:

The magnitude and confusion of the leadership literature is itself blinding, even when a person sincerely studies it in the hope of avoiding being a blind leader. No matter how confident and convincing a leader is, all too often followers are better off if they simply ignore the leader and follow their own lead. (p. 129)

We continue to practice a false “consensus-by-manipulation” through traditional leadership models that are ultimately always unsuccessful because people are not deceived by them and resent authoritarianism in any form. There is also a general repugnance for the bigoted values that cloak the reality of most leadership theories and models and a healthy and warranted skepticism about the moral and ethical arrogance of many leaders. Our leadership models create either stasis or catastrophe, not change and progress.

Without doubt all of the leadership definitions that Bennis and Nanus (1985) talk about focus on the same single leader accomplishing goals by leading followers to do what *the leader* believes is right instead of what *everyone* thinks and knows is right, and this is the exact problem: our blind faith in single leaders (Collison, 2005). The mythologized belief in a single person and his or her ability to succeed through individual skills, characteristics, or beliefs is both misguided, unrealistic, damaging, and in many cases dangerous and destructive. While Bennis and Nanus (1985) assert there is little consensus on the definition of effective leadership and effective organizations, the opposite is actually true, and there has been an extraordinary assumed consensus on what leadership is and how to practice it that has held for centuries. It doesn't matter which of the 350-plus definitions one chooses; the single, exalted patriarchal leadership paradigm employing power and authority to accomplish goals that underlies them is identical and needs to be abandoned—practically, conceptually, and theoretically (Levine-Rasky, 2007). It is unsuitable for education just as it is equally unsuitable for politics, economics, religion, and social organization.

Education is a political and a trend-driven revolving door of leadership and curriculum change. As each new panacea for leadership is marketed by business, management theorists, or academics, senior administrators within

education eagerly and quickly latch on to these ideas and become dedicated, slavish devotees. Each new untested leadership theory is introduced uncritically with great fanfare to principals and quickly becomes the new universal remedy (Leo & Barton, 2006). Politically driven change is the only constant in education, and leadership in education, yet little in education or leadership actually changes. Nothing gets a chance to firm up and take root because methods, practices, and theories are constantly evolving and educators are constantly chasing a receding light in the distance and left feeling inadequate. The shifting sands of leadership are always giving way under those aspiring to be leaders because the expectations are constantly being revised. In addition, the expectations are often so rarefied and mythic that ordinary educators are more often than not overwhelmed as to what to do and left feeling inadequate in the process (S. Davis, 2000; Davis, Darling-Hammond, LaPointe, & Meyerson, 2005). Generally only the positives in these initiatives are highlighted—rarely any difficulties or negatives. Once they have been discarded after a realistic test drive, they are infrequently discussed as lessons for the future, nor is there any accountability for those superintendents who led them. Questions raised at the point of implementation are viewed as “resistance” and problematic. Everyone is expected to immediately adhere and conform to the new theory—without questioning or thinking about it and particularly without rejecting it—despite Bennis and Nanus’s (1985) observations on the relative futility of such a process. Education is famous for implementation before validation; this is consummately true with leadership theory and practice.

Rather than implementing leadership practices after they have been researched and proven over time, education continually latches on to the “flavor of the month” and pursues it with a passion until it exhausts itself and is discarded. This approach is tremendously destabilizing to those in the system. The rules of the game change constantly. Rather than letting each person lead in his or her unique way, a one-size-fits-all approach is used to the detriment of various school administrators’ performance and professional confidence. The environment of leadership and curriculum implementation needs to become far more critical and skeptical than it has been in the past, and teachers and principals need to be given the right to fully vet all initiatives. Each of the new leadership models is invariably only a variation on the centuries-long paternal theme of leaders being special people (most often male, but now also female) who do special things while the rest of the uninspired followers watch the “sage on the stage” in awe. We choose leaders and leadership models on

the basis of emotion, not empirical and qualitative evidence, in contrast to medicine and other professional disciplines. We would be much better served by leadership models that deemphasize formal and informal differences between organizational members.

The reality is that there are absolutely no fundamental differences between these leaders and followers other than a biased, corrupt, power-based system of authority and cronyism that masquerades as democracy and leadership. Most organizations are authoritarian oligarchies. In reality a more equitable, balanced, and less heroic adult approach would get far more mileage than top-down models, and organizations would be far more effective and positive environments generating positive self-esteem amongst educators, particularly in education where all employees are highly educated and trained (Elmore, 2000). We need to move toward a democratic professional model, not an authoritarian master-servant one (Stern, 2002). Even if this latter approach is less efficient, the people working in it would be far more fulfilled, happy, and motivated, but this is highly unlikely. More fulfilled educators would be far more productive and creative, pushing education and students to new heights.

Democratic organizations would have different metrics for success and effectiveness that might be similar, but in many cases would be significantly different than traditional organizations. Gone would be the sole focus on business efficiency (most businesses are highly inefficient and wasteful) and production, replaced with a focus on quality decisions that meet the needs of students and society and are supported by educators that are made in a truly professional and consensual manner, taking the time required to do so.

Educators, as trained practicing professionals, should always have the final say in educational decisions like every other profession. Open and not controlled or manipulated consultation would be the hallmark of such organizations as well as shared power and formal authority. This would lead to carefully considered and planned decisions and actions that would be far more effective than hastily planned directions that subsequently fail to succeed. It would also make it much more difficult for leaders to claim any effects on the process. Currently, messianic vision is a key manufactured component of leadership, not realism or fact.

Another problem with this type of leadership paradigm is that the leader is under significant pressure to produce action and results, leading to poorly determined plans of action that often lead to more failure and disaster than if the decision was made democratically over a longer period of time from a broad variety of perspectives, and change was actually slower. In modern

education we have been deceived into thinking that because information technology and the pace of corporate change increases daily, leaders and organizations must mimic this, when in education the opposite is true. If anything, endless definitions of leadership should lead us to overwhelmingly conclude that there are no specific leadership approaches that are any better than any other, and educators should be left alone and allowed to practice the form of leadership that they are most comfortable with—advice Charles Handy (1981) gave more than 30 years ago. This would naturally lead to more open, diverse, and democratic organizations.

Instead, in most school systems, the latest leadership fad is forcibly imposed on even the most experienced and skilled leaders with little awareness of the destructive consequences created by this insulting process. Management by Objectives, Management by Walking Around, Strategic Planning, Professional Learning Communities, Instructional Leadership, the leadership wisdom of Jesus—the list is endless. In terms of educational leadership—there are always a host of models promoted at any given time, but most are simply minor variations on the same theme—they often suggest a different relationship between leaders and followers or minor changes to leadership perspectives, but they rarely suggest significant changes to the key areas of the power and authority relationships between leaders and followers, superintendents and principals, principals and teachers, or teachers and students, or to the structures of organizations with which they work that are the key to building a new education system and a truly democratic society (J. Ryan, 2006). The same old, tired, top-down, charismatic, and messianic control models with superficial tweaks are regularly trotted out as the new answer for leadership.

Only slavish adherence to the most current popularized form is allowed, without reference to the long history of failure in leadership theorizing, leading to constant undercurrents of conflict and disharmony in most educational organizations (Fullan & Steigelbauer, 1991). Most principals and vice principals who are well-educated and capable leaders and who want professional autonomy and respect in their schools and from their school systems resent the tell-and-sell approach to leadership that they still get. What they want is to be respected and supported in the practice of their highly political and demanding roles, the respect and support of their superintendents, directors, and trustees, and to work openly and professionally with staff, students, and parents without the constant pressure of hidden agendas or demands to produce politically driven results in environments where the path to getting them is unknown to anyone—but they rarely get this (L. Wright, 2008). In contrast

to their desires, they are micromanaged and talked down to by overbearing senior superintendents and directors who dictate their every move and admonish them whenever there is even a minor problem in their schools while being oblivious to their own shortcomings as leaders. Rather than achieving truly collaborative decisions based on equality, educators get forced decisions based on the demand of the superintendent or director resulting from the aggressiveness of a given parent.

Today in education we pay great attention to the squeaky wheel while disenfranchising the silent majority who quietly trust the system and its professionals. It is a demeaning and patronizing negative relationship that most school administrators work in on a daily basis. School principals also do not want to be second-guessed and undermined by politically motivated, career-minded superiors who place career and image before effective and necessary school-based decisions. In these concerns and others principals and teachers are never substantively consulted on their ideas for leadership in education or about change. These perfectionist expectations of principals are similar to arbitrarily demanding a cure for cancer from doctors when science knows the overwhelming complexity of the problem defies such oversimplified expectations.

Educational leadership has become big business and an end unto itself rather than a means to an end. We live in the age of the expert and instant gratification when we should be living in the age of the professional educator and slow, measured change. Principals and teachers are perfectly capable of practicing education and handling its issues. Careerism has become rampant in education and everyone is opportunistically climbing the career ladder to the detriment of education in schools and professional relationships with colleagues. Empowering school-based educators with real stand-alone power and authority would significantly increase the effectiveness of schools and education (S. J. Maxcy, 1991).

As key change agents (Noonan, Walker, & Kutsyruba, 2008), principals are the focus of the vast majority of the traditional leadership literature in education and the legal requirements in most legislation that continually exhorts them to be better leaders using superficially changing yet static leadership approaches produced by the academic theory factories of the ivory tower universities, a host of business schools, the military, the private sector, the media, and other political pundits, all who promote the patriarchal traditional model. Paradoxically, they are given little real authority or power to deliver on these expectations. In modern schools where neoconservative managerialism is predominant, they are effectively highly trained

and educated line managers, not leaders. As Levine-Rasky (2007) asserts, "Education is a consumer good that becomes elitist and anti-egalitarian in the hands of the New Right. That school choice and its confluence with neo-liberal policy-making in education can be regarded as an expression of power is unremarkable" (p. 397).

Principals are constantly being pulled in different directions and on the receiving end of this leadership blitzkrieg, leaving them feeling perpetually shell-shocked and inadequate by this onslaught of expectations delivered to them by senior administrators and others who have been officially designated "leaders" and are thus considered "officially" superior and beyond question by the organization or those below them. This focus on being a leader often distracts principals from leading in their most natural and effective way. Senior leaders talk down to and patronize principals and vice-principals about their leadership shortcomings while failing to analyze or live up to these same remonstrances themselves. Principals exist with little real support to do their jobs (Colvin, 2007).

Ironically, there is little real leadership in education or elsewhere. Most leadership is not leadership for change but leadership for stasis, control, and self-fulfillment. There is a significant difference. The former changes educational structures, theories, and practices and most importantly leadership itself, while the latter creates the appearance of formal surface activity and change while reaffirming the status quo of formal and informal power and authority. Most, if not all, of the leadership models in education, as elsewhere in our society, are imported—predetermined—from business, sports, and the military—all primarily male-dominated, competitive, control models of leadership and organizations. Their utility or value for educational or political purposes is limited due to their utilitarian, manipulative origins but is infrequently challenged despite their checkered record of success. Leadership in education must be different because the goal is to develop democratic human capacity, not produce a product or profit.

Leaders in education (principals and teachers in particular) are viewed within this hierarchical deficit model as never good enough, experienced enough, or smart enough to be considered real leaders or respected professionals; they are constantly in the formative phase—perpetual novitiates—chasing some unreal ideal of leadership promoted by a revolving door of "experts." In essence, principals are never trusted to do their job. Heenan and Bennis (1999) describe the failure of this kind of approach in describing the change in thinking by the iconic head of design at GM, Bob Lutz:

With Eaton as role model, Lutz seems to have overcome his superman complex and adopted a more trusting, decentralist philosophy. Lutz admits he's discovered it's better to trust everyone all the time and get burned once or twice than it is to distrust everyone all the time undermining them in the process. "Most highly qualified people can be trained to work their tails off for the company, and make the right judgments," Lutz says. "They don't need constant supervision and control to do the right thing. That trust begets trust. And trust begets better performance." (p. 32)

In education, lack of trust characterizes the field. Despite theoretical assertions to the contrary, education is mired in a dysfunctional, authoritarian past of Theory X thinking that condemns it to repeatedly fail at educational and leadership change. A massive reform of the power relationships in education emphasizing more professional and collegial relationships is required. Principals are given no real professional respect, autonomy, acknowledgment, support, or control unless they have the good fortune to win the promotion lottery and move further up the bureaucratic ladder as a formal senior administrator (Darling-Hammond, et al., 1995). Magically, by the power of patriarchal leadership and cronyism, they become "a leader" in the formal but also in the figurative sense, despite the fact their actual knowledge, skills, and experience are identical before and after the event.

The success and achievements of those formally chosen as leaders is most often based on power and authority, not their personal leadership abilities. They immediately are imbued with a sense of entitlement and superiority that invariably leads to an ethical failure. As Thoms (2008) notes, "Leadership induces and maintains a leader's belief that they are exempt from moral requirements placed on others (Price, 2000)" (p. 424). Their promotion invariably occurs not through any expertise, knowledge, or academic credentials they may possess but on the basis of demonstrating deference and acquiescence to the patriarchal power hierarchy and the current superior's vision and mission—"kissing ass" in the cruder parlance or the old boys (or old girls) club that still actively operates in all school systems, governments, and private and public organizations. If you have concerns, disagree with a superior (especially in public), or have ideas that vary from the power-based status quo, you are on the outside looking in, which is not healthy for the organization or its clients because real roadblocks to progress are never vetted. You are ostracized whether you are right or wrong. Immediately the hierarchy imbues formal leaders with the new inviolate status quo and their knowledge, word, and authority is immediately unquestionable. Challenges to their legitimacy as leaders are taken

as a personal affront rather than legitimate issues. All those beneath them in the hierarchy are suddenly expected and required to demonstrate respect and deference to their newly minted authority, even if they were not respected or listened to prior to their appointments. Professionals who were equals one day with a colleague are subordinates the next despite nothing changing in their relationship, including their professional knowledge.

Senior administrators are instantly given the mantle of leader and expert in the various forms of leadership being promulgated, and their views are promoted throughout the system. They are given the authority to force their views on their organization—and they do. Organizational culture is not a shared process; it is an imposed one. In education this patriarchal crony model still dominates leadership selection and is destructive to the goals of creating a democratic professional contemporary education system. It is a corrupt and corrupting system of promotion and organizational culture. Modern education has become an old boys *and* an old girls club. Female leaders have been subsumed into the patriarchal cult of authority and power. The gender of leaders has changed but not the leadership model.

There are additional serious problems with this approach that have evolved as education has moved forward. In the past 30 years educators at all levels have achieved increasingly higher levels of formal education, training, and experience and in many cases have the same if not more qualifications than the senior administrators (often their junior) that are now leading them. With the competitive values of rampant careerism and managerialism in education everywhere, people are constantly jockeying for position and young, inexperienced, politically amoral leaders are being quickly promoted up the ladder through a new crony system without the qualifications, knowledge, or experience to fill the leadership roles they are taking on (Fitzgerald, 2009).

What this new cadre of leadership hopefuls have perfected is ingratiating themselves to existing status quo leaders under the euphemism of “networking.” Careerism has taken over the politics of education where everyone is jockeying to get the next promotion and thus operate professionally in a self-interested utilitarian manner to promote their careers while losing sight of the public good in their schools. Competitive utilitarianism has invaded educators as well as education. This has created a new organizational “culture of compliance” where everyone in the organization is careful not to make any misstep that might be misconstrued and negatively influence their career aspirations. Speaking openly and ethically is the kiss of death to leadership aspirations even when done professionally. Even minor problems can

derail a career. Those in the organization are even more careful to monitor the political climate of the board to ensure they are always affirming the views and values of the director and senior superintendents. It has also created a heightened "culture of ingratiation" as people present an artificial veneer of pleasant professionalism to create the charade of cooperation and collaboration and agreement on values and goals to ensure their career success. "False collaboration" has become a new tool to suppress dissent in modern organizations and so is highly valued in opposition to frank and honest discussion. As a result, the effectiveness of educational organizational cultures has declined and ossified.

However, this only masks the real conflicts and animosities in the education system and makes them worse by forcing them underground. The "old boys club" and now "old girls club" is alive and well across the country and around the world. The more deferential and flattering one is to the self-perceived leadership personas and ideas of these senior leaders, the more chance one has of being promoted and being viewed as a "team player," which is patrimonial code for doing what you are told or thinking like the leader (Wong & Sunderman, 2001). In either case this does not lead to creative, vibrant organizational cultures, leadership, or results.

Anyone who has worked in an organization knows that the formal ideals of leaders are a sham and that it never has been about qualifications, experience, or knowledge but about the "old boys" and more recently "old girls" clubs (P. Johnson, 2005). In some situations, female directors have reversed the gender balance to favor women through the persistent application of gender bias in hiring and promotion, perpetuating the same kind of discrimination that women used to experience only toward men. Gender chauvinism has simply changed hands, not introduced post-gender equality.

Female leaders have become just as easily corrupted as the male leaders that they railed against during the years of affirmative action and feminism that opened a path for them to their positions in the first place. While the formal visible trappings of power and prestige have been dismantled in our modern, "progressive" democracies, the internal organizational landscape remains firmly intact, and "right-thinking" is demanded of anyone aspiring for promotion (Water, 1998). Right-thinking usually means agreeing with whatever the leader of the organization and other superiors think, articulate, and believe. These are the unwritten "rules of the game" in modern organizations. Flatter my leadership ego and you will get promoted. Never let real concerns become public where they can be openly discussed and confronted. The traditional

leadership model creates a system where leaders seek and receive affirmation for their views without criticism to temper them. They live in a bubble. All real organizational problems are suppressed, resulting in ineffectiveness, stagnation, and futility. This is never good for the culture of an organization and particularly caustic to education, where democratic and professional freedom should be a core value rather than a core catchphrase. Vibrant criticism keeps organizations healthy and focused. Education, like most organizations, actively discourages this. Since aspiring employees know that criticizing a leader is career suicide, no one raises any real concerns about the system, how it operates, or about leadership itself, leading to large-scale school reform disasters such as strategic and site-based planning in the 1990s, the financial meltdown of 2008 leading to a worldwide recession, the Gulf oil spill, and the *Challenger* and *Columbia* spacecraft disasters. Anyone who disagrees with a leader also has little or no legal protection in doing so. All the cards are stacked against change and dissent. Leadership, as it is currently conceived and practiced, undermines the authority and professional self-esteem of educators in schools.

This situation leads to personal and professional moral quandary and professional conflicts as young, inexperienced superintendents who have been promoted quickly up the career ladder supercede much more experienced and qualified principals who are not favored due to their wisdom and justifiable cynicism about leadership. These leadership neophytes continue to naively force their decisions on those same principals and teachers when they have no moral, experiential, or academic authority to do so but firmly believing that because they have been promoted they must be right. Today there are as many women conducting their leadership in this way as men. The agenda of senior administrators is often oriented around "résumé stacking" so they look good for their next promotion. In the modern, individualist, competitive neoconservative education environments, career building has become the full-time job of almost everyone who enters educational administration. This new phenomenon has moved the focus away from quality professional decision making and organizational commitment toward politically advantageous decision making. No one who is in a particular level of administration plans on staying there for long anymore; they all want and expect to be promoted. To do this they must aggressively support and implement the various initiatives supported by their superiors with excessive enthusiasm so as to get noticed for promotion, just like in the private sector. This means they drive change in their schools for self-serving instead of educationally sound reasons, placing a burden on their staffs to successfully deliver for them. Teachers and principals

are now the stepping stones upon which career-oriented educators rise up the corporate ladder who feel they are being used for self-serving purposes disguised as professionalism. They are all looking ahead and drive agendas and staffs to look good to superiors who might promote them. This means they drive the agendas that their superiors promote, not the agendas their teachers or the public want or need, and rarely critically examine or question them.

The entire professional decision-making process in education has been negatively skewed to reflect political, corporate, and career-building priorities while the real concerns of principals and teachers about effective education are repeatedly ignored for political reasons. This is extremely unhealthy for education and democracy and debilitating for the principals and teachers who must professionally struggle in this artificial environment, where expectations are placed on them that are completely unrealistic and about which they are rarely consulted nor do they support. Professional education has become self-centered, narcissistic, and utilitarian as everyone from parents to trustees, superintendents, principals, and teachers use education for their personal self-interested ends under the guise of public involvement and consultation, leading to constant conflict and a paralysis of real reform in the face of superficial political reform (Shields, 2005). As a result, senior administrators, vocal parents, and trustees often override principal and teacher decisions leading to frustration, anger, conflict, and cynicism among the latter. Blackmore (2002) describes the problem for teachers:

There is increasing recognition that leadership is diffuse and dispersed, occurring in a variety of ways and in numerous contexts. Significant evidence supports the view that teacher-student interaction is the most significant direct factor in improving student learning. Yet, recent policies and career structures focus on the principal as change agent and fail to recognize teacher leadership as agency for change (Bascia & Hargreaves, 2000). Teachers have been positioned in the shame and blame discourses as failures. There is much evidence that teachers feel under stress (with overwork), under pressure (to perform), and under threat (of job security) (Troman, 2000). Much reform has been dependent on teacher goodwill, and many teachers are exhausted. Much of the passion teachers brought to their work has dissipated. (pp. 206–207)

The old methods and structures do not work on many levels. We need to restructure power and authority to eliminate these conflicts and create a more autonomous, equal, productive, and professional work environment in education that gives full and unhindered control of it to the professionals who deliver it directly to students: principals and teachers (Hubbard & Datnow, 2000).

Educational leadership culture is formally and superficially positive, constructive, and collaborative. It is a disempowering rather than empowering model of leadership and power. Educators are expected to support the vision, however flawed. In education, this is particularly problematic. The culture of education has become corrupted by self-serving power under the guise of leadership.

Rather than working with principals and teachers as professional equals as they should, senior superintendents and directors expect people to obey their commands in an environment where their commands have no validity or professional credibility any longer and their knowledge has no dominance. Their only credibility lies in the use of power. This has led to a serious gap between the autocratic decisions made by senior administration and trustees that often exclude the input or professional views of principals or teachers, leading to continuous and growing conflicts between the groups as senior administrators force decisions on educators and school administrators despite serious concerns raised about them. One example of this is the implementation of province and state-wide accountability testing. In an other insulting irony of openness and representation, students are now given seats as “trustees” while principals have no such voice at the board table.

Leadership is not and never has been about actually exercising leadership but controlling followers, instead of empowering them. In the duplicitous and artificial world of modern educational leadership theory and practice, *empowerment* has become an overused, meaningless word that disguises status quo power and authority (Brookfield, 2005). Real empowerment does not mean token empowerment, as is often bandied about in this hackneyed word that does little to decentralize authority and is most often paternally granted by the leader, but true empowerment providing followers with full formal and equal power and authority with superiors in a fully professionalized environment to allow them complete control over their decisions—in this case, principals and teachers (Apple, 2006; Sorenson, 1995).

Educational Leadership and Resistance

For those individuals in education or any other organization who disagree with traditional leadership and its underlying reliance on authoritative power, manipulation, and control, there are few options to develop and exercise a fairer, more democratic, reasonable, and collaborative kind of leadership where power and authority are shared and people engage as professional equals rather

than superiors and subordinates (Hatcher, 2005; L. Wright, 2008). Principals and teachers are the particular victims of such a disempowering system. The current cadre of leaders and organizational participants have no interest in reforming leadership or the structure of their organizations because they do not see a problem with them. There are no vehicles to accomplish change other than covert resistance or passive withdrawal, which is the path most teachers and principals take (Clements & Washbush, 1999). Top-down organizations such as education do not engage in discussions of their internal problems with a view to reform because it would necessarily have to involve discussing and critiquing the performance of the senior administrators who are responsible for the system and of the authoritarian values that dominate it. If principals and teachers work within the system for change, things happen so slowly that real change never happens. If they go outside the system or criticize it internally, they are ostracized or terminated so change does not happen. Any way change processes are framed they entrench the status quo. Democratic leadership has completely different goals than traditional patriarchal power-based leadership as Starratt (2004) expresses:

The fifth premise concerns a framework for thinking about the leadership of democratic organizations. Rather than emphasizing a framework of technical rationality, in which goals and objectives are set and then appropriate means are operationalized for their efficient and effective achievement, I want to emphasize leadership as "cultivation". By this I mean that democratic leadership is primarily concerned to cultivate an environment that supports participation, sharing of ideas, and the virtues of honesty, openness, flexibility, and compassion. Democratic educational leadership should be focused on cultivating school environments where Taylor's richer and fuller humanity is experienced and activated by people acting in communion. People with many different backgrounds, interests and abilities can bring these together in a common public work; namely a rich quality of learning by all members. (p. 388)

Democratic education in this sense is not about the individual at the top and making him or her look and feel good as traditional education does, but focusing on the issues by everyone without singling out one individual for particular recognition. In traditional organizations, individuals who are not part of the power structure are given little consideration or opportunities to express their concerns or change the system, and leaders give their ideas little credence. Few bureaucratic organizations tolerate democratic processes within their structures, and even if they do, it is in a controlled and restricted way toward pre-determined ends. Despite the fact that democratic practices are a far more healthy and adult approach to decision making in organizations

and are prized and desired by most professionals, they are rarely attempted anywhere around the globe.

The vast majority of organizations—large or small, private or public, professional or labor-based—are organized on hierarchical, authority-based principles that exclude the majority and exert control by the few rather than include and allow control by the many. So even if we have political democracy in theory, we have organizational and leadership oligarchy within it, making any real democracy impossible. Authoritarianism is cloaked in the robes of democracy in a patriarchal society to make it appear acceptable. Those in power are afraid that without their power they will have no leadership—and they are right. If educational organizations were structured with equal formal power between directors, superintendents, principals, and teachers, for example, education would be dramatically different and significantly more effective because the vast majority of those working in education would be enfranchised rather than disenfranchised as they are under the current system (Blackmore, 2006; Cambron-McCabe & McCarthy, 2005; Hatcher, 2005; Shields, 2005).

Anyone who has ever worked in an education system knows that the unspoken subtext is the important one to be listened to as in most organizations. Speaking out, asking probing questions, speaking out of turn, or seeking justification for actions or decisions of superiors is heavily frowned upon and openly discouraged—even in a profession like education—particularly if those questions are coming from a “subordinate” to a “superior.” Persistent challenging of the sanctioned authority is most often the death knell to career prospects. Proper deference to formal authority is always demanded. In education in Ontario this expectation is imposed on principals and vice principals who are now employed on Personal Services Agreements since 1998 that provide them with no tenure and leave them in a precarious situation in a highly politicized and conflicted environment. Any questioning of authority could lead to insubordination, discipline, or dismissal. They have been effectively silenced as a professional group from raising any real concerns or problems within education. Quiet compliance is expected, even from well-educated professionals such as elementary and secondary principals and teachers.

The removal of tenure has also been used as a method of control over academics in universities to restrict intellectual freedom. This organizational sub-culture heavily skews results in favor of the formal leader and senior administrators in school systems. Principals and teachers have been so co-opted into this system of repression that they do not even raise concerns through their professional organizations any longer lest they be viewed as “unprofessional,”

not “collaborative,” or not “team-players (Bogotch, 2000).” Consensus, collaboration and cooperation, and being a team player have all become perverse bludgeons with which to extract compliance from educators and curb their free expression. They have long ago given up the fight for professional autonomy, respect, and power within their organizations, so much so that in the case of teachers they have chosen to retreat into labor union affiliation rather than fight for their formal designation of professional associations like doctors, etc.

Those who ingratiate themselves to senior leaders are viewed as good candidates for leadership advancement and “team players” and are subsequently promoted, thus entrenching the status quo for another generation. It is a corrupt, dysfunctional, and unproductive cycle that must be challenged and changed. It is a Catch-22 for those aspiring to be democratic leaders; they are not viewed as true leaders by the traditional leadership system if they protest, and if they comply they must forgo their ethical and professional concerns about being traditional leaders and bigot themselves like everyone else. They have to go along to get along. The result of this organizational culture is fear, compliance, stagnation, and stasis. While education is constantly trumpeting its success and change, it is one of the most unchanging institutions in existence. Dufour and Eaker (1999) describe a meeting of the Reagan administration in the United States to celebrate school reform initiatives that had cost billions of dollars where those in attendance ended up concluding there weren’t any, a conclusion also reached by the Department of Education Undersecretary following his resignation.

The reason for the failed cycle of educational reform is the entrenchment of a bureaucratic, authoritarian, and undemocratic educational hierarchy that creates despair and cynicism among educators about change, because they have no control over it (Dufour & Eaker, 1999; Gray, et al., 2007; Toll, 2001; Willower, 1997). Change is so politicized it is unpredictable, which is destabilizing for educators and education. It is highly ironic that this kind of entrenched, repressive leadership practice and unchanging unsuccessful organizational structures exist within a purportedly modern democratic institution.

Currently education has cloaked its authoritarianism in self-effacing models such as servant (Thoms, 2008), cultural (Herman & Herman, 1993), and moral leadership (Sergiovanni, 1992) and other such bigoted, self-righteous, and manipulative postures while still practicing control-based, traditional leadership. Leaders are now well-disguised wolves cloaked in contemporary sheep’s clothing. Few if any leaders are “walking the talk.” This kind of duplicitousness is an all-too-common and unsavory component of almost all education

systems and a serious roadblock to more positive, independent, and professional cultures in education (Hatcher, 2005; Wright, 2008). Until we take on the tough issue of power and authority in educational leadership, educational organizations, and elsewhere—who has it, who benefits from it, and who wants it and why—we will continue in the dysfunctional cycle of failed, leadership-driven educational change that has characterized the system for decades and will continue to characterize it into the future. It is a repetitive cycle of imposed change, resistance, and failure followed by the same cycle again under a different banner. Within this system, as Starratt (2004) states, democratic leadership is an oxymoron.

The autonomy of education and the professionals who work in it must be protected and encouraged since it is the only primary potential source of democracy. This is a significant responsibility and requires balanced, objective commitment from educators to deliver this goal, but educators must be given this responsibility and right—unfettered by political special interests or personal agendas outside its operation. While the public, parents, trustees, senior managers, and governments all have a right to have a say and have input into decisions—if education is to deliver on its democratic promise—it must be left to educators, as professionals, to decide what decisions should be made to ensure this. It cannot be open to political manipulation, interference, or ideological control by self-serving public groups or vested interests, even well-meaning ones, but that is exactly the current state.

Educators tend to be a morally conservative and altruistic group who are motivated to enter education to make a difference rather than by remuneration like in the private sector. They are quickly disillusioned by the politically vicious environment that education actually is. They are more than competent and trustworthy to run our education system in the best interests of its students. It is time we started to let them do this. To achieve this, principals and teachers must have full tenure restored to act professionally and independently to make decisions critical to effective schooling in the same way that tenure works to ensure academic freedom and objectivity. Teachers must be made autonomous professionals without union affiliation to fully realize the professional potential of the field and place high expectations on them (Apple, 2006). Principals, teachers, and anyone else who works in traditional organizations are ultimately forced to engage in quiet, personal guerrilla warfare with superiors, the system, and now an increasingly radical and aggressive public in an attempt to survive and maintain their ethical, professional, and personal integrity. Open warfare is constantly ongoing just below the surface

of any traditional organization and in schools across the country. It is going on between teachers and parents, principals and parents, teachers and principals, principals and superintendents, and between schools and the public. It is an unnoticed struggle for political control of schools that has become continuous, destabilizing, ongoing, and dysfunctional in the past several decades of neoconservative control of education.

Educational cultures are most often full of palpable sublimated tension as political power struggles play out day to day, all of which are a major distraction from the difficult and challenging job of running schools. French (1985) describes the deep and complex subtleties of fear and coercion that are the well-known currency of leadership in educational bureaucracies:

Even in positions with tenure, like those of some academies, coercive techniques can be applied that isolate an individual from the academic community and from a voice in the structure, so that although the body is present in the structure, the person is effectively removed. Every hierarchy maintains itself by the inculcation of fear. (p. 303)

The techniques of coercion can be subtle, yet palpable. Principals know this only too well. Thus patriarchy and hierarchy are in themselves contrary to freedom and democracy. If one looks around our world today, one is hard pressed to identify a government, church, economic, political, or educational organization that does not function in this way. This organizational principle, whether in leadership or organizations themselves, reflects power and domination and is a demeaning self-fulfilling prophecy where patriarchal leadership is perpetually re-embedded in organizational cultures of all kinds and the only kind of leadership promoted, recognized, or rewarded is the status quo, patriarchal kind as currently acted out by both men and women who hold these positions. Healthy, open, honest dialogue or resistance to the will of superiors is not encouraged or supported, thus inhibiting real educational progress and change. This makes it impossible to bring real, democratic change to educational organizations, governments, or society. What we are forced to accept is autocracy parading as democracy. Education is particularly sensitive to the impacts of this situation.

Critical Resistance and Education

As difficult and challenging as this situation is, we have a moral responsibility and good reason to discern the "other reality" of a full and participatory

democratic educational system and critically evaluate the goals, directions, and outcomes of our education system through a lens that takes issue with the claims of Western corporate democracies, their education systems, and the commercialized democratic values of our consumer-driven society. Cambron-McCabe and McCarthy (2005) reference the views of Henry Giroux on this demand:

Giroux (1993) has urged educational leadership faculty to create "a new language capable of asking new questions and generating more critical practices" (p. 37). He has noted that "such a language would have to reformulate traditional notions of authority, ethics, power, culture, and pedagogy" (p. 37). The emerging social justice discourse provides a means to create this language and to focus directly on concerns about equity, student achievement, diversity, privilege, and social responsibility. (p. 214)

As Giroux implies, deep seated, comprehensive, and not surface reform is required. Rather than being givens in society, all of these forces are nothing more than theories and beliefs about how the world works that reflect a particular right-wing, patriarchal ideological perspective that has been forced on society throughout history and after a century of testing has failed repeatedly to deliver on its promises or to validate its fundamental premises (Giroux, 2004). The data on wealth and poverty are a stunning repudiation of the positive and cheery, deceptive rhetoric and candy-cane media images of the capitalist system and its values (Herman & Chomsky, 2002).

Whether we are for or against changes to education or society, they ultimately affect us all indiscriminately. In the global world of instant communication and instant destruction we can no longer keep our heads in the sand and claim ignorance of outside forces. The same is true of changes in any other area of the world today. Anything happening anywhere has a direct affect upon us right where we live. We must abandon our one-sided, romanticized, and blinkered Pollyanna view of our social and educational systems and evaluate them in a hard and realistic light that reveals their flaws to correct them. As Elmore (2000) concludes, "De-romanticizing leadership would have a very positive effect on the quality of schools" (p. 13). We need to move from pretend leadership to real leadership. Focusing on the positive may be a laudable personal approach to issues, but it is not a viable approach to social progress. Ignoring the persistent and endemic problems of poverty, inequity, greed, wealth, racism, and sexism and their sources in our society will hardly make them go away or change (Ehrenreich, 2001). Actively and aggressively

altering education and the rest of our society to reflect democratic values will. Equally, we clearly know the cause and the solution to many of these issues, but we lack the collective courage and will to implement them by reforming patriarchy and capitalism in our society. Attempting to gently encourage these elements to change themselves is pointless. The voluntary compliance of the oppressors will not happen. Governments in support of citizens must force democratic change; that is their job. In contrast today we have neoconservative forces all over the world that are actively dismantling democracy even in the highly touted Western democracies of Canada and the United States.

Most governments, academics, and educational leaders, however, are generally not of this view and are biased, self-interested cheerleaders for the traditional education and social system, leadership models, and economic practices of society (Giroux, 2004; Laxer, 1999). They rarely if ever closely and critically examine its fundamental goals, impacts, results, purposes, or directions or openly criticize it, let alone actively change it. While there is a great deal of posturing about change, little real change occurs. They work in their cloistered academic silos or political think tanks churning out de-contextualized irrelevance that is eagerly consumed by segmented social sectors that live in their own glass houses. Today we have an excess of informational freedom but little real change. Dialogue is a placebo for real change. There is less interest in bridging ideological divides or changing behavior. All are hesitant about embarking on real deep-seated reform of education, academia, or society because such a change would affect them directly and require personal as well as social change so they collectively reject real change as a whole for fear of what it will bring (A. Johnson, 2005). This is a dangerous position because change usually happens whether we want it or not, so we would be better to embark on a process of managed change toward democracy rather than civil war for change that is uncontrollable. Rather than being critical, they are complacent. There can be no greater sin. People should be more concerned about what they have and why they have it. If the South had relented on the depravity of slavery, they could have saved the United States a catastrophic conflict that they ultimately lost.

Everyone in the system has their comfortable little spaces carved out, and they are unwilling to disturb the system despite its serious and nagging fundamental problems and inadequacies for fear of dislocating their self-satisfied lives. This is what leads us to ignore genocide and devastation around the world unless it happens to us personally. It is the Anne Frank syndrome. If all of us living in glass houses don't start throwing bricks to shatter this

self-induced and self-supported delusion, someone on the outside will, and we will be totally unprepared for the forces that will be unleashed. The United States learned this on December 7, 1941, and again on September 11, 2001, 60 years after Pearl Harbor, yet we continue to ignore the global cries for real democratic freedom around the globe—a freedom that entails freedom from the exploitation as workers, as people, and as men and women. Those who do not learn from the lessons of history are destined to repeat it is an old truism that has merit (Lerner, 1997). The world learned this in 1929, 1980, 1999, and 2008 during the disturbingly regular financial crises created by capitalism's boom and bust ethos. We are witnessing it again with the vicious theologically driven barbarity of ISIL. Change begins with ourselves and if not it begins with someone else—either way, change happens. If we think it can't get any worse, it can, it does—and it has.

As a society we need to carefully and continuously determine how education works, who benefits from it, and whose interests it really serves. We must ask the same questions about our economic, political, religious, social, and personal systems as well. As Barlow and Robertson (1994) state, "Education cannot be depoliticized. Indeed, its political nature should be made more evident, so that the public can more readily identify the intent and impact of education reforms. Why are changes being made? Whose interests are being served, and at what price?" (p. 113). Michael Apple (2006) further states:

Education is a site of struggle and compromise. It serves as a proxy as well for larger battles over what our institutions should do, whom they should serve, and who should make these decisions. And yet, by itself education is one of the major arenas in which resources, power, and ideology specific to policy, finance, curriculum, pedagogy, and evaluation in education are worked through. Thus, education is both cause and effect, determining and determined. (p. 213)

As Apple points out, education is a pivot point for social change and thus is critical in the change process of society. We ignore this at our peril. We take our education system for granted but education determines how all the rest of our world ultimately works, so what is being conveyed is of tantamount importance to our future well-being. We need to know who is controlling education and the inputs to our future citizens. Democracy is not only the freedom to consume. All educators and the public who aspire to true participatory democracy must raise their voices and take action to create changes that will make that happen and to confront the forces of status quo power and

authority. Henry Giroux (2004) declares this call to arms for everyone who believes in real, full democracy, particularly educators:

As I have said throughout this book, intellectuals bear a special ethical and political responsibility at a time when the forces of mass persuasion and power assault all things democratic and non-commercial on this planet. The urgency of the current historical moment demands that intellectuals discard the professionalism, careerism, and isolation that make them largely irrelevant. Intellectuals inside and outside the university have an important obligation to offer alternative critical analyses, dismantle the illusory discourse of power, and work with others in creating an international social movement for social justice and radical change. In short, educators need to become provocateurs; they need to take a stand while refusing to be involved in either a cynical relativism or doctrinaire politics. Central to intellectual life is the pedagogical and political imperative that academics engage in rigorous social criticism while becoming a stubborn force for challenging false prophets, deflating the claims of triumphalism, and critically engaging all those social relations that promote material and symbolic violence. (p. 142)

We also need to examine, problematize, and interrogate the empirical results of the effects of capitalism on society by looking at the type of world that the democratic gulag has produced over the past century and will continue to produce if not changed. It is a polarized and polarizing vision and reality based on exploitation to generate material wealth. It cannot continue. Even a cursory look at our world would indicate it has failed to advance the condition of society for the majority of its inhabitants in anything other than a relatively positive manner. We live in a world of rapidly growing disparity and dysfunction between the haves and the have-nots and between various religious and political ideologies driven by patriarchal values, and we staunchly do nothing to change the system that has led to this point. This has not changed for centuries. We must examine who is included, exalted, and beatified by our present social system as well as, more importantly, who and how many are excluded, marginalized, and demonized by this adversarial, competitive social structure and why. The 99% need to raise their voices to a cacophony to assault the forces of privatism and elitism. Even those who believe in the current system are finding it more and more difficult to defend the obvious and glaring human disparities that they attempt to explain away. We also need to understand education's role in this process.

A more critical review of education will result in a better education system and a more truly democratic society in the future. As it is, we appear to be moving in exactly the opposite direction toward a more right-wing, individualistic, unrealistic, competitive, and destructive Darwinian future fueled

by religious and economic ideological fundamentalism that pits nation against nation and individual against individual in a damaging, self-destructive spiral of decline and eventual extinction. Despite its high-minded moral approach to democracy and its responsibility in preparing students for the future, education is in reality a rigid, unforgiving (and unapologetic) system of military-style indoctrination into the values of class and gendered democratic capitalist patriarchy, leadership, and economics coupled with factory-style assembly-line learning that are anachronisms in what should be a progressive, modern, evolving, and increasingly democratic society.

Education is the most powerful and universal socializing agent of the status quo that creates the citizens of the future. In Western societies everyone is required by law to go through it, so no one is left untouched by it. Together with a pernicious, pervasive, and subtle electronic media possessing the power to casually indoctrinate students and adults alike into values and beliefs of dominant economic interests in society, its power is formidable (Herman & Chomsky, 2002). We must be far more vigilant about the sinister propaganda side of media that Herman and Chomsky warned about more than a decade ago. There has been an electronic invasion in global society that is taking over our lives in unknown and unseen ways. There must be checks and balances built in to ensure that education and media are used critically, responsibly, and effectively to create a real democratic society, not just the illusion of one. As a result, both deserve to and should be subject to the most rigorous independent and governmental scrutiny and regulation at all times, yet in most cases little attention is paid to the why of education or the dark side of media. Most attention is focused on the how of education and the overt message of media, yet it is the why that is at the root of our problems, not the myriad of specific problems it continually attempts to address.

If we change the core of the system, everything else will take care of itself. This means controlling and managing the private sector as well as it manages the public one and public input to ensure that democratic values prevail in all aspects of life. We need to act just as aggressively as they currently do to manage society to ensure the values of wealth, power, authority, and control permeate our lived experiences. You cannot have a system that has controls on the public side without having the same controls on the private side. Equally, you cannot have a democracy that has different values for the public than for the private sector. Wealth and social justice are not separate social paths. The private/public divide has worked against democracy. To improve education and democracy we need to infuse democratic practices into everything we do

in society and not in just token ways or with easy sound-bites. Education and democracy are symbiotic (Portelli, 2001). Democratic practice means continuously attending to the serious task of the equal sharing of formal power and authority to drive change in both the private and public sectors. It means social decision making for the collective good that drives the structure and operation of our major social institutions and their core values. Currently that exists almost nowhere in Western democracies. Ignoring this divide will result in a global civil war of epic proportions and massive destruction and conflict that could effectively destroy society as we have known it. We can either accept change or have it imposed on us by global frustration with the status quo.

Democracy cannot take root in democratic authoritarianism or cultural imperialism. Throughout the last century since its foundation, education has never been open to serious debate about its core purposes, its structure, or organization, simply its methods. Most important initiatives (in particular leadership) have been delivered pre-digested to principals and teachers by vested interests within the private sector, senior bureaucrats in governments, and universities and school boards for "fine-tuning" and implementation. The decision about the philosophy, theory, and application of the initiative has already been made after some obligatory token gestures of consultation. Educators do not have nor have they ever had the right of first refusal about education reform as equal partners in the process. They are the last, instead of the first, to learn of educational change. In education as in society everyone has become too comfortable with the system and too comfortable with our contented consumer lifestyles to ask the hard questions about who sustains this system, how, and why. We have become a society of implementers rather than questioners.

Despite operating on outmoded, antiquated, and questionable values, structures, and knowledge, we continue to employ the same education "machine" to produce adults as we did more than a century ago without ever questioning whether it is proper, effective, fair, or useful in producing a modern democratic society. We continue to take the same approach to our legal, economic, political, and religious systems as well. Nothing that was relevant to anyone a hundred or a thousand years ago can be relevant today. We take the view that all these institutions have reached their final zenith, rather than being works in progress. This self-satisfaction will be our downfall.

As a public, we have ceased to question the ethics or the morals of the education itself or its goals; we are only concerned with how to implement them and make them work better. Most troubling, it is educators who have ceased to question the foundations of their own profession and to challenge

the status quo in a monumental act of professional surrender to the powers that be. Educators at all levels do not seem to realize that their calling is the highest moral demand that can be placed on any professional or any citizen—that of preserving and advancing the course of democracy and democratic rights in society. Educators should be vocal and at the forefront of media coverage of educational and societal issues as experts on school change and social issues. No profession has such a deep and implicit understanding of social problems as educators. It is this heavy burden that professional educators of the future need to take far more seriously and be involved in far more actively. Those who should be on the front lines of the battle for professional, self-controlled, autonomous, and democratic education are in fact subordinate and silent on the issue and co-collaborators in reinforcing the existing patriarchal status quo as are teachers' unions and other vested interests such as trustees (Lerner, 1997).

We need to reinvigorate this morally corrupt debate if society is to succeed for humanity. Educators must take a more active leadership role in this challenge. What should the experience of education look like if a responsible, productive, democratic citizen rather than a dutiful employee is our goal (Bates, 2006; Starratt, 2004)? Democratic education today has become an accepted and formulaic sham, a slave to the fundamentalist economic ideals of capitalism and authoritarian democratic dictatorships. We believe that we have perfected the system of producing democratic adults just as we have perfected the economic system. Nothing could be further from the truth, and we see the evidence of this all around us every day. Creating a democratic education system is the right and responsibility of every person, and every person has a right to be directly involved, not given token input and dismissed, which is frequently the case. In our media-savvy society, substantive, broadly based public input on key social issues such as this should be exploding rather than imploding.

John Goodlad (1990), in his seminal study of teacher preparation *Teachers for Our Nation's Schools*, states: "Clearly, faculty who perceive the function of school narrowly and teaching as a mechanistic series of steps provide the wrong role models" (p. 52). Teaching should be a driver of change, not permanence. The education system is still primarily structured to focus its attention on the elite academic stream of students who are bound for university despite the fact that they represent a small percentage of the whole school population and a miniscule percentage of that group who eventually graduate from university. The majority of students will either go to work or college after secondary school, yet programs to support these students are a secondary

focus in most school approaches. Secondary school is well named—it trains the majority of its students to be secondary by denying them a substantive formative role in their education or future. This methodology mimics life in society. Students are released into the democratic gulag where they encounter more hierarchy, authoritarianism, and bureaucracy. Rather than a rule and punish system, a democratic approach should take a rule and reward system to promote cooperation and positive behavior rather than disciplining negative behavior. Student, faculty, and parent discipline councils could be one model to begin to create real experiences with democratic decisions that are meaningful to students, where students and faculty sit as equals to determine the course of action for discipline in their schools as well as constructive actions that can be taken to improve student relationships with the system of education (Cowans, 2007; Grogan, 2005; J. Ryan, 2006; L. Wright, 2008).

Society must take responsibility for the situation that in many cases it has created through its economic policies. If prisoners in institutions had good educations, stable families, good economic prospects, and proper care and support, it is unlikely that they would have done poorly in school or dropped out or ended up in prison in the first place. Our education and economic systems are culpable in these realities. The solution to educational problems lies in economic policies, and the solution to economic policies lies in government policies. The economic system we have does not work, so it is no surprise that the education system we have does not work, either. We cannot fix one without fixing the other. Education works with what society sends it, and in most cases the product is damaged from economic policies. The link between social problems and the outcomes of democratic capitalism and its impact is direct and undeniable.

Clearly the professionalization of the roles of teachers and principals employing democratic leadership is the real key to making school change like this work—something that has never been attempted in other than token ways around the globe (Bolton & Muzio, 2008; Doyle, 2003; Portelli, 2001; Stern, 2002; Terhart, 1998). Leaders need to suppress their urge to lead and get out of the way to allow full professionalization to proceed in a radically restructured education system that is organized to support and facilitate school level educators rather than control and manage them. We need to unshackle educators to let them do what they do best: teach and organize. As Elmore (2000) states:

Public schools and school systems, as they are presently constituted, are simply not led in ways that enable them to respond to the increasing demands they face under standards-based reform. Further, if schools, school systems, and their leaders respond

to standards-based reforms in the way they have responded to other attempts at broad scale reform of public education over the past century, they will fail massively and visibly, with an attendant loss of public confidence and serious consequences for public education. The way out of this problem is through the large scale improvements of instruction, something public education has been unable to do to date, but which is possible with dramatic changes in the way public schools define and practice leadership. (p. 2)

Standards-based reform has already failed in its mandate as standardized tests and accountability measures have been softened to allow better performance for students because the results are not justifying the millions being spent on elaborate window-dressing exercises in public accountability (Wien & Dudley-Marling, 2001). Leadership has similarly been mired in status quo redundancy since Elmore issued his challenge. We spend far more on health care with far less accountability than we do on education. It is a waste of money and time.

Both teachers and principals passively resist imposed change and a restriction of their professional autonomy. This has led to the repeated failure of large-scale school reform over the past 50 years (Dufour & Eaker, 1999; Zimmerman, 2006). Their resistance is a silent cry for respect by educators who want to be treated and empowered as equals in the world of education and recognized for the skill and knowledge that they bring to the job, just like any other profession. They also want the full authority to carry out their work in the best manner that they determine, similar to other professions, instead of pandering to political vested interests who seek to destabilize their schools for self-serving political or ideological reasons. This is the only way to attract highly qualified people to the education profession as well, in particular males.

Education is constantly being buffeted by political forces that are the hidden reason why it cannot perform effectively. The people who dedicate their entire lives to education should be the ones who have the final say in how it runs. They also desire to be treated like full professionals with the commensurate respect and without the patronizing monitoring of their work and meaningless administrivia such as performance reviews every 3–5 years, the completion of day books, and other professional managerial encumbrances that are not required in any other profession once the individual has qualified, and do nothing to improve education or professionalize teaching (Hoy & Miskel, 1996). They are a complete waste of time. The message this sends to educators is that they are not trusted and competent professionals. Doctors, lawyers, engineers, and architects are responsible to their professional bodies

and their patients and clients alone (Hoy & Miskel, 1996; S. J. Maxcy, 1991). No one monitors and questions their competence at regular intervals or on a daily basis throughout their careers. The professional monitoring of educators has crippled education and hobbled productive reform.

The massive and overbearing authoritarian bureaucracy of education needs to be dismantled and the control over education turned over to professional educators to allow them to educate and innovate free from interference and unreasonable restrictions by the public, school boards, and micro-managing superintendents and directors, but with their complete support in a significantly altered power relationship. Education needs to be run as an arm's length, independent organization from the government much like Crown corporations. In this case, the dog should be wagging the tail.

The entire system needs to be turned upside down, with teachers at the top of the pyramid supported by a growing base of directors, superintendents, and academic experts who provide assistance for teachers and principals as they require and take formal direction *from them* about their needs, not the other way around as it is currently. This is not to say that ideas cannot arise from multiple sources, but principals and teachers must have the primary control over decisions about whether to adopt, reject, or defer educational ideas and strategies since they exist in the vast majority in education. Their professional views and opinions should carry weight both in education and society as they do in Finland. The most powerful professionals in education should be teachers and principals, not directors and superintendents. Central board office staff's function should be to efficiently run the operation of the school system while principals and teachers direct the educational operation of the schools. They should formally work as professional equals to create true consensus and shared decision making.

The old hierarchical superior/subordinate structure of education needs to be dismantled. Unfortunately, the main roadblock to such liberating change is an entrenched system of traditional leadership and the structures that support it. As Kretoivics et al. (1991) point out:

Unfortunately, traditional school reform has yielded efforts and results that have been limited at best. We believe that the failure of the majority of school reform efforts stems from the fact that they are top-down models that remove teachers, parents, and building-level administrators from the process. (p. 295)

Despite this observation, educational reform continues in the same dysfunctional pattern today. These unsuccessful models are replaced with the

same ones since the traditional authority model is critical to the success of neopatriarchy and cannot be abandoned. Instead, new hybrids of the traditional, singular, control-based, top-down leadership and organizational approaches have been re-introduced over the past 50 years with regularity under the guise of democratic participation such as management by objectives (MBO), rational planning, strategic and site or school-based planning, participatory decision making, professional learning communities, as well as a litany of leadership models such as servant, collective, distributed, moral, instructional, and managerial, to name a few (Wright, 2001). They have been conceived, promoted, implemented, and abandoned with regularity in education as each has fallen into political disfavor or disinterest after being unable to live up to its promise. They inevitably fail after being revealed to be ineffective, unwieldy, and time-consuming or a charade of traditional, top-down leadership and the status quo to those who are subject to their mandate. The status quo still controls the change process, to their own advantage. Teachers and principals need to take control of school reform. Most teachers take the approach “and this too shall pass”—and it usually does (Leithwood & Mascoll, 2008). As Hargreaves and Fullan (1998) assert:

What's Worth Fighting for Out There? makes two equal claims. It tells “society” that until it realizes that the quality and morale of teachers is absolutely central to the well-being of students and their learning, all serious reform efforts are bound to fail. Second, it says that teachers cannot wait for society to get it right. They will become their own worst enemies if they do not take action to help break the current deadlock of despair that envelopes public school systems everywhere. (p. 4)

Resistance by educators (or anyone else for that matter) to change is often viewed negatively when in fact those who resist often have legitimate reasons for doing so (Fullan, 2001). Opposition should be given serious consideration to create more effective change, but rarely is (Zimmerman, 2006). In corporate society we are interested in change for change's sake, not for any justifiable reason. We are hooked on change even when no change would be more productive. Change is encouraged to sell products—“planned obsolescence”—and to make profits but not to improve democracy and the democratic experience. It works well for business, not so well for everything else.

Despite the appearance of constant change over the past century, education and the act of teaching have remained remarkably the same. Teachers still lead a group of young people to engage with knowledge and progress in their development, and this is the most important act in education. The act of

education is a personal interchange that cannot be streamlined, economized, standardized, technologized, or made more efficient. No amount of urgency, accountability, or vision will change this fundamental abstract and qualitative relationship between teachers and students, and nothing can substitute for it, despite the allure of current technology and other curriculum innovations. No amount of educational faddism can substantially alter this critical interchange or improve its results. For this reason methods of change should focus on supporting teachers—what they want, what they need, and what they are willing to accept. The real way to achieve quality education is to have high academic and experiential requirements, hire the best educated and trained teachers, pay them highly to attract the best, and treat them with the commensurate professional respect and courtesy that we do every other full profession (Hoy & Miskel, 1996; Stern, 2002). After all, they have the future in their hands. If the billions of dollars that have been wasted on educational reform had been spent on this, we would already have a far more effective, creative, and democratic education system that meets the needs of all students.

In contrast, the current role for teachers and principals in the majority of change initiatives is to rubber-stamp them for the governments, academic experts, school systems, and senior leaders. There is a significant difference. This type of disempowering climate is what drives people away from education as a career. Change comes to educators pre-formatted and pre-digested. The resistance of educators is often mistaken for an unwillingness by teachers or principals to commit to change, when in fact it is repeatedly a symptom that teachers and principals do not want to be patronized and talked-down to or forced, coerced, or cajoled into doing something they do not agree with professionally and believe that something else (or often continuing with present practice) would be better. Their resistance is a symptom of systemic problems with the change culture of education within a power-based model that need to be fixed, and we should see it as such, not as thoughtless, change-blocking obstreperousness.

The constant stream of politically driven change in education has been debilitating for teachers and principals, demeaning of their concerns, and destabilizing, destructive, and dismissive of its failure to produce long-lasting change results. Rather than bringing change, we attempt again and again to alter the targets of change. Constant change has been disruptive and unsuccessful for education and paralyzing for educators who have unfairly taken the brunt of the flak for underperforming schools, an underperforming economy, and an underperforming society, despite the fact that they have done

their best to implement flawed reforms such as standardized testing only to be humiliated as low test scores are used as a stick with which to bludgeon the profession and to incite public hostility toward educators. These initiatives only serve to de-professionalize and demoralize teachers (Murphy, 2001). As John Goodlad (1990) observes, "The sure way to fail at educational reform is to ask of schools what they cannot do. Disappointed by the failure of such over-inflated reform efforts, we tend to abuse our schools. And abused institutions, like abused humans, perform poorly" (p. 17).

Education, like the media, is most often offered as a benign, productive, and innocent part of our smoothly running society and of individuals, but it has much more negative, utilitarian, and instrumental goals that few are willing to acknowledge, let alone even challenge (Herman & Chomsky, 2002). The espoused purposes of education are not its values-in-use. Education is a negative, repressive system that crushes the creativity, hope, and life out of those it educates, leaving them as social automatons in a mechanistic, utilitarian world.

The intent of education is not democratic; if it was, education would be far more self-critical, reflective, and open to democratic dialogue, criticism, and change from within and without, and we would live in a much more democratic and open world. The focus would be on creating democratic experiences for people in every way and manner possible. If education was truly democratic it would be much more fluid and flexible than it is today, allowing for different views, practices, and theories to be piloted and practiced to ensure that democratic education is delivered. Leaders in education and everywhere have failed to empower teachers and principals for decades while promising to do so. Full empowerment is not a privilege designed to educators by benevolent patriarchs but their right in a supposedly democratic education system and society. Shared power equals empowerment.

Education and Change—Changing Education

It is time we abandoned the patriarchal legacy of male power, authority, and control as the *modus operandi* of leaders—particularly in education—and began to lead in truly democratic power-equalizing ways that reject the economic values of the private sector and focus on real, human, professional values of educators and society: compassion, social justice, and collective cooperation within a social, political, educational, economic, and personal environment

that has as its main priority improving people's lives, sharing wealth equitably, providing the basic necessities to the world, balancing power, and creating real consensus (Apple & Beane, 2007; Saltman, 2007; Schafer, 2008). It is time we harnessed the power of free-enterprise economics and put it in the service of social rather than individual goals (McQuaig, 2001). It is time we stopped talking about it and started doing something concrete to make it a reality. In short, it is time for win-win social economics instead of win-lose, and educators should lead the change.

Leadership is heavily biased toward formal positional authority and is buttressed by a ponderous, supportive vertical bureaucracy that focuses on policies and rules while the vast majority of the leadership literature attributes the success of leaders to their personal charismatic qualities or vision (Gilbert & Matviuk, 2008; Wong & Sunderman, 2001). Leadership is an elaborately constructed social mythology with little relationship to its grim historical reality. Consensus building, collaboration, and democratic forms of leadership are a false pastiche promoted within this setting and structure that is completely antithetical and caustic to these ideals. Most "collaborative" decisions in education are artificially forced and controlled by senior administrators through positional power and authority. They rarely reflect the concerns, wishes, and desires of principals or teachers as professional educators. Who defines the problem controls the issue. Thus freedom in education is ironically closely circumscribed and controlled.

The disconnect between theory and practice is endemic to educational reform and can be seen in the currently de-rigueur popular models in educational leadership: "distributed" (Harris & Muijs, 2003), "collective" (Leithwood & Mascal, 2008), "instructional" (Stewart, 2006), and "servant" (Mitgang, 2008; Sergiovanni, 1992) coupled with "professional learning communities" (Dufour & Eaker, 1999; Noonan, Walker, & Kutsyruba, 2008). All are focused on leaders, not followers, and portray leadership as a benign, positive, democratic, and collective enterprise between leaders and followers as though followers enjoyed the experience of being dominated and marginalized and were fully enfranchised. Rather, the relationship is a tense, stressful, authoritarian, and conflicted reality that is most often ultimately dictated by the leader and his or her formal positional power supported by an unrelentingly unchanging bureaucratic hierarchy. It is nothing more than elaborate professional and social role-playing by educators. They all conveniently ignore the significantly different power and authority relationships that exist between levels of the organization and between leaders and followers as well as the leviathan bureaucracy that crushes any spontaneity

and speed out of change initiatives while symbolically reinforcing the status quo. The constant silent, dysfunctional continuous patriarchal power struggle between leaders and followers is ignored (Collinson, 2005).

Any open, collaborative, and consensual organizational process is always a sham conducted within the background context of the power and authority of both leaders and the bureaucracy. At any time leaders can manipulate, force, or change the democratically decided or desired directions created by an individual or group and override these decisions as they often do. The recent actions of the Greek government regarding economic austerity measures is a current example. Consultation is a well-orchestrated charade in most cases. This is why there is such a deep cynicism toward change among educators and society. This happened with strategic planning but is a daily part of most educational and other organizations. Directions supported by hundreds of people are ultimately forced through the leadership Venturi Tube of a single organizational individual who can support or ignore their ideas. This is the Achilles heel of pyramid bureaucracies and heroic leadership models. It is a highly undemocratic structure governing what are ostensibly democratic processes. Trusting participants are left disillusioned and powerless to do anything to stop this, particularly principals and teachers (S. Maxcy, 1991; L. Wright, 2008).

The continuation of these anachronistic, traditional, singular leadership theorizing approaches and hierarchical bureaucratic organizational structures are the primary cause of the majority of the conflict and change failure that occurs in education and elsewhere where old ways of doing things clash with new views on democratic leadership and education much more than external challenges. While there is a widespread desire and belief in more democratic leadership as true partnership among principals and teachers and a willingness to initiate such change, little has practically been done to alter the culture of modern educational organizations. As Hatcher (2005) points out, "In the 'democratic school' participation was seen not as a management strategy, to be granted on licence as a privilege, but as a right, an entitlement, of the teaching staff" (p. 262). Over the history of humankind people have repeatedly expressed and held the desire to live in truly democratic societies while forces committed to domination and control have repeatedly prevented them from doing so (A. Johnson, 2005). Why can full democracy not be allowed to flourish in education and elsewhere? What great fears do we harbor regarding democratic processes (Starratt, 2004)? Why are we so invested as a human species in human misery, domination, and authority? Real democracy is the state of human autonomy preferred by all as a natural human, political, and

economic condition, yet we have a history littered with the casualties of this desire. As Lerner (1997) states: "Closing the gap between theory and practice in education means changing the value system by which theorizing is considered superior to doing. The citizen of the 21st century will need a new blend of interaction between these two polarities" (p. 92). We talk about being democratic, living in a democracy, and wanting democracy, but what we get is something completely different whether in education or society.

Education is a professional democratic culture confined within an outmoded, ponderous, antiquated patriarchal leadership bureaucracy and discourse that has no relevance to modern democratic aspirations of contemporary educators or to the techno-savvy, plugged-in younger generation, yet it continues to be prevalent everywhere. We are educating students for the future by using techniques from the past not only technologically but also culturally, intellectually, and personally. We need to pivot this thinking 180 degrees. We need to educate students to view their world critically and responsibly and connect their world with its sources that generate their reality. Students have to know how their food is produced, how and where their cell phones and clothes are made, and how their society functions in relation to and because of others. We need to inject social responsibility in students, not sanitize their world of it. This raises serious questions as to why this disconnect is the case. As Apple and Beane (2007) assert:

Like any serious school reform, the issue of sustainability needs early and persistent attention in a democratic school. Unlike other projects, however, creating a democratic school by definition involves certain things that are fundamental to sustainability: distributive leadership, consensus decision making, collaboration, and the like. As these features emerge in a democratic school, they must be coaxed into the deep structures and culture of the school as norms, rather than experiments. The same goes for other aspects of a democratic school, including family involvement and student voice. Only when the democratic way becomes the "way things are done around here" is there a chance for sustainability. (p. 38)

The critical feature that Apple and Beane neglect to mention is formal power, which must also be equalized if the other qualities of a democratic school are to be achieved. As Apple and Beane correctly indicate, democracy is a much more delicate concept than authority and needs to be cherished and nourished. Creating democracy requires far more hard work than creating domination. Employing domination is narcissistic while creating democracy requires thinking of others. We need to begin to put as much energy, money, resources, and enthusiasm into creating democratic environments as we have

into killing, maiming, and dominating people for the past several millennia. In modern educational organizations, distributive leadership, consensus decision making, and collaboration are all window-dressing conducted within the ideological confines of a strict, unbending hierarchical bureaucracy and authoritarian leadership practices. Democracy cannot flourish in this gilded cage. Apple and Beane's (2007) message is that we need to change "the way things are done around here," yet in examining any school system one finds there is little appetite for this. School structures, organizations, operations, leadership, and organizational culture continue to be mired in a comfortable top-down and a stultifying, authority-based status quo and are virtually unchanged in more than a century. Educators merely oil the humming machinery in the factory rather than dismantling it.

Parents have been given greatly increased political power in schools through parent councils at the same time as principals and teachers have had theirs sharply curtailed under the mantra of managerialism (Apple, 2006; Blackmore, 2006; Fitzgerald, 2009; J. Ryan, 2006). The result has been that vocal vested interest groups in schools have co-opted the education agenda to drive their purposes while ignoring the needs and concerns of the larger community. This has destabilized and politicized schools in an extremely unhealthy manner that was never the case before. To achieve Apple and Beane's (2007) goal there needs to be a levelling of the power and authority between superintendents, principals, and teachers, giving teachers and principals the primary or at the bare minimum equal authority, autonomy, and control over educational and school decision making in conjunction with parental input (not control) and academic educational research as the driver for change in the same way that law and medicine operate (Cowans, 2007; Dee, Henkin, & Duemer, 2003; L. Evans, 2001).

The other key change that must occur is to separate board-level organizational functions from education and schooling. Central offices should be responsible for the financial and operational management of schools to achieve cost efficiencies—nothing more. School trustees are a politically biased and irrelevant group who have little real power or authority any longer, and often interfere directly in school affairs in dysfunctional ways. Trustees misinterpret their collective authority as a board as individual authority as a trustee, which is not accurate or legally appropriate. Trustees are no longer required or productive in education. Education-related matters should be under the primary control of the principals of schools and their teachers, assisted by superintendents and others but not controlled by them. Superintendents should answer

to principals, not the other way around. Principals as a group should be given the primary responsibility and full authority over school education, and their collective and individual word should be final to restore stability to education. In short, we need to fully professionalize education in a major restructuring of its core functions (Apple, 2006). At the least principals and senior managers should have equal formal organizational authority to become fully enfranchised professionals with a real say in what happens. This includes hiring, curriculum, special education, and all other services delivered to the school so that the needs of each school can be met by a custom-tailored plan that suits that community. If principals can't hire and fire the staff they believe will make their school successful, then they should not be held accountable for school performance. Bureaucratic HR departments have taken over personnel decision making, often overriding local principal choices. Parents, through school councils, should have advisory input only into the decisions of staff and principals, nothing more, eliminating the contentious school-level struggles between a few politically driven parents with agendas and the principal or staff that currently plague schools across the nation. Citizen councils don't tell doctors how to operate or run hospitals—schools should be no different. The principal of the school should be the last court of appeal for parents, not superintendents or the director.

Traditional schooling has failed and continues to fail to fulfill the contemporary needs of students, teachers, and principals. It is time we tried a bold and sensible approach to right the ship by giving control of education to principals and teachers by empowering them, both of whom are extremely well-qualified to take on this responsibility. This will clear the politically correct logjam in education and allow local principals the freedom and the respect they deserve. Central office staff should function as system level coordinators of services rather than monitors and micro-managers of school operations as they are now. The existing power structures of the organizational bureaucracy and leadership must be dismantled to create a climate for free democratic discourse, leadership, and schools to evolve. Unfortunately, this will either take courageous leadership from principals and teachers and their professional organizations to challenge the status quo and demand this change or those who hold power to initiate changes that deconstruct the hierarchy they work in. The likelihood of either happening is extremely low at the present time, but the need is pressing.

Increasingly, private sector values are taking full control of education at every level, disenfranchising those who have democratic aims. This is why we see so much unrest around the world as people as a collective group resist and

struggle against punitive, arbitrary forms of patriarchal leadership. This leads to ineffective and expensive large-scale change initiatives that waste taxpayers' money while keeping organizational cultures stagnant, unchanging, and unresponsive to the real needs of the future and the real desired future of those who must deal with the existing system. Past large-scale change efforts such as strategic and school-based planning were superficial exercises that were only intended to give the appearance of change, not to create real, deep-seated structural change in organizations, power, or leadership. Their heightened promise led to an even deeper sense of disillusionment and cynicism among educators when they failed to deliver their empowering expectations to schools. A hierarchical bureaucracy filters and focuses out important change ideas and allows only those that are consistent with the narrow professional views of traditional senior management to prevail, leading to the continuous cycle of failed school reform we have endured for decades (Gray et al., 2007; Portin, Alejano, Knapp, & Marzolf, 2006). Something needs to change for things to change.

In addition, the focus of education should shift from university preparation to more practical college or work preparation. Currently the entire system is geared to support the small percentage of students who attend university while ignoring the rest who go on to college or work. Our education system is an expensive, elite training ground; this needs to change. Of the small numbers who attend university, an even smaller number actually finish their studies. We have a massive system focused on elite success to the detriment of everyone else in it.

Education presents and promotes itself as democratic, professional, collaborative, consensual, and open, within a restricted, top-down bureaucratic system that represses any real development of these concepts except in extremely limited circumstances. Democracy or democratic leadership cannot exist or be developed within this environment, but this is what we are asked to believe. This is neither democratic nor educational. Rather than making their argument on the basis of its validity and letting the organization decide, leaders force the argument with their authority and manipulate the organization to consent (Freire, 2001). Top-down control is unsuitable and inappropriate for any modern democratic society and particularly education, yet we continue to return again and again to this type of educational change and people continue to reject and resist this style of leadership, leading to a dismal cycle of failed, large-scale education reform. From the publication of *A Nation at Risk* in the United States decades ago, large-scale reform documents, reports and studies have repeatedly revealed that the major reason for this

failure was the lack of substantive involvement of teachers and school-level educators (Kretovics et al., 1991). Since then reform has continued to impose top-down, expert-driven change (Duffy, 1994; Dufour & Eaker, 1999; Terhart, 1998). The result continues to be the same. Standardized testing will soon be gone like all the other global fixes for education that have failed in the past. These structures are overlaid with a thin veneer of more collaborative, democratic, and seemingly professional rhetoric that covers up the unchanging negative core of educational leadership and politically driven change that denies teachers a rightful place in the process.

In a true democracy there should be many leaders because they would only arise naturally with the complete and ongoing consent of those they are leading in a fluid and dynamic relationship controlled by the followers, not the leader (Bates, 2006; Blackmore, 2006; Hatcher, 2005; Mayrowetz, 2008; J. Ryan, 2006; Starratt, 2004). Democratic schooling should work in exactly the same way. As Blackmore (1989) indicates:

Rather than privileging the individual who is often already in a position of status and power because of specialist knowledge, capacities, skills or role allocation, expertise can, in a cooperative environment, empower the individual *and* the group. Leadership, and the power which accompanies it, would be redefined as the ability to *act with* others to do things that could not be done by the individual alone. Leadership, therefore, would be a form of empowerment and not of dominance or control (Ferguson, 1984, p. 206; see also Burbules, 1986). (p. 123)

Despite Blackmore's assertion, the latter continues to be the case and has enjoyed resurgence in the last 20 years under the neoliberal and neoconservative revival. In a democratic organization leaders would be frequent and varied in their roles and beliefs depending on the circumstances. Many people would lead over the course of a year. All would be equals in roles, power, and authority. None would be permanent (Cowans, 2007). Research indicates that participation of teachers in education is positively linked with four major outcomes: job satisfaction and morale, trust in school leaders, reduced stress and burnout, and reduced conflict on the job (Bacharach & Conley, 1989). Reducing bureaucracy and traditional top-down leadership while providing significantly more autonomy and authority to principals and teachers would have a major positive impact on these factors and their morale. Despite significant evidence that giving teachers and principals control over their profession would lead to improved outcomes, the system continues to resist such changes.

Education inculcates, indoctrinates, and socializes young and old alike to be the compliant citizens of the present and the future, no matter what the country, ideology, or time. Rather than an innocuous, undemanding process of learning and development, education is a purpose-driven exercise manipulated by every society to create the citizens it wants—but not necessarily the citizens they want to be. We need to direct far more critical attention to education and changing education to improve society (Brown, 2006).

While this all appears natural, neutral, and positive, most education systems and resultant societies have a significant negative potential built into their structure as well that is most often ignored. The success of the few is paraded in front of the world as the ideal to achieve, while the reality of the majority is a pale shadow of this dream. The question we must all answer is, How do we ensure that education does not become a force of dysfunctional ideological purpose and ensure that our democratic education system is, in fact, democratic (Starratt, 2004)? The only way to do that is to subject education and all other institutions in our society to rigorous and continuous critical scrutiny to ensure that they are meeting those criteria and to keep education independent of the ideological control of governments, activists, and external theorists. Starratt (2004) suggests a series of questions to test the veracity of a democratic education system as does Bates (2006), who employs Bottery's (1992) ideas for democratic school accountability:

- (1) Does the management of the school promote personal growth?
- (2) Does it treat people as ends in themselves or as means to ends?
- (3) Does it foster a rationality which is not only tolerant of criticism, but actually sees it as an essential part of school and society?
- (4) Does it repudiate the view of human beings as resources to be manipulated, and instead see them as resourceful humans?
- (5) Does it create an ethos where measures of democracy can be introduced and replicated within the society at large?
- (6) Does it foster an appreciation of the place of individuals as citizens within their own communities, states and world? (Bottery, 1992 quoted in Greenfield, 2004: 180) (pp. 143–144)

Education and educators must be independent and autonomous if it is to provide an education in democracy and create democratic citizens. There are no better people to leave this job to than those honest and committed people who dedicate their lives to it—principals and teachers—normal, common people who want the best for their society and have no personal agendas or self-interested motives in doing their job other than educating students in the

best way they know how. They have all shown themselves to be one of the last professional groups to conduct themselves with a high degree of moral purpose and integrity. They should be carefully screened for their views not on education but on democracy, human freedom, and the ways they believe it can be created through education. The attitudes, beliefs, and core values of our educators are the most important criteria for entry into the profession—knowledge, content, and skills are secondary. It is the context they educate from that is important, not the content. With information technology these values are even more important to providing students with the proper perspective on the material they access daily.

The prime goal of all education should be how well it attends to creating democratic values, attitudes, and beliefs in everything it does much like in Scandinavian countries (Johansson, 2004). We also must have a clear set of checks and balances built into the system by structuring educational power, authority, and organizations to reflect equalized formal power and authority between the various players that have a stake in its products to ensure that democratic consensus can prevail, not forced autocratic visions, and without intimidation, threat of job loss, formal authority, or subterfuge. This is crucial to change and currently this does not exist. Formal power and authority is organized vertically with all levels beneath one another and being subordinate to the decisions of an increasingly narrowing level above it. We need to invert this process so bottom-up decision making or “coffee filter” decision making becomes the norm, but we need to do it by reversing power and authority in organizations as well. What this essentially says is that currently we are putting all our eggs in one basket as we decide that certain individuals will be vested with more and more responsibility and power to direct the social vision of a particular organization, business, or government for the future, while this system ensures that they will become more and more detached from the one they are supposed to direct. This is a common but dangerous assumption that regularly leads to catastrophic results for society and individuals. The only circumstance where decisive leadership is required is in times of extreme crisis and this is rarely the daily reality of society or education.

Instead, we need to place our decision making in the hands of the largest subset of people possible to ensure checks and balances on leaders. To move gradually away from top-down authoritarian control in education and elsewhere means radically restructuring the culture and structures of education and all organizations from the ground up in slow but progressive ways that ensure the full professional autonomy and power to all parties directly involved

in educating children. Those removed from doing so should have sharply decreasing power as they move away from this primary contact. This is the only way to ensure quality decision making at the student and school levels in education, quality educational programs, and quality educational products. Education must be liberated from the chains of conservative, utilitarian mediocrity and allowed to flourish under truly free democratic mandate. A professionalized and independent education system is the best hope for a democratic future. Such a system would not be insensitive to public input and ideas but would have the ability to filter out ideas based on professional judgments and empirical and qualitative research without political interference and pressure. Professional autonomy would insulate educators and education from destabilizing and politically short-sighted decisions or directions.

Education (and particularly elementary school education) is one of the most politically contested, conflicted, and controversial arenas of social interaction and development, yet it is ironically sanitized of any political or religious debate (Brookfield, 2005). We pretend that education is not political. In education there are far more questions than answers, far more problems than solutions, and far more conflicts than harmony, yet most educational leaders work hard at creating the artificial impression that the answers are known, the path is clear, and the process established. Educators have been trained to espouse a blind faith in leaders and leadership. Education treats educators like students. If everyone just does what they are told and trusts their great leaders, everything will be fine. No one really believes this anymore, yet we keep going through the motions of traditional leadership. This encourages dependency and acceptance of external solutions or approaches that ultimately fail because they have not been developed and vetted by people themselves. Most educational organizations operate in a dual layered reality—the formal fabricated reality of the organization, its policies, philosophies, and practices and the underlying true reality that is lived and experienced by everyone who works in or is affected by the system. The latter is most often diametrically opposed to the former. The former is the tip of the iceberg of organizational reality while the latter is the submerged mass that defines what the real life of education is all about. It is time we started recognizing the mass of the iceberg beneath the waterline before it sinks the ship.

The excess of self-assurance of senior superintendents, directors, politicians, and academics who have the “vision” is the biggest threat to quality education in addition to the suppression of real dialogue about the purposes of education that occurs within educational organizations (Fitzgerald, 2009;

Freire, 2001). The current status quo sees no problems with how education is organized, and that is the major problem faced by those who aspire to a fully democratic society. In education, real discussion of issues by those who have the practical expertise such as teachers is ironically discouraged, trivialized, or ignored, and most forms of dissent against current practices is dismissed as the views of a small, radical minority or disgruntled employees. This is the disinformation and discreditation that neoconservatism injects into social debate. Those who want change are marginalized; those who want stability are rewarded. Superficial dialogue only is promoted—discussion that generally revolves around senior administrators or union executives pre-determined directions for the school system with a view to gathering “input” from “officially” recognized groups to fine tune these directions but not to change, reject, or substantially alter them. There is an accepted and elitist knowledge about education, leadership, and society that pervades educational discourse and restricts real debate about change. Education prides itself on a flawless, peaceful, conservative public image of problem-free operation while just beneath the surface lies an ocean of resentment, frustration, and anger among the public, students, teachers, and principals who are subject to this antiquated, corrupt, top-down, authoritarian juggernaut and its negative and debilitating emotional, psychological, and professional effects (Speilmann & Radnofsky, 1997).

In modern education around the world there has been little real debate about its goals and their value to society since the Industrial Revolution, although paradoxically it is one of the most discussed concepts worldwide (Wagner, 1993). The majority of the discussion in education and leadership is superficial noise and revolves around the authentication of traditional leadership and authority rather than the critical examination of it. It is primarily carried on by educational leaders, university academics, and government officials. More open and democratic approaches that allow educators and the public real input and control of the process is rarely in evidence despite much rhetoric about servant leadership, consensus, collaboration, and professional dialogue. Principals and teachers are expected to rubber stamp initiatives. The debate in school systems and nations is focused on how to do the job within the restricted parameters of traditional leadership and factory model education, not on whether or not the job itself is worth doing and the factory needs to be retooled or closed because it is no longer competitive or relevant.

We must return to this core debate to reinvigorate and protect education and democracy. All the discussion about leadership, curriculum, teaching, and structure is pre-determined, formulaic, and assumed. Everyone goes

through the well-rehearsed motions of continuous change but everything remains resolutely the same. As Toll (2001) points out, "Everyone wants change. Still, despite the encouragement for change from many people and sectors, and despite an elaborate technology of change that offers a smorgasbord of suggestions about how to achieve change, school change rarely takes place" (p. 2).

There are few real, sustained challenges to existing leadership theory, models, paradigms, or practices in education, and the same is true about curriculum, behavior management, teaching methods, or school structures as well. Rather than education being an open, creative place of innovation and professional experimentation with democratic methods to stimulate education and learning, it is instead a place of static slavishness and adherence to age-old historical beliefs about how people learn and should be taught, how power should be exercised, how democracy should be realized, what knowledge is important, and how society and organizations should be modeled, all based on patriarchal heraldic beliefs. This is the case despite a litany of leadership models, organizational theories, and curriculum efforts touting improvements in the system. When we stand back and view the core changes in education over the past century, they are minimal and shallow. The factory model remains firmly entrenched as are the market-led industrial business values that spawned it. Once again right-wing, rationalist views of society and education have reasserted themselves in the last 20 years. We see these today in standardized testing programs and calls for more "accountability" in education in relation to outcomes for students (Leo & Barton, 2006). The pendulum of education is quite restricted between conservative authoritarian and liberal authoritarian. It rarely swings toward liberal democratic, let alone fully liberated democratic.

This is the kind of society that modern education tacitly supports and promotes without interjecting a professional voice of reason into the debate. We have become unable and unwilling to demand a real democracy and democratic rights for our children or ourselves and afraid to challenge the relentless assault on our social psyche of free-enterprise materialism and all the crass, empty values that it brings with it. Patriarchal education, politics, and economics are the primary reasons for this situation. Rather than being the source of autonomous, democratic practices and ethics that it should be, modern education is the projection of partisan political ideologies and their superficial fulfillment in society. It is the mirror of the political climate of society and the puppet, rather than the architect, of its beliefs. The tail is wagging the dog

and education keeps chasing it in an endless and fruitless pursuit that leads it nowhere and exhausts its resources.

This means that education is a perpetually revolving door that exists in a constantly destabilized state as educators await the next election and the next about-face in education that will invariably ensue. This creates a culture of "suspended expectation" where nothing of substance gets done and teachers just work in maintenance mode until the next change that they know is coming (Dufour & Eaker, 1999; Leithwood & Mascal, 2008; Patterson, Purkey, & Parker, 1986). Change within stasis is the rule of the day. Rather than basing decisions on stable academic research in the field and the professional knowledge, experience, and expertise of educators, decision making is strictly controlled by massive politicized and self-interested educational and governmental bureaucracies that impose change from above and latch on to silver bullet theories for short-term gain, thus effectively killing off any real change. If education were left to educators, change would be much slower and less frequent just as it is in the medical sciences since research on school reform indicates the most important factor in embedding permanent change is time (Raywid, 1993). Thus, slowing down change would actually bring better and more sustainable change in the long term. Instead, change is accelerating as a relentlessly demanding irrational politicized process that expects more and more from education and educators in the theoretical belief that this will create better and more productive citizens.

In reality, the faster change happens, the less change there actually is. Principals, teachers, and students all have a finite capacity and tolerance for learning, and repeated change overwhelms their ability to absorb it. It cannot be forced. Most often, it is top-down surface change that does not involve or attempt to understand those who work closely in education in the schools—teachers, principals, students, and parents. Educational change has come to be based less on professional expertise and more on political whim. It is change for the sake of change leading to little real reform (Dufour & Eaker, 1999).

Since leadership and change are driven in a top-down, power-and-control patriarchal model, empowering teachers and principals by giving them both power and authority over their work is anathema to the goals of this system but would be a powerful antidote to the stagnation of the status quo. There are many ways to get to the same endpoint of an educated citizen and few hard and fast rules to follow in this pursuit. Change in the scientific community only proceeds after decades of empirical clinical study, and even then only cautiously, yet in education we change strategies like we change shoes. Most

have limited basis in validated educational research and are simply faddish theories driven by political expediency in conjunction with opportunistic academics. Theories are implemented in education with little proof that they work, whereas theories are rarely implemented in health care unless they are proven beyond any doubt through lengthy and rigorous empirical research and clinical trials. Law is practiced on the basis of centuries of elite "common law" and all cases are argued and decided within this context, yet education rarely uses the past to inform the future or research to inform its directions. This whole process demoralizes and defeats educators and students, leading to a utilitarian, politicized, and relativist approach to education rather than a sustainable and evolving one (Portelli & Solomon, 2001). After centuries of learning, we should know more about how to educate people, but we don't. The human to human interaction of learning is still a mystery.

This formal, sporadic consultation also leads to little change in the actual implementation or theory of the initiative. Strategic planning and standardized testing were clear examples of this where educators voiced strong concerns about the viability and value of such involved large-scale processes, but they were overwhelmed and ignored by eager senior administrators seeking to make political points with the public and a career gain by implementing the initiatives. Change in education is not a reciprocal interaction process between implementers and practitioners; it is a one-way monologue. Senior administrators in education went to training (brainwashing) sessions held by change gurus such as William Cook of the Cambridge Management Group in the 1990s and returned to their school systems proselytizing strategic planning as the new change panacea for education. After a decade of exhausting and expensive attempts to implement this cumbersome and costly process coupled with passive resistance from educators, boards gave up and another change dinosaur collapsed and died in the primeval ooze of educational reform. Consultation is strictly for show and the agenda of such inputs is always controlled by experts, politicians, or senior administrators who dictate the change process, not teachers or school level administrators, as strategic planning clearly demonstrated (Fullan & Steigelbauer, 1991). Instead of empowering schools, strategic planning ironically did the opposite as senior leaders tried to control the process to maintain their power and authority.

The leadership of the unions has a similar blocking function in the educational hierarchy. They work in the system as well and so take on pre-defined adversarial authority roles in representing their teachers and maintaining the oppositional status quo that gives them their jobs. They also restrict the free

speech of their members and thus restrict calls to liberate both educational and union organizations from male hierarchy and authority (Lerner, 1997). They also contribute to the persistence of patriarchy in education. Their function is generally to assist governments in adapting their members to the new changes, not controlling the change process on behalf of them or driving change initiatives based on teachers' professional beliefs or views. Teaching unions rarely take educational stands or positions on issues in education other than salary in contrast to professional organizations that control the knowledge base and practices of their members (Hoy & Miskel, 1996; S. Maxcy, 1991; S. Ryan, 1999). They do not present professional research or judgments about their professional work and as a result they are told what to do instead. Teachers' unions need to take full responsibility for the theory and practice of education and work with researchers to develop pedagogy and practice that they believe in and will defend and implement, and that is sanctioned by their College of Teachers. They need to abandon union affiliation if they ever hope to be considered true professionals (Weick & McDaniel, 1989). In contrast, to be viewed as politically acceptable they carry out their roles passively and rarely contest educational practices or innovations that directly affect their members in adverse ways. All educators are considered in the modern, neoconservative, and neoliberal managerial organizational culture to be line employees who are there to do their job and not ask any questions rather than well-qualified, highly skilled autonomous professionals. In the last 20 years of right-wing ideologies in education we have witnessed a constant deskilling and "dumbing down" of the input of principals and teachers (Apple, 2006; Sergiovanni, 1992; Tallerico & Blount, 2004). Not exactly the autonomous, well-educated profession that most teachers and principals thought they were signing up for when they trained to be teachers. As Roland Barth (1989) notes:

The biggest problem besetting schools is the primitive quality of human relationships among children, parents, teachers and administrators. Many schools perpetuate infantilism. School boards infantilize superintendents; superintendents, principals; principals, teachers; and teachers, children. This results in children and adults who frequently behave like infants, complying with authority because of fear or dependence, waiting until someone's back is turned to do something "naughty." To the extent that teachers become responsible for their own learning, they also become professional. (p. 234)

Barth argues for the full professionalization of teaching. The primary contributor to this infantilization in education is the patriarchal model upon

which it is built and the leadership models, structures, and organizational cultures that arise from it. It is most evident in elementary schools and preschool education where the majority of employees are women (Bernard, Hill, Falter, & Wilson, 2004; Burman, 2005; Sanal, 2008). Education is a subjective and human pursuit that is known best by the educators who teach the children they work with and as such they should have full control over their work within collectively established research-based, professional, and public boundaries but without the constant direct interference of these elements in their work. It would be like allowing people to give input into complicated surgery to ensure better outcomes. Once surgeons are trained; we let them operate. If education were left to educators with the input of governments and the public, the education system would be broadly based and would provide for a much wider diversity of options for students to achieve success in small settings.

The ultimate test of democratic change theories would be to equalize formal power and authority among all the various levels to see if the impact of leaders is still the same. Equalizing formal power and authority in education, not enhancing it, is the Rosetta stone for the implementation of democratic reform across society and ushering in a new era of full democracy that is the right of every citizen. The odds of this are highly unlikely. No one in education or academia is willing to risk promoting such an experiment because it would destroy the façade of traditional leadership theory and practice and reveal the real relationships between leaders and followers (Collinson, 2005). Everyone from the unions, to the boards, senior superintendents, the government, and current teachers are heavily invested in the status quo of dysfunctional siloed power and authority and do not want to change their comfortable roles, even if it means a better and more democratic education system and a more robust democracy. These theories never portray the continuous tension, conflict, and struggle that go on inside educational organizations between senior administrators who force a particular leadership approach on principals without allowing any flexibility in practice and principals who dominate teachers in a similar way (Portin, et al., 2006). There is no one way to lead or to follow, yet the variations in leadership and followership are minimal.

It is time we stopped dictating method and got on with educating flexibly. All of the previous approaches to large-scale school reform on their own were valid and viable if they had only been implemented in the manner they were intended, which was to empower teachers and principals to run their schools and have a significant role in educational change, which is what teachers desire (Fitzgerald, 2009). Unfortunately, control-obsessed leaders wouldn't

let go of their power and authority to let that happen. Allowing a diversity of educational practice, leadership, and structure would create a diverse and vibrant education system. Instead they were repeatedly hijacked by senior administrators who imposed "their vision" of the change process on principals and teachers, leading to their ultimate failure and abandonment. The problem with every one of them is that when they encountered the problem of restructuring power and authority to realize these changes, one after another, each change initiative came to a grinding halt.

Democratic change can only survive in a democratic organization that shares formal power and authority across the system but not in an environment of traditional leadership and bureaucratic organization that exists in all education today. Democracy cannot flourish in a gulag. Education cannot flourish in a gulag. Human freedom cannot flourish in a gulag. Unfortunately, we are blind to the democratic gulag we currently live in. We need to shake off the anaesthetic of patriarchal normality and begin to change our social practices. We need to radically reshape the organization, theory, and culture of education in more democratic ways while ignoring the demands of the private sector to give them employees. Elementary and secondary education should be generalist to create well-rounded, capable citizens, while college and university should then be for specialization followed by job-specific training once employed.

All of the supposedly "new" leadership concepts say nothing about changes to formal power and authority in organizations but naively assume and accept that these can be practiced and flourish within the repressive bureaucracies and historically top-down organizational cultures that currently exist. Collective and distributed leadership can only work with collective, equal, and distributed formal power and authority accompanying them, meaning a significant restructuring of the power and authority between principals and superintendents to create full professional standing and balanced autonomy for both. It also means a restructuring of bureaucracies and other hierarchic organizational structures to accompany these changes.

Currently educational change puts the majority of its energies into theory building and monitoring and managing change in the system, which effectively means monitoring, managing, and disciplining principals and teachers to ensure they do what they are told rather than doing what they want professionally and affirming school administrators and educators in the process. Rather than having educators create theory through practice, they are forced to validate theory for theorists. Most of the energy of school change is wasted

on managerial supervision and evaluation that research demonstrates is ineffective in creating personal, professional, or systemic change or commitment in teachers instead of putting it into making the change work for those who are implementing it. Real change, consensus, and democracy can only come within an environment of equalized and balanced formal and professional power between all levels of education and a flattening of educational bureaucracies to ensure more democratic decision making (Clark & Koonce, 1995; Hornstein, 1996; P. Johnson, 2005). We need to stop imposing everything on teachers. We need to move from leadership to "peopleship." Peopleship is the democratic equivalent of leadership. It is a word that in its meaning, structure, and concept abandons the regressive meaning of leadership as control for a new empowerment of people as equals and as new liberated leaders.

Currently change is similar to being allowed the freedom to exercise in the prison yard; you are still a prisoner and everyone knows this. None of the change concepts promoted over the last 50 years addressed the imbalance of power and authority between leaders and followers and the restructuring of the hierarchical nature of educational bureaucracies that promote an authoritarian culture that hangs like a sword of Damocles over all their well-intentioned change initiatives. Because education and most other major institutions are governed by traditional top-down leadership structures and cultures that impose change rather than develop it democratically, education is subject to the same endless cyclical real or imagined crisis-based change process that all other large institutions go through as one method of top-down control fails or is discredited and another method is developed and instituted (Klein, 2008). We keep getting our water from the same well and wonder why it is always tainted.

Within this mono-paradigmatic leadership and change culture and literature, education is constantly beset with political panaceas that appear with regularity and are intended to save society and education from incompetent teachers and public apathy. The hero model is premised on a single individual riding to the rescue of besieged communities or businesses and so generates a salvation mentality that seeks silver-bullet solutions to all problems—the medical model—all of which fail sooner or later because they are unrealistic, overly simplistic, romantic fantasies that only exist in movies and television. While there may be a silver bullet biologically or medically, there is none socially. Real change is a messy, complex, conflicted, and slow process that is resistant to instant fixes. It responds to honest and transparent collaboration with the goal of balancing formal power and authority between groups

rather than forced association. We cannot seem to accept this as educators, as leaders, or as a nation. Quick fixes provide superficial solutions but do not affect underlying systemic or paradigmatic problems. The only solution to deep-seated, long-term change is deep-seated, long-term efforts to change our fundamental paradigms about ourselves. We need to go from superficial change to deep change to improve the world. Society will need to make some difficult choices if it is to survive. To achieve this we must renounce patriarchy in all its incarnations and erase its influence on human behavior. This will require the courage and peopleship of men and women around the world.

CONCLUSION

We live in a democratic gulag within the well-orchestrated illusion of democracy, freedom, and autonomy in a world of self-deception that is so complete that we rarely question it. It is a restricted reality circumscribed by the values, attitudes, beliefs, and practices of patriarchy. This gulag is no different than the Soviet gulag described by Alexander Solzhenitsyn except that it is global and both internal and external. We live in the forest but cannot see the trees or the forest. It has become so normal that we do not even notice that we are living in a gulag; we accept it as our reality because we have no other point of reference. We are all Patrick McGoohan in *The Prisoner*. However, as this book has attempted to demonstrate, if we scratch the surface of its thin veneer, we can gain a glimpse of the paradoxical and pervasive inconsistencies and dysfunctions of patriarchy that dominate and threaten our modern world and skew human relations in destructive, subliminal ways. It is a world in which one gender prevails, and within that gender a small, elite group of the most ruthless and contriving dominate our social existence through violence, intimidation, and control. It is a world where the female half of the world's population is excluded, subordinated, and denied their basic human rights through the capricious and self-effacing beliefs of men. It is a world that most of us would prefer to ignore because confronting its ugliness implicates us all and demands that we

all make substantial changes to our social, cultural, intellectual, religious, political, and economic beliefs. Beneath the glitz, glamour, and minutia of daily life presented by media images of the success of the Western human enterprise, there exists a disturbing reality that we shut out of our consciousness but that is the most pressing problem for humanity today: the prevalence and predominance of patriarchy as the operative meta-ideology of global existence.

The gulag is built on a foundation of patriarchy; upon this rest the pillars of our major social institutions, upon which the living roof of our society is built. It employs authority, hierarchy, dominance, violence, and control to ensure the continuance of the social prison that we live in. The wardens of this gulag are men, but men and women are both prisoners and victims of the gulag (Lerner, 1986). It exists to further the interests of a small, elite group of individuals (primarily men) who enjoy status, power, and authority in this prison. They make the rules, interpret the world and existence as they see fit, and decide who lives and who dies. Whether we live in Western democracies, Middle East patriarchies, Russian oligarchies, or Chinese communism, or whether we are Christians, Muslims, Gentiles, or Jews or we are black, white, Asian, or Latino or we live under English, Chinese, or Sharia law, we live in the gulag of patriarchy. It knows no geographical, religious, geopolitical, economic, educational, or social boundaries (Afisi, 2010; Celikten, 2005; Chowdhury, 2009; O'Sullivan, 2001). It is responsible not only for the Soviet gulag but also virtually every other atrocity and oppressive event that has ever engulfed the world. It was in Bosnia and Herzegovina under Slobodan Milošević, in Cambodia under Pol Pot, in Germany under Hitler, and is currently in evidence in the Middle East with the ISIL terrorist insurgency. It is the dogmatic, petulant ideological whim of male superiority that rules us all in one form or another. It exists in domestic violence, pay inequity for women, child poverty, and the merciless exploitation of humanity through corporate globalization. Violence comes in many forms—some overt, others silent. Patriarchy is in continuous view in our television programming that romanticizes heroic machismo and in our media, government structures, legal frameworks, and personal relationships. It socializes both men and women into mutually engulfing, adversarial, and subordinating relationships (Lerner, 1986). Its message is always comply or suffer the consequences. It knows no liberty, no autonomy and no freedom.

Patriarchy is much more than a system of power in which men dominate; it is a hegemonic living reality that shapes our lives in a myriad of subtle and overt ways. Patriarchy is at once the most apparently innocuous and perplexingly

dangerous ideology affecting humankind today. It is everywhere and nowhere, visible and invisible, problematic and naturalized all at the same time (J. Acker; A. Johnson, 2005). It is the elephant in the room in every social situation anywhere in the world. Whether it is gender equity, poverty and wealth, sectarian or domestic violence, or capitalist free-market economics, patriarchy is there. It is the true invisible hand of the world. Like death, it is always standing in the wings. All that we see is the evidence of its influence but rarely the attribution of that evidence to patriarchy. It is, as has been noted of traditional organizational culture, "the way we do things around here." It has been so deeply socialized and ingrained into our cultural psyches over thousands of years of male dominance, violence, and control that for the most part we do not even give it a passing thought as we go about our daily lives; yet no other social factor has so deeply touched everyone in such a pervasive, all-encompassing, and internalizing way. Patriarchy has come to be viewed as a social anachronism and curiosity that is of little concern, rather than as an active, virulent, growing, and pervasive meta-ideology that dominates human relations in extremely dysfunctional ways and is the wellspring of all social culture and institutions today (Daly, 1978 cited in Walby, 1990). Patriarchy is the blood flowing through the veins of humanity.

Throughout the last seven millennia of recorded history and beyond men have defined what counts for knowledge, recorded their version of history as the victors, and forcibly claimed not only the physical landscape of the globe but also the psychological internal landscape of humanity. Despite its horrific record of death and destruction throughout the ages, men and women have come to a rapprochement with patriarchy and that is becoming increasingly problematic as we search in vain for the growing dysfunction and seemingly intractable and apparently mysterious problems of the world. We have all become creatures of men—genetically and figuratively. In that process patriarchy has also led to the suppression and eradication of any other forms of social evolution that might have led to more positive, egalitarian, collective, and fully democratic societies.

As this book has described, patriarchy is redolent in our societal values, leadership culture, and education systems. It is also the foundational ideology of our political, economic, and religious institutions as well. It has increasingly colonized both the physical and psychic landscapes of humanity to the point that we do not even conceive that a different and more democratic culture can exist. In our civilized arrogance we have assumed we are the highest extension of evolution. It has structured the reality of our lives and organizations

in specific ways that are based on authority, power, law, and obedience. Our traditional leadership models are shaped and designed around male visionary, messianic, and heroic gender patterns of aggression, violence, and domination that romanticize and idolize the victorious male. Our education systems emulate leadership models promulgated by business, the military, and sports to socialize our next generation into the same kind of leaders and citizens. Our education systems around the world continues to be structured on an authoritarian factory model developed at the height of 20th-century industrialization and reflects the values and beliefs of the men who created it. It remains an unchanged and unchanging ponderous bureaucracy that resembles a prison system more than an educational one, for both educators and students. What should be the wellspring of democracy and creative thinking of social organization is in contrast an authority-based and heavily scripted institution that demands compliance and conformity to a regressive model and punishes resistance and difference (Bogotch, 2000). Its primary role is custodial care and the infusion of content throughout a stepped system of hierarchy and authority. It is oppressive and suppressive. Without dramatic changes to our approaches to both leadership and education to focus on more democratic and open participatory organizations and educational experiences, we have little hope of turning back the evolutionary tide of patriarchy. We need to de-emphasize authority, position, and rule and rebalance power in organizations and society. We need to institute "peopleship" as the new leadership, which emphasizes the collective and collaborative grassroots nature of democratic leadership. Egalitarian democracy cannot exist in society, organizations or gender relationships as long as there is an imbalance of power between the parties. We must learn to see the value of non-competition, non-violence, and non-elitism and reward the value of true collaboration and the full autonomy of the person with all the rights and responsibility that entails.

The growing problem for humanity is the paradoxical invisibility and pervasiveness of patriarchy in our modern world. We have overreached our ability as a species to continue with an aggressive and dominant posture to life and living, which in our modern world is almost the exclusive preserve of males. Throughout our human history it is men who have employed violence to rape, pillage, and plunder with impunity, and it is this culture and self-declared divine right that we must problematize, reject, and censure. Our rapid intellectual and technological evolution is the Achilles heel of humanity because we have evolved much more slowly in our ability to curb our aggressive, competitive, violent, and dominant behavioral urges that regularly reveal

themselves in everything from domestic violence to geopolitical conflict. The growing problem that humanity must face is that in the nuclear age where Armageddon waits only a few short minutes away, we can no longer afford to ignore the potential of patriarchy to destroy humanity (Lerner, 1986). Given the growing sectarian and other forms of conflict, the serious degradation of the planet as a life-source for the world, and the intransigence of many political, religious, and gender-based positions, there should be a real sense of urgency to begin addressing the effects of patriarchy more directly and begin a global dialogue about change. Rather than attempting to solve and being overwhelmed by the myriad of problems in the world today, we would be better advised to seek long-term solutions to the real source of the problem than to continue putting out fires that constantly spring up (A. Johnson, 2005).

We must turn our serious attention to naming patriarchy as the source of the issue and begin to realize that what is required is a complete re-socialization of society into a more gender-balanced reality that entails the reduction in the socialization of aggression in both males and females to the re-socializing of women to be more assertive and to the abandonment of gender stereotypical influences. As Lerner (1997) states: "On the other hand, the goals of feminism cannot be achieved without a vast cultural revolution, involving every institution of society, in particular, the family. The magnitude of the social change needed presupposes the diffusion of the forces of change into every aspect of society" (p. 109). This requires a much deeper appreciation of the influence of patriarchy that goes far beyond superficial changes that have been achieved thus far. The implications of this are profound but imperative. This means less male men and less female women, but it does hold out hope for a new global reality that creates a society with fewer predilections for arbitrary aggression and violence as the answer to human problems and a more urgent interest in an egalitarian, collective, and fully participatory world. We must see patriarchy as our major social problem and our major roadblock to achieving a better world. We must begin to aggressively expose and address its impacts through social change, media influence, and particularly by changing the parenting of our children.

To embark on such a challenge has profound implications for virtually everything we do and requires deconstructing patriarchy as a working ideology over time. It will demand the concerted efforts of both men and women but primarily men who currently hold all the cards in their hands. It takes men to start speaking out aggressively against men about the behavior of men and taking real social, political, and economic leadership to back this up with

action. Violence is a male problem and it is time men started doing something about it rather than just paying it lip service. They can start by raising their sons to be better men. This task appears overwhelming but in reality many changes can be made that will immediately improve our global culture, from removing overt and gratuitous violence in sports, video games, movies, and television to provide a healthy and positive psychological environment for children and young adults to formulate their attitudes, values, and beliefs within, to addressing stereotypical images of women in the media. Rather than taking a laissez-faire attitude toward social expectations, we need to take an active and aggressive role through governments in setting collective human social standards for morality, business, religion, and education that deemphasize competitive violence, domination, and control. We need new political parties that focus on these goals to provide new options for the world. These patriarchal methods have a historical track record of dismal failure as a social strategy and need to be abandoned for ones that enfranchise rather than exclude. These are only a few of a myriad of changes that humankind must embark upon or face the demise of the human experience. The alternative is the extinction of the human species through nuclear conflagration or environmental degradation.

Patriarchy is the meta-ideology that has spawned all of our social institutions under the direct influence of men and is the source of the majority of our major social ills around the world, from wars and global conflict to gender relationships and domestic violence. It permeates and radiates from our religious, educational, political, and economic systems and our interpersonal relationships, but primarily it emanates from the arrogantly self-assumed superiority of men. Theorizing about patriarchy and change must include that diversity (Walby, 1990).

Patriarchy is a problem integrated in all aspects of society and must be addressed simultaneously across society if we are to succeed in blunting its influence. It saturates everything in our world. The first step to change is to give it a name, and that name is *patriarchy*. Nothing in our human universe, whether miniscule or major, escapes its conflicted and adversarial influence, and yet we rationalize and justify the host of problems it causes as a natural part of social evolution. It has burrowed its way into our social psyche and colonized our intellects. Its logic, authority, and practice continues to go unquestioned as we have internalized its ethos to the point that we do not question, challenge, or even believe that the world should or could be structured and orchestrated in any other way. We have become the perfect prisoners as Michel Foucault

(1995) documents in his work *Discipline and Punish: The Birth of the Prison*. We have absorbed the externalized authority and control of patriarchy to the point that it is no longer required to ensure its continuance and dominance—we reproduce and police it ourselves. In many ways this seems harmless and yet the potential for abuse is significant.

Patriarchy is the “new normal” in society much like being white is the invisible standard for race (Apple, 2006; Lerner, 1997). It is largely accepted with little sustained resistance by both men and women who play out their socially reproduced roles generation after generation without thinking about why these gender roles and socialization patterns exist and if they can or should be changed. As a human species we all prefer stasis to change, so we go with the flow in most cases. We accept authority, power, leadership, political governance, gender relationships, religious belief, and educational practice as realities that are random and coincidental rather than purposeful and contrived. We do all this at our ongoing peril, as this book has attempted to demonstrate.

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The Democratic Gulag is a provocative, comprehensive investigation of the pervasive and transparent power of patriarchy in contemporary society. It asserts that we live in a well-constructed social gulag of patriarchal values, beliefs, attitudes and behaviors that is created through the primary social institutions that we see as the foundations of modern civilization. The book is an in-depth academic study of the role of patriarchy in shaping modern social values and a comprehensive and contemporary cross-contextual analysis of the seminal role and paradoxes of patriarchy as the meta-ideology of human history. Employing the perspective of critical theory, it traces patriarchy through history to our contemporary world by examining its role in shaping democracy, education, religion, politics, economics, leadership and gender relationships. It suggests that rather than a social/historical curiosity, patriarchy is an under-theorized, active and virulent agent that continues to be the foundational source of our global social dysfunction. Without deconstructing and altering its ideological core as well as its complex and multi-disciplinary role in our present and future society, positive human social organization is unsustainable. It argues for the necessity of developing democratic and open leadership and governmental and personal relationships that will liberate humanity and create a post-patriarchal world.



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